

LilyPond Contemporary Notation Cookbook: Snippets and Their Grammars

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Contents

Foreword	viii
0.1 Preamble	viii
0.2 README	viii
0.3 Background	ix
0.4 How This Document Is Structured	x
0.5 LilyPond Version Used	x
0.6 AI/LLM Statement	xi
0.7 Acknowledgements	xi
1 Articulations	1
1.1 Accent-Staccato	1
1.1.1 Description	1
1.1.2 Grammar	1
1.1.3 Code	1
1.2 Accent-Tenuto	4
1.2.1 Description	4
1.2.2 Grammar	4
1.2.3 Code	4
1.3 Jeté (Ricochet)	6
1.3.1 Description	6
1.3.2 Grammar	6
1.3.3 Code	6
2 Beams	8
2.1 Wiggle Beam (zig-zag shaped beam)	8
2.1.1 Description	8
2.1.2 Grammar	8
2.1.3 Code	9
2.1.4 Discussion	13
3 Clefs	14
3.1 Piano Strings Clef	14
3.1.1 Description	14
3.1.2 Grammar	14
3.1.3 Code	15
3.2 String Position Clef	18

3.2.1	Description	18
3.2.2	Grammar	18
3.2.3	Code	18
3.2.4	Discussion	20
3.3	String Position Clef (revised)	22
3.3.1	Description	22
3.3.2	Grammar	22
3.3.3	Code	22
3.4	String Position Clef 2	26
3.4.1	Description	26
3.4.2	Grammar	26
3.4.3	Code	26
3.4.4	Discussion	28
3.5	String Position Clef 3a	29
3.5.1	Description	29
3.5.2	Grammar	29
3.5.3	Code	29
3.5.4	Discussion	32
3.6	String Position Clef 3b (Longer Span)	33
3.6.1	Description	33
3.6.2	Grammar	33
3.6.3	Code	33
3.6.4	Discussion	36
4	Dynamics	37
4.1	Dynamics in Quotation Marks	37
4.1.1	Description	37
4.1.2	Grammar	37
4.1.3	Code	37
4.1.4	Discussion	40
4.2	Enhanced Constante Hairpins I (Under The Staff)	41
4.2.1	Description	41
4.2.2	Grammar	41
4.2.3	Code	42
4.2.4	Discussion	52
4.3	Enhanced Constante Hairpins II (Over The Staff)	53
4.3.1	Description	53
4.3.2	Grammar	53
4.3.3	Code	54
4.3.4	Discussion	64
4.4	Enhanced Flared Hairpins I (Original Version)	65
4.4.1	Description	65
4.4.2	Grammar	66
4.4.3	Code	66
4.4.4	Discussion	86
4.5	Enhanced Flared Hairpins II (Curvy Version)	87
4.5.1	Description	87
4.5.2	Grammar	87

4.5.3	Code	88
4.5.4	Discussion	108
5	Noteheads	109
5.1	Jet Whistle (for flute) (deprecated)	109
5.1.1	Description	109
5.1.2	Grammar	109
5.1.3	Code	109
5.2	Jet Whistle (for flute) (Version 2)	111
5.2.1	Description	111
5.2.2	Grammar	111
5.2.3	Code	111
5.3	Line as a Notehead	113
5.3.1	Description	113
5.3.2	Grammar	113
5.3.3	Code	113
5.3.4	Discussion	116
5.4	Line as a Notehead 2	117
5.4.1	Description	117
5.4.2	Grammar	117
5.4.3	Code	117
5.5	Noteheadless	122
5.5.1	Description	122
5.5.2	Grammar	122
5.5.3	Code	122
5.5.4	Discussion	123
5.6	Slap Tongue, Type A	124
5.6.1	Description	124
5.6.2	Grammar	124
5.6.3	Code	124
5.7	Slap Tongue, Type B	125
5.7.1	Description	125
5.7.2	Grammar	125
5.7.3	Code	125
5.7.4	Discussion	125
5.8	Slashed Notehead	126
5.8.1	Description	126
5.8.2	Grammar	126
5.8.3	Code	126
5.9	Square Notehead	129
5.9.1	Description	129
5.9.2	Grammar	129
5.9.3	Code	129
5.10	Tone Cluster	131
5.10.1	Description	131
5.10.2	Grammar	131
5.10.3	Code	131
5.10.4	Discussion	134

5.11	Tongue Ram (for flute)	135
5.11.1	Description	135
5.11.2	Grammar	135
5.11.3	Code	135
5.11.4	Discussion	136
5.12	X In A Hollow Notehead	138
5.12.1	Description	138
5.12.2	Grammar	138
5.12.3	Code	138
6	Markups	140
6.1	Conducting Patterns	140
6.1.1	Description	140
6.1.2	Grammar	140
6.1.3	Code	140
6.2	Mute Sign	144
6.2.1	Description	144
6.2.2	Grammar	144
6.2.3	Code	144
7	Rhythm	146
7.1	Incomplete Tuplet Bracket for Irrational Time Signatures	146
7.1.1	Description	146
7.1.2	Grammar	146
7.1.3	Code	147
7.1.4	Discussion	148
7.2	Metric Modulation Equation (Regular Flag)	150
7.2.1	Description	150
7.2.2	Grammar	150
7.2.3	Code	151
7.3	Metric Modulation Equation (Straight Flag)	168
7.3.1	Description	168
7.3.2	Grammar	168
7.3.3	Code	169
8	Spanners	186
8.1	Arpeggio with Arrowhead and Vertical Hairpins	187
8.1.1	Description	187
8.1.2	Grammar	187
8.1.3	Code	188
8.2	Arrow Lines	193
8.2.1	Description	193
8.2.2	Grammar	193
8.2.3	Code	193
8.2.4	Discussion	196
8.3	Boulez Tie	198
8.3.1	Description	198
8.3.2	Grammar	198

8.3.3	Code	198
8.3.4	Discussion	199
8.4	Dashed Arrow Lines	200
8.4.1	Description	200
8.4.2	Grammar	200
8.4.3	Code	200
8.4.4	Discussion	203
8.5	Dashed Flat Slurs	204
8.5.1	Description	204
8.5.2	Grammar	204
8.5.3	Code	204
8.6	Flat Slurs	208
8.6.1	Description	208
8.6.2	Grammar	208
8.6.3	Code	208
8.6.4	Discussion	211
8.7	Grace Note Brackets I	212
8.7.1	Description	212
8.7.2	Grammar	212
8.7.3	Code	212
8.8	Grace Note Brackets II	217
8.8.1	Description	217
8.8.2	Grammar	217
8.8.3	Code	217
8.9	Tempo Arrows	222
8.9.1	Description	222
8.9.2	Grammar	222
8.9.3	Code	222
9	Staff Lines	226
9.1	Expanding, Shrinking and Bloated Staff Lines	226
9.1.1	Description	226
9.1.2	Grammar	226
9.1.3	Code	226
10	Stems	230
10.1	"M" on Stem	230
10.1.1	Description	230
10.1.2	Grammar	230
10.1.3	Code	230
10.2	Mute Sign on Stem	232
10.2.1	Description	232
10.2.2	Grammar	232
10.2.3	Code	232
10.3	"S" on Stem	235
10.3.1	Description	235
10.3.2	Grammar	235
10.3.3	Code	235

10.4	"V" on Stem	237
10.4.1	Description	237
10.4.2	Grammar	237
10.4.3	Code	237
11	Time Signatures	239
11.1	Fractional Time Signatures, Style A	240
11.1.1	Description	240
11.1.2	Grammar	240
11.1.3	Code	241
11.2	Fractional Time Signatures, Style B	246
11.2.1	Description	246
11.2.2	Grammar	246
11.2.3	Code	247
11.3	Fractional Time Signatures, Style C	253
11.3.1	Description	253
11.3.2	Grammar	253
11.3.3	Code	253
11.4	Compound Meter with Two Fractional Time Signatures, Style A	258
11.4.1	Description	258
11.4.2	Grammar	258
11.4.3	Code	258
11.4.4	Discussion	263
11.5	Compound Meter with Two Fractional Time Signatures, Style B	265
11.5.1	Description	265
11.5.2	Grammar	265
11.5.3	Code	265
11.5.4	Discussion	272
11.6	Compound Meter with Two Fractional Time Signatures, Style C	273
11.6.1	Description	273
11.6.2	Grammar	273
11.6.3	Code	273
11.6.4	Discussion	279
11.7	Compound Meter with Three Fractional Time Signatures, Style A	280
11.7.1	Description	280
11.7.2	Grammar	280
11.7.3	Code	280
11.7.4	Discussion	287
11.8	Compound Meter with Three Fractional Time Signatures, Style B	289
11.8.1	Description	289
11.8.2	Grammar	289
11.8.3	Code	289
11.8.4	Discussion	298
11.9	Compound Meter with Three Fractional Time Signatures, Style C	299
11.9.1	Description	299
11.9.2	Grammar	299
11.9.3	Code	299
11.9.4	Discussion	307

11.10 Time Signature with Decimals	308
11.10.1 Description	308
11.10.2 Grammar	308
11.10.3 Code	309
11.10.4 Discussion	312
12 Combinations	313
12.1 Prescriptive Notation for String Instruments	313
12.1.1 Description	313
12.1.2 Variables Used	313
12.1.3 Code	313
12.2 Multiple Instances Of Spanners At Once	319
12.2.1 Description	319
12.2.2 Variables Used	319
12.2.3 Code	319
13 Miscellanies	327
13.1 Shifting Staves, Rotated Clef and Time Signature	327
13.1.1 Description	327
13.1.2 Code	327
14 Exploring Scheme	330
14.1 Introduction	330
14.1.1 Step 1a: Focus on the Scheme Language Itself	330
14.1.2 Step 1b: Get Used to Prefix Notation	330
14.1.3 Step 2: Study Lots of Snippets	331
14.1.4 Step 3: Hack the Codes	333
14.2 Example 1: Creating a Time Signature with Its Compound Meter Form	336
14.2.1 Step 1: Analyze What Could Be Automatized	338
14.2.2 Step 2: Write the Code	338
Bibliography	341
Appendices	343
Appendix A: Resources	344

Foreword

0.1 Preamble

This document houses all the codes I built on LilyPond since September 2024. Because I deal with contemporary notations in my compositional practice, I found myself creating codes and turning them into variables in order to repeatedly use them in my projects. I created a dedicated `.ly` file to store these codes for use, which quickly became very lengthy. I thought it would be useful to organize them into a document where I could easily consult and remind myself what they are and how to use them. This is that document.

Because I use LilyPond actively in my daily compositional and musical typesetting activities, this document is a work in progress.

0.2 README

This document and the codes contained herein are under the MIT License. So long as you include the copyright as well as the MIT License permission notices, please feel free to use my codes in your LilyPond files or modify them according to your specific need. Furthermore, crediting in the following manner is greatly appreciated:

```
% Original Code written by Yoshiaki Onishi  
% https://github.com/yoshiakionishi/lilypond-snippets
```

I make this document public because I wish to return something useful to the LilyPond community, but also to seek and implement any improvements other users may find in my codes. Please feel free to reach out to the email address shown on the title page of this document.

In the interest of making the codes found in this document available to as many people as possible, I have avoided using copyrighted musical examples. However, wherever appropriate, I have provided bibliographical sources. Furthermore, I acknowledge that, just as academic work in humanities goes, my ideas are built on those that are formulated by others; as such, whenever there is a direct source of inspiration for formulating a code, I provide sources.

In creating this document, I make no claim that my notational choices represent an absolute standard that everyone should adhere to. Once the basic principles of notation and typesetting are established (e.g., avoiding collisions, etc.), notation becomes a personal decision for each composer, shaped by careful study of preexisting scores and an evaluation of their musical contexts.

For example, in his book *The Bass Clarinet – A Personal History*, Harry Sparnaay lists nine

variants of noteheads for the slap tongue technique.¹ In my work, I created two subcategories of the slap tongue technique: one followed by a pitch and another followed by an air sound (which produces the slap tongue effect that sounds “empty”). To distinguish between the two, I decided to use encircled noteheads—both filled and hollow—and attribute them to each subcategory. Again, this is a method that I have found works for my music, but I would be reluctant to suggest that others should follow the same.²

Readers are encouraged to modify my codes in order to suit their desired techniques. This document serves as a record of how I arrived at certain notational choices, because learning LilyPond meant that I would also need to become familiar with Scheme, which proved to be somewhat challenging—even though I have used Common Lisp before owing to programming in OpenMusic—because I had to make many guessworks as I navigated various Scheme codes in other snippets available online. I have also gained familiarity in PostScript language as I continued to familiarize myself with LilyPond.³

0.3 Background

After [MakeMusic](#) announced that they would cease development of the music notation software program [Finale](#), which I had used for the past twenty-four years, I decided to explore a few other music notation programs to determine the best alternative. At the time of writing this document in late November 2024, a little under three months have passed since I started using [LilyPond](#) for my daily typesetting needs. I now open LilyPond more often than Finale and am committed to using it for the foreseeable future. LilyPond appears to me as the way forward both as a composer and a musical typesetter, as other proprietary notation programs, such as Dorico (which MakeMusic has claimed to be the leading program in the industry) and Sibelius, fall short of what I wish to accomplish.

While LilyPond is “just” a music notation software program that I happened to choose, it is, in a way, more than a toolkit for a composer. It appears that way to me, at least, because choosing an open-source platform with strong community support and engagement, rather than a proprietary program where desired functionality is subject to the priorities of a small group of salaried developers, reflects a critique of the capitalist/commercialist mindset that often pervades a composer’s life.

For example, before transitioning to LilyPond, I briefly explored Dorico. However, as of late September 2024, its functionality for displaying straight flags was very limited; the angle of the straight flags provided by the software was too steep. I consulted the online forum and discovered that another user had posted a question similar to mine. The chief developer of Dorico responded to that post, noting that implementing improvements to this feature was possible but “not currently a high priority.”⁴ In this tiered structure typical of capitalism, composers may find themselves with increasingly limited creative “freedom.”

MakeMusic has heavily advertised on social media platforms that Finale users should migrate to Dorico because it is the “next industry standard.” However, this advertising seems to discourage

1. Harry Sparnaay, *The Bass Clarinet: A Personal History* (Periferia Sheet Music, 2012), 66.

2. This particular notation becomes quickly problematic in terms of rhythmic notation when a bar is longer than a half note (e.g. 1/2, 2/4, 4/8...) For this reason, I tend to favor time signatures that avoids the use of a half note, such as 3/8 or 5/16.

3. See Appendix A for some resources I referred to for Scheme- and PostScript-related matters.

4. See: <https://forums.steinberg.net/t/straight-flags-angle/766503>.

thoughtful consideration of alternatives, leaving little room for reflection or exploration. I became increasingly disillusioned as I witnessed the coercion to invest in a program—however exciting it may appear—with no definite promise of its long-term security and stability.

Of course, it is not my intent to claim that all composers should abandon their proprietary programs of choice, particularly those they have invested money in and/or have been using for many years. It is, however, important to note that:

1. All proprietary programs are at the mercy of the executives who run the companies behind them. “Oh, [insert the name of a proprietary program] is operated by [insert the name of its company], and I just don’t see them closing the program down,” someone might say. Yet, it happened to Finale.
2. All notation programs, owing to the ways they operate, exert some degree of influence on the way composers compose. As early as the 1980s, Finale’s *Mass Mover*, *Note Mover*, and MIDI playback features were already influential in shaping the way composers worked on their music.⁵ On the one hand, these features may have helped composers save time. On the other hand, their ready availability may have invited overuse.
3. The lack or underdevelopment of certain functionalities may also push composers to work in certain ways rather than others. Finale benefitted from having the flexibility to implement graphical notation, but even then, many of my composer friends found it practical to use external graphical editing programs to further refine their scores. Even from my personal experience using Finale, I encountered situations where I had to devise creative alternatives to meet my notational goals.

These points implicitly highlight the benefits of learning an additional notation program, ideally an open-source one, alongside the program one primarily uses. LilyPond resonated with me most because of its text-based interface, which I have become increasingly familiar with through my involvement in computer programming. As other users have remarked, I have also found it to be very flexible and extensible. All the snippets I list in this document can be reused with relative ease, allowing me to save time in the long run when using specialized notations in my music. This was not necessarily the case when working on the music notation of extended techniques in Finale.

0.4 How This Document Is Structured

Each chapter of this document addresses a specific element of music notation, such as noteheads, stems, beams, and so on. Some chapters, however, cover topics specific to LilyPond coding, such as Markups and Spanners. Snippets that use more than one snippet covered in earlier chapters, thus simulating practical applications of these snippets, are covered in the chapter *Combinations*. Snippets that do not appear to belong to earlier chapters find their home in the chapter *Miscellanies*.

Each snippet entry includes a musical example, a description, the relevant grammar, the code required for the snippet to function, and, whenever necessary, a “Discussion” section.

0.5 LilyPond Version Used

The version of LilyPond used to create these snippets is 2.26.0.

5. For example, watch from 15:20 of <https://youtu.be/T1IRlg87Qks>.

0.6 AI/LLM Statement

In coming up with the codes found in this document, I did not use commercially available AI Chatbot or Assistant. I underwent many hours of trials and errors (mostly errors) on each of the codes to create them. When I am stuck, which happens all the time, I refer to the LilyPond Manuals, as well as manuals for programming languages Scheme and PostScript. I have consulted other manuals that are relevant to the creation of these codes as appropriate. Sometimes I ask skilled programmers in the mailing list `lilypond-user` for help and hint. I primarily consult examples found on, among others, [lilypond-user mailing list](#) and [LilyPond Wiki Website](#). When I quote/reuse significant portion of the code or the idea that may be considered non-trivial, I credit them in my codes.

0.7 Acknowledgements

I thank the supportive community of LilyPond users, whose exchanges on `lilypond-user` mailing list have inspired me greatly.

Even though I have not met him, I am grateful to Ben Lemon for his generosity in creating and sharing his LilyPond tutorial videos on YouTube. These videos were immensely helpful during the initial stages of learning LilyPond.

I also want to thank my friends who inspired me to start using LilyPond. It was Cole Ingraham who first introduced me to the program in 2016. My initial attempt at using it was not successful, but more recently, Santiago Beis composed and typeset his orchestral piece *Spletna* entirely in LilyPond, which compelled me to give it another try.

I extend my gratitude to my former composition students at the University of Delaware School of Music, with whom I embarked on this journey of learning LilyPond. Even though they were not directly affected by Finale's discontinuation, they remained curious and enthusiastic about exploring this program. I hope that if the programs of their choice ever face a fate similar to Finale (though I sincerely hope they do not), they will be better equipped to adapt without the annoyance and arduous work often associated with transitioning to a new tool.

[Table of Contents](#)

Chapter 1

Articulations

1.1 Accent-Staccato



1.1.1 Description

While *accent-staccato* is not specific to contemporary music, in LilyPond, specifying accent and staccato via `->-` could cause the two articulation marks to be separated from each other. This happens because of the default setting for accents is to have them placed *outside* the staff line. For example, if you wrote `\stemUp g' '->-`, the following results:



This code implements a combination of the music glyphs `scripts.sforzato` and `scripts.staccato` as one entity.

1.1.2 Grammar

```
NOTE \accentStaccato
NOTE \accentStaccatoUp
NOTE \accentStaccatoDown
```

1.1.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 #(append! default-script-alist
4           (list
5             `(accentStaccatoUp
6               . (
```

```

7          (stencil . ,ly:text-interface::print)
8          (text . ,#{ \markup
9
10
11              \center-align
12              \combine \musicglyph "scripts.sforzato"
13              \translate #'(0 . -0.75)
14              \musicglyph "scripts.staccato"
15              #})
16          ; any other properties
17          (toward-stem-shift-in-column . 1.0)
18          (outside-staff-priority . #t)
19          (padding . 0.5)
20          (avoid-slur . around)
21          (side-axis . ,RIGHT)
22          ; new in 2.26.0, side-axis value needs to be specified
23          (direction . ,UP))))
24
25      (list
26        `(accentStaccatoDown
27          . (
28            (stencil . ,ly:text-interface::print)
29            (text . ,#{ \markup \center-align
30              \combine \musicglyph "scripts.staccato"
31              \translate #'(0 . -0.75)
32              \musicglyph "scripts.sforzato"
33              #})
34            ; any other properties
35            (toward-stem-shift-in-column . 1.0)
36            (outside-staff-priority . #t)
37            (padding . 0.5)
38            (avoid-slur . around)
39            (side-axis . ,RIGHT)
40            ; new in 2.26.0, side-axis value needs to be specified
41            (direction . ,DOWN))))))
42
43      accentStaccato = #(make-articulation 'accentStaccatoUp)
44      accentStaccatoUp = #(make-articulation 'accentStaccatoUp)
45      accentStaccatoDown = #(make-articulation 'accentStaccatoDown)
46
47
48      {
49        \override Staff.TimeSignature.stencil = ##f
50        \time 5/4
51
52        c'4\accentStaccato c'4 \accentStaccatoDown c''\accentStaccatoUp
53        \stopStaff
54        \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions = #'(4 -4)

```

```
55 \startStaff
56
57 \stemUp g' \tweak Y-offset #1.5 \accentStaccatoDown
58 \stemDown d' \tweak Y-offset #-0.5 \accentStaccatoUp
59 }
```

[Table of Contents](#)

1.2 Accent-Tenuto



1.2.1 Description

For the same rationale as explained in the [Accent-Staccato](#) entry, this code implements a combination of the music glyphs `scripts.sforzato` and `scripts.tenuto` as one entity.

1.2.2 Grammar

```
NOTE \accentTenuto
NOTE \accentTenutoUp
NOTE \accentTenutoDown
```

1.2.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 #(append! default-script-alist
4   (list
5     `(accentTenutoUp
6       . (
7         (stencil . ,ly:text-interface::print)
8         (text . ,#{ \markup
9
10
11           \center-align
12           \combine \musicglyph "scripts.sforzato"
13           \translate #'(0 . -0.75)
14           \musicglyph "scripts.tenuto"
15           #})
16       ; any other properties
17       (toward-stem-shift-in-column . 1.0)
18       (outside-staff-priority . #t)
19       (padding . 0.5)
20       (avoid-slur . around)
21       (side-axis . ,RIGHT)
22       ; new in 2.26.0, side-axis value needs to be specified
23       (direction . ,UP))))
24
25 (list
26   `(accentTenutoDown
27     . (
28       (stencil . ,ly:text-interface::print)
29       (text . ,#{ \markup \center-align
```

```

30             \combine \musicglyph "scripts.tenuto"
31             \translate #'(0 . -0.75)
32             \musicglyph "scripts.sforzato"
33             #})
34         ; any other properties
35         (toward-stem-shift-in-column . 1.0)
36         (outside-staff-priority . #t)
37         (padding . 0.5)
38         (avoid-slur . around)
39         (side-axis . ,RIGHT)
40         ; new in 2.26.0, side-axis value needs to be specified
41         (direction . ,DOWN))))))
42
43 accentTenuto = #(make-articulation 'accentTenutoUp)
44 accentTenutoUp = #(make-articulation 'accentTenutoUp)
45 accentTenutoDown = #(make-articulation 'accentTenutoDown)
46
47
48 {
49   \override Staff.TimeSignature.stencil = ##f
50   \time 5/4
51
52   c'4\accentTenuto c'4 \accentTenutoDown c''\accentTenutoUp
53   \stopStaff
54   \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions = #'(4 -4)
55   \startStaff
56
57   \stemUp g'' \tweak Y-offset #1.5 \accentTenutoDown
58   \stemDown d' \tweak Y-offset #-0.5 \accentTenutoUp
59 }

```

[Table of Contents](#)

1.3 Jeté (Ricochet)



1.3.1 Description

I use this notation to designate jeté/ricochet for string instruments, adding that the number of bounces are undetermined.¹

I apply this indication *above* the note regardless of how high or low the note is; however, in case of need, I have supplied the version to be used *under* the note.

1.3.2 Grammar

```
NOTE \jete
NOTE \jeteUp
NOTE \jeteDown
```

1.3.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 jeteDesign =
4 \markup
5 \center-align
6 \combine \combine \combine
7 \override #'(filled . #t)
8 \path #0.1
9 #'((moveto -0.25 0.5)
10 (curveto 0.35 1.1 0.85 1.1 1.45 0.5)
11 (curveto 0.85 0.8 0.35 0.8 -0.25 0.5)
12 (closepath))
13 \draw-circle #0.2 #0 ##t
14 \translate #'(0.6 . 0) \draw-circle #0.2 #0 ##t
15 \translate #'(1.2 . 0)\draw-circle #0.2 #0 ##t
16 #(append! default-script-alist
17 (list
18   \jetelistUp
19   . (
20     (stencil . ,ly:text-interface::print)
21     (text . ,#{ \markup \jeteDesign #})
22     ; any other properties
23     (toward-stem-shift-in-column . 1.0)
24     (outside-staff-priority . #t)
```

1. Concerning the technique of adding articulation designs to an internal alist, I was inspired by the following thread on lilypond-user mailing list: <https://lists.gnu.org/archive/html/lilypond-user/2015-04/msg00105.html>

```

25         (padding . 0.5)
26         (avoid-slur . around)
27         (side-axis . ,RIGHT)
28         ; new in 2.26.0, side-axis value needs to be specified
29         (direction . ,UP))))
30
31     (list
32     `(jetelistDown
33       . (
34         (stencil . ,ly:text-interface::print)
35         (text . ,#{ \markup \rotate #180 \jeteDesign #})
36         ; any other properties
37         (toward-stem-shift-in-column . 1.0)
38         (outside-staff-priority . #t)
39         (padding . 0.5)
40         (avoid-slur . around)
41         (side-axis . ,RIGHT)
42         ; new in 2.26.0, side-axis value needs to be specified
43         (direction . ,DOWN))))))
44
45     jete = #(make-articulation 'jetelistUp)
46     jeteUp = #(make-articulation 'jetelistUp)
47     jeteDown = #(make-articulation 'jetelistDown)
48
49
50     {c'4\jete c'4 \jeteDown c''\jeteUp }
51

```

Table of Contents

Chapter 2

Beams

2.1 Wiggle Beam (zig-zag shaped beam)



2.1.1 Description

Ordinary beams are replaced with zig-zag beams. A set of forward then backward beams are printed in the amount specified in the argument. I use this notation in such pieces as *jeux enjeux* (2022) for brass quintet, in order to designate somewhat uneven rhythmic figures, which are nonetheless to be played within the time frame indicated.

`\wiggleBeamOne` replaces an 8th-note beam.

`\wiggleBeamTwo` replaces a 16th-note beam.

`\wiggleBeamThree` replaces a 32nd-note beam.

`\wiggleBeam_markup` adds a zig-zag beam at will. This allows beaming of mixed note durations, such as:



`\wiggleBeamStemAdjust` allows the adjustment of a stem length, in the event the wiggle beam and the stem do not touch each other.

2.1.2 Grammar

```
\wiggleBeamOne #vOffset #howMany #width #rotation  
\wiggleBeamTwo #vOffset #howMany #width #rotation  
\wiggleBeamThree #vOffset #howMany #width #rotation
```

NB

- `hOffset` = (`\wiggleBeam_markup` only) the horizontal offset value originating from where the ordinary beam is placed.

- `vOffset` = the vertical offset value originating from where the ordinary beam is placed.
- `howMany` = how many "wiggles" to print. It only accepts integers.
- `width` = how wide each "wiggle" should appear. When in doubt, start with `#1`.
- `rotation` = a positive value would rotate the beam upward, and the negative value would rotate the beam downward.

NOTE `\wiggleBeam_markup #hOffset #vOffset #howMany #width #rotation`

NB

- `hOffset` = the horizontal offset value originating from where the ordinary beam is placed.
- `vOffset` = the vertical offset value originating from where an above-staff markup is placed. Thus, `#0` would place a wiggle beam above the staff line.
- `howMany` = how many "wiggles" to print. It only accepts integers.
- `width` = how wide each "wiggle" should appear. When in doubt, start with `#1`.
- `rotation` = a positive value would rotate the beam upward, and the negative value would rotate the beam downward.
- More than one `\wiggleBeam_markup` may be added in sequence, provided that for each instance all the arguments are defined.

`\wiggleBeamStemAdjust #fromMiddleLine #howFar` NOTE

NB

- `fromMiddleLine` = (`\wiggleBeamStemAdjust` only) = determines one end of the stem, `#0` being the middle line of an ordinary 5-line staff.
- `howFar` = (`\wiggleBeamStemAdjust` only) = computes how long the stem should be extended. A positive value would draw the stem upward, and a negative value would draw the stem downward. An integer corresponds to the distance between two staff lines of an ordinary 5-line staff.

2.1.3 Code

```

1 \version "2.26.0"
2 \language "english"
3
4 wiggleBeamOne =
5 #(define-music-function (vOffset howMany howWide howTilted)
6   (number? number? number? number?) #{
7   \once \override Voice.Beam.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
8   \once \override Voice.Beam.text = \markup {
9     \translate #(cons 0 vOffset)
10    \postscript #(string-append

```

```

11         "newpath
12         1 setlinejoin
13         1 setlinecap
14         0.35 setlinewidth
15         0.13 0 moveto "
16         (number->string howMany)
17         " {" (number->string (* 0.6 howWide)) " "
18         (number->string (+ 0.5 howTilted)) " rlineto "
19         (number->string (* 0.6 howWide))
20         " -0.5 rlineto} repeat
21     stroke"
22     )
23
24 }
25 #})
26
27
28 wiggleBeamTwo =
29 #(define-music-function (vOffset howMany howWide howTilted )
30   (number? number? number? number?) #{
31     \once \override Voice.Beam.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
32     \once \override Voice.Beam.text = \markup {
33       \translate #(cons 0 vOffset)
34       \postscript #(string-append
35         "newpath
36         1 setlinejoin
37         1 setlinecap
38         0.35 setlinewidth
39         0.13 0 moveto "
40         (number->string howMany)
41         " {" (number->string (* 0.6 howWide)) " "
42         (number->string (+ 0.5 howTilted)) " rlineto "
43         (number->string (* 0.6 howWide))
44         " -0.5 rlineto} repeat
45         stroke newpath
46         0.35 setlinewidth
47         1 setlinejoin
48         0.13 -0.75 moveto "
49         (number->string howMany)
50         " {" (number->string (* 0.6 howWide)) " "
51         (number->string (+ 0.5 howTilted)) " rlineto "
52         (number->string (* 0.6 howWide))
53         " -0.5 rlineto} repeat
54         stroke"
55         )
56     }
57     #})
58

```

```

59
60 wiggleBeamThree =
61 #(define-music-function (vOffset howMany howWide howTilted )
62   (number? number? number? number?)
63   #{
64     \once \override Voice.Beam.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
65     \once \override Voice.Beam.text = \markup          {
66       \translate #(cons 0 vOffset)
67       \postscript #(string-append
68         "newpath
69         1 setlinejoin
70         1 setlinecap
71         0.35 setlinewidth
72         0.13 0 moveto "
73         (number->string howMany) " {"
74         (number->string (* 0.6 howWide)) " "
75         (number->string (+ 0.5 howTilted)) " rlineto "
76         (number->string (* 0.6 howWide))
77         " -0.5 rlineto} repeat
78       stroke
79       newpath
80       0.35 setlinewidth
81       1 setlinejoin
82       0.13 -0.75 moveto "
83       (number->string howMany) " {"
84       (number->string (* 0.6 howWide)) " "
85       (number->string (+ 0.5 howTilted)) " rlineto "
86       (number->string (* 0.6 howWide))
87       " -0.5 rlineto} repeat
88       stroke
89       newpath
90       0.35 setlinewidth
91       1 setlinejoin
92       0.13 -1.5 moveto "
93       (number->string howMany) " {"
94       (number->string (* 0.6 howWide)) " "
95       (number->string (+ 0.5 howTilted)) " rlineto "
96       (number->string (* 0.6 howWide))
97       " -0.5 rlineto} repeat
98       stroke"
99     )
100   }
101   #})
102
103
104 wiggleBeam_markup =
105 #(define-music-function (hOffset vOffset howMany howWide howTilted )
106   (number? number? number? number? number?)

```



```

107   #{
108   ^\markup      {
109     \translate #(cons hOffset vOffset)
110     \postscript #(string-append
111       "newpath
112       1 setlinejoin
113       1 setlinecap
114       0.35 setlinewidth
115       0.17 0 moveto "
116       (number->string howMany) " {"
117       (number->string (* 0.6 howWide)) " "
118       (number->string (+ 0.5 howTilted)) " rlineto "
119       (number->string (* 0.6 howWide))
120       " -0.5 rlineto} repeat
121       stroke"
122     )
123
124   }
125   #})
126
127 wobbleBeamStemAdjust =
128 #(define-music-function (fromMiddleLine howFar)
129   (number? number?)
130   #{
131     \once \override Stem.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
132     \once \override Stem.text = \markup {
133       \postscript #(string-append
134         "newpath
135         0.12 setlinewidth
136         0 " (number->string fromMiddleLine) " moveto
137         0 " (number->string howFar) " rlineto
138         stroke"
139       )
140     }
141     #})
142
143
144 {
145   \wobbleBeamTwo #0 #9 #1.01 #0 c'16 c'
146   \wobbleBeamStemAdjust #-3 #3.4 c' c'
147   \wobbleBeamTwo #0 #5 #1.82 #0 g''
148   \wobbleBeamStemAdjust #2.5 #-3 g''
149   \wobbleBeamStemAdjust #2.5 #-3 g'' g''
150   \wobbleBeamTwo #-1 #9 #1.01 #-0.15 f''
151   \wobbleBeamStemAdjust #1.5 #-3.5 e''
152   \wobbleBeamStemAdjust #1 #-3.5 d''
153   \wobbleBeamStemAdjust #0.5 #-3.5 c''
154   \wobbleBeamOne #-3.5 #5 #1.4 #0.15 b'8

```

```

155 c''16 \wobbleBeam_markup #0 #-4.8 #2 #1.4 #0.15 d''
156 \wobbleBeamThree #-1.3 #19 #0.73 #0 g''32
157 \wobbleBeamStemAdjust #1.5 #-4 e''
158 \wobbleBeamStemAdjust #0.5 #-3 c'' g'' e''
159 \wobbleBeamStemAdjust #0.5 #-3 c''
160 \wobbleBeamStemAdjust #2.5 #-5 g'' e''
161 \bar ".."
162 }

```

2.1.4 Discussion

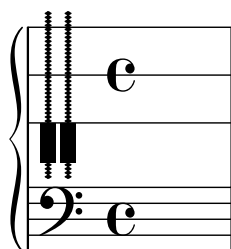
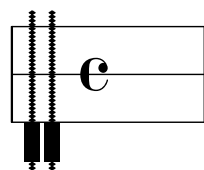
1. Admittedly, while the current setup allows great flexibility in making the wiggle beams appear, it is entirely possible that some of the parameters be automated.
2. When using many wiggle beams, it may be easier to make the score proportionally notated, in order to avoid the micromanagement of the parameters.

[Table of Contents](#)

Chapter 3

Clefs

3.1 Piano Strings Clef



3.1.1 Description

In tandem with the customized staff lines, this clef indicates the position(s) of the piano strings to be manipulated by hand inside the piano. The clef shows two piano strings with grooves (intended for low piano strings), as well as their dampers, indicated by the filled rectangles.

3.1.2 Grammar

```
\stopStaff
\pianoStringMutingChartClefStaff
\startStaff
...
\stopStaff
\pianoStaffRevert
\startStaff
```

3.1.3 Code

```

1  \version "2.26.0"
2
3  pianoStrings = #(ly:make-stencil (list
4                                     'embedded-ps
5                                     "gsave
6
7  /groove {
8    0.1 setlinewidth
9    0 0 0.5 -0.125 0 -0.25 rcurveto
10   closepath
11   fill
12 } def
13
14 /reversegroove {
15   0.1 setlinewidth
16   0 0 -0.5 -0.125 0 -0.25 rcurveto
17   closepath
18   fill
19
20 } def
21
22 /stringshape {
23   currentpoint translate
24   newpath
25   0.15 setlinewidth
26   0.5 5 moveto
27   0 -10.5 rlineto
28   stroke
29
30
31   5 -0.25 -5.25 { /i exch def
32   newpath
33   0.5 i moveto
34   groove } for
35
36   5 -0.25 -5.25 { /i exch def
37   newpath
38   0.5 i moveto
39   reversegroove
40   } for
41
42   newpath
43   0 3 translate
44   0 -5 moveto
45   0 -2.5 rlineto
46   1 0 rlineto

```

```

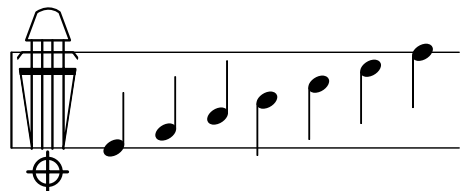
47 0 2.5 rlineto
48 closepath
49 fill
50 } def
51
52 stringshape
53 0 0 moveto
54 1.25 -3 rmoveto
55 stringshape
56
57
58
59 grestore
60 ")
61                                     (cons 2 0)
62                                     (cons 7.5 -7.5))
63
64 clefSpace = #(ly:make-stencil "" (cons -0 0 ) (cons 0 3) )
65
66 pianoStringMutingChartClefDesign =
67 #(ly:stencil-add
68   (ly:stencil-translate pianoStrings (cons 0 0))
69   (ly:stencil-translate clefSpace (cons 2 0))
70   (ly:stencil-translate clefSpace (cons 0 -5)
71     ;adjust the numbers for second 'space' to
72     ;vertically adjust the alignment
73   )
74 )
75
76
77
78
79 pianoStringMutingChartClefStaff = {
80   \override Staff.Clef.stencil = \pianoStringMutingChartClefDesign
81   \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions = #'(6 0 -6)
82   % \override Staff.Clef.show-horizontal-skylines = ##t
83   % \override Staff.Clef.show-vertical-skylines = ##t
84   \override Staff.NoteHead.no-ledgers = ##t
85 }
86
87 pianoStaffRevert = {
88   \revert Staff.Clef.stencil
89   \revert Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions
90   % \override Staff.Clef.show-horizontal-skylines = ##t
91   % \override Staff.Clef.show-vertical-skylines = ##t
92   \revert Staff.NoteHead.no-ledgers
93 }
94

```

```
95
96
97 \new Staff {
98
99   \stopStaff
100   \pianoStringMutingChartClefStaff
101   \startStaff
102   s1
103
104 }
105
106
107
108 \new PianoStaff <<
109   \new Staff {
110     \stopStaff
111     \pianoStringMutingChartClefStaff
112     \startStaff
113     s1
114   }
115   \new Staff {
116     \clef "F" s1
117   }
118 >>
119
```

[Table of Contents](#)

3.2 String Position Clef



3.2.1 Description

String position clef to indicate bowing position. See Discussion for the associated command, `\normalClef`.

3.2.2 Grammar

`\stringPositionClef`

3.2.3 Code

```

1  \version "2.26.0"
2
3  \pointAndClickOff
4  stringPositionClefDesign =
5  #(ly:make-stencil (list 'embedded-ps
6                        "gsave
7  currentpoint translate
8  /fingboardpath
9  {
10 newpath
11
12 -0.55 7.5 moveto
13 0 -3 rlineto
14 1 -6.5 rlineto
15 -1 -1 rlineto
16 0 -3 rlineto
17 4.1 0 rlineto
18 0 3 rlineto
19 -1 1 rlineto
20 1 6.5 rlineto
21 0 3 rlineto
22 closepath
23
24 } def
25
26 fingboardpath clip
27 newpath
28 0.15 setlinewidth

```

```
29 0.5 4.75 moveto
30 0 -6.8 rlineto
31 -0.75 5 rlineto
32 3.5 0 rlineto
33 -0.75 -5 rlineto
34 0. 6.8 rlineto
35 stroke
36 0.35 setlinewidth
37 -0.4 2.75 moveto
38 3.75 0 rlineto
39 stroke
40
41 %inner two line
42 newpath
43 0.15 setlinewidth
44 1.16 4.75 moveto
45 0. -6.8 rlineto
46 1.8 4.75 moveto
47 0. -6.8 rlineto
48 stroke
49
50 %bridge
51 newpath
52 -0.4 3.6 moveto
53 0.3 0.4 rlineto
54 3.2 0 rlineto
55 0.3 -0.4 rlineto
56 stroke
57
58 %tailpiece
59 0.15 4.75 moveto
60 1 setlinecap
61 1 setlinejoin
62 2.75 0 rlineto
63 -0.65 1.75 rlineto
64 -0 -0 -0.6 0.55 -1.45 0 rcurveto
65 closepath
66 stroke
67
68 %mutesign
69 newpath
70 0.2 setlinewidth
71 1 setlinecap
72 1.5 -2.25 moveto
73 0 -2.5 rlineto
74 0.25 -3.5 moveto
75 2.5 0 rlineto
76 stroke
```



```

77 newpath
78 1.5 -3.5 0.85 0 360 arc
79 stroke
80 grestore")
81             (cons 0 3)
82             (cons 0 1))
83
84 stringPositionClefSize =
85 #(lambda (grob)
86   (let* ((sPCS (ly:grob-property grob 'font-size 0.0))
87         (mult (magstep sPCS)))
88     (ly:stencil-scale
89      stringPositionClef
90      mult mult)))
91
92 stringPositionClef = {
93   \override Staff.Clef.stencil = \stringPositionClefDesign
94 }
95
96 normalClef = {
97   \revert Staff.Clef.stencil
98 }
99
100 {
101   \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions = #'(6 -6)
102   \override Staff.LedgerLineSpanner.stencil = ##f
103   \override Staff.TimeSignature.stencil = ##f
104   \override Staff.BarLine.stencil = ##f
105   \stringPositionClef c'4^\markup {
106     \translate #'(-3 . 2)
107     \musicglyph "space"
108   }
109   _\markup {
110     \translate #'(-3 . -3)
111     \musicglyph "space"
112   }
113   e' g' b' d'' f'' a''
114 }

```

3.2.4 Discussion

1. With the current design, `c'` would place a note at the lower end of the fingerboard. `a''` would place a note on the same line as the bridge.
2. The current design comes with the mute sign. If the mute sign is not needed, remove the following portion of the code above:

```

64 %mutesign
65 newpath

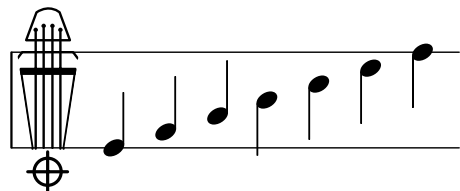
```

```
66 0.2 setlinewidth
67 1 setlinecap
68 1.5 -2.25 moveto
69 0 -2.5 rlineto
70 0.25 -3.5 moveto
71 2.5 0 rlineto
72 stroke
73 newpath
74 1.5 -3.5 0.85 0 360 arc
75 stroke
```

3. Once `\stringPositionClef` is used, in order to revert back to the normal clef, `\normalClef` must be used.
4. See [Prescriptive Notation for String Instruments](#) for a possible use of this clef.

[Table of Contents](#)

3.3 String Position Clef (revised)



3.3.1 Description

This is a revised version of the [String Position Clef](#), where the fine-tuner pins are graphically represented, as well as the four strings are arranged tighter than the previous version.

3.3.2 Grammar

`\stringPositionClef`

3.3.3 Code

```

1  \version "2.26.0"
2
3  % revision june 16 2026
4
5  stringPositionClefDesignRev =
6  #(ly:make-stencil (list 'embedded-ps
7                        "gsave
8  currentpoint translate
9  /fingboardpath
10 {
11
12 newpath
13 %0 1 .7 0 setcmykcolor
14 -0.5 7.5 moveto
15 0 -3 rlineto
16 1 -6.5 rlineto
17 -1 -1 rlineto
18 0 -3 rlineto
19 4.05 0 rlineto
20 0 3 rlineto
21 -1 1 rlineto
22 1 6.5 rlineto
23 0 3 rlineto
24 closepath
25
26 } def
27
28 % fingboardpath

```

```
29  fingboardpath clip
30
31  newpath
32  0.15 setlinewidth
33  0.75 5.25 moveto
34  0 -7.3 rlineto
35  -0.2 0 rmoveto
36  -0.75 5 rlineto
37  3.45 0 rlineto
38  -0.75 -5 rlineto
39  -0.2 0 rmoveto
40  0. 7.3 rlineto
41  stroke
42  0.35 setlinewidth
43  -0.4 2.75 moveto
44  3.75 0 rlineto
45  stroke
46
47  %inner two lines
48  newpath
49  0.15 setlinewidth
50  1.25 5.5 moveto
51  0. -7.5 rlineto
52  1.8 5.5 moveto
53  0. -7.5 rlineto
54  stroke
55
56
57  %finetuner pins
58  0.75 5.4 0.14 0 360 arc
59  fill
60  1.25 5.65 0.14 0 360 arc
61  fill
62  1.8 5.65 0.14 0 360 arc
63  fill
64  2.3 5.4 0.14 0 360 arc
65  fill
66
67
68
69  %bridge
70  newpath
71  -0.4 3.6 moveto
72  0.3 0.4 rlineto
73  3.2 0 rlineto
74  0.3 -0.4 rlineto
75  stroke
76
```

```

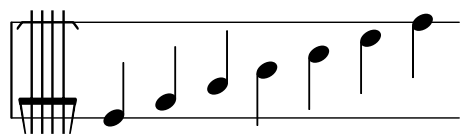
77 %tailpiece
78 0.15 4.75 moveto
79 1 setlinecap
80 1 setlinejoin
81 2.75 0 rlineto
82 -0.65 1.75 rlineto
83 -0 -0 -0.6 0.55 -1.45 0 rcurveto
84 closepath
85 stroke
86
87 %mute sign, delete if not needed
88 newpath
89 0.2 setlinewidth
90 1 setlinecap
91 1.5 -2.25 moveto
92 0 -2.5 rlineto
93 0.25 -3.5 moveto
94 2.5 0 rlineto
95 stroke
96 newpath
97 1.5 -3.5 0.85 0 360 arc
98 stroke
99
100 grestore")
101             (cons 0 3)
102             (cons 0 1))
103
104
105
106 stringPositionClefDesignRev = {
107   \override Staff.Clef.stencil =
108   \stringPositionClefDesignRev
109 }
110
111 normalClef = {
112   \revert Staff.Clef.stencil
113 }
114
115 {
116   \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions = #'(6 -6)
117   \override Staff.LedgerLineSpanner.stencil = ##f
118   \override Staff.TimeSignature.stencil = ##f
119   \override Staff.BarLine.stencil = ##f
120   \stringPositionClefDesignRev c'4^\markup {
121     \translate #'(-3 . 2)
122     \musicglyph "space"
123   }
124   _\markup {

```

```
125     \translate #'(-3 . -3)
126     \musicglyph "space"
127   }
128   e' g' b' d'' f'' a''
129 }
```

[Table of Contents](#)

3.4 String Position Clef 2



3.4.1 Description

String position clef to indicate bowing position, but this one provides more space between bridge and the edge of the fingerboard, allowing the visual-timbre correspondence between *sul ponticello* and *sul tasto*.

3.4.2 Grammar

`\stringPositionClef_two`

3.4.3 Code

```

1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 \pointAndClickOff
4 stringPositionClefDesign_two =
5 #(ly:make-stencil (list 'embedded-ps
6                      "gsave
7   currentpoint translate
8   /fingboardpath
9   {
10
11   newpath
12   -0.45 4.75 moveto
13   0 -5 rlineto
14   0.5 -2.75 rlineto
15   2.9 0 rlineto
16   0.5 2.75 rlineto
17   0 5 rlineto
18   closepath
19   } def
20
21   fingboardpath clip
22   newpath
23   0.15 setlinewidth
24   0.5 8 moveto
25   0 -13.8 rlineto
26   -0.75 5 rlineto
27   3.5 0 rlineto

```

```

28 -0.75 -5 rlineto
29 0 11 rlineto
30 stroke
31 0.35 setlinewidth
32 -0.4 -1 moveto
33 3.75 0 rlineto
34 stroke
35
36 %inner two line
37 newpath
38 0.15 setlinewidth
39 1.16 4.75 moveto
40 0. -7.75 rlineto
41 1.8 4.75 moveto
42 0. -7.75 rlineto
43 stroke
44
45 %bridge
46 newpath
47 -0.4 3.6 moveto
48 0.3 0.4 rlineto
49 3.2 0 rlineto
50 0.3 -0.4 rlineto
51 stroke
52
53 grestore")
54             (cons 0 3)
55             (cons 0 1))
56
57 stringPositionClef_two = {
58   \override Staff.Clef.stencil =
59   \stringPositionClefDesign_two
60 }
61
62 normalClef = {
63   \revert Staff.Clef.stencil
64 }
65
66 {
67   \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions = #'(6 -6)
68   \override Staff.LedgerLineSpanner.stencil = ##f
69   \override Staff.TimeSignature.stencil = ##f
70   \override Staff.BarLine.stencil = ##f
71   \stringPositionClef_two c'4^\markup {
72     \translate #'(-3 . 2)
73     \musicglyph "space"
74   }
75   _\markup {

```



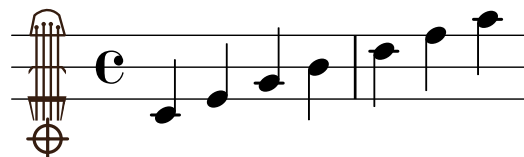
```
76    \translate #'(-3 . -3)
77    \musicglyph "space"
78    }
79    e' g' b' d'' f'' a''
80    }
```

3.4.4 Discussion

1. With the current design, `c'` would place a note at the lower end of the fingerboard. `a''` would place a note on the same line as the bridge.
2. Once `\stringPositionClef_two` is used, in order to revert back to the normal clef, `\normalClef` must be used.

[Table of Contents](#)

3.5 String Position Clef 3a



3.5.1 Description

In contrast to the two types of String Position Clefs introduced earlier, this clef helps facilitate the showing of the positions between the edge of the fingerboard and bridge, as well as between the bridge and the edge of the tailpiece.

3.5.2 Grammar

`\stringPositionClef_three`

3.5.3 Code

```

1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 stringPositionClef_three_Design =
4 #(ly:make-stencil (list 'embedded-ps
5                       "gsave
6   currentpoint translate
7   /fingboardpath
8   {
9     newpath
10    0 1 .7 0 setcmykcolor
11    0.3 4.75 moveto
12    0 -4.5 rlineto
13    -0.2 -0.5 rlineto
14    0.5 -2.15 rlineto
15    -1 0 rlineto
16    0 -3 rlineto
17    3.75 0 rlineto
18    0 3 rlineto
19    -1 0 rlineto
20    0.45 2.15 rlineto
21    -0.15 0.5 rlineto
22    0 4.5 rlineto
23    closepath
24    %stroke
25    .1 .4 .5 .9 setcmykcolor
26  } def
27
28 %fingboardpath

```

```
29
30 fingboardpath clip
31 newpath
32 0.15 setlinewidth
33 0.8 3.5 moveto
34 0 -5.85 rlineto
35 -0.2 0 rmoveto
36 -0.25 1.3 rlineto
37 2.2 0 rlineto
38 -0.2 -1.3 rlineto
39 -0.2 0 rmoveto
40 0. 5.85 rlineto
41 stroke
42 0.35 setlinewidth
43 0.15 -1 moveto
44 3.2 0 rlineto
45 stroke
46
47 %inner two line
48 newpath
49 0.15 setlinewidth
50 1.25 3.6 moveto
51 0. -5.95 rlineto
52 1.7 3.6 moveto
53 0. -5.95 rlineto
54 stroke
55
56 0.8 3.5 0.14 0 360 arc
57 fill
58 2.1525 3.5 0.14 0 360 arc
59 fill
60 1.25 3.7 0.14 0 360 arc
61 fill
62 1.7 3.7 0.14 0 360 arc
63 fill
64
65
66
67 %bridge
68 newpath
69 0.25 0.6 moveto
70 0.3 0.4 rlineto
71 1.85 0 rlineto
72 0.3 -0.4 rlineto
73 stroke
74
75 %tailpiece
76 0.425 3 moveto
```

```

77 1 setlinecap
78 1 setlinejoin
79 2.15 0 rlineto
80 -0.35 1.25 rlineto
81 -0 -0 -0.65 0.75 -1.55 0 rcurveto
82 closepath
83 stroke
84
85 %%% mute sign; commentify if not needed %%%
86 newpath
87 0.2 setlinewidth
88 1 setlinecap
89 1.5 -2.25 moveto
90 0 -2.5 rlineto
91 0.25 -3.5 moveto
92 2.5 0 rlineto
93 stroke
94 newpath
95 1.5 -3.5 0.85 0 360 arc
96 stroke
97 %%% end of mute sign for commenting/uncommenting %%%
98
99 grestore
100
101 ")
102             (cons 0 3)
103             (cons 0 1))
104
105 stringPositionClefSize =
106 #(lambda (grob)
107   (let* ((bCS (ly:grob-property grob 'font-size 0.0))
108          (mult (magstep bCS)))
109     (ly:stencil-scale
110      stringPositionClef
111      mult mult)))
112
113 stringPositionClef_three = {
114   \override Staff.Clef.stencil =
115   \stringPositionClef_three_Design
116 }
117
118 {
119   \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions = #'(4 0 -4)
120   \stringPositionClef_three
121   c'4^\markup {
122     \translate #'(-3 . 2)
123     \musicglyph "space"
124   }

```

```

125 _\markup {
126   \translate #'(-3 . -3)
127   \musicglyph "space"
128 }
129 e' g' b' d'' f'' a''
130 }
131
132

```

3.5.4 Discussion

1. With the current design, `e'` places a note at the lower end of the fingerboard. `b'` places a note at the bridge line, and `f''` places a note on the line indicating the edge of the tailpiece.
2. The current design comes with the mute sign. If the mute sign is not needed, remove the following portion of the code above:

```

64   %%% mute sign; commentify if not needed %%%
65   newpath
66   0.2 setlinewidth
67   1 setlinecap
68   1.5 -2.25 moveto
69   0 -2.5 rlineto
70   0.25 -3.5 moveto
71   2.5 0 rlineto
72   stroke
73   newpath
74   1.5 -3.5 0.85 0 360 arc
75   stroke
76   %%% end of mute sign for commenting/uncommenting %%%

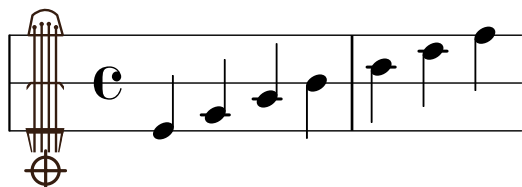
```

3. If you do not wish the ledger lines to appear within the staff line, consider using:

```
\override Staff.NoteHead.no-ledgers = ##t.
```

[Table of Contents](#)

3.6 String Position Clef 3b (Longer Span)



3.6.1 Description

The design of this clef is similar to [String Position Clef 3a](#); however, here the distance among the edge of the fingerboard, bridge, and the edge of the tailpiece is set wider.

3.6.2 Grammar

`\stringPositionClef_three`

3.6.3 Code

```

1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 stringPositionClef_three_longer_Design =
4 #(ly:make-stencil (list 'embedded-ps
5                       "gsave
6   currentpoint translate
7   /fingboardpath
8   {
9     newpath
10    0 1 .7 0 setcmykcolor
11    0.3 5.75 moveto
12    0 -6.5 rlineto
13    -0.2 -0.5 rlineto
14    0.5 -2.15 rlineto
15    -0.5 0 rlineto
16    0 -2.5 rlineto
17    2.75 0 rlineto
18    0 2.5 rlineto
19    -0.5 0 rlineto
20    0.45 2.15 rlineto
21    -0.15 0.5 rlineto
22    0 6.5 rlineto
23    closepath
24    %stroke
25    .1 .4 .5 .9 setcmykcolor
26  } def
27
28 %fingboardpath

```

```
29
30 fingboardpath clip
31 newpath
32 0.15 setlinewidth
33 0.8 4.5 moveto
34 0 -7.85 rlineto
35 -0.2 0 rmoveto
36 -0.25 1.3 rlineto
37 2.2 0 rlineto
38 -0.2 -1.3 rlineto
39 -0.2 0 rmoveto
40 0. 7.85 rlineto
41 stroke
42 0.35 setlinewidth
43 0.15 -2 moveto
44 3.2 0 rlineto
45 stroke
46
47 %inner two line
48 newpath
49 0.15 setlinewidth
50 1.25 4.6 moveto
51 0. -7.95 rlineto
52 1.7 4.6 moveto
53 0. -7.95 rlineto
54 stroke
55
56 0.8 4.5 0.14 0 360 arc
57 fill
58 2.1525 4.5 0.14 0 360 arc
59 fill
60 1.25 4.7 0.14 0 360 arc
61 fill
62 1.7 4.7 0.14 0 360 arc
63 fill
64
65
66
67 %bridge
68 newpath
69 0.25 0.6 moveto
70 0.3 0.4 rlineto
71 1.85 0 rlineto
72 0.3 -0.4 rlineto
73 stroke
74
75 %tailpiece
76 0.425 4 moveto
```

```

77 1 setlinecap
78 1 setlinejoin
79 2.15 0 rlineto
80 -0.35 1.25 rlineto
81 -0 -0 -0.65 0.75 -1.55 0 rcurveto
82 closepath
83 stroke
84 %{
85 %%% mute sign; commentify if not needed %%%
86 newpath
87 0.2 setlinewidth
88 1 setlinecap
89 1.5 -3.25 moveto
90 0 -2.5 rlineto
91 0.25 -4.5 moveto
92 2.5 0 rlineto
93 stroke
94 newpath
95 1.5 -4.5 0.85 0 360 arc
96 stroke
97 %%% end of mute sign for commenting/uncommenting %%%
98 %}
99 grestore
100
101 ")
102             (cons 0 3)
103             (cons 0 1))
104
105 stringPositionClefSize =
106 #(lambda (grob)
107   (let* ((bCS (ly:grob-property grob 'font-size 0.0))
108          (mult (magstep bCS)))
109     (ly:stencil-scale
110      stringPositionClef
111      mult mult)))
112
113 stringPositionClef_three_longer = {
114   \override Staff.Clef.stencil =
115   \stringPositionClef_three_longer_Design
116 }
117
118 {
119   \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions = #'(6 0 -6)
120   \stringPositionClef_three_longer
121   c'4^\markup {
122     \translate #'(-3 . 2)
123     \musicglyph "space"
124   }

```



```

125 _\markup {
126   \translate #'(-3 . -3)
127   \musicglyph "space"
128 }
129 e' g' b' d'' f'' a''
130 }
131
132

```

3.6.4 Discussion

1. With the current design, `c'` places a note at the lower end of the fingerboard. `b'` places a note at the bridge line, and `a''` places a note on the line indicating the edge of the tailpiece.
2. The current design comes with the mute sign. If the mute sign is not needed, remove the following portion of the code above:

```

64   %%% mute sign; commentify if not needed %%%
65   newpath
66   0.2 setlinewidth
67   1 setlinecap
68   1.5 -3.25 moveto
69   0 -2.5 rlineto
70   0.25 -4.5 moveto
71   2.5 0 rlineto
72   stroke
73   newpath
74   1.5 -4.5 0.85 0 360 arc
75   stroke
76   %%% end of mute sign for commenting/uncommenting %%%

```

3. If you do not wish the ledger lines to appear within the staff line, consider using:

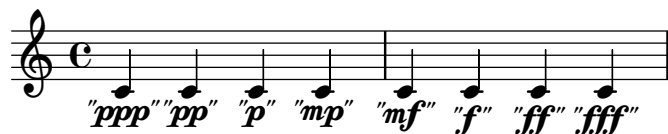
```
\override Staff.NoteHead.no-ledgers = ##t.
```

[Table of Contents](#)

Chapter 4

Dynamics

4.1 Dynamics in Quotation Marks



4.1.1 Description

Updated: November 12, 2025: hairpins will stop closer to the dynamics in quotation marks.

Dynamics in quotation marks, also known as *effort dynamics*, indicate those with which certain techniques must be carried on, understanding that the perceived dynamics will be quieter than what are indicated. Examples abound in scores by Helmut Lachenmann and others for such techniques as air sound, bowing directly on the bridge, etc..

4.1.2 Grammar

```
NOTE \qppp
NOTE \qpp
NOTE \qp
NOTE \qmp
NOTE \qmf
NOTE \qf
NOTE \qff
NOTE \qfff
```

4.1.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 \pointAndClickOff
4 qmp = #(make-dynamic-script
5       (markup
```

```

6      #:pad-x -1
7      ( #:combine
8        #:combine
9        #:translate '(-0.85 . -0.1)
10       #:normal-text (#:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")
11       #:dynamic "mp"
12       #:translate '(3.25 . -0.1)
13       #:normal-text (#:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\""))))
14 qp = #(make-dynamic-script
15         (markup
16           #:pad-x -1
17           (
18             #:combine
19             #:combine
20             #:translate '(-0.95 . -0.1)
21             #:normal-text (#:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")
22             #:dynamic "p"
23             #:translate '(1.35 . -0.1)
24             #:normal-text (#:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\""))))
25 qpp = #(make-dynamic-script
26         (markup
27           #:pad-x -1
28           ( #:combine
29             #:combine
30             #:translate '(-0.95 . -0.1)
31             #:normal-text (#:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")
32             #:dynamic "pp"
33             #:translate '(2.75 . -0.1)
34             #:normal-text (#:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\""))))
35 qppp = #(make-dynamic-script
36         (markup
37           #:pad-x -1
38           ( #:combine
39             #:combine
40             #:translate '(-0.95 . -0.1)
41             #:normal-text (#:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")
42             #:dynamic "ppp"
43             #:translate '(4.25 . -0.1)
44             #:normal-text (#:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\""))))
45 qmf = #(make-dynamic-script
46         (markup
47           #:pad-x -1
48           ( #:combine
49             #:combine
50             #:translate '(-0.85 . 0)
51             #:normal-text (#:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")
52             #:dynamic "mf"
53             #:translate '(3.25 . 0)

```

```

54         #:normal-text ( #:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")))))
55 qf = #(make-dynamic-script
56   (markup
57     #:pad-x -1
58     ( #:combine
59       #:combine
60       #:translate '(-0.75 . 0)
61       #:normal-text ( #:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")
62       #:dynamic "f"
63       #:translate '(1.65 . 0)
64       #:normal-text ( #:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")))))
65 qff = #(make-dynamic-script
66   (markup
67     #:pad-x -1
68     ( #:combine
69       #:combine
70       #:translate '(-0.75 . 0)
71       #:normal-text ( #:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")
72       #:dynamic "ff"
73       #:translate '(2.75 . 0)
74       #:normal-text ( #:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")))))
75 qfff = #(make-dynamic-script
76   (markup
77     #:pad-x -1
78     ( #:combine
79       #:combine
80       #:translate '(-0.75 . 0)
81       #:normal-text ( #:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")
82       #:dynamic "fff"
83       #:translate '(3.85 . 0)
84       #:normal-text ( #:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")))))
85
86 {
87
88   c'4\qppp
89   c'4\qpp
90   c'4\qp
91   c'4\qmp
92
93   c'4\qmf
94   c'4\qf
95   c'4\qff
96   c'4\qfff
97
98 }
99
100 \layout {
101   \context {

```

```
102   \Score      proportionalNotationDuration = #1/9
103   }
104 }
```

4.1.4 Discussion

In scores by Lachenmann, in concordance with German quotation marks (*Anführungszeichen*), the opening quotation mark points left, and placed on the bottom line, and the closing quotation mark points right and sits at the top of the last character. It would be possible to achieve this by adjusting the parameters in the Scheme code.¹

[Table of Contents](#)

1. See: <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/extending/markup-construction-in-scheme>

4.2 Enhanced Constante Hairpins I (Under The Staff)



4.2.1 Description

NB: Slight revision (December 23, 2025) has been carried out to make sure the hairpin terminates at the end of the staff line when it breaks out to the next system.

A constante hairpin, a horizontal line with a short hook at the end, indicates that a dynamic remains unchanged throughout the notes to which it is applied. There are many contemporary scores that utilize this type of hairpins, e.g. works by Brian Ferneyhough. In LilyPond, it is possible to specify constante hairpins by writing an override function:

```
\override Hairpin.stencil = #constante-hairpin
```

However, similar to the issues raised in the [Flared Hairpins](#), LilyPond's default constante hairpins could use some enhancements, particularly in regards to accommodating three separate components when they break into new systems: 1. beginning; 2. intermediate; and; 3. ending. Furthermore, when the constante hairpins break into a new system, it would sometimes be helpful to have the dynamic in parentheses to remind what the dynamic had been in the previous system, which could be taking place before the page turn.

4.2.2 Grammar

NOTE `\constante` `\DYNAMIC` NOTE(S) `\DYNAMIC` OR `\!`

This `\constante` accepts three optional arguments:

1. Vertical offset of the `constante` hairpin, indicated by a direction `#UP`, `#CENTER`, or `#DOWN`. Without specifying this argument, the default is `#CENTER`. You may use `#UP` when it is followed by a decrescendo hairpin, while you may use `#DOWN` when it is followed by a crescendo hairpin.
2. Whether or not to use cautionary dynamics in subsequent systems when the hairpin breaks into new systems, indicated by `##f` or `##t`. The default is `##f`.
3. Extra vertical adjustment is possible with the third argument by specifying a number. The default is `#0`.

4.2.3 Code

```

1  \version "2.26.0"
2
3
4  qf = #(make-dynamic-script
5      (markup
6          #:pad-x -1
7          ( #:combine
8              #:combine
9              #:translate '(-0.75 . 0)
10             #:normal-text (:#italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")
11             #:dynamic "f"
12             #:translate '(1.65 . 0)
13             #:normal-text (:#italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")))))
14
15  qmp = #(make-dynamic-script
16      (markup
17          #:pad-x -1
18          ( #:combine
19              #:combine
20              #:translate '(-0.85 . -0.1)
21              #:normal-text (:#italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")
22              #:dynamic "mp"
23              #:translate '(3.25 . -0.1)
24              #:normal-text (:#italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")))))
25
26
27  constante =
28  #(define-music-function (vOff cautionary moreOff dyn)
29      ( (ly:dir? CENTER) (boolean? #f) (number? 0) ly:event? )
30      (define-public
31          ((constante-hairpin-revised coords mirrored?) grob)
32          "This scheme code was originally the scheme code 'elbowed-hairpin
33 taken from output-lib.scm, and was revised to suit the need."
34          (define (scale-coords coords-list x y)
35              (map

```

```

36      (lambda (coord) (cons (* x (car coord)) (* y (cdr coord))))
37      coords-list))
38
39      (define (hairpin::print-part points decresc? me)
40        (let ((stil (make-connected-line points me)))
41          (ly:stencil-scale stil 1 1)))
42
43      ;; outer let to trigger suicide
44      (let ((sten (ly:hairpin::print grob)))
45        (if (grob::is-live? grob)
46            (let*
47              (
48                ;I've left decresc? function but removed all the if clause
49                ;associated with it, to simplify the code a little bit
50                (verticalOffset vOff)
51                (useCautionary? cautionary)
52                (moreOffset moreOff)
53                (hairpinHeight (ly:grob-property grob 'height))
54                (decresc? (eqv? (ly:grob-property grob 'grow-direction) LEFT))
55                (toBarline? (ly:grob-property grob 'to-barline))
56                ; (circled-tip? (ly:grob-property grob 'circled-tip))
57                (hairpinTypeA?
58                  (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob )           #f)
59                       (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob )         #f)
60                       (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob )        #f)
61                       (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob )      #f)
62                       (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob )       #f)
63                       (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
64                       (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
65                       (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob )              #t)
66                      )) ;Hairpins that end within one line without
67                ;reaching to the end of the system
68                (hairpinTypeB?
69                  (or (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob )           #t)
70                             (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob )         #t)
71                             (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob )        #f)
72                             (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob )      #f)
73                             (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob )       #f)
74                             (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
75                             (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
76                             (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob )              #f)
77                             )
78                      (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob )           #f)
79                           (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob )         #t)
80                           (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob )        #f)
81                           (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob )      #f)
82                           (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob )       #t)
83                           (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)

```



```

84          (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob )    #f)
85          (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob )                  #f)
86          )
87      )) ;Hairpins that breaks into next line
88  (hairpinTypeC?
89      (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob )                #f)
90            (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob )              #f)
91            (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob )             #t)
92            (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob )          #t)
93            (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob )           #t)
94            (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob )  #f)
95            (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob )  #f)
96            (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob )                  #f)
97            )) ;Midway-through Hairpins
98  (hairpinTypeD?
99      (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob )                #t)
100           (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob )              #f)
101           (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob )             #f)
102           (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob )          #t)
103           (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob )           #f)
104           (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob )  #f)
105           (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob )  #t)
106           (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob )                  #f)
107           )) ;multi-system Hairpin that terminates
108  (xex
109      (cons (car (ly:stencil-extent sten X))
110            (- (cdr (ly:stencil-extent sten X)) 1.25))
111      )
112  (lenx (interval-length xex))
113  (yex (ly:stencil-extent sten Y))
114  (leny (interval-length yex))
115  (xtrans (+ (car xex) 0))
116  (ytrans (car yex))
117  (uplist (scale-coords coords lenx (/ leny 2)))
118
119  (crescStencil
120
121      (if toBarline?
122          ;I added here to make it default to stretch
123          ;the hairpin immediately to the dynamics
124
125          (ly:stencil-translate
126              (hairpin::print-part
127                  (scale-coords coords
128                      (+ lenx 2.35) (/ leny 2))
129                  decresc? grob)
130
131              '(-0.5 . 0))

```

```

132         ;if not to barline
133         (ly:stencil-translate
134         (hairpin::print-part
135         (scale-coords coords
136           (+ lenx 2.35) (/ leny 2))
137         decresc? grob)
138
139         '(-0.5 . 0))
140
141     )
142 )
143 (crescStencilBrokenBeginning
144
145   (if toBarline?
146     ;I added here to make it default to stretch
147     ;the hairpin immediately to the dynamics
148
149     (hairpin::print-part (scale-coords
150       '((0 . 0) (1 . 0))
151       (+ lenx 1) (/ leny 2))
152     decresc? grob)
153
154     ;if not to barline
155     (ly:stencil-translate
156     (hairpin::print-part
157     (scale-coords '((0 . 0) (1 . 0))
158       (+ lenx 1.5) (/ leny 2))
159     decresc? grob)
160
161     '(-0.5 . 0))
162
163   )
164 )
165 (crescStencilBrokenContinuation
166   (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
167   ;if the cautionary accidentals are turned on
168   (if cautionary
169     (if (list? (ly:music-property dyn 'text))
170       ;this means, when the custom-made dynamics
171       ;(e.g. \qmp) are used
172       (grob-interpret-markup
173       grob
174       (markup
175       #:hspace 2
176       #:whiteout
177       #:center-align
178       (
179         #:concat
180         ( #:normal-text

```

```

180          (:translate '(0 . -0.25)
181             #:italic (:fontsize -0.5 "( "
182                        ))
183      #:pad-x
184      0.35
185      #:dynamic (ly:music-property dyn 'text)
186      #:normal-text
187      (:translate '(0.5 . -0.25)
188         #:italic (:fontsize -0.5 ")"))))
189    )
190  )
191  )
192  ;when in-house dynamics (e.g. \p) are used
193  (grob-interpret-markup
194    grob
195    (markup
196      #:hspace 2
197      #:center-align
198      #:whiteout
199      #:concat
200      (:normal-text
201        (:translate '(0 . -0.25)
202           #:italic (:fontsize 0.5 "("
203                     ))
204        (:translate '(0 . -0.25)
205           #:italic (:fontsize -10 " "
206                     ))
207        #:pad-x
208        0
209        #:dynamic (ly:music-property dyn 'text)
210        #:normal-text
211        (:translate '(0 . -0.25)
212           #:italic (:fontsize 0.5 ")"))))
213    )
214  ))
215  empty-stencil)
216  1
217  1
218  (hairpin::print-part (scale-coords
219                        '((0.01 . 0.15) (1 . 0.15))
220                        (+ lenx 1) (/ leny 2))
221                        decresc? grob)
222  -1.5
223  )
224  )
225  (crescStencilBrokenEnding
226    ;if the flare end is applied
227    ;on the dynamic at the beginning

```

```

228      ;of the system, meaning lenx is super low
229
230      (cond
231        ((< lenx 1)
232         (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
233          ;if the cautionary accidentals are turned on
234          (if cautionary
235            (if (list? (ly:music-property dyn 'text))
236              ;this means, when the custom-made dynamics
237              ;(e.g. \qmp) are used
238              (grob-interpret-markup
239               grob
240               (markup
241                #:hspace -1
242                #:whiteout
243                #:center-align
244                #:concat
245                (#:normal-text
246                 (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
247                  #:italic (#:fontsize -0.5 "( "
248                           ))
249
250                #:pad-x
251                0.25
252                #:dynamic (ly:music-property dyn 'text)
253                #:normal-text
254                (#:translate '(0.5 . -0.25)
255                 #:italic (#:fontsize -0.5 ")"))))
256              )
257              )
258          ;when in-house dynamics (e.g. \p) are used
259          (grob-interpret-markup
260           grob
261           (markup
262
263            #:hspace -1
264            #:whiteout
265            #:center-align
266            (
267              #:concat
268              (#:normal-text
269               (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
270                #:italic (#:fontsize 0.5 "( "
271                          ))
272
273              (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
274               #:italic (#:fontsize -10 " "
275                         ))
276
277              #:pad-x 0
278              #:dynamic (ly:music-property dyn 'text)

```

```

276             #:normal-text
277             (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
278                 #:italic (#:fontsize 0.5 "))))
279         ))
280     ))
281     empty-stencil
282 )
283 1
284 1
285 (hairpin::print-part
286   (scale-coords coords
287       (+ lenx 1.85) (/ leny 2) )
288   decresc? grob)
289 ;vertical alignment (to be refined possibly...?)
290 -1.75
291 )
292 )
293 ((>= lenx 1)
294 ;if the normal ending flare crescendo
295 ;is applied...
296 (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
297 ;if the cautionary accidentals are turned on
298 (if cautionary
299     (if (list? (ly:music-property dyn 'text))
300         ;this means, when the custom-made dynamics
301         ;(e.g. \qmp) are used
302         (grob-interpret-markup
303         grob
304         (markup
305             #:hspace 2
306             #:whiteout
307             #:center-align
308             #:concat
309             (#:normal-text
310                 (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
311                     #:italic (#:fontsize -0.5 "( "
312                         ))
313             #:pad-x 0.25
314             #:dynamic (ly:music-property dyn 'text)
315             #:normal-text
316             (#:translate '(0.5 . -0.25)
317                 #:italic (#:fontsize -0.5 "))))
318         )
319     )
320 ;if the in-house dynamics are used
321
322 (grob-interpret-markup
323 grob

```

```

324         (markup
325           #:hspace 2
326           #:whiteout
327           #:center-align
328           #:concat
329           (#:normal-text
330             (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
331               #:italic (#:fontsize 0.5 "("
332                 ))
333             (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
334               #:italic (#:fontsize -10 " "
335                 ))
336             #:pad-x
337             0
338             #:dynamic (ly:music-property dyn 'text)
339             #:normal-text
340             (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
341               #:italic (#:fontsize 0.5 ")"))))
342         )
343       ))
344     empty-stencil
345   )
346   1
347   1
348   (hairpin::print-part
349     (scale-coords coords
350       (+ lenx 1.85) (/ leny 2) )
351     decresc? grob)
352   ;vertical alignment (to be refined possibly...?)
353   -1.75
354   )
355   )
356   )
357   )
358
359
360   (cresc
361     (cond (hairpinTypeA? crescStencil)
362           (hairpinTypeB? crescStencilBrokenBeginning)
363           (hairpinTypeC? crescStencilBrokenContinuation)
364           (hairpinTypeD? crescStencilBrokenEnding)
365           )
366   )
367
368   (stil
369     (ly:stencil-aligned-to
370       (ly:stencil-translate
371         cresc

```

```

372         (cons xtrans ytrans))
373     Y CENTER))
374     (stil-y-extent (ly:stencil-extent stil Y)))
375 ; FOR DEBUG ONLY
376 ; (display (list? (ly:music-property dyn 'text)))
377 ; (newline)
378 ; (display dyn)
379 ; (newline)
380 ; (newline)
381 ; (display "Is this type A Hairpin? " )
382 ; (display hairpinTypeA?)
383 ; (newline)
384 ; (display "Is this type B Hairpin? " )
385 ; (display hairpinTypeB?)
386 ; (newline)
387 ; (display "Is this type C Hairpin? " )
388 ; (display hairpinTypeC?)
389 ; (newline)
390 ; (display "Is this type D Hairpin? " )
391 ; (display hairpinTypeD?)
392 ;
393 ; (newline)
394 ; (display "Is it decrescendo? " )
395 ; (display decresc?)
396 ; (newline)
397 ; (display "end-broken-spanner???" )
398 ; (display (end-broken-spanner? grob ))
399 ; (newline)
400 ; (display "(first-broken-spanner?) Is spanner broken
401 ;         and the first of its broken siblings? " )
402 ; (display (first-broken-spanner? grob ))
403 ; (newline)
404 ; (display "middle-broken-spanner???" )
405 ; (display (middle-broken-spanner? grob ))
406 ; (newline)
407 ;
408 ; (display "Is spanner broken and not the first of
409 ;         its broken siblings? " )
410 ; (display (not-first-broken-spanner? grob ))
411 ; (newline)
412 ;
413 ; (display "Is spanner broken and not the last of
414 ;         its broken siblings? " )
415 ; (display (not-last-broken-spanner? grob ))
416 ; (newline)
417 ;
418 ; (display "unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner???" )
419 ; (display (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ))

```

```

420         ; (newline)
421         ;
422         ; (display "unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner???" )
423         ; (display (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) )
424         ; (newline)
425         ; (display "unbroken spanner?? " )
426         ; (display (unbroken-spanner? grob ) )
427         ; (newline)
428         ; (newline)
429         ; (display "distance of xex " )
430         ; (display lenx )
431         ; (newline)
432         ; (newline)
433         (ly:make-stencil (ly:stencil-expr stil) xex stil-y-extent))
434     ;; return empty, if no Hairpin.stencil present.
435     '()))
436
437     #{
438         #dyn
439         \tweak Hairpin.stencil
440         #(lambda (grob)
441             ;depending on the hairpin opening width,
442             ;you can adjust the value here vvv
443             (constante-hairpin-revised '((0 . 0) (1.0 . 0) (1.0 . 0.9)) #f)
444             )
445         % This calculates the tweak value for
446         % the value of the constante V-offset
447         \tweak Y-offset #(lambda (grob)
448                             (+ (* vOff (ly:grob-property grob 'height))
449                                (* (ly:grob-property grob 'height) -0.5 vOff )
450                                moreOff
451                                )
452                             )
453
454         \<
455         #}
456     )
457 \layout {
458     indent = #0
459     line-width = #100
460     ragged-last = ##f
461 }
462 {
463
464     \override Hairpin.height = #0.5
465     \override Hairpin.to-barline = ##f
466     % \override Hairpin.stencil = #constante-hairpin
467     \override Hairpin.after-line-breaking = ##t

```



```

468 c'2 \constante #UP \mf c'2 c'2 \> c'2
469 c'2 \constante #DOWN ##t #0.3 \p c'2
470 \break c'4 4 4 4 c'4 4 4 4 \break
471 c''2 \< c'2 \! \constante #DOWN ##f \qf \break
472 c'2 c'2\< c'2 c'2 c'2
473 \revert Hairpin.to-barline
474 \afterGrace 31/32
475 { c'2 \constante #CENTER ##f \ff} s32\! \break
476 c'2\f c'2\< c'2 c'2 c'2
477 \revert Hairpin.to-barline
478 \after 1*25/64 \!
479 { c'2 \constante #CENTER ##f \ff }
480 \bar "|."
481 }
482

```

4.2.4 Discussion

For the purpose of using it in my own musical typesetting, this constante hairpin snippet has been designed to work with a narrower hairpin height, e.g.

`\override Hairpin.height = #0.5` (the default is 0.666.)

[Table of Contents](#)

4.3 Enhanced Constante Hairpins II (Over The Staff)



4.3.1 Description

NB: Revision (August 19, 2026) has been carried out in modifying where the default parenthesized dynamics will be placed. Before, the parenthesized dynamics with whiteout would be placed on top of the constante line after the line break, but at a position that exposes the beginning part of the constante line. I fixed it so that the dynamics would hide the beginning part of the constante line.
 - Slight revision (December 23, 2025) has been carried out to make sure the hairpin terminates at the end of the staff line when it breaks out to the next system.

The motivation for creating an enhancement to the default constante hairpin provided by LilyPond was that it would not allow the hook to be inverted when placed over the staff.

See [Enhanced Constante Hairpins I \(Under The Staff\)](#) for more information.

4.3.2 Grammar

NOTE \constante \DYNAMIC NOTE(S) \DYNAMIC OR \!

This \constante accepts three optional arguments:

1. Vertical offset of the constante hairpin, indicated by a direction #UP, #CENTER, or #DOWN. Without specifying this argument, the default is #CENTER. You may use #DOWN when it is followed by a decrescendo hairpin, while you may use #UP when it is followed by a crescendo hairpin.²

2. Note that the directions are flipped from Enhanced Constante Hairpins I!

2. Whether or not to use cautionary dynamics in subsequent systems when the hairpin breaks into new systems, indicated by `##f` or `##t`. The default is `##f`.
3. Extra vertical adjustment is possible with the third argument by specifying a number. The default is `#0`.

Furthermore, when using the dynamic *p*, *pp*, etc., it is possible that the initial horizontal line may be too high. In this case, use `\tweak Y-offset #0` to be placed between the numerical value for the extra vertical adjustment and the dynamics.

4.3.3 Code

```

1  \version "2.26.0"
2
3
4  qf = #(make-dynamic-script
5      (markup
6          #:pad-x -1
7          ( #:combine
8              #:combine
9              #:translate '(-0.75 . 0)
10             #:normal-text (#:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")
11             #:dynamic "f"
12             #:translate '(1.65 . 0)
13             #:normal-text (#:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")))))
14
15  qmp = #(make-dynamic-script
16      (markup
17          #:pad-x -1
18          ( #:combine
19              #:combine
20              #:translate '(-0.85 . -0.1)
21              #:normal-text (#:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")
22              #:dynamic "mp"
23              #:translate '(3.25 . -0.1)
24              #:normal-text (#:italic #:fontsize 0.75 "\"")))))
25
26
27  constanteUP =
28  #(define-music-function ( vOff cautionary moreOff dyn)
29      ( (ly:dir? CENTER) (boolean? #t) (number? 0) ly:event? )
30      (define-public
31          ((constante-hairpin-revised coords mirrored?) grob)
32          "This scheme code was originally the scheme code 'elbowed-hairpin
33 taken from output-lib.scm, and was revised to suit the need."
34          (define (scale-coords coords-list x y)
35              (map
36                  (lambda (coord) (cons (* x (car coord)) (* y (cdr coord))))
37                  coords-list))

```

```

38 (define (hairpin::print-part points decresc? me)
39   (let ((stil (make-connected-line points me)))
40     (ly:stencil-scale stil 1 1)))
41
42
43 ;; outer let to trigger suicide
44 (let ((sten (ly:hairpin::print grob)))
45   (if (grob::is-live? grob)
46       (let*
47         (
48          ;I've left decresc? function but removed all the if clause
49          ;associated with it, to simplify the code a little bit
50          (verticalOffset vOff)
51          (moreOffset moreOff)
52          (hairpinHeight (ly:grob-property grob 'height))
53          (decresc? (eqv? (ly:grob-property grob 'grow-direction) LEFT))
54          (toBarline? (ly:grob-property grob 'to-barline))
55          ; (circled-tip? (ly:grob-property grob 'circled-tip))
56          (hairpinTypeA?
57            (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
58                  (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
59                  (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
60                  (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
61                  (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
62                  (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
63                  (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
64                  (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob ) #t)
65                  )) ;Hairpins that end within one line without
66          ;reaching to the end of the system
67          (hairpinTypeB?
68            (or (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
69                      (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
70                      (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
71                      (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
72                      (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
73                      (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
74                      (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
75                      (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob ) #f)
76                      )
77                (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
78                      (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
79                      (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
80                      (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
81                      (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
82                      (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
83                      (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
84                      (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob ) #f)
85                      )
86            )
87          )
88       )
89   )

```

```

86         )) ;Hairpins that breaks into next line
87 (hairpinTypeC?
88   (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob )           #f)
89         (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob )         #f)
90         (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob )        #t)
91         (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob )      #t)
92         (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob )       #t)
93         (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
94         (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
95         (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob )             #f)
96         )) ;Midway-through Hairpins
97 (hairpinTypeD?
98   (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob )           #t)
99         (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob )         #f)
100        (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob )        #f)
101        (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob )      #t)
102        (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob )       #f)
103        (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
104        (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
105        (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob )             #f)
106        )) ;multi-system Hairpin that terminates
107 (xex
108   (cons (car (ly:stencil-extent sten X))
109         (- (cdr (ly:stencil-extent sten X)) 1.25))
110 )
111 (lenx (interval-length xex))
112 (yex (ly:stencil-extent sten Y))
113 (leny (interval-length yex))
114 (xtrans (+ (car xex) 0))
115 (ytrans (car yex))
116 (uplist (scale-coords coords lenx (/ leny 2)))
117
118 (crescStencil
119
120   (if toBarline?
121     ;I added here to make it default to stretch
122     ;the hairpin immediately to the dynamics
123
124     (ly:stencil-translate
125       (hairpin::print-part
126         (scale-coords coords
127           (+ lenx 2.35) (/ leny 2))
128         decresc? grob)
129
130       '(-0.5 . 0))
131     ;if not to barline
132     (ly:stencil-translate
133       (hairpin::print-part

```

```

134         (scale-coords coords
135             (+ lenx 2.35) (/ leny 2))
136         decresc? grob)
137
138     '(-0.5 . 0))
139
140     )
141 )
142 (crescStencilBrokenBeginning
143
144     (if toBarline?
145         ;I added here to make it default to stretch
146         ;the hairpin immediately to the dynamics
147
148         (hairpin::print-part (scale-coords
149                               '((0 . 0) (1 . 0))
150                               (+ lenx 1) (/ leny 2))
151                               decresc? grob)
152
153         ;if not to barline
154         (ly:stencil-translate
155         (hairpin::print-part
156         (scale-coords '((0 . 0) (1 . 0))
157                       (+ lenx 1.5) (/ leny 2))
158         decresc? grob)
159
160         '(-0.5 . 0))
161
162     )
163 )
164 (crescStencilBrokenContinuation
165 (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
166 ;if the cautionary accidentals are turned on
167 (if cautionary
168     (if (list? (ly:music-property dyn 'text))
169         ;this means, when the custom-made dynamics
170         ;(e.g. \qmp) are used
171         (grob-interpret-markup
172         grob
173         (markup
174         #:hspace 2
175         #:whiteout
176         #:center-align
177         (
178         #:concat
179         (#:normal-text
180         (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
181                     #:italic (#:fontsize -0.5 "( "

```

```

182         #:pad-x
183         0.35
184         #:dynamic (ly:music-property dyn 'text)
185         #:normal-text
186         (#:translate '(0.5 . -0.25)
187           #:italic (#:fontsize -0.5 "))))
188     )
189   )
190 )
191 ;when in-house dynamics (e.g. \p) are used
192 (grob-interpret-markup
193   grob
194   (markup
195     #:hspace 2
196     #:center-align
197     #:whiteout
198     #:concat
199     (#:normal-text
200       (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
201         #:italic (#:fontsize 0.5 "("
202           ))
203       (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
204         #:italic (#:fontsize -10 " "
205           ))
206       #:pad-x
207       0
208       #:dynamic (ly:music-property dyn 'text)
209       #:normal-text
210       (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
211         #:italic (#:fontsize 0.5 "))))
212   )
213 ))
214 empty-stencil)
215 1
216 1
217 (hairpin::print-part (scale-coords
218   '((0.01 . 0.15) (1 . 0.15))
219   (+ lenx 1) (/ leny 2))
220   decresc? grob)
221 -1.5
222 )
223 )
224 (crescStencilBrokenEnding
225   ;if the flare end is applied
226   ;on the dynamic at the beginning
227   ;of the system, meaning lenx is super low
228
229   (cond

```

```

230      ((< lenx 1)
231      (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
232      ;if the cautionary accidentals are turned on
233      (if cautionary
234      (if (list? (ly:music-property dyn 'text))
235      ;this means, when the custom-made dynamics
236      ;(e.g. \qmp) are used
237      (grob-interpret-markup
238      grob
239      (markup
240      #:hspace 0
241      #:whiteout
242      #:center-align
243      #:concat
244      (#:normal-text
245      (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
246      #:italic (#:fontsize -0.5 "( "
247      ))
248      #:pad-x
249      0.25
250      #:dynamic (ly:music-property dyn 'text)
251      #:normal-text
252      (#:translate '(0.5 . -0.25)
253      #:italic (#:fontsize -0.5 ")"))))
254      )
255      )
256      ;when in-house dynamics (e.g. \p) are used
257      (grob-interpret-markup
258      grob
259      (markup
260      #:hspace 0
261
262      #:whiteout
263      #:center-align
264      (
265      #:concat
266      (#:normal-text
267      (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
268      #:italic (#:fontsize 0.5 "( "
269      ))
270      (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
271      #:italic (#:fontsize -10 " "
272      ))
273      #:pad-x
274      0
275      #:dynamic (ly:music-property dyn 'text)
276      #:normal-text
277      (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)

```



```

278                                     #:italic (:#:fontsize 0.5 "))))
279                                 ))
280                             ))
281                         empty-stencil
282                     )
283                 1
284             1
285         (hairpin::print-part
286         (scale-coords coords
287             (+ lenx 1.85) (/ leny 2) )
288         decresc? grob)
289     ;vertical alignment (to be refined possibly...?)
290     -1.75
291 )
292 )
293 ((>= lenx 1)
294 ;if the normal ending flare crescendo
295 ;is applied...
296 (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
297 ;if the cautionary accidentals are turned on
298 (if cautionary
299     (if (list? (ly:music-property dyn 'text))
300         ;this means, when the custom-made dynamics
301         ;(e.g. \qmp) are used
302         (grob-interpret-markup
303         grob
304         (markup
305             #:hspace 1.5
306             #:whiteout
307             #:center-align
308             #:concat
309             (:#:normal-text
310                 (:#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
311                     #:italic (:#:fontsize -0.5 "( "
312                         ))
313                 #:pad-x 0.25
314                 #:dynamic (ly:music-property dyn 'text)
315                 #:normal-text
316                 (:#:translate '(0.5 . -0.25)
317                     #:italic (:#:fontsize -0.5 "))))
318             )
319         )
320 ;if the in-house dynamics are used
321
322 (grob-interpret-markup
323 grob
324 (markup
325     #:hspace 1.5

```

```

326             #:whiteout
327             #:center-align
328             #:concat
329             (#:normal-text
330              (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
331               #:italic (#:fontsize 0.5 "("
332                        ))
333              (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
334               #:italic (#:fontsize -10 " "
335                        ))
336              #:pad-x
337              0
338              #:dynamic (ly:music-property dyn 'text)
339              #:normal-text
340              (#:translate '(0 . -0.25)
341               #:italic (#:fontsize 0.5 ")"))))
342         )
343     ))
344     empty-stencil
345 )
346 1
347 1
348 (hairpin::print-part
349   (scale-coords coords
350    (+ lenx 1.85) (/ leny 2) )
351   decresc? grob)
352 ;vertical alignment (to be refined possibly...?)
353 -1.75
354 )
355 )
356 )
357 )
358
359
360 (cresc
361   (cond (hairpinTypeA? crescStencil)
362         (hairpinTypeB? crescStencilBrokenBeginning)
363         (hairpinTypeC? crescStencilBrokenContinuation)
364         (hairpinTypeD? crescStencilBrokenEnding)
365         )
366 )
367
368 (stil
369   (ly:stencil-aligned-to
370    (ly:stencil-translate
371     cresc
372     (cons xtrans ytrans))
373    Y CENTER))

```

```

374      (stil-y-extent (ly:stencil-extent stil Y)))
375      ; FOR DEBUG ONLY
376      ; (display (list? (ly:music-property dyn 'text)))
377      ; (newline)
378      ; (display dyn)
379      ; (newline)
380      ; (newline)
381      ; (display "Is this type A Hairpin? " )
382      ; (display hairpinTypeA?)
383      ; (newline)
384      ; (display "Is this type B Hairpin? " )
385      ; (display hairpinTypeB?)
386      ; (newline)
387      ; (display "Is this type C Hairpin? " )
388      ; (display hairpinTypeC?)
389      ; (newline)
390      ; (display "Is this type D Hairpin? " )
391      ; (display hairpinTypeD?)
392      ;
393      ; (newline)
394      ; (display "Is it decrescendo? " )
395      ; (display decresc?)
396      ; (newline)
397      ; (display "end-broken-spanner???" " )
398      ; (display (end-broken-spanner? grob ))
399      ; (newline)
400      ; (display "(first-broken-spanner?) Is spanner broken
401      ;           and the first of its broken siblings? " )
402      ; (display (first-broken-spanner? grob ) )
403      ; (newline)
404      ; (display "middle-broken-spanner???" " )
405      ; (display (middle-broken-spanner? grob ) )
406      ; (newline)
407      ;
408      ; (display "Is spanner broken and not the first of
409      ;           its broken siblings? " )
410      ; (display (not-first-broken-spanner? grob ) )
411      ; (newline)
412      ;
413      ; (display "Is spanner broken and not the last of
414      ;           its broken siblings? " )
415      ; (display (not-last-broken-spanner? grob ) )
416      ; (newline)
417      ;
418      ; (display "unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner???" " )
419      ; (display (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) )
420      ; (newline)
421      ;

```

```

422         ; (display "unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner??? " )
423         ; (display (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) )
424         ; (newline)
425         ; (display "unbroken spanner?? " )
426         ; (display (unbroken-spanner? grob ) )
427         ; (newline)
428         ; (newline)
429         ; (display "distance of xex " )
430         ; (display lenx )
431         ; (newline)
432         ; (newline)
433         (ly:make-stencil (ly:stencil-expr stil) xex stil-y-extent))
434     ;; return empty, if no Hairpin.stencil present.
435     '()))
436
437     #{
438     #dyn
439     \tweak Hairpin.stencil
440     #(lambda (grob)
441         ;depending on the hairpin opening width,
442         ;you can adjust the value here vvv
443         (constante-hairpin-revised '((0 . 0) (1.0 . 0) (1.0 . -0.9)) #f)
444
445     )
446     % This calculates the tweak value for
447     % the value of the constante V-offset
448     \tweak Y-offset #(lambda (grob)
449         (+ (* vOff (ly:grob-property grob 'height))
450            (* (ly:grob-property grob 'height) -0.5 vOff )
451            moreOff
452          )
453       )
454
455     \<
456     #}
457     )
458     \layout {
459     indent = #0
460     line-width = #100
461     ragged-last = ##f
462     }
463     {
464     \dynamicUp
465     \override Hairpin.height = #0.5
466     \override Hairpin.to-barline = ##t
467     % \override Hairpin.stencil = #constante-hairpin
468     \override Hairpin.after-line-breaking = ##t
469     c'2 \constanteUP #DOWN \mf c'2 c'2 \> c'2

```

```

470 c'2 \constanteUP #UP ##t #0.3 \tweak Y-offset #0 \p c'2
471 \break c'4 4 4 4 c'4 4 4 4 \break
472 c''2 \< c'2 \! \constanteUP #UP ##f \qf \break
473 c'2 c'2\< c'2 c'2 c'2
474 \revert Hairpin.to-barline
475 \afterGrace 31/32
476 { c'2 \constanteUP #CENTER ##f \ff} s32\! \break
477 c'2\f c'2\< c'2 c'2 c'2
478 \revert Hairpin.to-barline
479 \after 1*25/64 \!
480 { c'2 \constanteUP #CENTER ##f \ff }
481 \bar "|."
482 }
483

```

4.3.4 Discussion

For the purpose of using it in my own musical typesetting, this `constante` hairpin snippet has been designed to work with a narrower hairpin height, e.g.

`\override Hairpin.height = #0.5` (the default is 0.666.)

[Table of Contents](#)

4.4 Enhanced Flared Hairpins I (Original Version)

The musical score example shows six staves of music. The first staff begins with a *fff* dynamic and a long hairpin. The second staff continues the melody. The third staff features dynamics *ff*, *p*, and *p* with corresponding hairpins. The fourth staff continues the melody. The fifth staff starts with an accent and *f* dynamic. The sixth staff shows a hairpin with *f* and *p* dynamics.

4.4.1 Description

NB: Significantly updated on December 23 and 24, 2025, with new commands being added on January 15 2026.

(See [Enhanced Flared Hairpins II](#) for the flared hairpins with curved flares.)

In LilyPond, it is possible to specify flared hairpins by writing an override command:

```
\override Hairpin.stencil = #flared-hairpin
```

There are several aspects to LilyPond's default flared hairpin that could be seen as limitations and would be best overcome:

1. Because the flare of the hairpin is drawn using the scheme code 'elbowed-hairpin in the file `output-lib.scm` that uses a list of points from 0 (beginning) to 1 (end), the longer the hairpin is, the longer its flare becomes. While there may be a case where the longer flare is preferred, in the case of a long hairpin, it becomes more difficult to immediately discern a flared hairpin.
2. While LilyPond's ordinary hairpins do have three separate components when they break into new systems: 1. beginning; 2. intermediate; and; 3. ending, the default flared hairpins draw

identical “flared” hairpins when the lines break. This could invite confusions as it may tempt players to do flared crescendo/diminuendos at the end of each system.

3. When the default flared hairpins are activated, `\override Hairpin.circled-tips` (i.e. to apply circled tips at the onset of the crescendo or at the end of decrescendo) ceases to work.

In developing this enhanced flared hairpin, I have attempted to accommodate different case scenarios, e.g. having `\override Hairpin.to-barline`, `\override Hairpin.after-line-breaking` set to either `##t` or `##f`. It is subject to further refinements. I have also coded the circled-tip dynamic sign as well as tweak functions to be used when the circled-tip dynamic signs are used in tandem with the hairpins.

4.4.2 Grammar

```
\override Hairpin.to-barline = ##f OR ##t
\override Hairpin.after-line-breaking = ##t OR ##f
```

```
NOTE \DYNAMIC \flaredCresc \< NOTE(S) \DYNAMIC OR \!
```

```
NOTE \DYNAMIC \flaredDecresc \> NOTE(S) \DYNAMIC OR \!
```

If you wish to use circled tips, instead of using `\override Hairpin.circled-tip = ##t`, write:

```
NOTE \o \flaredCresc \< NOTE(S) \DYNAMIC OR \! \flaredDecresc \> NOTE(S) \o
```

Update: January 15, 2026 If you are using the flared crescendo/diminuendo to a note that also has `\after`, use:

```
\flaredCrescOverride NOTE \DYNAMIC \<
\flaredDecrescOverride NOTE \DYNAMIC \>
```

Considering that flared hairpins are often used in tandem with ordinary hairpins, I have embedded `\tweak Hairpin.stencil = #flared-hairpin-new` in `\flaredCresc` and `\flaredDecresc`. Therefore, it is not necessary to write an `\override` command to change the stencil used.

Update: December 23-24, 2025 `\flaredCresc` and `\flaredDecresc` accepts a number as an optional argument. This functionality has been added to allow the adjustment of flaring end of the hairpin, as well as the horizontal placement of the small piece of the arrival hairpin when `\override to-barline` is set `##f`. While I have striven to set the default setting in such a way that these micro-adjustments are not necessary, it seemed helpful to add this functionality when further refinement is needed. Think of this as an `X-offset` for the arrival point. See **Code**.

Update: January 15, 2026 I have discovered that `\flaredCresc` and `\flaredDecresc` do not work when it is applied to a note that also has `\after` preceding it, e.g. when the hairpin is terminated within the given note. In order to make such a case work, I have created additional commands `\flaredCrescOverride` and `\flaredDecrescOverride`, which use `\once \override` commands instead of `\tweak`. These commands also accept an optional argument that behaves like `X-offset`.

4.4.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
```

```

3
4 % similar to the original version
5
6 #(define-public ((elbowed-hairpin-revised coords mirrored?) grob)
7   "This scheme code was originally the scheme code 'elbowed-hairpin
8   taken from output-lib.scm, and was revised to suit the need.
9   "
10  (define (scale-coords coords-list x y)
11    (map
12      (lambda (coord) (cons (* x (car coord)) (* y (cdr coord))))
13      coords-list))
14
15  (define (hairpin::print-part points decresc? me)
16    (let ((stil (make-connected-line points me)))
17      (if decresc? (ly:stencil-scale stil -1 1)
18        (ly:stencil-scale stil 1 1))))
19
20  ;; outer let to trigger suicide
21  (let ((sten (ly:hairpin::print grob)))
22    (if (grob::is-live? grob)
23      (let*
24        ((decresc? (eqv? (ly:grob-property grob 'grow-direction) LEFT))
25         (hairpinHeight (ly:grob-property grob 'height))
26         (toBarline? (ly:grob-property grob 'to-barline))
27         (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
28         (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
29                       (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
30                       '())))
31        (hairpinTypeA?
32          (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob )           #f)
33               (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob )         #f)
34               (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob )        #f)
35               (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob )     #f)
36               (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob )      #f)
37               (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
38               (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
39               (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob )             #t)
40               )) ;Hairpins that end within one line without reaching
41          ;to the end of the system
42          (hairpinTypeB?
43            (or (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob )           #t)
44                      (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob )         #t)
45                      (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob )        #f)
46                      (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob )     #f)
47                      (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob )      #f)
48                      (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
49                      (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
50                      (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob )             #f)

```



```

51         )
52     (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob )           #f)
53          (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob )         #t)
54          (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob )        #f)
55          (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob )     #f)
56          (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob )      #t)
57          (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
58          (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
59          (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob )             #f)
60         )
61     )) ;Hairpins that breaks into next line
62 (hairpinTypeC?
63   (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob )           #f)
64        (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob )         #f)
65        (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob )        #t)
66        (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob )     #t)
67        (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob )      #t)
68        (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
69        (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
70        (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob )             #f)
71       )) ;Midway-through Hairpins
72 (hairpinTypeD?
73   (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob )           #t)
74        (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob )         #f)
75        (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob )        #f)
76        (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob )     #t)
77        (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob )      #f)
78        (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
79        (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
80        (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob )             #f)
81       )) ;multi-system Hairpin that terminates
82 (xex (if decresc?
83      (cons (+ (car (ly:stencil-extent sten X)) 0.75)
84            (cdr (ly:stencil-extent sten X)))
85      (cons (car (ly:stencil-extent sten X))
86            (- (cdr (ly:stencil-extent sten X)) 1.25))
87      ))
88 (lenx (interval-length xex))
89 (yex (ly:stencil-extent sten Y))
90 (leny (interval-length yex))
91 (xtrans (+ (car xex) (if decresc? lenx 0)))
92 (ytrans (car yex))
93 (uplist (scale-coords coords lenx (/ leny 2)))
94 (downlist (scale-coords coords lenx (/ leny -2)))
95 ; crescStencil is used when the flared crescendo takes place
96 ; and finishes within one line.
97 (crescStencil
98   (if toBarline?

```

```

99      ;I added here to make it default to stretch
100     ;the hairpin immediately to the dynamics
101     (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
102     (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
103     (hairpin::print-part
104     (scale-coords
105     coords
106     (+ lenx 0.95) (/ leny 2)) decresc? grob)
107     1
108     -1
109     (if mirrored?
110     (hairpin::print-part
111     (scale-coords
112     coords
113     (+ lenx 0.95) (/ leny -2)) decresc? grob)
114     empty-stencil)
115     -0.1 ;vertical padding value here
116     )
117     0
118     1
119     (make-path-stencil
120     (list
121     'moveto 0 (* 0.2 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
122     'rlineto 0.25 0.3
123     'moveto 0 (* -0.2 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
124     'rlineto 0.25 -0.3
125     )
126     0.1
127     2
128     2
129     #f
130     )
131     -0.075
132     )
133     ;if not to barline
134     (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
135     (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
136     (hairpin::print-part
137     (scale-coords
138     coords
139     (+ lenx 0.95) (/ leny 2)) decresc? grob)
140     1
141     -1
142     (if mirrored?
143     (hairpin::print-part
144     (scale-coords
145     coords
146     (+ lenx 0.95) (/ leny -2)) decresc? grob)

```

```

147         empty-stencil)
148     -0.1 ;vertical padding value here
149 )
150 0
151 1
152 (make-path-stencil
153
154     (list
155         'moveto 0 (* 0.2 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
156         'rlineto 0.25 0.3
157         'moveto 0 (* -0.2 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
158         'rlineto 0.25 -0.3
159     )
160     0.1
161     2
162     2
163     #f
164     )
165     -0.075
166 ))
167 )
168 ; when crescendo begins but breaks off to
169 ; the subsequent system(s)
170 (crescStencilBrokenBeginning
171     ; if the hairpin is set only to barline...
172     (if toBarline?
173         ; ... AND if the hairpin finishes at the beginning
174         ; of the next line
175         (if (= (length siblings) 1)
176             (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
177                 (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
178                     (hairpin::print-part
179                         (scale-coords
180                             coords
181                             (+ lenx 0.95) (/ leny 2)) decresc? grob)
182                     1
183                     -1
184                     (if mirrored?
185                         (hairpin::print-part
186                             (scale-coords
187                                 coords
188                                 (+ lenx 0.95) (/ leny -2)) decresc? grob)
189                             empty-stencil)
190                         -0.1 ;vertical padding value here
191                     )
192                     0
193                     1
194                     (make-path-stencil

```

```

195         (list
196           'moveto 0 (* 0.2 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
197           'rlineto 0.25 0.3
198           'moveto 0 (* -0.2 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
199           'rlineto 0.25 -0.3
200         )
201         0.1
202         2
203         2
204         #f
205         )
206         -0.075
207         )
208         (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
209           (hairpin::print-part
210             (scale-coords
211               coords
212               (+ lenx 1.6) (/ leny 1.5)) decresc? grob)
213           1
214           -1
215           (if mirrored?
216             (hairpin::print-part
217               (scale-coords
218                 coords
219                 (+ lenx 1.6) (/ leny -1.5)) decresc? grob)
220             empty-stencil)
221           -0.1 ;vertical padding value here
222         )
223       )
224     )
225     (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
226       (hairpin::print-part
227         (scale-coords
228           coords
229           (+ lenx 1) (/ leny 1.5)) decresc? grob)
230       1
231       -1
232       (if mirrored?
233         (hairpin::print-part
234           (scale-coords
235             coords
236             (+ lenx 1) (/ leny -1.5)) decresc? grob)
237         empty-stencil)
238       -0.1 ;vertical padding value here
239     )
240   )
241 )
242 )

```

```

243      (crescStencilBrokenContinuation
244        (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
245          (hairpin::print-part
246            (scale-coords
247              coords
248              (+ lenx 1) (/ leny 2)) decresc? grob)
249          1
250          -1
251          (if mirrored?
252            (hairpin::print-part
253              (scale-coords
254                coords
255                (+ lenx 1) (/ leny -2)) decresc? grob)
256            empty-stencil)
257          0.1 ;vertical padding value here
258        )
259      )
260      (crescStencilBrokenEnding
261        ;if the flare end is applied
262        ;on the dynamic at the beginning
263        ;of the system, meaning lenx is super low
264        (cond ((< lenx 0.2)
265              (make-path-stencil
266                (list 'moveto 0.45 (* 0.2 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
267                    'rlineto -0.65 -0.1
268                    'moveto 0.45 (* 0.2 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
269                    'rlineto 0.25 0.3
270                    'moveto 0.45 (* -0.2 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
271                    'rlineto -0.65 0.1
272                    'moveto 0.45 (* -0.2 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
273                    'rlineto 0.25 -0.3
274                  )
275              0.1
276              2
277              2
278              #f
279            ))
280        ((and (≥ lenx 0.2) (< lenx 2))
281          ;if the flare end is applied
282          ;on the note at the beginning of the system
283          ;without the dynamics (lenx is about 1 to 2)
284          (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
285            (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
286              (hairpin::print-part
287                (scale-coords
288                  (list
289                    (cons (- (car (car coords)) 0)
290                      (cdr (car coords) )))

```

```

291         (cons (- (car (cadr coords)) 0)
292               (cdr (cadr coords))))
293     (+ lenx 0.25) (/ leny 2.75)) decresc? grob)
294     1
295     -1
296     (if mirrored?
297         (hairpin::print-part
298           (scale-coords
299             (list
300               (cons (- (car (car coords)) 0)
301                     (cdr (car coords) ))
302               (cons (- (car (cadr coords)) 0)
303                     (cdr (cadr coords) ))
304               (+ lenx 0.25) (/ leny -2.75)) decresc? grob)
305           empty-stencil)
306     0.1 ;vertical padding value here
307     )
308     0
309     1
310     (make-path-stencil
311       (list 'moveto 0 (* 0.15 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
312             'rlineto 0.25 0.3
313             'moveto 0
314             (- (* -0.15 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.1)
315             'rlineto 0.25 -0.3
316             )
317     0.1
318     2
319     2
320     #f
321     )
322     -0.075
323     ))
324     ((>= lenx 2)
325       ;if the normal ending flare crescendo
326       ;is applied...
327       (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
328         (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
329           (hairpin::print-part
330             (scale-coords
331               coords
332               (+ lenx 0.25) (/ leny 3)) decresc? grob)
333           1
334           -1
335           (if mirrored?
336             (hairpin::print-part
337               (scale-coords
338                 coords

```

```

339          (+ lenx 0.25) (/ leny -3)) decresc? grob)
340      empty-stencil)
341      0.1 ;vertical padding value here
342      )
343      0
344      1
345      (make-path-stencil
346      (list 'moveto 0 (* 0.133 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
347            'rlineto 0.25 0.3
348            'moveto 0
349            (- (* -0.133 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.1)
350            'rlineto 0.25 -0.3
351            )
352      0.1
353      2
354      2
355      #f
356      )
357      -0.075
358      ))
359      )
360      )
361      (decrescStencil
362      (if toBarline?
363      ;I added here to make it default to stretch
364      ;the hairpin immediately to the dynamics
365      (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
366      (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
367      (hairpin::print-part
368      (scale-coords
369      coords
370      (+ lenx 0.25) (/ leny 2)) decresc? grob)
371      1
372      -1
373      (if mirrored?
374      (hairpin::print-part
375      (scale-coords
376      coords
377      (+ lenx 0.25) (/ leny -2)) decresc? grob)
378      empty-stencil)
379      -0.1 ;vertical padding value here
380      )
381      0
382      -1
383      (make-path-stencil
384      (list 'moveto 0 (* 0.19 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
385            'rlineto -0.25 0.3
386            'moveto 0 (* -0.19 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )

```

```

387             'rlineto -0.25 -0.3
388         )
389         0.1
390         2
391         2
392         #f
393     )
394     -0.075
395 )
396 ;if not to barline
397 (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
398 (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
399 (hairpin::print-part
400 (scale-coords
401 coords
402 (+ lenx 0.25) (/ leny 2)) decresc? grob)
403 1
404 -1
405 (if mirrored?
406 (hairpin::print-part
407 (scale-coords
408 coords
409 (+ lenx 0.25) (/ leny -2)) decresc? grob)
410 empty-stencil)
411 -0.1 ;vertical padding value here
412 )
413 0
414 -1
415 (make-path-stencil
416 (list
417 'moveto 0 (* 0.2 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
418 'rlineto -0.25 0.3
419 'moveto 0 (* -0.2 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
420 'rlineto -0.25 -0.3
421 )
422 0.1
423 2
424 2
425 #f
426 )
427 -0.075
428 ))
429 )
430
431 (decrescStencilBrokenBeginning
432 (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
433 (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
434 (hairpin::print-part

```



```

435         (scale-coords
436           coords
437           (+ lenx 0.2) (/ leny 2.5))
438         decresc? grob)
439     1
440   -1
441   (if mirrored?
442     (hairpin::print-part
443       (scale-coords
444         coords
445         (+ lenx 0.2) (/ leny -2.5)) decresc? grob)
446     empty-stencil)
447   0.1 ;vertical padding value here
448 )
449 0
450 -1
451 (make-path-stencil
452   (list 'moveto 0 (* 0.15 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
453         'rlineto -0.25 0.3
454         'moveto 0
455         (- (* -0.15 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.1)
456         'rlineto -0.25 -0.3
457       )
458   0.1
459   2
460   2
461   #f
462   )
463   -0.075
464   )
465 )
466 (decrescStencilBrokenEnding
467   (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
468     (hairpin::print-part uplist decresc? grob)
469     1
470     -1
471     (if mirrored?
472       (hairpin::print-part downlist decresc? grob)
473       empty-stencil)
474     -0.1 ;vertical padding value here
475     )
476   )
477 (cresc
478   (cond (hairpinTypeA? crescStencil)
479         (hairpinTypeB? crescStencilBrokenBeginning)
480         (hairpinTypeC? crescStencilBrokenContinuation)
481         (hairpinTypeD? crescStencilBrokenEnding)
482   )

```

```

483         )
484     (decrec
485         (cond (hairpinTypeA? decrescStencil)
486               (hairpinTypeB? decrescStencilBrokenBeginning)
487               (hairpinTypeC? crescStencilBrokenContinuation)
488               ;crescStencilBrokenContinuation can be used for decresc
489               ;as well, because it gets inverted.
490               (hairpinTypeD? decrescStencilBrokenEnding)
491             )
492     )
493     (stil
494       (ly:stencil-aligned-to
495         (ly:stencil-translate
496           (if decresc?
497             decrec
498             cresc
499           )
500         (cons xtrans ytrans))
501       Y CENTER))
502     (stil-y-extent (ly:stencil-extent stil Y)))
503 ; for debugging purposes
504 ;     (display "Is this type A Hairpin? " )
505 ;     (display hairpinTypeA?)
506 ;     (newline)
507 ;     (display "Is this type B Hairpin? " )
508 ;     (display hairpinTypeB?)
509 ;     (newline)
510 ;     (display "Is this type C Hairpin? " )
511 ;     (display hairpinTypeC?)
512 ;     (newline)
513 ;     (display "Is this type D Hairpin? " )
514 ;     (display hairpinTypeD?)
515 ;
516 ;     (newline)
517 ;     (display "Is it decrescendo? " )
518 ;     (display decresc?)
519 ;     (newline)
520 ;     (display "end-broken-spanner??? " )
521 ;     (display (end-broken-spanner? grob ))
522 ;     (newline)
523 ;     (display "(first-broken-spanner?) Is spanner broken
524 ;and the first of its broken siblings? " )
525 ;     (display (first-broken-spanner? grob ) )
526 ;     (newline)
527 ;     (display "middle-broken-spanner??? " )
528 ;     (display (middle-broken-spanner? grob ) )
529 ;     (newline)
530 ;

```

```

531      ;      (display "Is spanner broken and not the first of
532      ;its broken siblings? " )
533      ;      (display (not-first-broken-spanner? grob ) )
534      ;      (newline)
535      ;
536      ;      (display "Is spanner broken and not the last of
537      ;its broken siblings? " )
538      ;      (display (not-last-broken-spanner? grob ) )
539      ;      (newline)
540      ;
541      ;      (display "unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner??? " )
542      ;      (display (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) )
543      ;      (newline)
544      ;
545      ;      (display "unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner??? " )
546      ;      (display (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) )
547      ;      (newline)
548      ;      (display "unbroken spanner?? " )
549      ;      (display (unbroken-spanner? grob ) )
550      ;      (newline)
551      ;      (newline)
552      ;      (display "distance of xex " )
553      ;      (display lenx )
554      ;      (newline)
555      ;      (newline)
556      (ly:make-stencil (ly:stencil-expr stil) xex stil-y-extent))
557      ;; return empty, if no Hairpin.stencil present.
558      '()))))
559
560      #(define-public flared-hairpin-new
561      (elbowed-hairpin-revised '((0 . 0) (1 . 0.5))
562      #t))
563
564      #(define-public o
565      (make-music 'AbsoluteDynamicEvent
566      'text
567      (markup
568      #:pad-x -inf.0
569      #:concat (
570      #:pad-to-box '(0 . 0.1) '(-0.75 . 1.75)
571      #:translate '(0 . 0.6)
572      #:musicglyph "scripts.flageolet"
573      ))
574      ))
575
576      flaredCresc =
577      #(define-music-function (num dyn) ((number? 0) ly:event? )
578      (let* ((hOffset num))

```

```

579   #{
580     \tweak Hairpin.stencil #flared-hairpin-new
581     \tweak Hairpin.shorten-pair
582     #(lambda (grob)
583       (let* (
584         ;; have we been split?
585         (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
586
587         ;; if yes, get the split pieces (our siblings)
588         (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
589                       (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
590                       '()))))
591
592       (cond
593         ((= (length siblings) 0)
594          (cons -0.6 hOffset)
595          )
596         ((and (>= (length siblings) 1)
597              (eq? (car siblings) grob)
598              )
599          (cons -0.6 0))
600         )
601
602
603
604     )
605   )
606   \tweak Hairpin.after-line-breaking
607   #(lambda (grob)
608     (let* (
609       ;; have we been split?
610       (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
611
612       ;; if yes, get the split pieces (our siblings)
613       (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
614                     (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
615                     '()))
616       (toBarline? (ly:grob-property grob 'to-barline))
617     )
618
619     (cond ((< (length siblings) 2)
620            (ly:grob-set-property!
621             grob 'shorten-pair
622             (cons -0.6 (* hOffset -1)))
623
624            )
625
626     ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)

```

```

627             (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob)
628             toBarline? )
629
630         (ly:grob-set-property!
631         grob 'shorten-pair
632         (cons 0 (- -0.6 hOffset)))
633
634     )
635     ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
636          (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob)
637          (not toBarline?) )
638      (ly:grob-set-property!
639      grob 'shorten-pair
640      (cons (+ -0.6 hOffset) (- -0.6 hOffset)))
641      )
642    )
643  )
644  )
645  )
646  )
647  ) #dyn #}}}
648
649  flaredCrescOverride =
650  #(define-music-function (num mus) ((number? 0) ly:music? )
651    (let* ((hOffset num))
652      #{
653        \once \override Hairpin.stencil = #flared-hairpin-new
654        \once \override Hairpin.shorten-pair =
655        #(lambda (grob)
656          (let* (
657            ;; have we been split?
658            (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
659
660            ;; if yes, get the split pieces (our siblings)
661            (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
662                          (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
663                          '())))
664
665            (cond
666              ((= (length siblings) 0)
667               (cons -0.6 hOffset)
668              )
669              ((and (>= (length siblings) 1)
670               (eq? (car siblings) grob)
671               )
672               (cons -0.6 0))
673            )
674

```

```

675
676
677   )
678   )
679   \once \override Hairpin.after-line-breaking =
680   #(lambda (grob)
681     (let* (
682       ;; have we been split?
683       (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
684
685       ;; if yes, get the split pieces (our siblings)
686       (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
687                     (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
688                     '()))
689       (toBarline? (ly:grob-property grob 'to-barline))
690     )
691
692     (cond ((< (length siblings) 2)
693           (ly:grob-set-property!
694             grob 'shorten-pair
695             (cons -0.6 (* hOffset -1)))
696
697           )
698
699           ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
700                (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob)
701                toBarline? )
702
703            (ly:grob-set-property!
704              grob 'shorten-pair
705              (cons 0 (- -0.6 hOffset)))
706
707            )
708
709            ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
710                 (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob)
711                 (not toBarline? )
712                 (ly:grob-set-property!
713                   grob 'shorten-pair
714                   (cons (+ -0.6 hOffset) (- -0.6 hOffset)))
715
716                 )
717            )
718
719           )
720     ) #mus #}))
721
722 flaredDecresc =

```

```

723 #(define-music-function (num dyn) ((number? 0) ly:event? )
724   (let* ((hOffset num))
725     #{
726       \tweak Hairpin.stencil #flared-hairpin-new
727       \tweak Hairpin.shorten-pair
728       #(lambda (grob)
729         (let* (
730           ;; have we been split?
731           (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
732
733           ;; if yes, get the split pieces (our siblings)
734           (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
735                         (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
736                         '()))
737           (toBarline? (ly:grob-property grob 'to-barline))
738
739           )
740
741         (cond
742           ((and (zero? (length siblings)) (not toBarline?))
743            (cons hOffset -0.6)
744            )
745           ((and (zero? (length siblings)) toBarline?)
746            (cons hOffset -0.6)
747            )
748           ((and (>= (length siblings) 1)
749                (eq? (car siblings) grob)
750                )
751            (cons -0.6 0))
752           )
753         )
754       )
755     \tweak Hairpin.after-line-breaking
756     #(lambda (grob)
757       (let* (
758         ;; have we been split?
759         (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
760
761         ;; if yes, get the split pieces (our siblings)
762         (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
763                       (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
764                       '()))
765
766         (cond
767           ((and (>= (length siblings) 1)
768                (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob))
769           (ly:grob-set-property!
770            grob 'shorten-pair

```

```

771      (cons (+ -0.6 hOffset) (- -0.6 hOffset)))
772    )
773
774    ((zero? (length siblings) )
775     #f
776    )
777
778    ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
779          (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob)
780          toBarline? )
781     (ly:grob-set-property!
782      grob 'shorten-pair
783      (cons 0 (- -0.6 hOffset)))
784    )
785
786    ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
787          (eq? (car siblings) grob)
788          )
789     (ly:grob-set-property!
790      grob 'shorten-pair
791      (cons 0 0))
792    )
793
794    ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
795          (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob)
796          (not toBarline?) )
797     (ly:grob-set-property!
798      grob 'shorten-pair
799      (cons (+ -0.6 hOffset) (- -0.6 hOffset)))
800    )
801  )
802
803
804  )
805  ) #dyn #}))
806
807  flaredDecrescOverride =
808  #(define-music-function (num mus) ((number? 0) ly:music? )
809    (let* ((hOffset num))
810      #{
811        \once \override Hairpin.stencil = #flared-hairpin-new
812        \once \override Hairpin.shorten-pair =
813        #(lambda (grob)
814          (let* (
815              ;; have we been split?
816              (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
817
818              ;; if yes, get the split pieces (our siblings)

```



```

819         (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
820                       (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
821                       '()))
822         (toBarline? (ly:grob-property grob 'to-barline))
823
824     )
825
826 (cond
827   ((and (zero? (length siblings)) (not toBarline?))
828     (cons hOffset -0.6)
829     )
830   ((and (zero? (length siblings)) toBarline?)
831     (cons hOffset -0.6)
832     )
833   ((and (>= (length siblings) 1)
834         (eq? (car siblings) grob)
835         )
836     (cons -0.6 0))
837   )
838 )
839 )
840 \once \override Hairpin.after-line-breaking =
841 #(lambda (grob)
842   (let* (
843     ;; have we been split?
844     (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
845
846     ;; if yes, get the split pieces (our siblings)
847     (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
848                   (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
849                   '()))
850
851     (cond
852       ((and (>= (length siblings) 1)
853         (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob))
854       (ly:grob-set-property!
855        grob 'shorten-pair
856        (cons (+ -0.6 hOffset) (- -0.6 hOffset)))
857       )
858
859     ((zero? (length siblings) )
860      #f
861      )
862
863     ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
864          (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob)
865          toBarline? )
866      (ly:grob-set-property!

```

```

867         grob 'shorten-pair
868         (cons 0 (- -0.6 hOffset)))
869     )
870
871     ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
872          (eq? (car siblings) grob)
873          )
874     (ly:grob-set-property!
875      grob 'shorten-pair
876      (cons 0 0))
877     )
878
879     ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
880          (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob)
881          (not toBarline?) )
882     (ly:grob-set-property!
883      grob 'shorten-pair
884      (cons (+ -0.6 hOffset) (- -0.6 hOffset)))
885     )
886 )
887
888 )
889 ) #mus #}}))
890
891
892 \layout {
893   indent = #0
894   line-width = #100
895   ragged-last = ##f
896 }
897
898
899
900 {
901   \override Hairpin.height = #0.5
902   % \override Hairpin.stencil = #flared-hairpin-new
903   \override Hairpin.to-barline = ##f
904   \override Hairpin.after-line-breaking = ##f
905
906   c' \fff \flaredCresc \< c' c' c' \o \flaredDecresc #-0.25 \>
907   c' c'\o\flaredCresc #-0.6 \< c' c' \break
908   \repeat unfold 3 {c' c' c' c'} \break
909   c'\ff \flaredDecresc \> c' c' c'
910   c' \p \flaredCresc \< c' c' \flaredDecresc \> c'
911   c' \p \flaredCresc \< c' c'\! \flaredDecresc \> c' \break
912   \repeat unfold 3 {c' c' c' c'} \break
913   c' \f \flaredDecresc \> c' c' c'\o \flaredCresc #-1 \<
914   c' c' c' c' \break c'\! s4 s4 s4 \bar"."

```

```
915 \once \override Hairpin.extra-offset = #'(1.5 . 0)
916 \flaredCrescOverride #1.5 \after 2. \f c'1 \<
917 \flaredDecrescOverride #1 \after 2. \p c'1 \> \bar"."
918 }
```

4.4.4 Discussion

[Table of Contents](#)

4.5 Enhanced Flared Hairpins II (Curvy Version)

The image displays six staves of musical notation in treble clef, illustrating various dynamic markings and hairpin types. The first staff shows a *fff* marking with a curved hairpin. The second staff is marked with a '3' at the beginning. The third staff shows a *ff* marking followed by two *p* markings, each with a curved hairpin. The fourth staff is marked with a '9' at the beginning. The fifth staff shows an *f* marking with a curved hairpin. The sixth staff, marked with a '14' at the beginning, shows two *f* markings with curved hairpins. The notation includes various dynamic markings (*fff*, *ff*, *p*, *f*) and hairpin symbols (curved lines with dots) indicating changes in volume.

4.5.1 Description

NB: Significantly updated on December 23, 2025 and cosmetic alteration undertaken on December 24, 2025, as well as new commands being added on January 15 2026.

See [Enhanced Flared Hairpins I](#) for the flared hairpins similar to [LilyPond's default flared hairpins](#).

This version implements hairpins with flares that are curved. Initially Santiago Beis inspired me to take advantage of Phi Curve in making the curvy flares as natural as possible, though I have departed from that approach as I found using `rcurve` useful in `make-path-stencil`, which I then combined with the crescendo lines using `ly:stencil-combine-at-edge`.

4.5.2 Grammar

```
\override Hairpin.to-barline = ##f OR ##t
\override Hairpin.after-line-breaking = ##t OR ##f
```

NOTE \DYNAMIC \flaredCrescCurvy \< NOTE(S) \DYNAMIC OR \!

NOTE \DYNAMIC \flaredDecrescCurvy \> NOTE(S) \DYNAMIC OR \!

If you wish to use circled tips, instead of using `\override Hairpin.circled-tip = ##t`, write:

NOTE \o \flaredCrescCurvy \< NOTE(S) \DYNAMIC OR \! \flaredDecrescCurvy \> NOTE(S) \o

Update: January 15, 2026 If you are using the flared crescendo/diminuendo to a note that also has `\after`, use:

```
\flaredCrescCurvyOverride NOTE \DYNAMIC \<
\flaredDecrescCurvyOverride NOTE \DYNAMIC \>
```

Considering that flared hairpins are often used in tandem with ordinary hairpins, I have embedded `\tweak Hairpin.stencil = #flared-hairpin-curved` in `\flaredCrescCurvy` and `\flaredDecrescCurvy`. Therefore, it is not necessary to write an `\override` command to change the stencil used.

Update: December 23-24, 2025 `\flaredCresc` and `\flaredDecresc` accepts a number as an optional argument. This functionality has been added to allow the adjustment of flaring end of the hairpin, as well as the horizontal placement of the small piece of the arrival hairpin when `\override to-barline` is set `##f`. While I have striven to set the default setting in such a way that these micro-adjustments are not necessary, it seemed helpful to add this functionality when further refinement is needed. Think of this as an `X-offset` for the arrival point. See **Code**.

Update: January 15, 2026 I have discovered that `\flaredCrescCurvy` and `\flaredDecrescCurvy` do not work when it is applied to a note that also has `\after` preceding it, e.g. when the hairpin is terminated within the given note. In order to make such a case work, I have created additional commands `\flaredCrescCurvyOverride` and `\flaredDecrescCurvyOverride`, which use `\once \override` commands instead of `\tweak`. These commands also accept an optional argument that behaves like `X-offset`.

4.5.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 % curvy version
4
5 #(define-public ((curvy-elbowed-hairpin coords mirrored?) grob)
6   "This scheme code was originally the scheme code 'elbowed-hairpin
7   taken from output-lib.scm, and was revised to suit the need.
8   "
9   (define (scale-coords coords-list x y)
10     (map
11       (lambda (coord) (cons (* x (car coord)) (* y (cdr coord))))
12     coords-list))
13
14   (define (hairpin::print-part points decresc? me)
15     (let ((stil (make-connected-line points me)))
16       (if decresc? (ly:stencil-scale stil -1 1)
17         (ly:stencil-scale stil 1 1))))
18
19   ;; outer let to trigger suicide
```

```

20  (let ((sten (ly:hairpin::print grob)))
21    (if (grob::is-live? grob)
22      (let*
23        ((decresc? (eqv?
24                    (ly:grob-property grob 'grow-direction) LEFT))
25         (hairpinHeight (ly:grob-property grob 'height))
26         (toBarline? (ly:grob-property grob 'to-barline))
27         (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
28         (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
29                       (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
30                       '())))
31      (hairpinTypeA?
32        (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob )           #f)
33              (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob )         #f)
34              (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob )        #f)
35              (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob )     #f)
36              (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob )      #f)
37              (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
38              (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
39              (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob )             #t)
40              )) ;Hairpins that end within one line without
41      ;reaching to the end of the system
42      (hairpinTypeB?
43        (or (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob )           #t)
44                  (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob )         #t)
45                  (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob )        #f)
46                  (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob )     #f)
47                  (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob )      #f)
48                  (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
49                  (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
50                  (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob )             #f)
51                  )
52            (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob )           #f)
53                  (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob )         #t)
54                  (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob )        #f)
55                  (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob )     #f)
56                  (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob )      #t)
57                  (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
58                  (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
59                  (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob )             #f)
60                  )
61            )) ;Hairpins that breaks into next line
62      (hairpinTypeC?
63        (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob )           #f)
64              (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob )         #f)
65              (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob )        #t)
66              (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob )     #t)
67              (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob )      #t)

```

```

68      (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
69      (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
70      (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob ) #f)
71      )) ;Midway-through Hairpins
72  (hairpinTypeD?
73    (and (eqv? (end-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
74          (eqv? (first-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
75          (eqv? (middle-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
76          (eqv? (not-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
77          (eqv? (not-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
78          (eqv? (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) #f)
79          (eqv? (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) #t)
80          (eqv? (unbroken-spanner? grob ) #f)
81          )) ;multi-system Hairpin that terminates
82  (xex (if decresc?
83        (cons (+ (car (ly:stencil-extent sten X)) 0.75)
84              (cdr (ly:stencil-extent sten X)))
85        (cons (car (ly:stencil-extent sten X))
86              (- (cdr (ly:stencil-extent sten X)) 1.75)))
87        ))
88  (lenx (interval-length xex))
89  (yex (ly:stencil-extent sten Y))
90  (leny (interval-length yex))
91  (xtrans (+ (car xex) (if decresc? lenx 0)))
92  (ytrans (car yex))
93  (uplist (scale-coords coords lenx (/ leny 2)))
94  (downlist (scale-coords coords lenx (/ leny -2)))
95  ; crescStencil is used when the flared crescendo takes place
96  ; and finishes within one line.
97  (crescStencil
98    (if toBarline?
99      ;I added here to make it default to stretch
100     ;the hairpin immediately to the dynamics
101     (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
102       (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
103         (hairpin::print-part
104           (scale-coords
105             coords
106             (+ lenx 0.95) (/ leny 2)) decresc? grob)
107         1
108         -1
109         (if mirrored?
110           (hairpin::print-part
111             (scale-coords
112               coords
113               (+ lenx 0.95) (/ leny -2)) decresc? grob)
114             empty-stencil)
115         -0.1 ;vertical padding value here

```

```

116         )
117     0
118     1
119     (make-path-stencil
120     (list
121         'moveto 0
122         (+ (* 0.1665 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.015)
123         'rcurveto 0 0 0.3 -0.0 0.4 0.3
124         'moveto 0
125         (- (* -0.1665 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.015)
126         'rcurveto 0 0 0.3 0.0 0.4 -0.3
127     )
128     0.1
129     2
130     2
131     #f
132     )
133     -0.075
134     )
135     ;if not to barline
136     (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
137     (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
138     (hairpin::print-part
139     (scale-coords
140     coords
141     (+ lenx 0.95) (/ leny 2)) decresc? grob)
142     1
143     -1
144     (if mirrored?
145     (hairpin::print-part
146     (scale-coords
147     coords
148     (+ lenx 0.95) (/ leny -2)) decresc? grob)
149     empty-stencil)
150     -0.1 ;vertical padding value here
151     )
152     0
153     1
154     (make-path-stencil
155
156     (list
157         'moveto 0
158         (+ (* 0.1665 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.015)
159         'rcurveto 0 0 0.3 -0.0 0.4 0.3
160         'moveto 0
161         (- (* -0.1665 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.015)
162         'rcurveto 0 0 0.3 0.0 0.4 -0.3
163     )

```



```

164         0.1
165         2
166         2
167         #f
168     )
169     -0.075
170 ))
171 )
172 ; when crescendo begins but breaks off to
173 ; the subsequent system(s)
174 (crescStencilBrokenBeginning
175   ; if the hairpin is set only to barline...
176   (if toBarline?
177     ; ... AND if the hairpin finishes at the beginning
178     ; of the next line
179     ( if (= (length siblings) 1)
180       (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
181         (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
182           (hairpin::print-part
183             (scale-coords
184               coords
185               (+ lenx 0.95) (/ leny 2)) decresc? grob)
186           1
187           -1
188           (if mirrored?
189             (hairpin::print-part
190               (scale-coords
191                 coords
192                 (+ lenx 0.95) (/ leny -2)) decresc? grob)
193             empty-stencil)
194           -0.1 ;vertical padding value here
195         )
196       0
197       1
198       (make-path-stencil
199         (list
200           'moveto 0
201           (+ (* 0.1665 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.015)
202           'rcurveto 0 0 0.3 -0.0 0.4 0.3
203           'moveto 0
204           (- (* -0.1665 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.015)
205           'rcurveto 0 0 0.3 0.0 0.4 -0.3
206         )
207       0.1
208       2
209       2
210       #f
211     )

```

```

212         -0.075
213     )
214     (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
215       (hairpin::print-part
216         (scale-coords
217           coords
218           (+ lenx 1) (/ leny 1.5)) decresc? grob)
219       1
220       -1
221       (if mirrored?
222         (hairpin::print-part
223           (scale-coords
224             coords
225             (+ lenx 1) (/ leny -1.5)) decresc? grob)
226         empty-stencil)
227       -0.1 ;vertical padding value here
228     )
229   )
230 )
231 (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
232   (hairpin::print-part
233     (scale-coords
234       coords
235       (+ lenx 1) (/ leny 1.5)) decresc? grob)
236   1
237   -1
238   (if mirrored?
239     (hairpin::print-part
240       (scale-coords
241         coords
242         (+ lenx 1) (/ leny -1.5)) decresc? grob)
243     empty-stencil)
244   -0.1 ;vertical padding value here
245 )
246 )
247 )
248 )
249 (crescStencilBrokenContinuation
250   (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
251     (hairpin::print-part
252       (scale-coords
253         coords
254         (+ lenx 1) (/ leny 2)) decresc? grob)
255     1
256     -1
257     (if mirrored?
258       (hairpin::print-part
259         (scale-coords

```

```

260         coords
261         (+ lenx 1) (/ leny -2)) decresc? grob)
262     empty-stencil)
263     0.1 ;vertical padding value here
264 )
265 )
266 (crescStencilBrokenEnding
267 ;if the flare end is applied
268 ;on the dynamic at the beginning
269 ;of the system, meaning lenx is super low
270 (cond ((< lenx 0.2)
271       (make-path-stencil
272         (list 'moveto 0.45 (* 0.2 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
273               'lineto -0.5 0.1
274               'moveto 0.45 (* 0.2 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
275               'rcurveto 0 0 0.3 0 0.4 0.3
276               'moveto 0.45 (* -0.2 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
277               'lineto -0.5 -0.1
278               'moveto 0.45 (* -0.2 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
279               'rcurveto 0 0 0.3 0 0.4 -0.3
280             )
281         0.1
282         2
283         2
284         #f
285       ))
286 ((and (>= lenx 0.2)(< lenx 2))
287 ;if the flare end is applied
288 ;on the note at the beginning of the system
289 ;without the dynamics (lenx is about 1 to 2)
290 (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
291 (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
292 (hairpin::print-part
293 (scale-coords
294 (list
295 (cons (- (car (car coords)) 0)
296 (cdr (car coords) )))
297 (cons (- (car (cadr coords)) 0)
298 (cdr (cadr coords) )))
299 (+ lenx 0.25) (/ leny 2.75)) decresc? grob)
300 1
301 -1
302 (if mirrored?
303 (hairpin::print-part
304 (scale-coords
305 (list
306 (cons (- (car (car coords)) 0)
307 (cdr (car coords) )))

```

```

308             (cons (- (car (cadr coords)) 0)
309                   (cdr (cadr coords))))
310             (+ lenx 0.25) (/ leny -2.75)) decresc? grob)
311         empty-stencil)
312     0.1 ;vertical padding value here
313 )
314 0
315 1
316 (make-path-stencil
317   (list 'moveto 0 (* 0.15 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) )
318         'rcurveto 0 0 0.3 -0.0 0.4 0.3
319         'moveto 0
320         (- (* -0.15 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.1)
321         'rcurveto 0 0 0.3 0.0 0.4 -0.3
322         )
323     0.1
324     2
325     2
326     #f
327     )
328     -0.075
329     ))
330 ((>= lenx 2)
331  ;if the normal ending flare crescendo
332  ;is applied...
333
334  (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
335  (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
336  (hairpin::print-part
337  (scale-coords
338  coords
339  (+ lenx 0.75) (/ leny 3)) decresc? grob)
340  1
341  -1
342  (if mirrored?
343  (hairpin::print-part
344  (scale-coords
345  coords
346  (+ lenx 0.75) (/ leny -3)) decresc? grob)
347  empty-stencil)
348  0.1 ;vertical padding value here
349  )
350  0
351  1
352  (make-path-stencil
353  (list 'moveto 0
354        (+ (* 0.111 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.01 )
355        'rcurveto 0 0 0.3 -0.0 0.4 0.3

```

```

356             'moveto 0
357             (- (* -0.111 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.11)
358             'rcurveto 0 0 0.3 0.0 0.4 -0.3
359         )
360         0.1
361         2
362         2
363         #f
364     )
365     -0.075
366 ))
367 )
368 )
369 (decreascStencil
370   (if toBarline?
371     ;I added here to make it default to stretch
372     ;the hairpin immediately to the dynamics
373     (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
374       (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
375         (hairpin::print-part
376           (scale-coords
377             coords
378             (+ lenx 0.25) (/ leny 2)) decreasc? grob)
379         1
380         -1
381         (if mirrored?
382           (hairpin::print-part
383             (scale-coords
384               coords
385               (+ lenx 0.25) (/ leny -2)) decreasc? grob)
386           empty-stencil)
387         -0.1 ;vertical padding value here
388       )
389       0
390       -1
391       (make-path-stencil
392         (list 'moveto 0
393               (+ (* 0.1665 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.015)
394               'rcurveto 0 0 -0.3 -0.0 -0.4 0.3
395               'moveto 0
396               (- (* -0.1665 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.015)
397               'rcurveto 0 0 -0.3 0.0 -0.4 -0.3
398             )
399         0.1
400         2
401         2
402         #f
403       )

```

```

404         -0.075
405     )
406     ;if not to barline
407     (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
408     (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
409     (hairpin::print-part
410     (scale-coords
411     coords
412     (+ lenx 0.25) (/ leny 2)) decresc? grob)
413     1
414     -1
415     (if mirrored?
416     (hairpin::print-part
417     (scale-coords
418     coords
419     (+ lenx 0.25) (/ leny -2)) decresc? grob)
420     empty-stencil)
421     -0.1 ;vertical padding value here
422     )
423     0
424     -1
425     (make-path-stencil
426     (list
427     'moveto 0
428     (+ (* 0.1665 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.015)
429     'rcurveto 0 0 -0.3 -0.0 -0.4 0.3
430     'moveto 0
431     (- (* -0.1665 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.015)
432     'rcurveto 0 0 -0.3 0.0 -0.4 -0.3
433     )
434     0.1
435     2
436     2
437     #f
438     )
439     -0.075
440     ))
441 )
442
443 (decrescStencilBrokenBeginning
444 (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
445 (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
446 (hairpin::print-part
447 (scale-coords
448 coords
449 (+ lenx 0.2) (/ leny 2.5))
450 decresc? grob)
451 1

```

```

452         -1
453         (if mirrored?
454           (hairpin::print-part
455             (scale-coords
456               coords
457               (+ lenx 0.2) (/ leny -2.5)) decresc? grob)
458           empty-stencil)
459         0.1 ;vertical padding value here
460       )
461     0
462     -1
463     (make-path-stencil
464       (list 'moveto 0
465             (+ (* 0.135 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.01 )
466             'rcurveto 0 0 -0.3 -0.0 -0.4 0.3
467             'moveto 0
468             (- (* -0.135 (/ hairpinHeight 0.666) ) 0.11)
469             'rcurveto 0 0 -0.3 0.0 -0.4 -0.3
470             )
471       0.1
472       2
473       2
474       #f
475       )
476     -0.075
477   )
478 )
479 (decrescStencilBrokenEnding
480 (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
481 (hairpin::print-part uplist decresc? grob)
482 1
483 -1
484 (if mirrored?
485   (hairpin::print-part downlist decresc? grob)
486   empty-stencil)
487 -0.1 ;vertical padding value here
488 )
489 )
490 (cresc
491 (cond (hairpinTypeA? crescStencil)
492       (hairpinTypeB? crescStencilBrokenBeginning)
493       (hairpinTypeC? crescStencilBrokenContinuation)
494       (hairpinTypeD? crescStencilBrokenEnding)
495     )
496 )
497 (decrec
498 (cond (hairpinTypeA? decrescStencil)
499       (hairpinTypeB? decrescStencilBrokenBeginning)

```

```

500         (hairpinTypeC? crescStencilBrokenContinuation)
501         ;crescStencilBrokenContinuation can be used for
502         ;decresc as well, because it gets inverted.
503         (hairpinTypeD? decrescStencilBrokenEnding)
504     )
505 )
506 (stil
507   (ly:stencil-aligned-to
508     (ly:stencil-translate
509       (if decresc?
510         decresc
511         cresc
512       )
513       (cons xtrans ytrans))
514     Y CENTER))
515 (stil-y-extent (ly:stencil-extent stil Y)))
516 ; for debugging purposes
517 ;   (display "Is this type A Hairpin? " )
518 ;   (display hairpinTypeA?)
519 ;   (newline)
520 ;   (display "Is this type B Hairpin? " )
521 ;   (display hairpinTypeB?)
522 ;   (newline)
523 ;   (display "Is this type C Hairpin? " )
524 ;   (display hairpinTypeC?)
525 ;   (newline)
526 ;   (display "Is this type D Hairpin? " )
527 ;   (display hairpinTypeD?)
528 ;
529 ;   (newline)
530 ;   (display "Is it decrescendo? " )
531 ;   (display decresc?)
532 ;   (newline)
533 ;   (display "end-broken-spanner??? " )
534 ;   (display (end-broken-spanner? grob ))
535 ;   (newline)
536 ;   (display "(first-broken-spanner?) Is spanner broken
537 ;and the first of its broken siblings? " )
538 ;   (display (first-broken-spanner? grob ) )
539 ;   (newline)
540 ;   (display "middle-broken-spanner??? " )
541 ;   (display (middle-broken-spanner? grob ) )
542 ;   (newline)
543 ;
544 ;   (display "Is spanner broken and not the first of
545 ;its broken siblings? " )
546 ;   (display (not-first-broken-spanner? grob ) )
547 ;   (newline)

```



```

548      ;
549      ;      (display "Is spanner broken and not the last of
550      ;its broken siblings? " )
551      ;      (display (not-last-broken-spanner? grob ) )
552      ;      (newline)
553      ;
554      ;      (display "unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner??? " )
555      ;      (display (unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner? grob ) )
556      ;      (newline)
557      ;
558      ;      (display "unbroken-or-first-broken-spanner??? " )
559      ;      (display (unbroken-or-last-broken-spanner? grob ) )
560      ;      (newline)
561      ;      (display "unbroken spanner?? " )
562      ;      (display (unbroken-spanner? grob ) )
563      ;      (newline)
564      ;      (newline)
565      ;      (display "distance of xex " )
566      ;      (display lenx )
567      ;      (newline)
568      ;      (newline)
569      (ly:make-stencil (ly:stencil-expr stil) xex stil-y-extent))
570      ;; return empty, if no Hairpin.stencil present.
571      '()))
572
573      #(define-public flared-hairpin-curved
574      (curvy-elbowed-hairpin '((0 . 0) (1 . 0.5))
575      #t))
576
577      #(define-public o
578      (make-music 'AbsoluteDynamicEvent
579      'text
580      (markup
581      #:pad-x -inf.0
582      #:concat (
583      #:pad-to-box '(0 . 0.1) '(-0.75 . 1.75)
584      #:translate '(0 . 0.6)
585      #:musicglyph "scripts.flageolet"
586      ))
587      ))
588      flaredCrescCurvy =
589      #(define-music-function (num dyn) ((number? 0) ly:event? )
590      (let* ((hOffset num))
591      #{
592      \tweak Hairpin.stencil #flared-hairpin-curved
593      \tweak Hairpin.shorten-pair
594      #(lambda (grob)
595      (let* (

```

```

596         ;; have we been split?
597         (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
598
599         ;; if yes, get the split pieces (our siblings)
600         (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
601                       (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
602                       '()))
603
604     (cond
605      ((= (length siblings) 0)
606       (cons -0.6 hOffset)
607       )
608      ((and (>= (length siblings) 1)
609            (eq? (car siblings) grob)
610            )
611       (cons -0.6 0))
612      )
613
614
615    )
616  )
617
618  \tweak Hairpin.after-line-breaking
619  #(lambda (grob)
620    (let* (
621      ;; have we been split?
622      (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
623
624      ;; if yes, get the split pieces (our siblings)
625      (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
626                    (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
627                    '()))
628      (toBarline? (ly:grob-property grob 'to-barline))
629      )
630
631      (cond ((< (length siblings) 2)
632            (ly:grob-set-property!
633             grob 'shorten-pair
634             (cons -0.6 (* hOffset -1)))
635            )
636
637            ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
638                  (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob)
639                  toBarline? )
640            (ly:grob-set-property!
641             grob 'shorten-pair

```

```

644         (cons 0 (- -0.6 hOffset)))
645
646
647     )
648     ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
649          (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob)
650          (not toBarline?) )
651      (ly:grob-set-property!
652       grob 'shorten-pair
653       (cons (+ -0.6 hOffset) (- -0.6 hOffset))))
654
655     )
656   )
657
658   )
659   ) #dyn #}))
660
661 flaredDecrescCurvy =
662 #define-music-function (num dyn) ((number? 0) ly:event? )
663 (let* ((hOffset num))
664   #{
665     \tweak Hairpin.stencil #flared-hairpin-curvy
666     \tweak Hairpin.shorten-pair
667     #(lambda (grob)
668       (let* (
669         ;; have we been split?
670         (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
671
672         ;; if yes, get the split pieces (our siblings)
673         (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
674                       (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
675                       '()))
676         (toBarline? (ly:grob-property grob 'to-barline))
677
678         )
679
680       (cond
681         ((and (zero? (length siblings)) (not toBarline?))
682          (cons hOffset -0.6)
683          )
684         ((and (zero? (length siblings)) toBarline?)
685          (cons hOffset -0.6)
686          )
687         ((and (>= (length siblings) 1)
688              (eq? (car siblings) grob)
689              )
690          (cons -0.6 0))
691       )

```

```

692     )
693   )
694   \tweak Hairpin.after-line-breaking
695   #(lambda (grob)
696     (let* (
697       ;; have we been split?
698       (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
699
700       ;; if yes, get the split pieces (our siblings)
701       (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
702                     (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
703                     '()))))
704
705     (cond
706       ((and (>= (length siblings) 1)
707            (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob))
708        (ly:grob-set-property!
709         grob 'shorten-pair
710         (cons (+ -0.6 hoffset) (- -0.6 hoffset)))
711       )
712
713       ((zero? (length siblings) )
714        #f
715       )
716
717       ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
718            (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob)
719            toBarline? )
720        (ly:grob-set-property!
721         grob 'shorten-pair
722         (cons 0 (- -0.6 hoffset)))
723       )
724
725       ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
726            (eq? (car siblings) grob)
727            )
728        (ly:grob-set-property!
729         grob 'shorten-pair
730         (cons 0 0))
731       )
732
733       ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
734            (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob)
735            (not toBarline?) )
736        (ly:grob-set-property!
737         grob 'shorten-pair
738         (cons (+ -0.6 hoffset) (- -0.6 hoffset)))
739       )

```

```

740         )
741
742
743     )
744     ) #dyn #}}}
745
746 \layout {
747     indent = #0
748     line-width = #100
749     ragged-last = ##t
750 }
751
752
753 flaredCrescCurvyOverride =
754 #(define-music-function (num mus) ((number? 0) ly:music? )
755   (let* ((hOffset num))
756     #{
757       \once \override Hairpin.stencil = #flared-hairpin-curved
758       \once \override Hairpin.shorten-pair =
759       #(lambda (grob)
760         (let* (
761             ;; have we been split?
762             (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
763
764             ;; if yes, get the split pieces (our siblings)
765             (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
766                           (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
767                           '())))
768           (cond
769             ((= (length siblings) 0)
770              (cons -0.6 hOffset)
771              )
772             ((and (>= (length siblings) 1)
773              (eq? (car siblings) grob)
774              )
775              (cons -0.6 0))
776           )
777         )
778       )
779 \once \override Hairpin.after-line-breaking =
780 #(lambda (grob)
781   (let* (
782     ;; have we been split?
783     (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
784
785     ;; if yes, get the split pieces (our siblings)
786     (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
787                   (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)

```

```

788             '()))
789         (toBarline? (ly:grob-property grob 'to-barline))
790     )
791
792     (cond ((< (length siblings) 2)
793           (ly:grob-set-property!
794             grob 'shorten-pair
795             (cons -0.6 (* hOffset -1)))
796           )
797
798           ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
799                (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob)
800                toBarline? )
801
802             (ly:grob-set-property!
803               grob 'shorten-pair
804               (cons 0 (- -0.6 hOffset)))
805             )
806
807           ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
808                (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob)
809                (not toBarline? )
810                (ly:grob-set-property!
811                  grob 'shorten-pair
812                  (cons (+ -0.6 hOffset) (- -0.6 hOffset)))
813                )
814           )
815
816     )
817
818   )
819 ) #mus #}))
820
821
822
823
824 flaredDecrescCurvyOverride =
825 #define-music-function (num mus) ((number? 0) ly:music? )
826 (let* ((hOffset num))
827   #{
828     \once \override Hairpin.stencil = #flared-hairpin-curved
829     \once \override Hairpin.shorten-pair =
830     #lambda (grob)
831       (let* (
832         ;; have we been split?
833         (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
834
835         ;; if yes, get the split pieces (our siblings)

```

```

836         (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
837                       (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
838                       '()))
839         (toBarline? (ly:grob-property grob 'to-barline))
840
841     )
842
843     (cond
844       ((and (zero? (length siblings)) (not toBarline?))
845        (cons hOffset -0.6)
846        )
847       ((and (zero? (length siblings)) toBarline?)
848        (cons hOffset -0.6)
849        )
850       ((and (>= (length siblings) 1)
851            (eq? (car siblings) grob)
852            )
853        (cons -0.6 0))
854     )
855   )
856 )
857 \once \override Hairpin.after-line-breaking =
858 #(lambda (grob)
859   (let* (
860     ;; have we been split?
861     (orig (ly:grob-original grob))
862
863     ;; if yes, get the split pieces (our siblings)
864     (siblings (if (ly:grob? orig)
865                  (ly:spanner-broken-into orig)
866                  '()))
867
868     (cond
869       ((and (>= (length siblings) 1)
870        (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob))
871       (ly:grob-set-property!
872        grob 'shorten-pair
873        (cons (+ -0.6 hOffset) (- -0.6 hOffset)))
874     )
875
876     ((zero? (length siblings) )
877      #f
878     )
879
880     ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
881          (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob)
882          toBarline? )
883      (ly:grob-set-property!

```

```

884         grob 'shorten-pair
885         (cons 0 (- -0.6 hOffset)))
886     )
887
888     ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
889          (eq? (car siblings) grob)
890          )
891     (ly:grob-set-property!
892      grob 'shorten-pair
893      (cons 0 0))
894     )
895
896     ((and (>= (length siblings) 2)
897          (eq? (car (last-pair siblings)) grob)
898          (not toBarline?) )
899     (ly:grob-set-property!
900      grob 'shorten-pair
901      (cons (+ -0.6 hOffset) (- -0.6 hOffset)))
902     )
903 )
904
905
906 )
907 ) #mus #}}))
908 \layout {
909   ragged-last = ##f
910 }
911 {
912   \override Hairpin.height = #0.5
913   % \override Hairpin.stencil = #flared-hairpin-curve
914   \override Hairpin.to-barline = ##f
915   \override Hairpin.after-line-breaking = ##f
916
917   c' \fff \flaredCrescCurvy #0.25 \< c' c' c' \o \flaredDecrescCurvy #0 \>
918   c' c' \o \flaredCrescCurvy #-0.6 \< c' c' \break
919   \repeat unfold 3 {c' c' c' c'} \break
920   c' \ff \flaredDecrescCurvy \> c' c' c'
921   c' \p \flaredCrescCurvy \< c' c' \flaredDecrescCurvy \> c'
922   c' \p \flaredCrescCurvy \< c' c' \! \flaredDecrescCurvy \> c' \break
923   \repeat unfold 3 {c' c' c' c'} \break
924   c' \f \flaredDecrescCurvy \> c' c' c' \o \flaredCrescCurvy #-1 \<
925   c' c' c' c' \break c' \! s4 s4 s4 \bar "."
926   \once \override Hairpin.extra-offset = #'(1.5 . 0)
927   \flaredCrescCurvyOverride #1.5 \after 2. \f c'1 \<
928   \flaredDecrescCurvyOverride #1 \after 2. \f c'1 \> \bar "."
929 }
930

```

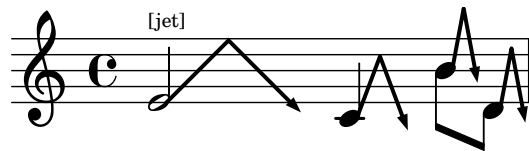

4.5.4 Discussion

[Table of Contents](#)

Chapter 5

Noteheads

5.1 Jet Whistle (for flute) (deprecated)



5.1.1 Description

This snippet has been deprecated. The snippet itself works for 2.26.0; however, readers are advised to use [Version 2](#) of the implementation (initially released Aug. 10, 2025), which will continue to be updated.

Implementation of the jet whistle, as described in *The Techniques of Flute Playing* by Carin Levine and Christina Mitropoulos-Bott.¹

5.1.2 Grammar

`\jet NOTE #X-length`

5.1.3 Code

```
1 jet = #(define-music-function (pitchthing width) (ly:music? number?)
2         (define p1 (ly:music-property pitchthing 'pitch))
3         (define steps (+ -6 (ly:pitch-steps p1)))
4         (define radToDeg (* 180 (/ 1 3.141592653589793)))
5         #{ #pitchthing ^\markup {
6             \postscript
7             #(string-append "gsave newpath 0.2 setlinewidth 1.15 "
8                             (number->string
```

1. Carin Levine and Christina Mitropoulos-Bott, *The techniques of flute playing = Die Spieltechnik der Flöte* (Kassel ; New York: Bärenreiter, 2003), 18.

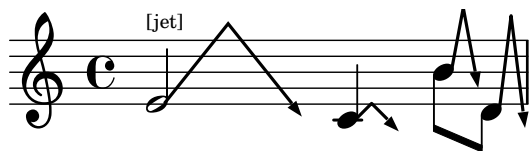
```

9              (+ -2.5 (* 0.5 steps))) " moveto "
10             (number->string
11              (* 0.5 width)) " 4 rlineto "
12             (number->string
13              (* 0.5 width)) " -4 rlineto
14
15             stroke
16             newpath
17             0.1 setlinewidth "
18             (number->string (+ 1.15 width)) " "
19             (number->string (+ -2.55 (* 0.5 steps)))
20             " moveto "
21             (number->string
22              (* radToDeg (atan (/ (* width 0.5) 4))))
23             " rotate
24
25             0 -1 rlineto
26             -0.35 1 rlineto
27             0.7 0 rlineto
28             -0.35 -1 rlineto
29             closepath
30             fill
31             grestore
32             ")
33         } #}})
34
35 \score {
36   {
37     \jet e'2~\markup {\fontsize #-5 {[jet]}} #8
38     \jet c'4 #3
39     \stemDown \jet b'8 #1.5
40     \jet d'8 #1.5
41   }
42
43   \layout {
44     \context {
45       \Score proportionalNotationDuration = #(ly:make-moment 1/10)
46       \override SpacingSpanner.uniform-stretching = ##t
47     }
48   }
49 }

```

[Table of Contents](#)

5.2 Jet Whistle (for flute) (Version 2)



5.2.1 Description

Implementation of the jet whistle, as described in *The Techniques of Flute Playing* by Carin Levine and Christina Mitropoulos-Bott.²

This is an improved version of the [original version of the jet whistle implementation](#). This version adds the functionality to adjust the height, as well as the width of the jet whistle sign.

5.2.2 Grammar

`\jet NOTE #Y-length #X-length`

5.2.3 Code

```

1
2 \version "2.26.0"
3
4 jet = #(define-music-function (pitchthing height width) (ly:music? number? number?)
5       (define p1 (ly:music-property pitchthing 'pitch))
6       (define steps (+ -6 (ly:pitch-steps p1)))
7       (define radToDeg (* 180 (/ 1 3.141592653589793)))
8
9
10      #{ #pitchthing ^\markup {
11          \postscript #(string-append
12                      "gsave
13 newpath
14 0.2 setlinewidth
15 1.15 " (number->string (+ -2.5 (* 0.5 steps))) " moveto "
16
17                      (number->string (* 0.5 width)) " "
18                      (number->string height) " rlineto "
19                      (number->string (* 0.5 width)) " "
20                      (number->string (* height -1))
21                      " rlineto
22 stroke
23 newpath
24 0.1 setlinewidth
25 "
26                      (number->string (+ 1.15 width)))

```

2. Levine and Mitropoulos-Bott, *The techniques of flute playing = Die Spieltechnik der Flöte*, 18.

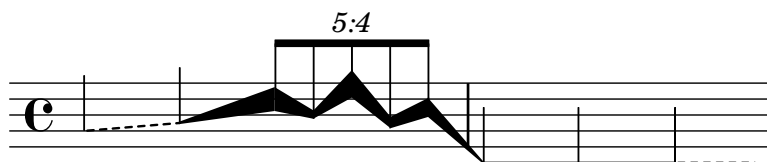
```

27             " " (number->string (+ -2.55 (* 0.5 steps)))
28             " moveto "
29             (number->string
30             (* radToDeg (atan (/ (* width 0.5) height))))
31             " rotate
32 0 -1 rlineto
33 -0.35 1 rlineto
34 0.7 0 rlineto
35 -0.35 -1 rlineto
36 closepath
37 fill
38 grestore
39 ")
40         } #})
41
42
43 \score {
44 {
45   \jet e'2~\markup {\fontsize #-5 {[jet]}} #5 #8
46   \jet c'4 #1 #2
47   \stemDown
48   \jet b'8 #4 #1.5
49   \jet d'8 #6 #1.5
50 }
51
52 \layout {
53   \context {
54     \Score proportionalNotationDuration = #1/10
55     \override SpacingSpanner.uniform-stretching = ##t
56   }
57 }
58 }
59

```

[Table of Contents](#)

5.3 Line as a Notehead



5.3.1 Description

These functions replace an ordinary notehead with a dashed or a continuous line. For the continuous line, it is possible to adjust the beginning and ending thicknesses.

5.3.2 Grammar

```
\dashedLineNotehead NOTE1 PITCH #x-dist
\modularLineNotehead NOTE1 PITCH #beginningThick #endingThick #x-dist
```

NB

1. NOTE1 specifies with which note the line starts. If necessary, the duration must be set, as well.
2. PITCH specifies with which pitch the line ends. Enter only the pitch; this information is used to determine the angle of the line, and it has no effect in displaying the rhythm.
3. x-dist specifies how long the line is.
4. beginningThick (for modularLineNotehead only) specifies how thick the beginning part of the line should be. #15 gives a thin line, similar to the \dashedLineNotehead line. #100 is as thick as a space between two neighboring lines of a staff.
5. endingThick (for modularLineNotehead only) specifies how thick the ending part of the line should be. #15 gives a thin line, similar to the \dashedLineNotehead line. #100 is as thick as a space between two neighboring lines of a staff.

5.3.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 noteheadless = \once \override Voice.NoteHead.stencil = #point-stencil
4
5 dashedLineNotehead =
6 #(define-music-function
7   (beginning end x-distance) (ly:music? ly:music? number?)
8   (let*
9     (
10      (p1 (ly:music-property beginning 'pitch))
11      (p2 (ly:music-property end 'pitch))
12      (steps
13        (-
14          (+ (* 7 (ly:pitch-octave p2)) (ly:pitch-notename p2))
15          (+ (* 7 (ly:pitch-octave p1)) (ly:pitch-notename p1))
```

```

16      )
17      )
18      )
19      #{
20      {
21        \once \override Voice.NoteHead.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
22        \once \override Voice.NoteHead.stem-attachment = #'(0 . 0)
23        \once \override Staff.LedgerLineSpanner.stencil = ##f
24        \once \override Voice.NoteHead.text = \markup          {
25          % \translate #(cons 0 0)
26          \postscript
27          #(string-append
28            "newpath 1 setlinecap
29              0.15 setlinewidth
30              0 0 moveto
31              [.4 .4 .4 .4] 3 setdash "
32            (number->string x-distance) " " (number->string (* steps 0.5))
33            " rlineto stroke"
34          )
35        }
36        #beginning
37        \revert Voice.NoteHead.stencil
38        \revert Staff.LedgerLineSpanner.stencil
39      }
40      #})
41    )
42
43    modularLineNotehead =
44    #(define-music-function
45      (beginning end beginningThickness endingThickness x-distance)
46      (ly:music? ly:music? number? number? number?)
47      (let*
48        (
49          (p1 (ly:music-property beginning 'pitch))
50          (p2 (ly:music-property end 'pitch))
51          (steps
52            (-
53              (+ (* 7 (ly:pitch-octave p2)) (ly:pitch-notename p2))
54              (+ (* 7 (ly:pitch-octave p1)) (ly:pitch-notename p1))
55            )
56          )
57        )
58      #{
59      {
60
61        \once \override Voice.NoteHead.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
62        \once \override Voice.NoteHead.stem-attachment = #'(0 . 0)
63        \once \override Voice.LedgerLineSpanner.transparent = ##t

```

```

64     \once \override Voice.NoteHead.text = \markup          {
65         \postscript
66         #(string-append
67             "newpath 1 setlinecap 0.1 setlinewidth -0.05 0 moveto 0 "
68             (number->string (* beginningThickness 0.005)) " rlineto "
69             (number->string x-distance) " "
70             (number->string (+ (- (* endingThickness 0.005)
71                                   (* beginningThickness 0.005) )
72                                   (* steps 0.5)))
73             " rlineto 0 "
74             (number->string (* endingThickness -0.01)) " rlineto "
75             (number->string (* -1 x-distance)) " "
76             (number->string (- (* endingThickness 0.005)
77                                   (* beginningThickness 0.005)
78                                   (* steps 0.5)))
79             " rlineto
80                 closepath
81                 fill"
82         )
83     }
84     #beginning
85     \revert Voice.NoteHead.stencil
86     \revert Staff.LedgerLineSpanner.stencil
87 }
88 #})
89 )
90
91
92 \score {
93 {
94     \omit Staff.Clef
95     \dashedLineNotehead g'4 a' #6
96     \modularLineNotehead a' d'' #15 #150 #6
97     \override TupletNumber.text = #tuplet-number::calc-fraction-text
98
99     \stemUp \tuplet 5/4 {
100         \modularLineNotehead d''8 b' #150 #50 #2.5
101         \modularLineNotehead b' f'' #50 #175 #2.5
102         \modularLineNotehead f'' a' #175 #70 #2.5
103         \modularLineNotehead a' c'' #70 #120 #2.5
104         \modularLineNotehead c'' c' #120 #15 #3.5
105     }
106     |
107     \modularLineNotehead c'4 c' #15 #15 #12
108     \noteheadless c'
109     \dashedLineNotehead c' c' #5
110 }
111

```



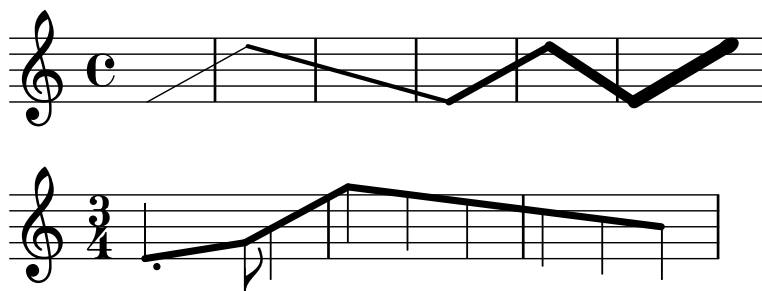
```
112 \layout {
113   \context {
114     \Score proportionalNotationDuration = #1/10
115     \override SpacingSpanner.uniform-stretching = ##t
116   }
117 }
118 }
119
```

5.3.4 Discussion

See [Prescriptive Notation for String Instruments](#) for a possible use of this notehead.

[Table of Contents](#)

5.4 Line as a Notehead 2



5.4.1 Description

These functions replace ordinary noteheads with a dashed or a continuous line. However, unlike the [First Version](#), these functions use `\glissando` as the basis for drawing the line.

5.4.2 Grammar

```
\lineNotehead #THICKNESS NOTE
\lineNoteheadOn #THICKNESS STARTING_NOTE NOTES...
\lineNoteheadOff ARRIVING_NOTE
\lineNoteheadWithRhythm #THICKNESS NOTE
\lineNoteheadWithRhythmOn #THICKNESS STARTING_NOTE NOTES...
\lineNoteheadWithRhythmOff ARRIVING_NOTE
```

NB

1. `\lineNotehead` only shows the line on the staff.
2. `\lineNoteheadWithRhythm` retains the rhythmic information.
3. `\lineNotehead` and `\lineNoteheadWithRhythm` applies the line from one note to another, without the line spanning multiple notes.
4. If the line must span over more than a note, use `\lineNoteheadOn` or `\lineNoteheadWithRhythmOn`.
5. In order to exit the line-as-a-notehead mode, use `\lineNoteheadOff` for both `\lineNotehead` and `\lineNoteheadWithRhythm`. In case the notehead must be disguised at the arrival, you may reduce the font size of the Notehead very drastically. See the Code for an example of this.
6. When using `\lineNoteheadWithRhythm` and `\lineNoteheadWithRhythmOn`, cautions must be paid to the placements of the augmentation dots and the intermediate stems. In the Code, I use:
`\once \override Voice.Dots.extra-offset = #'(0 . -1)`
 And place this *before* the `\lineNoteheadWithRhythmOn`.

5.4.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
```

```

3 % revised on January 25 2025
4
5 lineNotehead =
6 #(define-music-function (thickness note) (number? ly:music? )
7   #{
8     \once \override NoteHead.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
9     \once \override NoteHead.text = \markup{ \char ##x200A }
10    \once \override Dots.stencil = ##f
11    \once \override Glissando.breakable = ##t
12    \once \override Glissando.after-line-breaking = ##t
13    \once \override Glissando.thickness = #thickness
14    \once \override Glissando.bound-details =
15    #'(
16      (left (padding . 0))
17      (right (padding . 0))
18    )
19    #note
20    \glissando
21
22  #})
23
24 lineNoteheadOn =
25 #(define-music-function (thickness note) (number? ly:music?)
26   #{
27     \override Stem.stencil = ##f
28     \override Flag.stencil = ##f
29     \override TupletBracket.stencil = ##f
30     \override TupletNumber.stencil = ##f
31     \override Beam.stencil = ##f
32     \override NoteHead.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
33     \override NoteHead.text = \markup{ \char ##x200A }
34     \override Dots.stencil = ##f
35     \override Glissando.breakable = ##t
36     \override Glissando.after-line-breaking = ##t
37     \override Glissando.thickness = #thickness
38     \override Glissando.bound-details =
39     #'(
40       (left (padding . 0))
41       (right (padding . 0))
42     )
43     #note
44     \glissando
45     \override NoteColumn.glissando-skip = ##t
46   #})
47
48
49 lineNoteheadWithRhythm =
50 #(define-music-function (thickness note) (number? ly:music?)

```

```

51   #{
52     \once \override NoteHead.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
53     \once \override NoteHead.text = \markup{ \char ##x200A }
54     \once \override Glissando.breakable = ##t
55     \once \override Glissando.after-line-breaking = ##t
56     \once \override Glissando.thickness = #thickness
57     \once \override Glissando.bound-details =
58     #'(
59       (left (padding . 0))
60       (right (padding . 0))
61     )
62     #note
63     \glissando
64
65   #})
66
67 lineNoteheadWithRhythmOn =
68 #(define-music-function (thickness note) (number? ly:music?)
69   #{
70     \override NoteHead.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
71     \override NoteHead.text = \markup{ \char ##x200A }
72     \override Glissando.breakable = ##t
73     \override Glissando.after-line-breaking = ##t
74     \override Glissando.thickness = #thickness
75     \override Glissando.bound-details =
76     #'(
77       (left (padding . 0))
78       (right (padding . 0))
79     )
80     #note
81     \glissando
82     \override NoteColumn.glissando-skip = ##t
83   #})
84
85
86 lineNoteheadOff =
87 {
88   \revert Stem.stencil
89   \revert Flag.stencil
90   \revert Beam.stencil
91   \revert NoteHead.stencil
92   \revert Dots.stencil
93   \revert Glissando.breakable
94   \revert Glissando.after-line-breaking
95   \revert Glissando.thickness
96   \revert Glissando.bound-details
97   \revert NoteColumn.glissando-skip
98   \revert TupletBracket.stencil

```

```

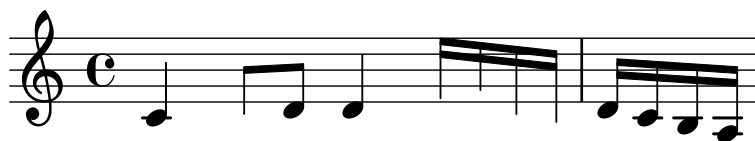
99  \revert TupletNumber.stencil
100 \revert Beam.stencil
101 }
102
103
104 {
105
106  \lineNotehead #1 e'1
107  \lineNoteheadOn #3
108  e''1
109  b'1
110  \lineNoteheadOff
111  \lineNotehead #5
112  e'1
113  \lineNotehead #7
114  e''1
115  \lineNoteheadOn #9 e'4
116  e''4. e'8
117  \lineNoteheadOff
118  \omit Stem
119  e''4
120
121 }
122
123 \score {
124   {
125     \time 3/4
126     \once \override Voice.Dots.extra-offset = #'(0 . -1)
127     \lineNoteheadWithRhythm #5 e'4.
128     \stemDown
129     \lineNoteheadWithRhythmOn #5
130
131     g'8
132     b'4
133     \lineNoteheadOff
134     \lineNoteheadWithRhythmOn #5
135     g''4
136     f''4
137     e''4
138     d''4
139     c''4
140     \lineNoteheadOff
141     \once \override NoteHead.font-size = #-30
142     b'4
143   }
144   \layout {
145     \context{
146       \Score proportionalNotationDuration = #1/8

```

147 }
148 }
149 }

[Table of Contents](#)

5.5 Noteheadless



5.5.1 Description

This snippet is hardly my own idea, as I largely quoted this technique from one of the snippets available on LilyPond Wiki, formerly LSR.³ However, I list it here because:

1. it took a while for me to find the workaround for maintaining the musical spacing as a result of omitting noteheads. It is worth noting that because merely disabling `NoteHead.stencil` will render the spacing to be squished, the approach of specifying `##t` for `NoteHead.transparent` (which itself will *not* eliminate the ledger lines) then `##t` for `NoteHead.no-ledgers` is effective in maintaining the general spacing.

See Discussion.

5.5.2 Grammar

```
\noteheadless NOTE
\noteheadlessOn NOTE
\noteheadlessOff
```

NB

1. `\noteheadless` affects only one note immediately following.
2. For a group of notes, use `\noteheadlessOn` to toggle on the function. `\noteheadlessOff` will toggle off the function.

5.5.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 %% Inspired by:
4 %% http://lsr.di.unimi.it/LSR/Item?id=796
5
6
7 noteheadless = {
8   \once \override Voice.NoteHead.transparent = ##t
9   \once \override Voice.NoteHead.no-ledgers = ##t
10 }
11
12 noteheadlessOn = {
13   \override Voice.NoteHead.transparent = ##t
14   \override Voice.NoteHead.no-ledgers = ##t
15 }
```

3. See: https://wiki.lilypond.community/wiki/Creating_harp_glissandi

```

16 noteheadlessOff = {
17   \revert Voice.NoteHead.transparent
18   \revert Voice.NoteHead.no-ledgers
19 }
20
21
22 {
23   c'4 \noteheadless c'8 d' d'4
24   \noteheadlessOn e'16 f' c' b |
25   \noteheadlessOff d' c' b a
26 }
27

```

5.5.4 Discussion

As discussed in the [Learning Manual](#), overriding `NoteHead.stencil` to `##f` will cause an error when the processing requires the dimensions of the `NoteHead`. I now recommend:

```
\once \override NoteHead.stencil = #point-stencil
```

There is also another special stencil, namely `#empty-stencil`, but this appears to cause the processing to assume that there is no pitch assigned to the particular note. In the aforementioned snippet found on LilyPond Wiki, it causes the glissando line to only reach and emerge out of the middle of the five-line staff.

[Table of Contents](#)

5.6 Slap Tongue, Type A



5.6.1 Description

In my music, I use encircled noteheads to denote slap tongues. Type A, encircled filled notehead, is used for a slap tongue with a regular note immediately following.

5.6.2 Grammar

`\slapA NOTE`

NB It only affects one note, owing to the `\once \override` functions within the code.

5.6.3 Code

```

1  \version "2.26.0"
2
3  slapA = #(define-music-function (note) (ly:music?)
4            #{ \once \override Voice.NoteHead.stencil =
5              #ly:text-interface::print
6              \once \override Voice.NoteHead.text =
7              \markup {
8                \concat {
9                  \musicglyph "noteheads.s2"
10                 \postscript "newpath
11 -0.675 0.025 0.75 0 360 arc
12 closepath
13 stroke"
14             }
15             }
16             $note #})
17
18
19 {
20  \slapA c'4 \slapA d' \slapA e' \slapA f'
21  \slapA f'' \slapA e'' \slapA d'' \slapA c''
22 }
```

[Table of Contents](#)

5.7 Slap Tongue, Type B



5.7.1 Description

In my music, I use encircled noteheads to denote slap tongues. Type B, encircled hollow notehead, is used for a slap tongue with an air sound immediately following.

5.7.2 Grammar

`\SlapB NOTE`

NB It only affects one note, owing to the `\once \override` functions within the code.

5.7.3 Code

```

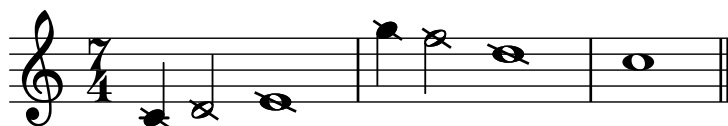
1  \version "2.26.0"
2
3  slapB = #(define-music-function (note) (ly:music?)
4      #{ \once \override Voice.NoteHead.stencil =
5          #ly:text-interface::print
6          \once \override Voice.NoteHead.text =
7              \markup {
8                  \concat {
9                      \musicglyph "noteheads.s1"
10                     \postscript "newpath
11 -0.675 0.025 0.75 0 360 arc
12 closepath
13 stroke"
14             }
15         }
16     $note #})
17
18 {
19     \slapB c'4 \slapB d' \slapB e' \slapB f'
20     \slapB f'' \slapB e'' \slapB d'' \slapB c''
21 }
22
```

5.7.4 Discussion

As the musical example shows, when the Type B Slap Tongue notehead is applied to a quarter note, it could invite confusion in terms of rhythm. As a slap tongue itself is a short sound, I only use the slap tongue noteheads on eighth notes or shorter note durations.

[Table of Contents](#)

5.8 Slashed Notehead



5.8.1 Description

Noteheads with backslashes applied.⁴ I use this notehead to indicate, for example, notes on the piano whose strings are prepared, thus producing pitch/sound different from what is expected normally.

5.8.2 Grammar

```
\slashNote NOTE
\slashNoteOn NOTE
\slashNoteOff
```

NB `\slashNote` only affects one note, owing to the `\once \override` functions within the code. For a group of notes to have slashes applied, use `\slashNoteOn`. `\slashNoteOff` cancels the application.

5.8.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 % Inspired by the code provided by Jean Abou Samra
4 % https://lists.gnu.org/archive/html/lilypond-user/2022-11/msg00333.html
5
6 slashNote =
7 \once \override Voice.NoteHead.stencil =
8 #(grob-transformer
9   'stencil
10  (lambda (grob original)
11    (let* ((added-markup
12            #{
13              \markup \general-align #Y #CENTER
14              #(case (ly:grob-property grob 'duration-log)
15                  ((0) #{ \markup \concat {
16                    \musicglyph "noteheads.s0"
17                    \postscript
18                    "gsave
19                      0.17 setlinewidth
20                      -2.3 0.6 moveto
21                      0.3 -0.6 lineto
22                      stroke
23                      grestore"
```

4. The code provided by Jean Abou Samra in the following discussion thread on lilypond-user was very helpful in creating this code: <https://lists.gnu.org/archive/html/lilypond-user/2022-11/msg00333.html>

```

24         } #})
25
26         ((1) #{ \markup \concat {
27             \musicglyph "noteheads.s1"
28             \postscript
29             "gsave
30                 0.17 setlinewidth
31                 -1.5 0.6 moveto
32                 0.3 -0.6 lineto
33                 stroke
34                 grestore"
35             } #})
36
37         ((2) #{ \markup \concat {
38             \musicglyph "noteheads.s2"
39             \postscript
40             "gsave
41                 0.17 setlinewidth
42                 -1.5 0.6 moveto
43                 0.3 -0.6 lineto
44                 stroke
45                 grestore"
46             } #}))
47     #})
48     (added-stencil (grob-interpret-markup grob added-markup)))
49     (if (ly:stencil? original)
50         (ly:stencil-add original added-stencil)
51         added-stencil)))
52
53
54
55 slashNoteOn =
56 \override Voice.NoteHead.stencil =
57 # (grob-transformer
58     'stencil
59     (lambda (grob original)
60         (let* ((added-markup
61             #{
62                 \markup \general-align #Y #CENTER
63                 # (case (ly:grob-property grob 'duration-log)
64                     ((0) #{ \markup \concat {
65                         \musicglyph "noteheads.s0"
66                         \postscript
67                         "gsave
68                             0.17 setlinewidth
69                             -2.3 0.6 moveto
70                             0.3 -0.6 lineto
71                             stroke

```

```

72         grestore"
73     } #})
74     ((1) #{ \markup \concat {
75         \musicglyph "noteheads.s1"
76         \postscript
77         "gsave
78             0.17 setlinewidth
79             -1.5 0.6 moveto
80             0.3 -0.6 lineto
81             stroke
82             grestore"
83         } #})
84     ((2) #{ \markup \concat {
85         \musicglyph "noteheads.s2"
86         \postscript
87         "gsave
88             0.17 setlinewidth
89             -1.5 0.6 moveto
90             0.3 -0.6 lineto
91             stroke
92             grestore"
93         } #}))
94     #})
95     (added-stencil (grob-interpret-markup grob added-markup)))
96     (if (ly:stencil? original)
97         (ly:stencil-add original added-stencil)
98         added-stencil)))
99
100
101 slashNoteOff = \revert Voice.NoteHead.stencil
102
103
104 {
105     \time 7/4
106     \slashNote c'4
107     \slashNote d'2
108     \slashNote e'1
109     \slashNoteOn g''4 f''2 d''1
110     \slashNoteOff c''1 \bar "||"
111 }
112

```

[Table of Contents](#)

5.9 Square Notehead



5.9.1 Description

Filled and hollow square noteheads.

5.9.2 Grammar

```
\squareHollowNotehead NOTE
\squareHollowNoteheadOn NOTES
\squareHollowNoteheadOff
\squareFilledNotehead NOTE
\squareFilledNoteheadOn NOTES
\squareFilledNoteheadOff
```

```
\slashNoteOn NOTE
\slashNoteOff
```

NB `\squareHollowNotehead` and `\squareFilledNotehead` only affect one note, owing to the `\once \override` functions within the code. For a group of notes, use `\squareHollowNoteheadOn` or `\squareFilledNoteheadOn`. `\squareHollowNoteheadOff` and `\squareFilledNoteheadOff` cancel the application.

5.9.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 % See also: https://lsr.di.unimi.it/LSR/Item?id=516
4 % UPDATED June 13 2025
5
6 squareHollowNoteheadDesign =
7 #(ly:make-stencil '(path 0.15 (moveto 0.0 0.425
8                               rlineto 1.2 0
9                               rlineto 0 -0.875
10                              rlineto -1.2 0
11                              closepath)
12                               )
13      (cons -0.15 1.275)
14      (cons -1 1))
15
16 squareHollowNotehead =
17 #(define-music-function (note) (ly:music?)
18   #{\once \override Voice.NoteHead.stencil =
19     \squareHollowNoteheadDesign $note #})
```

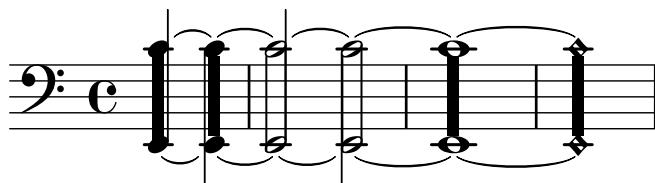
```

20
21 squareHollowNoteheadOn =
22 #(define-music-function (note) (ly:music?)
23   #{\override Voice.NoteHead.stencil =
24     \squareHollowNoteheadDesign $note #})
25
26 squareHollowNoteheadOff = \revert Voice.NoteHead.stencil
27
28 squareFilledNoteheadDesign =
29 #(ly:make-stencil '(path 0.15 (moveto 0.0 0.425
30                               rlineto 1.2 0
31                               rlineto 0 -0.875
32                               rlineto -1.2 0
33                               closepath)
34
35                               round
36                               round
37                               #t)
38   (cons -0.15 1.275)
39   (cons -1 0))
40
41 squareFilledNotehead =
42 #(define-music-function (note) (ly:music?)
43   #{\once \override Voice.NoteHead.stencil =
44     \squareFilledNoteheadDesign $note #})
45 squareFilledNoteheadOn =
46 #(define-music-function (note) (ly:music?)
47   #{\override Voice.NoteHead.stencil =
48     \squareFilledNoteheadDesign $note #})
49
50 squareFilledNoteheadOff = \revert Voice.NoteHead.stencil
51
52 {
53   \squareHollowNotehead c'8
54   \squareHollowNoteheadOn d' e' f'
55   \squareHollowNoteheadOff
56   \squareFilledNotehead c'8
57   \squareFilledNoteheadOn d' e' f'
58   \squareFilledNoteheadOff
59   \squareHollowNotehead a''8
60   \squareHollowNoteheadOn g'' f'' e''
61   \squareHollowNoteheadOff
62   \squareFilledNotehead a''8
63   \squareFilledNoteheadOn g'' f'' e''
64   \squareFilledNoteheadOff
65 }

```

[Table of Contents](#)

5.10 Tone Cluster



5.10.1 Description

Inspired by the tone cluster notation of Henry Cowell and others. See [Discussion](#).

5.10.2 Grammar

```
\toneClusterBar NOTE1 NOTE2 yOffset yLengthAdjust
\toneClusterBarHollow NOTE1 NOTE2 yOffset yLengthAdjust
\toneClusterBarWhole NOTE1 NOTE2 yOffset yLengthAdjust
```

NB

1. The order of pitch boundaries as shown by NOTE1 and NOTE2 does not matter; NOTE1 can be upper or lower pitch boundary, and vice versa for NOTE2. See [Code](#).
2. `yOffset` indicates where the upper part of the cluster sign begins. When set to #0, it starts right at the top line of the ordinary 5-line staff. Each positive/negative integer will bring the beginning point up/down by a space of two neighboring lines of the staff.
3. `yLengthAdjust` indicates any value by which the cluster bar may be extended or reduced. When set to #0, the cluster bar will be as long as the distance between the lower boundary of the upper notehead and upper boundary of the lower notehead. Each positive/negative integer will add/reduce the length of the bar by a space of two neighboring lines of the staff.

For this reason, when the tone cluster sign is applied to a quarter-note dyad, you may wish to set the upper part of the cluster bar right in the middle of the notehead. In the snippet shown, the first cluster's `yOffset` is set to #1. `yLengthAdjust` is also set to #1, meaning that the cluster bar will go down to the center of the lower notehead. The second cluster intentionally shows what happens when the bar only touches the two boundaries of the noteheads.

4. `\toneClusterBarHollow` shows the notation (quite à la Cowell) specifically for hollowed noteheads. Some people may prefer this notation, instead.
5. `\toneClusterBarWhole` is specifically for the tone cluster notation as applied to a whole-note dyad, owing to width being wider than the quarter or half noteheads.
6. These functions may be used in tandem with other noteheads, as well as ties. See [Code](#).

5.10.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 toneClusterBar =
4 #(define-music-function (note1 note2 yOffset yLengthAdjust)
5   (ly:music? ly:music? number? number?))
```



```

6      (let* (
7          (note1p (ly:music-property note1 'pitch))
8          (note2p (ly:music-property note2 'pitch))
9          (note1pnumber (+ (* 7 (ly:pitch-octave note1p))
10                           (ly:pitch-notename note1p)))
11          (note2pnumber (+ (* 7 (ly:pitch-octave note2p))
12                            (ly:pitch-notename note2p)))
13          (pitchDistance (abs (- note1pnumber note2pnumber))))
14      )
15      #{
16          < #note1
17          #note2 > ^\markup {
18              \postscript
19              #(string-append
20                  "gsave
21                      newpath
22                      0.3 " (number->string (- yOffset 0.5)) " moveto
23                      0.7 0 rlineto
24                      0 " (number->string (- (* -0.5 pitchDistance)
25                                              (- yLengthAdjust 1))) " rlineto
26                      -0.7 0 rlineto
27                      closepath
28                      fill
29                      grestore")
30              }
31          #}
32      )
33  )
34
35
36  toneClusterBarHollow =
37  #(define-music-function (note1 note2 yOffset yLengthAdjust)
38      (ly:music? ly:music? number? number?)
39      (let* (
40          (note1p (ly:music-property note1 'pitch))
41          (note2p (ly:music-property note2 'pitch))
42          (note1pnumber (+ (* 7 (ly:pitch-octave note1p))
43                           (ly:pitch-notename note1p)))
44          (note2pnumber (+ (* 7 (ly:pitch-octave note2p))
45                            (ly:pitch-notename note2p)))
46          (pitchDistance (abs (- note1pnumber note2pnumber))))
47      )
48      #{
49          < #note1
50          #note2 > ^\markup {
51              \postscript
52              #(string-append
53                  "gsave

```

```

54         newpath
55         0.1 " (number->string (- yOffset 0.5)) " moveto
56         0 " (number->string (- (* -0.5 pitchDistance)
57             (+ 0.5 yLengthAdjust))) " rlineto
58         0.125 setlinewidth
59         1.3 "(number->string (+ 0.75 (- yOffset 0.5))) " moveto
60         0 " (number->string (- (* -0.5 pitchDistance)
61             (+ 0.75 yLengthAdjust))) " rlineto
62         stroke
63         grestore")
64     }
65     #}
66 )
67 )
68
69
70 toneClusterBarWhole =
71 #(define-music-function (note1 note2 yOffset yLengthAdjust)
72   (ly:music? ly:music? number? number?)
73   (let* (
74     (note1p (ly:music-property note1 'pitch))
75     (note2p (ly:music-property note2 'pitch))
76     (note1pnumber (+ (* 7 (ly:pitch-octave note1p))
77                     (ly:pitch-notename note1p)))
78     (note2pnumber (+ (* 7 (ly:pitch-octave note2p))
79                     (ly:pitch-notename note2p)))
80     (pitchDistance (abs (- note1pnumber note2pnumber)))
81   )
82   #{
83     < #note1
84     #note2 > ~\markup {
85       \postscript
86       #(string-append
87         "gsave
88         newpath
89         0.125 setlinewidth
90         0.55 " (number->string (- yOffset 0.5)) " moveto
91         0 " (number->string (- (* -0.5 pitchDistance)
92             (- yLengthAdjust 1))) " rlineto
93         0.75 0 rlineto
94         0 " (number->string (abs (- (* -0.5 pitchDistance)
95             (- yLengthAdjust 1))) " rlineto
96         closepath fill
97         grestore")
98     }
99     #}
100   )
101 )

```

```

102
103
104 {
105   \time 4/4
106   \partial 2
107   \clef "F"
108   \stemUp \toneClusterBar c'4~ e,~ #1 #1
109   \stemDown \toneClusterBar e,~ c'4~ #0.5 #0
110   \stemUp \toneClusterBarHollow c'2~ e,~ #0.5 #-0.5
111   \stemDown \toneClusterBarHollow c'2~ e,~ #0.5 #-0.5
112   \toneClusterBarWhole c'1~ e,~ #0.5 #0
113   \toneClusterBar c'1~\harmonic e,~\harmonic #0.5 #0
114 }
115

```

5.10.4 Discussion

There have been some discussions on `lilypond-user` mailing list in the past that readers may consult for further ideas on implementing different types of tone cluster notation:

- <https://lists.gnu.org/archive/html/lilypond-user/2008-10/msg00484.html> (This one in particular lists other notational conventions established by other composers)
- <https://lists.gnu.org/archive/html/lilypond-user/2020-12/msg00130.html>

[Table of Contents](#)


```

23
24
25 % The following is deprecated and is no longer functional. I hope to
26 % revisit this and improve upon it.
27 % tgrWithIndication =
28 % #(define-music-function (note1) (ly:music?)
29 %   (let*
30 %     (p1 #{ #(ly:music-deep-copy note1) \harmonic #})
31 %     (p2 #{ \transpose c df, #(ly:music-property note1 'pitch)#})
32 %     (d1 (ly:music-property note1 'duration))
33 %   )
34 %   #{ < $p1
35 %     \single \override NoteHead.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
36 %     \single \override NoteHead.text =
37 %       \markup \musicglyph "noteheads.s2triangle"
38 %     \single \override Stem.stencil =
39 %       $p2 > $d1 ^\markup {\override #'(font-size . -2) {[T.R.]}} }
40 %   #}
41 %   ))
42 %
43 % tgr =
44 % #(define-music-function (note1) (ly:music?)
45 %   (let*
46 %     (p1 #{ #(ly:music-deep-copy note1) \harmonic #})
47 %     (p2 #{ \transpose c df, #(ly:music-property note1 'pitch)#})
48 %     (d1 (ly:music-property note1 'duration))
49 %   )
50 %   #{ < $p1
51 %     \single \override NoteHead.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
52 %     \single \override NoteHead.text =
53 %       \markup \musicglyph "noteheads.s2triangle"
54 %     \single \override Stem.stencil =
55 %       $p2 > $d1 #}
56 %   ))
57 %
58 % {
59 %   \language "english" \tgrWithIndication d'4-. ->
60 %   \tgr cs'4-. -> \tgr ef'4-. ->
61 % }
62 %
63
64

```

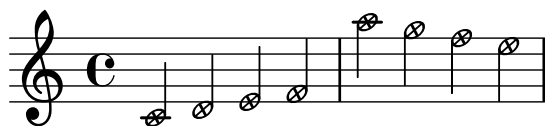
5.11.4 Discussion

I leave the deprecated code here, in hopes that I will revisit and improve upon it. For the time being, however, I have used the following in my recent pieces calling for this technique, and it worked well. I hope to eventually automate it.

```
<e' \harmonic
  \tweak NoteHead.stencil #ly:text-interface::print
  \tweak NoteHead.text
  \markup \musicglyph "noteheads.s2triangle" f>8
```

[Table of Contents](#)

5.12 X In A Hollow Notehead



5.12.1 Description

While LilyPond Notation Reference provides an example of an X-in-a-circle notehead, its shape differs from the regular notehead.⁶ This implementation simulates a hollow notehead with which the X notehead is combined.

5.12.2 Grammar

`\cirX NOTE`

5.12.3 Code

```

1  \version "2.26.0"
2
3  % Stem attachment function inspired by:
4  % https://lsr.di.unimi.it/LSR/Snippet?id=518
5
6  cirX = #(define-music-function (note) (ly:music?)
7    #{
8      \temporary \override NoteHead.stencil =
9      #ly:text-interface::print
10     \temporary \override NoteHead.text =
11     \markup
12     \translate #'(0.6 . 0)
13     \pad-x #-0.22
14     \rotate #35
15     \scale #'(1 . 0.65)
16     \combine \combine \combine \combine
17     \override #'(thickness . 2)
18     \draw-line #'(0.05 . 0.6)
19     \override #'(thickness . 2)
20     \draw-line #'(-0.05 . -0.6)
21     \override #'(thickness . 2)
22     \draw-line #'(0.6 . 0.1 )
23     \override #'(thickness . 2)
24     \draw-line #'(-0.6 . -0.1 )
25     \draw-circle #0.65 #0.175 ##f
26
27     \temporary \override NoteHead.stem-attachment =
28     #(lambda (grob)
29       (let* ((stem (ly:grob-object grob 'stem))

```

6. <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/notation/modifying-stencils>

```

30             (dir (ly:grob-property stem 'direction UP))
31             (is-up (eqv? dir UP)))
32         (cons dir (if is-up 0.2 -0.2))))
33     #note
34     \revert NoteHead.stencil
35     \revert NoteHead.text
36     \revert NoteHead.stem-attachment
37 #})
38
39
40 {
41   \cirX c'4 \cirX d' \cirX e' \cirX f'
42   \cirX a''4 \cirX g'' \cirX f'' \cirX e''
43 }
44

```

[Table of Contents](#)

Chapter 6

Markups

6.1 Conducting Patterns



6.1.1 Description

Conducting patterns. While there are several examples of conducting patterns available on LSR,¹ the conducting shapes in my implementation are not affected by the horizontal length of given durations.

6.1.2 Grammar

```
NOTE \condOne
NOTE \condTwoA
NOTE \condTwoB
NOTE \condThree
NOTE \condDoubleTwoA
NOTE \condDoubleTwoB
NOTE \condDoubleThree
```

6.1.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 condOnePattern =
4 #'((moveto 0.25 1.75)
5    (rlineto 0 -1.75))
```

1. See: <https://lsr.di.unimi.it/LSR/Item?id=523> and <https://lsr.di.unimi.it/LSR/Item?id=259>

```

6
7  condTwoPatternA =
8  #'((moveto 0.25 1.75)
9      (rlineto 0 -1.75)
10     (rlineto 2 0)
11     (rlineto 0 1.75))
12
13  condDoubleTwoPatternA =
14  #'((moveto 0.25 1.75)
15      (rlineto 0 -1.75)
16      (rlineto 2 0)
17      (rlineto 0 1.75)
18      (moveto 0.65 1.75)
19      (rlineto 0 -1.35)
20      (rlineto 1.2 0)
21      (rlineto 0 1.35))
22
23  condTwoPatternB =
24  #'((moveto 0.25 1.75)
25      (rlineto 0 -1.75)
26      (rlineto 1.25 1.75))
27
28  condDoubleTwoPatternB =
29  #'((moveto 0.25 1.75)
30      (rlineto 0 -1.75)
31      (rlineto 1.25 1.75)
32      (moveto 0.6 1.75)
33      (rlineto 0 -0.7)
34      (rlineto 0.5 0.7))
35
36  condThreePattern =
37  #'((moveto 1.15 1.75)
38      (rlineto -1 -1.75)
39      (rlineto 2 0)
40      (closepath))
41
42  condDoubleThreePattern =
43  #'((moveto 1.15 1.75)
44      (rlineto -1 -1.75)
45      (rlineto 2 0)
46      (closepath)
47      (moveto 1.15 1.05)
48      (rlineto -0.385 -0.7)
49      (rlineto 0.75 0)
50      (closepath))
51
52
53  condOne = ^\markup {

```

```

54  \override #'(line-join-style . round)
55  \path #0.25 #condOnePattern
56  }
57
58  condTwoA = ^\markup {
59    \override #'(line-join-style . round)
60    \path #0.25 #condTwoPatternA
61  }
62  condTwoB = ^\markup {
63    \override #'(line-join-style . round)
64    \path #0.25 #condTwoPatternB
65  }
66  condDoubleTwoA = ^\markup {
67    \override #'(line-join-style . round)
68    \path #0.25 #condDoubleTwoPatternA
69  }
70
71  condDoubleTwoB = ^\markup {
72    \override #'(line-join-style . round)
73    \path #0.25 #condDoubleTwoPatternB
74  }
75
76  condThree = ^\markup {
77    \override #'(line-join-style . round)
78    \path #0.25 #condThreePattern
79  }
80
81  condDoubleThree = ^\markup {
82    \override #'(line-join-style . round)
83    \path #0.25 #condDoubleThreePattern
84  }
85
86  %% Source inspired by
87  %% and adapted from: http://lsr.di.unimi.it/LSR/Item?id=629
88  spacerVoice = \new Voice {
89    \override MultiMeasureRest.transparent = ##t
90    \override MultiMeasureRest.minimum-length = #14
91    R16*5
92  }
93
94
95  \score {
96    {
97      \time 5/8
98      b'4 \condTwoA b'4. \condThree \bar "||"
99      b'4 \condTwoB b'4. \condThree \bar "||"
100     b'8 \condOne b'4 \condTwoA b'4 \condTwoA \bar "||"
101     \time 5/16

```

```
102    << {b'8 \condDoubleTwoA b'8. \condDoubleThree} \spacerVoice >> \bar "||"  
103    << {b'8 \condDoubleTwoB b'8. \condDoubleThree} \spacerVoice >> \bar "||"  
104  }  
105  
106  }  
107
```

[Table of Contents](#)

6.2 Mute Sign



6.2.1 Description

Implementation of the mute sign, used to indicate that vibrating strings must be dampened at a specified moment. Its provenance can be traced back to Carlos Salzedo's *Modern Study of the Harp*.²

6.2.2 Grammar

NOTE/REST[^]\mutesign

6.2.3 Code

```

1  \version "2.26.0"
2
3  mutesign = \markup {
4    \translate #'(0.5 . 0)
5    \postscript
6
7    "newpath
8    0.2 setlinewidth
9    1 setlinecap
10   0 0 moveto
11   0 2.5 rlineto
12   -1.25 1.25 moveto
13   2.5 0 rlineto
14   stroke
15   newpath
16   0 1.25 0.85 0 360 arc
17   stroke"
18
19 }
20
21 {
22   c'2. r4^\mutesign^\markup {
23     \translate #'(-3 . 2)
24     \musicglyph "space"
25   }
26
27 }
```

2. Carlos Salzedo, *L'étude moderne de la harpe... Modern study of the harp* (New York - Boston, G. Schirmer, 1921), 19.

Table of Contents

Chapter 7

Rhythm

7.1 Incomplete Tuplet Bracket for Irrational Time Signatures



7.1.1 Description

This entry implements the irrational time signatures¹ as seen on LSR.² Concerning the irrational time signatures, in her *Behind Bars: the Definitive Guide to Music Notation*, Elaine Gould suggests the use of denominator as any division of the semibreve/whole note.³ However, in these pages there has not been a mention of the use of tuplet brackets while the non-conventional time signature is in place. There are examples, such as *Asyla* for large orchestra by Thomas Adès,⁴ where tuplet brackets are placed atop "incomplete" tuplets.

While it is still prudent to spend a paragraph explaining the nature of the irrational time signatures in the preface, my preference has also been to utilize incomplete tuplet brackets, in order to allow the reading of the rhythm consistent and smooth from bars with ordinary time signatures. It is also helpful to have the brackets shown in cases of compound time signatures that use irrational time signatures in part (see the first measure of the example).

7.1.2 Grammar

```
\incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet ...  
\incompleteSmallTupletBracket \tuplet ...
```

NB

1. For incomplete tuplets with two or more notes, use `\incompleteTupletBracket`.

1. See [Chapter Time Signatures](#) for discussion on the variants of the irrational/fractional time signatures.
2. <https://lsr.di.unimi.it/LSR/Snippet?id=552>
3. Elaine Gould, *Behind bars : the definitive guide to music notation* (London: Faber Music, 2011), 180–181, Book.
4. Thomas Adès, *Asyla : for large orchestra* (Faber Music, 1997).

2. For incomplete tuplets with one note, use `\incompleteSmallTupletBracket`. This was created specifically to ensure that the brackets appear properly in tight space that one-note tuplet customarily gives.

7.1.3 Code

```

1  \version "2.26.0"
2
3  %% "suppressWarning" function comes from:
4  %% http://lsr.di.unimi.it/LSR/Item?id=552
5
6  % Warnings may be suppressed using 'ly:expect-warning'
7  % Or use the here defined 'suppressWarning'-function, working since 2.20.
8
9  suppressWarning =
10 # (define-void-function (amount message) (number? string?)
11   (for-each
12     (lambda (warning)
13       (ly:expect-warning message))
14     (iota amount 1 1)))
15
16 \suppressWarning 3 "strange time signature found"
17
18 incompleteTupletBracket = {
19   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
20   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
21
22 }
23 incompleteSmallTupletBracket = {
24   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
25   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
26   \once \override Voice.TupletNumber.X-offset =
27     # (lambda (grob)
28       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
29         2.2
30         1.2))
31
32   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.shorten-pair =
33     # (lambda (grob)
34       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
35         '(-0.7 . 0.15)
36         '(-0.3 . 0.8)))
37   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.X-positions =
38     # (lambda (grob)
39       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
40         '(1.8 . 3)
41         '(0.3 . 2.7)))
42 }

```



```

43
44
45 {
46
47   \timeAbbrev #'((2 4) (4 12))
48   f'4 f'
49   \tuplet 3/2 {g'8[ g' g']}
50   \incompleteSmallTupletBracket
51   \tuplet 3/2 {a'8 }|
52   \set Score.proportionalNotationDuration = #1/16
53   \time 4/20
54   \incompleteTupletBracket
55   \tuplet 5/4 {b'16[ b' b' b']} |
56
57   \time 4/12
58   \tuplet 3/2 {c''8[ g' e']}
59   \incompleteSmallTupletBracket
60   \tuplet 3/2 {c'8} |
61   \tuplet 3/2 {c'8[ e' g']}
62   \incompleteSmallTupletBracket
63   \tuplet 3/2 {c''8} |
64 }
65
66
67

```

7.1.4 Discussion

In the preceding code, I have opted to notate the tuplets within the bars with irrational time signatures in an ordinary manner, using `\tuplet`. This is to ensure that the incomplete tuplet bracket appears. Compare this with the quoted LSR No. 552, which has a different way of reducing the note duration in order to fit them into the bar with irrational time signature. Observe the way duration is multiplied by fractions, e.g. Line 6.

```

1  {
2    \time 4/4
3    \tempo 4 = 60
4    fis4 fis fis fis
5    \time 2/6
6    g4*2/3 g |
7    g4*2/3 g |
8    \time 4/5
9    as4*4/5 as as as8*4/5 g |
10   \tuplet 3/2 { as4*4/5 as as } as4*4/5 as8*4/5 g |
11   \time 3/7
12   fis4*4/7 fis fis |
13   fis4*4/7 fis fis |
14 }

```

Table of Contents

7.2 Metric Modulation Equation (Regular Flag)

The image shows two musical staves illustrating the Metric Modulation Equation (Regular Flag).
 The first staff is in 2/4 time. It starts with a tempo marking of 60. A measure of four eighth notes is followed by a measure of five eighth notes, with a '5' above the notes and a left arrow pointing to the first note. This is followed by a measure of three eighth notes, with a '3' above the notes and a right arrow pointing to the last note. The tempo then changes to 75. The next measure contains five eighth notes, with a '5:4' bracket above and a '4:3' bracket below. This is followed by a measure of three eighth notes, with a '3' above the notes and a right arrow pointing to the last note.
 The second staff is in 4/4 time. It starts with a tempo marking of 83.33. A measure of three eighth notes is followed by a measure of three eighth notes, with a '3' above the notes and a left arrow pointing to the first note. The tempo then changes to 6/8. The next measure contains three eighth notes, with a '3' above the notes and a right arrow pointing to the last note. The staff ends with a double bar line.

7.2.1 Description

This entry implements a metric modulation formula that indicates a note value of one measure being equal to another note value of the subsequent measure. While this notation has existed for a very long time, it was in the twentieth century where composers such as Elliott Carter used them extensively in their works. This code follows the convention commonly seen in Carter's scores, where the formula is accompanied by the right and left arrows to state explicitly that the note value on the left refers to that of the preceding measure, while the one on the right refers to that of the subsequent measure.⁵

Another version with notes with straight flags can be found [here](#).

7.2.2 Grammar

```
\ModEquation
  LEFT_NOTE_DURATION #'((LEFT_TUPLET_1)(LEFT_TUPLET_2))
  RIGHT_NOTE_DURATION #'((RIGHT_TUPLET_1)(RIGHT_TUPLET_2))
  #V_OFFSET #H_OFFSET
\ModEquationBegin
  LEFT_NOTE_DURATION #'((LEFT_TUPLET_1)(LEFT_TUPLET_2))
  RIGHT_NOTE_DURATION #'((RIGHT_TUPLET_1)(RIGHT_TUPLET_2))
  #V_OFFSET
```

NB

5. While it may be beyond the scope of this Cookbook, stating the orientation of the note value clarifies any ambiguities, as the convention in the classical period had the two note values flipped, where the note on the left indicated the note value of the forthcoming measure, and the one on the right, that of the preceding measure. See Arthur Weisberg, *Performing twentieth-century music : a handbook for conductors and instrumentalists* (New Haven: Yale University Press, 1996), 52.

1. `\MModEquation` utilizes LilyPond's `\textEndMark` functions. It is therefore meant to be used at the end of a measure where the metric modulation is about to take place. Then you may use `\tempo` function on LilyPond to indicate the new tempo in the subsequent measure.
2. `\MModEquationBegin`, on the other hand, uses LilyPond's `\textMark` functions, which places texts at the beginning of a measure. It is meant to be used as part of the editing process. Because `\MModEquation` places the formula at the end of a measure, when that measure is at the end of a system, requiring another formula at the beginning of the subsequent measure (i.e. at the beginning of a new system) may be plausible. Using `\MModEquationBegin` may be the solution.
3. For `LEFT_NOTE_DURATION` and `RIGHT_NOTE_DURATION`, use a numerical value *without* `#`. You may add dot(s) to indicate augmentation dot(s).
4. For the variables 2 and 4, you may put up to two instances of tuplet values, in the form of list(s) within a list. At the minimum, you will need to supply an empty list, i.e. `#'()`.

For example, if it is a simple triplet you wish to implement, you would write:

```
#'( ( 3 ) )
```

If you wish to indicate tuplet in ratio, e.g. quintuplet in the span of 4 of the note values, you would create a list with two items, i.e.:

```
#'( ( 5 4 ) )
```

You may set another tuplet instance *above* the initial tuplet, so the following list:

```
#'( ( 4 3 ) ( 5 4 ) )
```

...would produce the tuplet indication at the end of measure 3 in the example shown above.

5. For `#V_OFFSET` and `#H_OFFSET` (only for `\MModEquation`), enter numbers preceded by `#`. These numbers adjust the placement of the formula. When in doubt, start with `#0`.

7.2.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 MModEquation =
4 #(define-music-function
5   (notevalue1 ratio1 notevalue2 ratio2 verticaloffset horizontaloffset)
6   (ly:duration? list? ly:duration? list? number? number?)
7   (let* (
8     (noteone notevalue1)
9     (notetwo notevalue2)
10    (ratioone ratio1)
11    (ratiotwo ratio2)
12    )
13   #{
14     \tweak X-offset #(- horizontaloffset 0.35)
15     \tweak Y-offset #verticaloffset
```

```

16 \textEndMark \markup \right-align {
17 \hspace #-0.5
18 \raise #0
19 \fontsize #-4.5
20 \override #'(self-alignment . LEFT)
21 {
22   {
23     \note { $noteone } #(if (= (ly:duration-log noteone) 4) 1 1 )
24   }
25   {
26     \hspace #(if (< (ly:duration-log noteone) 3) -4.15
27                (+ (* (ly:duration-dot-count noteone) -0.5) -4.5))
28     \concat {
29       \combine
30       \musicglyph "arrowheads.open.OM1"
31       \draw-line #'(2 . 0) \fontsize #-5 \musicglyph "space"
32     }
33   }
34   {
35     \hspace #(cond ((<= (ly:duration-log noteone) 2) 0.75)
36                   ((> (ly:duration-log noteone) 2) 0.25) )
37     \raise #(cond
38              ((= (ly:duration-log noteone) 0) -2)
39              ((and (> (ly:duration-log noteone) 0)
40                  (<= (ly:duration-log noteone) 4) ) -.5)
41              ((> (ly:duration-log noteone) 4)
42               (+ (* (- (ly:duration-log noteone) 5) 0.6) 0))
43            )
44     #(cond
45        ((= (length ratioone) 1)
46         (markup
47          #:line
48          (#:hspace
49           -4.5
50           #:raise
51           2.75
52           (#:center-column
53            (#:concat
54             (#:translate
55              (cons 3.5 0.5)
56              (#:override
57               (cons 'thickness 1.5)
58               (#:translate
59                (cons -3.5 0)
60                (#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))))
61          #:hspace
62          -0.1
63          #:override

```

```

64         (cons 'thickness 1.5)
65         (:translate
66         (cons 0 0.5)
67         (:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5))))
68     #:vspace
69     -0.45
70     #:whiteout
71     (:halign
72     1.75
73     (:concat
74     (:fontsize
75     -1
76     (:italic (:fontsize -5 (:musicglyph "space"))))
77     #:fontsize
78     -1
79     #:italic
80     (if (= (length (car ratioone)) 2)
81         (begin (string-append
82                 (number->string (car (car ratioone)))
83                 ":"
84                 (number->string (cadr (car ratioone)))) )
85         (number->string (car (car ratioone)))
86         )
87
88     (:italic (:fontsize -5 (:musicglyph "space"))))))))
89
90 ((= (length ratioone) 2)
91 (markup
92   #:line
93   (:hspace
94   -4.5
95   #:raise
96   2.75
97   (:center-column
98   (:concat
99   (:translate
100   (cons 3.5 0.5)
101   (:override
102   (cons 'thickness 1.5)
103   (:translate
104   (cons -3.5 0)
105   (:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))))
106   #:hspace
107   -0.1
108   #:override
109   (cons 'thickness 1.5)
110   (:translate
111   (cons 0 0.5)

```

```

112         (:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5))))
113 #:vspace
114 -0.45
115 #:whiteout
116 (:halign
117 1.75
118 (:concat
119 (:fontsize
120 -1
121 (:italic (:fontsize -5 (:musicglyph "space")))
122 #:fontsize
123 -1
124 #:italic
125 (if (= (length (car ratioone)) 2)
126     (begin (string-append
127             (number->string (car (car ratioone)))
128             ":"
129             (number->string (cadr (car ratioone)))) )
130     (number->string (car (car ratioone)))
131     )
132     (:italic (:fontsize -5 (:musicglyph "space"))))))))
133 #:line
134 (:hspace
135 -4.8
136 #:raise
137 4
138 (:center-column
139 (:concat
140 (:translate
141 (cons 3.5 0.5)
142 (:override
143 (cons 'thickness 1.5)
144 (:translate
145 (cons -3.5 0)
146 (:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))
147 #:hspace
148 -0.1
149 #:override
150 (cons 'thickness 1.5)
151 (:translate
152 (cons 0 0.5)
153 (:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5))))
154 #:vspace
155 -0.45
156 #:whiteout
157 (:halign
158 1.75
159 (:concat

```

```

160         (:fontsize
161         -1
162         (:italic (:fontsize -5 (:musicglyph "space")))
163         (:fontsize
164         -1
165         (:italic
166         (if (= (length (cadr ratioone)) 2)
167             (begin (string-append
168                     (number->string (car (cadr ratioone)))
169                     ":"
170                     (number->string (cadr (cadr ratioone)))) )
171             (number->string (car (cadr ratioone)))
172             )
173         (:italic (:fontsize -5 (:musicglyph "space"))))))))
174     ))
175 )
176 }
177 }
178 }
179 \tweak self-alignment-X #CENTER
180 \tweak Y-offset #(- verticaloffset 0.4)
181 \tweak X-offset #(- horizontaloffset 0.35)
182 \textEndMark \markup { \fontsize #-3 "="}
183
184 \tweak Y-offset #verticaloffset
185 \tweak self-alignment-X #RIGHT
186 \tweak X-offset #(- horizontaloffset 0.35)
187 \tweak self-alignment-Y -1
188 \textEndMark \markup \left-align {
189   \hspace #1.9
190   \raise #0
191   \fontsize #-4.5
192   \concat {
193     {
194       \hspace #(cond ((<= (ly:duration-log notetwo) 2) 4)
195                     ((> (ly:duration-log notetwo) 2) 3.75) )
196       \raise #(cond
197         ((= (ly:duration-log notetwo) 0) -2)
198         ((and (> (ly:duration-log notetwo) 0)
199              (<= (ly:duration-log notetwo) 4) ) -.5)
200         ((> (ly:duration-log notetwo) 4)
201          (+ (* (- (ly:duration-log notetwo) 5) 0.6) 0))
202       )
203     #(cond
204       ((= (length ratiotwo) 1)
205        (markup
206         #:line
207         (:hspace

```



```

208      -4.5
209      #:raise
210      3.25
211      (#:center-column
212        (#:concat
213          (#:translate
214            (cons 3.5 0.5)
215            (#:override
216              (cons 'thickness 1.5)
217              (#:translate
218                (cons 0 -0.5 )
219                (#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5)))
220            )
221          #:hspace
222          -0.1
223          #:override
224          (cons 'thickness 1.5)
225          (#:translate
226            (cons -3.5 0)
227            (#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))
228      #:vspace
229      -0.35
230      #:whiteout
231      (#:halign
232        1.75
233        (#:concat
234          (#:fontsize
235            -1
236            (#:italic (#:fontsize -5 (#:musicglyph "space"))))
237          #:fontsize
238          -1
239          #:italic
240          (if (= (length (car ratiotwo)) 2)
241            (begin (string-append
242                  (number->string (car (car ratiotwo)))
243                  ":"
244                  (number->string (cadr (car ratiotwo)))) )
245            (number->string (car (car ratiotwo)))
246          )
247          (#:italic
248            (#:fontsize -5
249              (number->string (car (car ratiotwo))))))
250      ((= (length ratiotwo) 2)
251      (markup
252        #:line
253        (#:hspace
254          -4.5
255          #:raise

```

```

256      3.25
257      (:center-column
258        (:concat
259          (:translate
260            (cons 3.5 0.5)
261            (:override
262              (cons 'thickness 1.5)
263
264              (:translate
265                (cons 0 -0.5 )
266                (:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5)))
267              )
268              #:hspace
269              -0.1
270              #:override
271              (cons 'thickness 1.5)
272              (:translate
273                (cons -3.5 0)
274                (:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))))
275      #:vspace
276      -0.35
277      #:whiteout
278      (:halign
279        1.75
280        (:concat
281          (:fontsize
282            -1
283            (:italic (:fontsize -5 (:musicglyph "space"))))
284          #:fontsize
285          -1
286          #:italic
287          (if (= (length (car ratiotwo)) 2)
288              (begin (string-append
289                      (number->string (car (car ratiotwo)))
290                      ":"
291                      (number->string (cadr (car ratiotwo)))) )
292              (number->string (car (car ratiotwo)))
293              )
294          (:italic (:fontsize -5 (:musicglyph "space"))))))))
295      #:line
296      (:hspace
297        -4.8
298        #:raise
299        4.5
300        (:center-column
301          (:concat
302            (:translate
303              (cons 3.5 0.5)

```

```

304         (:override
305         (cons 'thickness 1.5)
306         (:translate
307         (cons 0 -0.5 )
308         (:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5)))
309         )
310         #:hspace
311         -0.1
312         #:override
313         (cons 'thickness 1.5)
314         (:translate
315         (cons -3.5 0)
316         (:draw-line (cons -4.25 0)))
317         )
318         #:vspace
319         -0.35
320         #:whiteout
321         (:halign
322         1.75
323         (:concat
324         (:fontsize
325         -1
326         (:italic (:fontsize -5 (:musicglyph "space"))))
327         #:fontsize
328         -1
329         #:italic
330         (if (= (length (cadr ratiotwo)) 2)
331             (begin (string-append
332                     (number->string (car (cadr ratiotwo)))
333                     ":"
334                     (number->string (cadr (cadr ratiotwo))))))
335             (number->string (car (cadr ratiotwo)))
336             )
337         )
338         (:italic (:fontsize -5 (:musicglyph "space"))))))))
339     ))
340 )
341 }
342 {
343     \hspace #-4.25
344     \note { $notetwo } #(if (= (ly:duration-log notetwo) 4) 1 1 )
345 }
346 {
347     \hspace #0.5
348     \combine
349     \draw-line #'(-2 . 0)
350     \musicglyph "arrowheads.open.01"
351 }

```

```

352     }
353   }
354   #})
355 )
356
357
358
359 MModEquationBegin =
360 #(define-music-function
361   (notevalue1 ratio1 notevalue2 ratio2 verticaloffset )
362   (ly:duration? list? ly:duration? list? number? )
363   (let* (
364     (noteone notevalue1)
365     (notetwo notevalue2)
366     (ratioone ratio1)
367     (ratiotwo ratio2)
368   )
369     #{
370       \tweak Y-offset #verticaloffset
371       \textMark \markup \left-align {
372
373
374         \raise #0
375         \fontsize #-4.5
376         \override #'(self-alignment . LEFT)
377         {
378           {
379             \hspace #(if (< (ly:duration-log noteone) 3) -4.15
380                           (+ (* (ly:duration-dot-count noteone) -0.5) -4.5))
381             \concat {
382               \combine
383               \musicglyph "arrowheads.open.OM1"
384               \draw-line #'(2 . 0) \fontsize #-5 \musicglyph "space"
385             }
386           }
387
388           {
389             \hspace #-0.5
390             \note { $noteone } #(if (= (ly:duration-log noteone) 4) 1 1 )
391           }
392
393           {
394             \hspace #(cond
395               ((<= (ly:duration-dot-count noteone) 1) -0.5)
396               ((> (ly:duration-dot-count noteone) 1)
397                (+ (* (ly:duration-dot-count noteone) -0.5) -0.25)))
398             \right-align

```

```

400     \raise #(cond
401         ((= (ly:duration-log noteone) 0) -2)
402         ((and (> (ly:duration-log noteone) 0)
403              (<= (ly:duration-log noteone) 4) ) -.5)
404         ((> (ly:duration-log noteone) 4)
405          (+ (* (- (ly:duration-log noteone) 5) 0.6) 0))
406     )
407
408     #(cond
409         ((= (length ratioone) 1)
410          (markup
411           #:line
412           (#:hspace
413            -4.5
414            #:raise
415            2.75
416            (#:center-column
417             (#:concat
418              (#:translate
419               (cons 3.5 0.5)
420              (#:override
421               (cons 'thickness 1.5)
422              (#:translate
423               (cons -3.5 0)
424              (#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))))
425             #:hspace
426             -0.1
427             #:override
428             (cons 'thickness 1.5)
429             (#:translate
430              (cons 0 0.5)
431              (#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5))))))
432          #:vspace
433          -0.45
434          #:whiteout
435          (#:halign
436           1.75
437           (#:concat
438            (#:fontsize
439             -1
440             (#:italic (#:fontsize -5 (#:musicglyph "space"))))
441            #:fontsize
442            -1
443            #:italic
444            (if (= (length (car ratioone)) 2)
445                 (begin (string-append
446                        (number->string (car (car ratioone)))
447                        " : "

```

```

448             (number->string (cadr (car ratioone)))) )
449         (number->string (car (car ratioone)))
450     )
451
452     (#:italic
453     (#:fontsize -5
454     (#:musicglyph "space")))))))))))
455
456 ((= (length ratioone) 2)
457 (markup
458   #:line
459   (#:hspace
460     -4.5
461     #:raise
462     2.75
463     (#:center-column
464       (#:concat
465         (#:translate
466           (cons 3.5 0.5)
467           (#:override
468             (cons 'thickness 1.5)
469             (#:translate
470               (cons -3.5 0)
471               (#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))))
472         #:hspace
473         -0.1
474         (#:override
475           (cons 'thickness 1.5)
476           (#:translate
477             (cons 0 0.5)
478             (#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5))))))
479         #:vspace
480         -0.45
481         #:whiteout
482         (#:halign
483           1.75
484           (#:concat
485             (#:fontsize
486               -1
487               (#:italic (#:fontsize -5 (#:musicglyph "space"))))
488             #:fontsize
489             -1
490             #:italic
491             (if (= (length (car ratioone)) 2)
492               (begin (string-append
493                     (number->string (car (car ratioone)))
494                     ":"
495                     (number->string (cadr (car ratioone))))))

```

```

496         (number->string (car (car ratioone)))
497     )
498     (#:italic (:fontsize -5 (:musicglyph "space"))))))))
499
500 #:line
501 (:hspace
502   -4.8
503   #:raise
504   4
505   (:center-column
506     (:concat
507       (:translate
508         (cons 3.5 0.5)
509         (:override
510           (cons 'thickness 1.5)
511           (:translate
512             (cons -3.5 0)
513             (:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))))
514       #:hspace
515       -0.1
516       #:override
517       (cons 'thickness 1.5)
518       (:translate
519         (cons 0 0.5)
520         (:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5))))))
521   #:vspace
522   -0.45
523   #:whiteout
524   (:halign
525     1.75
526     (:concat
527       (:fontsize
528         -1
529         (:italic (:fontsize -5 (:musicglyph "space"))))
530       #:fontsize
531       -1
532       #:italic
533       (if (= (length (cadr ratioone)) 2)
534         (begin (string-append
535                 (number->string (car (cadr ratioone)))
536                 ":"
537                 (number->string (cadr (cadr ratioone)))) )
538           (number->string (car (cadr ratioone)))
539         )
540       )
541     )
542   )
543 )

```

```

544
545   }
546   {
547     \hspace #(+ (* (ly:duration-dot-count noteone) 0.35) -0.2)
548     \fontsize #2 \lower #0.5  ""
549   }
550   \concat {
551
552   {
553     \hspace #(cond ((<= (ly:duration-log notetwo) 2) 4.15 )
554                   ((> (ly:duration-log notetwo) 2) 4.15) )
555     \raise #(cond
556              ((= (ly:duration-log notetwo) 0) -2)
557              ((and (> (ly:duration-log notetwo) 0)
558                  (<= (ly:duration-log notetwo) 4) ) -.5)
559              ((> (ly:duration-log notetwo) 4)
560               (+ (* (- (ly:duration-log notetwo) 5) 0.6) 0))
561              )
562
563     #(cond
564       ((= (length ratiotwo) 1)
565        (markup
566         #:line
567         (#:hspace
568          -4.5
569          #:raise
570          3.25
571          (#:center-column
572           (#:concat
573            (#:translate
574             (cons 3.5 0.5)
575             (#:override
576              (cons 'thickness 1.5)
577
578              (#:translate
579               (cons 0 -0.5 )
580               (#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5))))
581             )
582
583            #:hspace
584            -0.1
585
586            #:override
587            (cons 'thickness 1.5)
588            (#:translate
589             (cons -3.5 0)
590             (#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))))
591

```



```

592
593      #:vspace
594      -0.35
595      #:whiteout
596      (#:halign
597      1.75
598      (#:concat
599      (#:fontsize
600      -1
601      (#:italic (#:fontsize -5 (#:musicglyph "space"))))
602      #:fontsize
603      -1
604      #:italic
605      (if (= (length (car ratiotwo)) 2)
606          (begin (string-append
607                  (number->string (car (car ratiotwo)))
608                  ":"
609                  (number->string (cadr (car ratiotwo)))))
610              (number->string (car (car ratiotwo)))
611              )
612          (#:italic
613            (#:fontsize -5
614              (#:musicglyph "space"))))))))
615
616      ((= (length ratiotwo) 2)
617      (markup
618      #:line
619      (#:hspace
620      -4.5
621      #:raise
622      3.25
623      (#:center-column
624      (#:concat
625      (#:translate
626      (cons 3.5 0.5)
627      (#:override
628      (cons 'thickness 1.5)
629      (#:translate
630      (cons 0 -0.5 )
631      (#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5)))
632      )
633      #:hspace
634      -0.1
635      #:override
636      (cons 'thickness 1.5)
637      (#:translate
638      (cons -3.5 0)
639      (#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))))

```

```

640      #:vspace
641      -0.35
642      #:whiteout
643      (#:halign
644      1.75
645      (#:concat
646      (#:fontsize
647      -1
648      (#:italic (#:fontsize -5 (#:musicglyph "space"))))
649      #:fontsize
650      -1
651      #:italic
652      (if (= (length (car ratiotwo)) 2)
653          (begin (string-append
654                  (number->string (car (car ratiotwo)))
655                  ":"
656                  (number->string (cadr (car ratiotwo)))))
657              (number->string (car (car ratiotwo)))
658              )
659          (#:italic
660          (#:fontsize -5
661          (#:musicglyph "space"))))))))
662
663      #:line
664      (#:hspace
665      -4.8
666      #:raise
667      4.5
668      (#:center-column
669      (#:concat
670      (#:translate
671      (cons 3.5 0.5)
672      (#:override
673      (cons 'thickness 1.5)
674      (#:translate
675      (cons 0 -0.5 )
676      (#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5)))
677      )
678      #:hspace
679      -0.1
680      #:override
681      (cons 'thickness 1.5)
682      (#:translate
683      (cons -3.5 0)
684      (#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0)))
685      )
686      #:vspace
687      -0.35

```

```

688         #:whiteout
689         (:#:halign
690         1.75
691         (:#:concat
692         (:#:fontsize
693         -1
694         (:#:italic (:#:fontsize -5 (:#:musicglyph "space")))
695         #:fontsize
696         -1
697         #:italic
698         (if (= (length (cadr ratiotwo)) 2)
699             (begin (string-append
700                     (number->string (car (cadr ratiotwo)))
701                     ":"
702                     (number->string (cadr (cadr ratiotwo))))))
703             (number->string (car (cadr ratiotwo)))
704             )
705         (:#:italic
706         (:#:fontsize -5
707         (:#:musicglyph "space"))))))))
708     ))
709 )
710 }
711 {
712     \hspace #-4
713     \note { $notetwo }
714     #(if (= (ly:duration-log notetwo) 4) 1 1 )
715 }
716 {
717     \hspace #0.5
718     \combine
719     \draw-line #'(-2 . 0)
720     \musicglyph "arrowheads.open.01"
721 }
722 }
723 }
724 }
725 #})
726 )
727
728 {
729     \time 2/4
730     \tempo 4 = 60
731     c'16
732     ^\markup {\translate #'(0 . 10) " "}
733     [ c'16 c'16 c'16 ]
734     \tuplet 5/4 {c'16 [ c'16 c'16 c'16 c'16 ] }
735     \MModEquation 16 #'((5)) 16 #'() #8 #0

```

```

736 \tempo 4 = 75
737 c'16 [ c'16 c'16 c'16 ]
738 \tuplet 3/2 {c'8 [ c'8 c'8 ] }
739 \override TupletNumber.text = #tuplet-number::calc-fraction-text
740 \tuplet 5/4 {c'8 [ c'8 ] \tuplet 4/3 { c'8 [ c'8 c'8 c'8 ] }}
741 \MModEquation 8 #'((4 3)(5 4)) 8 #'((3)) 8 #-3
742 \revert TupletNumber.text
743 \break
744 \MModEquationBegin 8 #'((4 3)(5 4)) 8 #'((3)) #6.5
745 \tuplet 3/2 {
746   c'8
747   ^\markup {\translate #'(0 . 10) " "}
748   ^\markup
749   {\fontsize #-1 \raise #0.25 \note {4} #1 "= 83.33"}
750   [ c'8 c'8 ]
751 }
752 \tuplet 3/2 {
753   c'8 c'8 c'8
754   \MModEquation 4 #'() 4. #'() #6 #0
755 }
756 \time 6/8
757 c'8 c'8 c'8 c'4.
758 \bar "|."
759 }

```

[Table of Contents](#)

7.3 Metric Modulation Equation (Straight Flag)

The image displays two musical staves illustrating metric modulation using straight flags. Above the first staff, a diagram shows a 5-measure phrase (indicated by a bracket and '5') and a 3-measure phrase (indicated by a bracket and '3'). A tempo change from 60 to 75 is indicated. Above the second staff, a diagram shows a 5:4 to 4:3 modulation (indicated by a bracket and '5:4' over '4:3') and a 3-measure phrase (indicated by a bracket and '3'). A tempo change from 83.33 to 60 is indicated. The notation includes various note values, rests, and bar lines.

7.3.1 Description

This is an alternative implementation of the metric modulation formula, introduced in the [previous entry](#), except this time it uses notes with the modern straight flag.

7.3.2 Grammar

```
\MModEquationSTR
LEFT_NOTE_DURATION #'((LEFT_TUPLET_1)(LEFT_TUPLET_2))
RIGHT_NOTE_DURATION #'((RIGHT_TUPLET_1)(RIGHT_TUPLET_2))
#V_OFFSET #H_OFFSET
\MModEquationBeginSTR
LEFT_NOTE_DURATION #'((LEFT_TUPLET_1)(LEFT_TUPLET_2))
RIGHT_NOTE_DURATION #'((RIGHT_TUPLET_1)(RIGHT_TUPLET_2))
#V_OFFSET
```

NB

1. `\MModEquationSTR` utilizes LilyPond's `\textEndMark` functions. It is therefore meant to be used at the end of a measure where the metric modulation is about to take place. Then you may use `\tempo` function on LilyPond to indicate the new tempo in the subsequent measure.
2. `\MModEquationBeginSTR`, on the other hand, uses LilyPond's `\textMark` functions, which places texts at the beginning of a measure. It is meant to be used as part of the editing process. Because `\MModEquationSTR` places the formula at the end of a measure, when that measure is at the end of a system, requiring another formula at the beginning of the subsequent measure (i.e. at the beginning of a new system) may be plausible. Using `\MModEquationBeginSTR` may be the solution.
3. For `LEFT_NOTE_DURATION` and `RIGHT_NOTE_DURATION`, use a numerical value *without* #. You may add dot(s) to indicate augmentation dot(s).

4. For the variables 2 and 4, you may put up to two instances of tuplet values, in the form of list(s) within a list. At the minimum, you will need to supply an empty list, i.e. #'().

For example, if it is a simple triplet you wish to implement, you would write:

```
#' ( ( 3 ) )
```

If you wish to indicate tuplet in ratio, e.g. quintuplet in the span of 4 of the note values, you would create a list with two items, i.e.:

```
#' ( ( 5 4 ) )
```

You may set another tuplet instance *above* the initial tuplet, so the following list:

```
#' ( ( 4 3 ) ( 5 4 ) )
```

...would produce the tuplet indication at the end of measure 3 in the example shown above.

5. For #V_OFFSET and #H_OFFSET (only for \MModEquationSTR), enter numbers preceded by #. These numbers adjust the placement of the formula. When in doubt, start with #0.

7.3.3 Code

```

1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 MModEquationSTR =
4 #(define-music-function
5   (notevalue1 ratio1 notevalue2 ratio2 verticaloffset horizontaloffset)
6   (ly:duration? list? ly:duration? list? number? number?)
7   (let* (
8       (noteone notevalue1)
9       (notetwo notevalue2)
10      (ratioone ratio1)
11      (ratiotwo ratio2)
12      )
13   #{
14     \tweak X-offset #(- horizontaloffset 0.35)
15     \tweak Y-offset #verticaloffset
16     \textEndMark \markup \right-align {
17       \hspace #-0.5
18       \raise #0
19       \fontsize #-4.5
20       \override #'(self-alignment . LEFT)
21       {
22         {
23           \override #'(flag-style . modern-straight-flag)
24           \note { $noteone } #(if (= (ly:duration-log noteone) 4) 1 1 )
25         }
26         {
27           \hspace #(if (< (ly:duration-log noteone) 3) -4.15
```

```

28          (+ (* (ly:duration-dot-count noteone) -0.5) -4.5))
29      \concat {
30          \combine
31          \musicglyph "arrowheads.open.OM1"
32          \draw-line #'(2 . 0) \fontsize #-5 \musicglyph "space"
33      }
34  }
35  {
36      \hspace #(cond ((<= (ly:duration-log noteone) 2) 0.75)
37                    ((> (ly:duration-log noteone) 2) 0.25) )
38      \raise #(cond
39          ((= (ly:duration-log noteone) 0) -2)
40          ((and (> (ly:duration-log noteone) 0)
41              (<= (ly:duration-log noteone) 4) ) -.5)
42          ((> (ly:duration-log noteone) 4)
43              (+ (* (- (ly:duration-log noteone) 5) 0.6) 0))
44          )
45      #(cond
46          ((= (length ratioone) 1)
47              (markup
48                  #:line
49                  (#:hspace
50                      -4.5
51                      #:raise
52                      2.75
53                      (#:center-column
54                          (#:concat
55                              (#:translate
56                                  (cons 3.5 0.5)
57                                  (#:override
58                                      (cons 'thickness 1.5)
59                                      (#:translate
60                                          (cons -3.5 0)
61                                          (#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))))
62                              #:hspace
63                              -0.1
64                              #:override
65                              (cons 'thickness 1.5)
66                              (#:translate
67                                  (cons 0 0.5)
68                                  (#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5))))))
69                      #:vspace
70                      -0.45
71                      #:whiteout
72                      (#:halign
73                          1.75
74                          (#:concat
75                              (#:fontsize

```

```

76         -1
77         (:#:italic (:#:fontsize -5 (:#:musicglyph "space")))
78         #:fontsize
79         -1
80         #:italic
81         (if (= (length (car ratioone)) 2)
82             (begin (string-append
83                     (number->string (car (car ratioone)))
84                     ":"
85                     (number->string (cadr (car ratioone)))) )
86                 (number->string (car (car ratioone)))
87                 )
88
89         (:#:italic (:#:fontsize -5 (:#:musicglyph "space")))))))))))
90
91     ((= (length ratioone) 2)
92     (markup
93     #:line
94     (:#:hspace
95     -4.5
96     #:raise
97     2.75
98     (:#:center-column
99     (:#:concat
100    (:#:translate
101    (cons 3.5 0.5)
102    (:#:override
103    (cons 'thickness 1.5)
104    (:#:translate
105    (cons -3.5 0)
106    (:#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))))
107    #:hspace
108    -0.1
109    #:override
110    (cons 'thickness 1.5)
111    (:#:translate
112    (cons 0 0.5)
113    (:#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5))))))
114    #:vspace
115    -0.45
116    #:whiteout
117    (:#:halign
118    1.75
119    (:#:concat
120    (:#:fontsize
121    -1
122    (:#:italic (:#:fontsize -5 (:#:musicglyph "space")))
123    #:fontsize

```



```

124         -1
125         #:italic
126         (if (= (length (car ratioone)) 2)
127             (begin (string-append
128                     (number->string (car (car ratioone)))
129                     ":"
130                     (number->string (cadr (car ratioone)))) )
131             (number->string (car (car ratioone)))
132         )
133         (#:italic (#:fontsize -5 (#:musicglyph "space"))))))))
134 #:line
135 (#:hspace
136   -4.8
137   #:raise
138   4
139   (#:center-column
140     (#:concat
141       (#:translate
142         (cons 3.5 0.5)
143         (#:override
144           (cons 'thickness 1.5)
145           (#:translate
146             (cons -3.5 0)
147             (#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))))
148     #:hspace
149     -0.1
150     #:override
151     (cons 'thickness 1.5)
152     (#:translate
153       (cons 0 0.5)
154       (#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5))))))
155 #:vspace
156 -0.45
157 #:whiteout
158 (#:halign
159   1.75
160   (#:concat
161     (#:fontsize
162       -1
163       (#:italic (#:fontsize -5 (#:musicglyph "space")))
164       #:fontsize
165       -1
166       #:italic
167       (if (= (length (cadr ratioone)) 2)
168           (begin (string-append
169                   (number->string (car (cadr ratioone)))
170                   ":"
171                   (number->string (cadr (cadr ratioone)))) )

```

```

172             (number->string (car (cadr ratioone)))
173         )
174         (#:italic (#:fontsize -5 (#:musicglyph "space"))))))))
175     ))
176 )
177 }
178 }
179 }
180 \tweak self-alignment-X #CENTER
181 \tweak Y-offset #(- verticaloffset 0.4)
182 \tweak X-offset #(- horizontaloffset 0.35)
183 \textEndMark \markup { \fontsize #-3 "="}
184
185 \tweak Y-offset #verticaloffset
186 \tweak self-alignment-X #RIGHT
187 \tweak X-offset #(- horizontaloffset 0.35)
188 \tweak self-alignment-Y -1
189 \textEndMark \markup \left-align {
190   \hspace #1.9
191   \raise #0
192   \fontsize #-4.5
193   \concat {
194     {
195       \hspace #(cond ((<= (ly:duration-log notetwo) 2) 4)
196                     ((> (ly:duration-log notetwo) 2) 3.75) )
197       \raise #(cond
198                 ((= (ly:duration-log notetwo) 0) -2)
199                 ((and (> (ly:duration-log notetwo) 0)
200                     (<= (ly:duration-log notetwo) 4) ) -.5)
201                 ((> (ly:duration-log notetwo) 4)
202                 (+ (* (- (ly:duration-log notetwo) 5) 0.6) 0))
203             )
204       #(cond
205         ((= (length ratiotwo) 1)
206          (markup
207           #:line
208           (#:hspace
209            -4.5
210            #:raise
211            3.25
212            (#:center-column
213             (#:concat
214              (#:translate
215               (cons 3.5 0.5)
216               (#:override
217                (cons 'thickness 1.5)
218                (#:translate
219                 (cons 0 -0.5 )

```

```

220         (#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5)))
221     )
222     #:hspace
223     -0.1
224     #:override
225     (cons 'thickness 1.5)
226     (#:translate
227     (cons -3.5 0)
228     (#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))
229 #:vspace
230 -0.35
231 #:whiteout
232 (#:halign
233 1.75
234 (#:concat
235 (#:fontsize
236 -1
237 (#:italic (#:fontsize -5 (#:musicglyph "space"))))
238 #:fontsize
239 -1
240 #:italic
241 (if (= (length (car ratiotwo)) 2)
242     (begin (string-append
243             (number->string (car (car ratiotwo)))
244             ":"
245             (number->string (cadr (car ratiotwo)))) )
246     (number->string (car (car ratiotwo)))
247     )
248     (#:italic
249     (#:fontsize -5
250     (#:musicglyph "space"))))))))
251 ((= (length ratiotwo) 2)
252 (markup
253 #:line
254 (#:hspace
255 -4.5
256 #:raise
257 3.25
258 (#:center-column
259 (#:concat
260 (#:translate
261 (cons 3.5 0.5)
262 (#:override
263 (cons 'thickness 1.5)
264
265 (#:translate
266 (cons 0 -0.5 )
267 (#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5)))

```

```

268         )
269     #:hspace
270     -0.1
271     #:override
272     (cons 'thickness 1.5)
273     (#:translate
274       (cons -3.5 0)
275       (#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))
276   #:vspace
277   -0.35
278   #:whiteout
279   (#:halign
280     1.75
281     (#:concat
282       (#:fontsize
283         -1
284         (#:italic (#:fontsize -5 (#:musicglyph "space"))))
285       #:fontsize
286       -1
287       #:italic
288       (if (= (length (car ratiotwo)) 2)
289         (begin (string-append
290                 (number->string (car (car ratiotwo)))
291                 ":"
292                 (number->string (cadr (car ratiotwo)))) )
293           (number->string (car (car ratiotwo)))
294         )
295       (#:italic (#:fontsize -5 (#:musicglyph "space"))))))))
296   #:line
297   (#:hspace
298     -4.8
299     #:raise
300     4.5
301     (#:center-column
302       (#:concat
303         (#:translate
304           (cons 3.5 0.5)
305           (#:override
306             (cons 'thickness 1.5)
307             (#:translate
308               (cons 0 -0.5 )
309               (#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5)))
310           )
311       #:hspace
312       -0.1
313       #:override
314       (cons 'thickness 1.5)
315       (#:translate

```

```

316         (cons -3.5 0)
317         (:draw-line (cons -4.25 0)))
318     )
319     #:vspace
320     -0.35
321     #:whiteout
322     (:halign
323     1.75
324     (:concat
325     (:fontsize
326     -1
327     (:italic (:fontsize -5 (:musicglyph "space"))))
328     #:fontsize
329     -1
330     #:italic
331     (if (= (length (cadr ratiotwo)) 2)
332         (begin (string-append
333                 (number->string (car (cadr ratiotwo)))
334                 ":"
335                 (number->string (cadr (cadr ratiotwo)))))
336         (number->string (car (cadr ratiotwo)))
337         )
338
339     (:italic (:fontsize -5 (:musicglyph "space"))))))))
340 ))
341 )
342 }
343 {
344     \hspace #-4.25
345     \override #'(flag-style . modern-straight-flag)
346     \note { $notetwo } #(if (= (ly:duration-log notetwo) 4) 1 1 )
347 }
348 {
349     \hspace #0.5
350     \combine
351     \draw-line #'(-2 . 0)
352     \musicglyph "arrowheads.open.01"
353 }
354 }
355 }
356 #})
357 )
358
359
360 MModEquationBeginSTR =
361 #(define-music-function
362     (notevalue1 ratio1 notevalue2 ratio2 verticaloffset )
363     (ly:duration? list? ly:duration? list? number? )

```

```

364 (let* (
365     (noteone notevalue1)
366     (notetwo notevalue2)
367     (ratioone ratio1)
368     (ratiotwo ratio2)
369 )
370 #{
371
372   \tweak Y-offset #verticaloffset
373   \textMark \markup \left-align {
374
375     \raise #0
376     \fontsize #-4.5
377     \override #'(self-alignment . LEFT)
378     {
379       {
380         \hspace #(if (< (ly:duration-log noteone) 3) -4.15
381                     (+ (* (ly:duration-dot-count noteone) -0.5) -4.5))
382         \concat {
383           \combine
384           \musicglyph "arrowheads.open.OM1"
385           \draw-line #'(2 . 0) \fontsize #-5 \musicglyph "space"
386         }
387       }
388
389       {
390         \hspace #-0.5
391         \override #'(flag-style . modern-straight-flag)
392         \note { $noteone } #(if (= (ly:duration-log noteone) 4) 1 1 )
393       }
394
395
396       {
397         \hspace #(cond
398                     ((<= (ly:duration-dot-count noteone) 1) -0.5)
399                     ((> (ly:duration-dot-count noteone) 1)
400                      (+ (* (ly:duration-dot-count noteone) -0.5) -0.25)))
401         \right-align
402         \raise #(cond
403                     ((= (ly:duration-log noteone) 0) -2)
404                     ((and (> (ly:duration-log noteone) 0)
405                          (<= (ly:duration-log noteone) 4) ) -.5)
406                     ((> (ly:duration-log noteone) 4)
407                      (+ (* (- (ly:duration-log noteone) 5) 0.6) 0))
408                     )
409
410         #(cond
411             ((= (length ratioone) 1)

```

```

412      (markup
413        #:line
414        (#:hspace
415          -4.5
416          #:raise
417          2.75
418          (#:center-column
419            (#:concat
420              (#:translate
421                (cons 3.5 0.5)
422                (#:override
423                  (cons 'thickness 1.5)
424                  (#:translate
425                    (cons -3.5 0)
426                    (#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))))
427            #:hspace
428            -0.1
429            #:override
430            (cons 'thickness 1.5)
431            (#:translate
432              (cons 0 0.5)
433              (#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5))))))
434        #:vspace
435        -0.45
436        #:whiteout
437        (#:halign
438          1.75
439          (#:concat
440            (#:fontsize
441              -1
442              (#:italic (#:fontsize -5 (#:musicglyph "space"))))
443            #:fontsize
444            -1
445            #:italic
446            (if (= (length (car ratioone)) 2)
447              (begin (string-append
448                    (number->string (car (car ratioone)))
449                    ":"
450                    (number->string (cadr (car ratioone)))) )
451              (number->string (car (car ratioone))))
452            )
453          (#:italic
454            (#:fontsize -5
455              (#:musicglyph "space"))))))))
456
457      ((= (length ratioone) 2)
458      (markup

```

```

460      #:line
461      (#:hspace
462        -4.5
463        #:raise
464        2.75
465        (#:center-column
466          (#:concat
467            (#:translate
468              (cons 3.5 0.5)
469              (#:override
470                (cons 'thickness 1.5)
471                (#:translate
472                  (cons -3.5 0)
473                  (:#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))))
474            #:hspace
475            -0.1
476            #:override
477            (cons 'thickness 1.5)
478            (#:translate
479              (cons 0 0.5)
480              (:#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5))))))
481      #:vspace
482      -0.45
483      #:whiteout
484      (#:halign
485        1.75
486        (#:concat
487          (#:fontsize
488            -1
489            (:#:italic (:#:fontsize -5 (:#:musicglyph "space"))))
490          #:fontsize
491          -1
492          #:italic
493          (if (= (length (car ratioone)) 2)
494              (begin (string-append
495                      (number->string (car (car ratioone)))
496                      ":"
497                      (number->string (cadr (car ratioone))))))
498              (number->string (car (car ratioone))))
499          )
500          (:#:italic (:#:fontsize -5 (:#:musicglyph "space"))))))))
501
502      #:line
503      (#:hspace
504        -4.8
505        #:raise
506        4
507        (#:center-column

```



```

508         (:concat
509         (:translate
510         (cons 3.5 0.5)
511         (:override
512         (cons 'thickness 1.5)
513         (:translate
514         (cons -3.5 0)
515         (:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))))
516     #:hspace
517     -0.1
518     #:override
519     (cons 'thickness 1.5)
520     (:translate
521     (cons 0 0.5)
522     (:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5))))))
523     #:vspace
524     -0.45
525     #:whiteout
526     (:halign
527     1.75
528     (:concat
529     (:fontsize
530     -1
531     (:italic (:fontsize -5 (:musicglyph "space"))))
532     #:fontsize
533     -1
534     #:italic
535     (if (= (length (cadr ratioone)) 2)
536         (begin (string-append
537                 (number->string (car (cadr ratioone)))
538                 ":"
539                 (number->string (cadr (cadr ratioone)))) )
540         (number->string (car (cadr ratioone)))
541         )
542     (:italic (:fontsize -5 (:musicglyph "space"))))))))
543     ))
544     )
545
546
547 }
548 {
549     \hspace #(+ (* (ly:duration-dot-count noteone) 0.35) -0.2)
550     \fontsize #2 \lower #0.5  "="
551 }
552 \concat {
553
554 {
555     \hspace #(cond ((<= (ly:duration-log notetwo) 2) 4.15 )

```

```

556          ((> (ly:duration-log notetwo) 2) 4.15) )
557 \raise #(cond
558   ((= (ly:duration-log notetwo) 0) -2)
559   ((and (> (ly:duration-log notetwo) 0)
560    (<= (ly:duration-log notetwo) 4) ) -.5)
561   ((> (ly:duration-log notetwo) 4)
562    (+ (* (- (ly:duration-log notetwo) 5) 0.6) 0))
563   )
564
565 #(cond
566   ((= (length ratiotwo) 1)
567    (markup
568     #:line
569     (#:hspace
570      -4.5
571      #:raise
572      3.25
573      (#:center-column
574       (#:concat
575        (#:translate
576         (cons 3.5 0.5)
577         (#:override
578          (cons 'thickness 1.5)
579
580          (#:translate
581           (cons 0 -0.5 )
582           (#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5))))
583        )
584
585        #:hspace
586        -0.1
587
588        #:override
589        (cons 'thickness 1.5)
590        (#:translate
591         (cons -3.5 0)
592         (#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))))
593
594   #:vspace
595   -0.35
596   #:whiteout
597   (#:halign
598    1.75
599    (#:concat
600     (#:fontsize
601      -1
602      (#:italic (#:fontsize -5 (#:musicglyph "space"))))

```

```

604         #:fontsize
605         -1
606         #:italic
607         (if (= (length (car ratiotwo)) 2)
608             (begin (string-append
609                     (number->string (car (car ratiotwo)))
610                     ":"
611                     (number->string (cadr (car ratiotwo)))))
612                 (number->string (car (car ratiotwo)))
613             )
614         #:italic
615         (#:fontsize -5
616             (#:musicglyph "space")))))))))))
617
618 ((= (length ratiotwo) 2)
619 (markup
620   #:line
621   (#:hspace
622     -4.5
623     #:raise
624     3.25
625     (#:center-column
626       (#:concat
627         (#:translate
628           (cons 3.5 0.5)
629           (#:override
630             (cons 'thickness 1.5)
631             (#:translate
632               (cons 0 -0.5 )
633               (#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5))))
634         )
635         #:hspace
636         -0.1
637         #:override
638         (cons 'thickness 1.5)
639         (#:translate
640           (cons -3.5 0)
641           (#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0))))
642     #:vspace
643     -0.35
644     #:whiteout
645     (#:halign
646       1.75
647       (#:concat
648         (#:fontsize
649           -1
650           (#:italic (#:fontsize -5 (#:musicglyph "space"))))
651         #:fontsize

```

```

652         -1
653         #:italic
654         (if (= (length (car ratiotwo)) 2)
655             (begin (string-append
656                     (number->string (car (car ratiotwo)))
657                     ":"
658                     (number->string (cadr (car ratiotwo)))))
659                 (number->string (car (car ratiotwo)))
660             )
661         (#:italic
662         (#:fontsize -5
663         (#:musicglyph "space"))))))))
664
665 #:line
666 (#:hspace
667 -4.8
668 #:raise
669 4.5
670 (#:center-column
671 (#:concat
672 (#:translate
673 (cons 3.5 0.5)
674 (#:override
675 (cons 'thickness 1.5)
676 (#:translate
677 (cons 0 -0.5 )
678 (#:draw-line (cons 0 -0.5)))
679 )
680 #:hspace
681 -0.1
682 #:override
683 (cons 'thickness 1.5)
684 (#:translate
685 (cons -3.5 0)
686 (#:draw-line (cons -4.25 0)))
687 )
688 #:vspace
689 -0.35
690 #:whiteout
691 (#:halign
692 1.75
693 (#:concat
694 (#:fontsize
695 -1
696 (#:italic (#:fontsize -5 (#:musicglyph "space")))
697 #:fontsize
698 -1
699 #:italic

```

```

700             (if (= (length (cadr ratiotwo)) 2)
701                 (begin (string-append
702                         (number->string (car (cadr ratiotwo)))
703                         ":"
704                         (number->string (cadr (cadr ratiotwo)))))
705                     (number->string (car (cadr ratiotwo)))
706                     )
707                 (:#:italic
708                 (:#:fontsize -5
709                     (:#:musicglyph "space"))))))))
710         ))
711     )
712 }
713 {
714     \hspace #-4
715     \override #'(flag-style . modern-straight-flag)
716     \note { $notetwo }
717     #(if (= (ly:duration-log notetwo) 4) 1 1 )
718 }
719 {
720     \hspace #0.5
721     \combine
722     \draw-line #'(-2 . 0)
723     \musicglyph "arrowheads.open.01"
724 }
725 }
726 }
727 }
728 #})
729 )
730
731
732 {
733     \time 2/4
734     \tempo 4 = 60
735     c'16
736     ^\markup {\translate #'(0 . 10) " "}
737     [ c'16 c'16 c'16 ]
738     \tuplet 5/4 {c'16 [ c'16 c'16 c'16 c'16 ] }
739     \MModEquationSTR 16 #'((5)) 16 #'() #8 #0
740     \tempo 4 = 75
741     c'16 [ c'16 c'16 c'16 ]
742     \tuplet 3/2 {c'8 [ c'8 c'8 ] }
743     \override TupletNumber.text = #tuplet-number::calc-fraction-text
744     \tuplet 5/4 {c'8 [ c'8 ] \tuplet 4/3 { c'8 [ c'8 c'8 c'8 ] }}
745     \MModEquationSTR 8 #'((4 3)(5 4)) 8 #'((3)) 8 #-3
746     \revert TupletNumber.text
747     \break

```

```

748 \MModEquationBeginSTR 8 #'((4 3)(5 4)) 8 #'((3)) #6.5
749 \tuplet 3/2 {
750   c'8
751   ^\markup {\translate #'(0 . 10) " "}
752   ^\markup
753   {\fontsize #-1 \raise #0.25 \note {4} #1 "= 83.33"}
754   [ c'8 c'8 ]
755 }
756 \tuplet 3/2 {
757   c'8 c'8 c'8
758   \MModEquationSTR 4 #'() 4. #'() #6 #0
759 }
760 \time 6/8
761 c'8 c'8 c'8 c'4.
762 \bar "|."
763 }
764
765 \layout {
766   \context{
767     \Score
768     harmonicDots = ##t
769     \override Flag.stencil = #modern-straight-flag
770     \override MetronomeMark.flag-style = #'modern-straight-flag
771     \override StemTremolo.shape = #'beam-like
772     \override StemTremolo.slope = #0.4
773
774   }
775 }
776
777

```

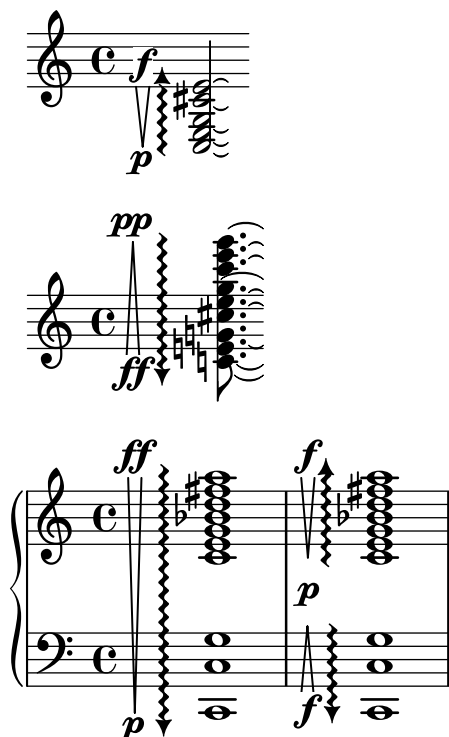
[Table of Contents](#)

Chapter 8

Spanners

This chapter covers snippets that take advantages of spanners (text, line, etc.) in one way or another. Because functions such as `\startTextSpan` and `\stopTextSpan` activate and deactivate these snippets, caution must be paid when using more than one of them at the same time. See [Example in Combinations](#) to avoid conflicts between or among the spanner snippets.

8.1 Arpeggio with Arrowhead and Vertical Hairpins



8.1.1 Description

Implementation of vertical hairpins associated with the directional arpeggios. LilyPond already provides functionality for the arpeggios with arrowheads.¹ However, I could not find a convenient snippet for the vertical hairpins to be used in tandem with such arpeggios.

In fact, I decided to take the route of drawing vertical hairpin with `\path` function within `\markup`. Should you so desire, you could tweak the value within it to further customize the opening width of the hairpin, for example.

Note that there are two functions, one to be used for single-staff arpeggios, another one for arpeggio that spans over multiple staves. This is because for the latter, the context must be set to `Score` instead of `Staff`.

8.1.2 Grammar

```
\arpeggioWithVerticalHairpinSingleStaff
  #ARPEGGIO_DIRECTION #CRESCENDO_DIRECTION "DYNAMIC_TOP" "DYNAMIC_BOTTOM" #HAIRPIN_X-
OFFSET
\arpeggioWithVerticalHairpinMultipleStaves
  #ARPEGGIO_DIRECTION #CRESCENDO_DIRECTION "DYNAMIC_TOP" "DYNAMIC_BOTTOM" #HAIRPIN_X-
OFFSET
```

NB

1. https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.26/Documentation/internals/arpeggio_002dinterface

- `#ARPEGGIO_DIRECTION` sets the direction of the arrowhead. `#UP` places an arrowhead at the top of the arpeggio, while `#DOWN` at the bottom.
- `#CRESCENDO_DIRECTION` defines the direction of the *crescendo as a shape*. To avoid any confusion, it is encouraged to think of this argument independently from the arpeggio direction you previously declared, and to think in a purely visual way (i.e. “How does this crescendo look on the paper, is it looking like V or Λ ?”). For example, `#UP` places a hairpin that looks like V while `#DOWN` will place a hairpin that looks like Λ .
- `"DYNAMIC_TOP"` and `"DYNAMIC_BOTTOM"` determine which dynamic indications to place at the top and the bottom of the hairpin, respectively. Note that you have to put the dynamics in quotation marks. If you desire no dynamic marking, for either end or both of the hairpin, use `" "`, i.e. surround a space with quotation marks. Declaring `" "` will result in warning messages.
- `#HAIRPIN_X-OFFSET` determines the distance between the hairpin and the arpeggio. Normally setting this argument to `#0` should pose no problem.

8.1.3 Code

```

1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 \language "english"
4
5 arpeggioWithVerticalHairpinSingleStaff =
6 #(define-music-function
7   (arpeggioDirection hairpinType dynamicUP dynamicDOWN hairpinOffset )
8   (ly:dir? ly:dir? string? string? number? )
9   #{
10     \once \override Staff.Arpeggio.X-extent =
11     #'(-2 . 0.75)
12     % NB: Override this value if you wish to adjust
13     % the general placement of arpeggio and hairpin
14     % as a pair
15     \once \override Staff.Arpeggio.stencil =
16     #(grob-transformer
17       'stencil
18       (lambda (grob original)
19         (let* ((pos (ly:grob-property grob 'positions))
20               (arpeggioArrowStencil
21                 (if (eq? arpeggioDirection UP )
22                     ;FOR UPWARD ARROW
23                     (cons 0.4 (+ (cdr pos) 1.45))
24                     ;FOR DOWNWARD ARROW
25                     (cons 0.4 (- (car pos) 1.75))
26                 )
27               )
28         (added-markup-one
29           (markup

```

```

30         #:overlay
31         (
32         #:translate arpeggioArrowStencil
33         #:scale (cons 1.25 1.25)
34         #:arrow-head 1 (if (eq? arpeggioDirection UP ) 1 -1) #t
35         )
36     ))
37 (hairpinStencil
38   (if (eq? hairpinType UP )
39       ; UNCOMMENT THIS FOR UPWARD CRESCENDO
40       (list (list 'moveto -1 (car pos))
41             (list 'rlineto -0.5 (- (cdr pos) (car pos)))
42             (list 'moveto -1 (car pos))
43             (list 'rlineto 0.5 (- (cdr pos) (car pos)))
44             )
45       ; UNCOMMENT THIS FOR DOWNWARD CRESCENDO
46       (list (list 'moveto -0.5 (car pos))
47             (list 'rlineto -0.5 (- (cdr pos) (car pos)))
48             (list 'moveto -1.5 (car pos))
49             (list 'rlineto 0.5 (- (cdr pos) (car pos)))
50             )
51       ))
52 (added-markup-two
53   (markup
54     #:overlay
55     (
56       #:general-align X CENTER
57       #:translate-scaled (cons -1.5 (+ (cdr pos) 1))
58       #:whiteout
59       #:dynamic
60       dynamicUP
61
62       #:general-align X CENTER
63       #:path 0.15 hairpinStencil
64
65       #:general-align X CENTER
66       #:translate-scaled (cons -1.5 (- (car pos) 1.5))
67
68       #:whiteout
69       #:dynamic
70       dynamicDOWN
71     )
72   )
73 )
74 (added-stencil-one
75   (ly:stencil-add original
76                     (grob-interpret-markup
77                     grob added-markup-one)))

```

```

78         (added-stencil-two
79         (grob-interpret-markup grob added-markup-two))
80     )
81
82     (if (ly:stencil? original)
83         (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge added-stencil-one
84                                     X -1
85                                     added-stencil-two
86                                     hairpinOffset)
87         added-stencil
88     ))))
89 #})
90
91 arpeggioWithVerticalHairpinMultipleStaves =
92 #(define-music-function
93   (arpeggioDirection hairpinType dynamicUP dynamicDOWN hairpinOffset )
94   (ly:dir? ly:dir? string? string? number? )
95   #{
96     \once \override Score.Arpeggio.X-extent =
97     #'(-2 . 0.75)
98     \once \override Score.Arpeggio.stencil =
99     #(grob-transformer
100       'stencil
101       (lambda (grob original)
102         (let* ((pos (ly:grob-property grob 'positions))
103                (arpeggioArrowStencil
104                 (if (eq? arpeggioDirection UP )
105                     ;FOR UPWARD ARROW
106                     (cons 0.4 (+ (cdr pos) 1.45))
107                     ;FOR DOWNWARD ARROW
108                     (cons 0.4 (- (car pos) 1.75))
109                 )
110                )
111         (added-markup-one
112         (markup
113           #:overlay
114           (
115             #:translate arpeggioArrowStencil
116             #:scale (cons 1.25 1.25)
117             #:arrow-head 1 (if (eq? arpeggioDirection UP ) 1 -1) #t
118           )
119         ))
120       (hairpinStencil
121       (if (eq? hairpinType UP )
122           ; UNCOMMENT THIS FOR UPWARD CRESCENDO
123           (list (list 'moveto -1 (car pos))
124                 (list 'rlineto -0.5 (- (cdr pos) (car pos)))
125                 (list 'moveto -1 (car pos))

```

```

126             (list 'rlineto 0.5   (- (cdr pos) (car pos)))
127         )
128     ; UNCOMMENT THIS FOR DOWNWARD CRESCENDO
129     (list (list 'moveto -0.5 (car pos))
130           (list 'rlineto -0.5   (- (cdr pos) (car pos)))
131           (list 'moveto -1.5 (car pos))
132           (list 'rlineto 0.5   (- (cdr pos) (car pos)))
133         )
134     ))
135 (added-markup-two
136   (markup
137     #:overlay
138     (
139       #:general-align X CENTER
140       #:translate-scaled (cons -1.5 (+ (cdr pos) 1))
141       #:whiteout
142       #:dynamic
143       dynamicUP
144
145       #:general-align X CENTER
146       #:path 0.15 hairpinStencil
147
148       #:general-align X CENTER
149       #:translate-scaled (cons -1.5 (- (car pos) 1.5))
150
151       #:whiteout
152       #:dynamic
153       dynamicDOWN
154     )
155   )
156 )
157 (added-stencil-one
158   (ly:stencil-add original
159                     (grob-interpret-markup
160                      grob added-markup-one)))
161 (added-stencil-two
162   (grob-interpret-markup grob added-markup-two))
163 )
164
165 (if (ly:stencil? original)
166     (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge added-stencil-one
167                                  X -1
168                                  added-stencil-two
169                                  hairpinOffset)
170     added-stencil
171   ))))
172 #}}
173

```

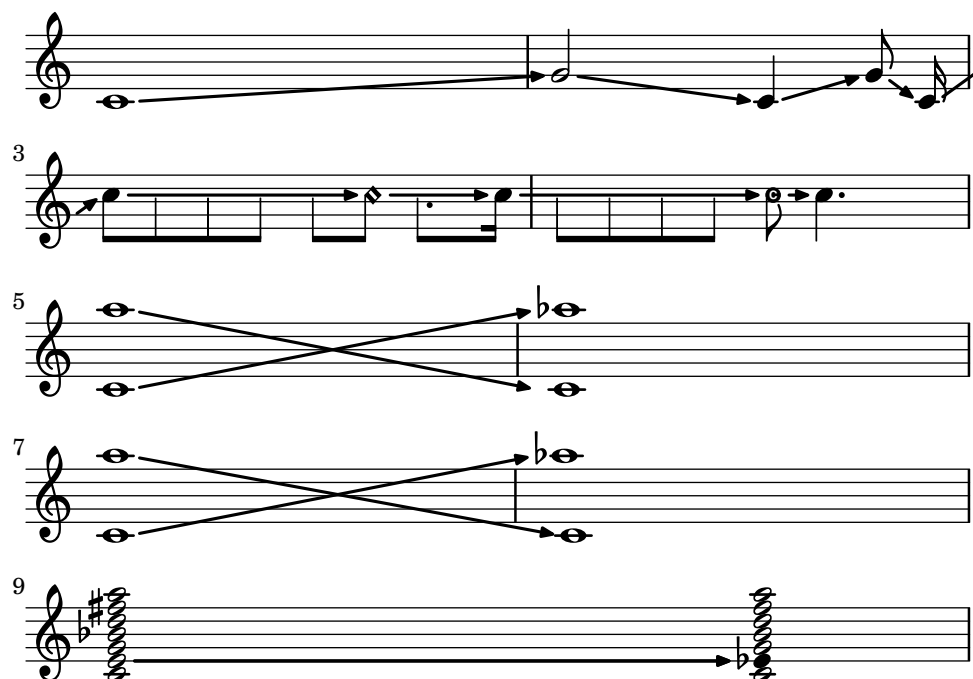
```

174
175
176
177 {
178   \arpeggioWithVerticalHairpinSingleStaff #UP #UP "f" "p" #0
179   <c e g cs' e'>2 \arpeggio \laissezVibrer
180 }
181 {
182   \arpeggioWithVerticalHairpinSingleStaff #DOWN #DOWN "pp" "ff" #0
183   \transpose c' c'' { <c! e! g! cs' e' g' c'' e'' g''>8. }
184   \arpeggio \laissezVibrer
185 }
186
187 \score {
188   \new PianoStaff \with {
189
190   } <<
191   \new Staff = "right" \with { }
192   {
193     \arpeggioWithVerticalHairpinMultipleStaves #DOWN #UP "ff" "p" #0.25
194     \once \set Score.connectArpeggios = ##t
195     <c' e' g' bf' d'' fs'' a''>1 \arpeggio |
196     \arpeggioWithVerticalHairpinSingleStaff #UP #UP "f" " " #0
197     % NB: When you wish to place no dynamic,
198     % make sure you include an empty space between quotation marks,
199     % otherwise 'warning: Found infinity or nan in output. Substituting 0.0'
200     % message will result.
201     <c' e' g' bf' d'' fs'' a''>1 \arpeggio
202     \tweak extra-offset #'(-5.25 . -0.75) \p
203   }
204
205   \new Staff = "left" \with {
206   } {
207     \clef bass <c, c g >1 \arpeggio
208     \arpeggioWithVerticalHairpinSingleStaff #DOWN #DOWN " " "f" #0.5
209     \once \override Staff.Arpeggio.extra-offset = #'(-1.75 . 1)
210     % NB: in order to align the hairpin applied to the right hand staff,
211     % extra-offset has been applied to offset the arpeggio and hairpin.
212     <c, c g >1 \arpeggio
213   }
214   >>
215 }

```

[Table of Contents](#)

8.2 Arrow Lines



8.2.1 Description

Implementation of arrow lines. It takes advantage of the `\glissando` function. It is possible to have the arrow line span over multiple notes, as `glissando-skip` parameter is set to `##t`. When the arrow line spans over multiple systems, the arrow mark will not appear at the end of the system.² Furthermore, it is possible to use the function on dyads and chords. The placement of the beginning of the arrow is adjusted according to the different types of notehead.

8.2.2 Grammar

```
\arrowLineOn STARTING_NOTE (NOTES...)
\arrowLineOff ARRIVAL_NOTE
```

8.2.3 Code

```
1
2 \version "2.26.0"
3
4 \arrowLineOn =
5 #(define-music-function (note)(ly:music?)
6   (define paddingvalue (if (music-is-of-type? note 'event-chord)
7     (ly:duration-log
8       (ly:music-property
9         (first
10          (ly:music-property note 'elements))
11          'duration)))
```

2. See [Discussion](#) for more details.

```

12             (ly:duration-log
13             (ly:music-property note 'duration))))
14
15     #{
16
17     \override Glissando.breakable = ##t
18     \override Glissando.after-line-breaking = ##t
19     \override Glissando.thickness = #2.35
20     \override Glissando.bound-details.right.arrow = ##t
21     \override Glissando.bound-details.right-broken.arrow = ##f
22     \override Glissando.bound-details.right-broken.padding = #-1
23     \override Glissando.bound-details.left.padding =
24     #(cond ((= paddingvalue 0) 0.85)
25            ((= paddingvalue 1) 0.65)
26            ((>= paddingvalue 2) 0.65))
27
28     \override Glissando.bound-details.right.padding = #0.25
29     #note
30     \glissando \override NoteColumn.glissando-skip = ##t
31     #})
32
33
34 arrowLineOff =
35 {
36   \revert Glissando.breakable
37   \revert Glissando.after-line-breaking
38   \revert Glissando.thickness
39   \revert Glissando.bound-details.right.arrow
40   \revert Glissando.bound-details.right-broken.arrow
41   \revert Glissando.bound-details.right-broken.padding
42   \revert Glissando.bound-details.left.padding
43   \revert Glissando.bound-details.right.padding
44   \revert NoteColumn.glissando-skip
45 }
46
47
48
49 \score {
50
51   {
52     \override Score.TimeSignature.stencil = ##f
53
54     \arrowLineOn
55     c'1
56     \arrowLineOff
57
58     \arrowLineOn
59     g'2

```

```

60    \arrowLineOff
61
62    \arrowLineOn
63    c'4
64    \arrowLineOff
65
66    \arrowLineOn
67    g'8 \noBeam
68    \arrowLineOff
69    \arrowLineOn
70    c'16 s16 |
71
72    \break
73    \arrowLineOff
74    \arrowLineOn
75    c''8
76    \override Voice.NoteHead.transparent = ##t
77    8 8 8 8
78    \revert Voice.NoteHead.transparent
79    \arrowLineOff
80
81    \arrowLineOn
82    8 \harmonic
83    \override Voice.NoteHead.transparent = ##t
84    \once \override Voice.Dots.extra-offset = #'(-1 . -0.75)
85
86    8.
87    \revert Voice.NoteHead.transparent
88    \arrowLineOff
89
90    \arrowLineOn
91    16
92
93    \override Voice.NoteHead.transparent = ##t
94    8 8 8 8
95    \revert Voice.NoteHead.transparent
96    \arrowLineOff
97    \easyHeadsOn
98    \arrowLineOn
99    8
100   \arrowLineOff
101   \easyHeadsOff
102   4.
103   \break
104   \arrowLineOn
105   <c' a''>1
106
107   \arrowLineOff

```



```

108   <aes'' c'>1
109
110   <<
111   { \arrowLineOn a''1 \arrowLineOff c'1} \\
112   {\arrowLineOn c'1 \arrowLineOff aes''1}
113   >>
114
115   \break
116   \override Voice.Stem.stencil = ##f
117   \override Voice.NoteHead.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
118   \override Voice.NoteHead.text = \markup{\musicglyph "noteheads.s1"}
119   \set glissandoMap = #'((1 . 1) (1 . 1))
120   \arrowLineOn
121   <c' e' g' bes' d'' fis'' a''>2
122   s4
123   \arrowLineOff
124   <c'
125   \single \override NoteHead.text =
126   \markup{\musicglyph "noteheads.s2"} es'
127   g' bes' d'' fis'' a''>4
128
129   }
130
131
132   \layout {
133
134     indent = #0
135     line-width = #125
136     ragged-last = ##f
137
138     \context {
139       \Score
140       proportionalNotationDuration = #1/7
141     }
142   }
143 }
144

```

8.2.4 Discussion

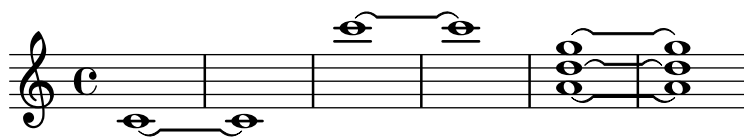
There are a few things to consider when using the arrow lines on dyads and chords:

- By default, all pair of notes will have arrow lines. In order to selectively show the arrow lines, use `\set glissandoMap`. See [1.3.3 Expressive marks as lines](#) in LilyPond's *Notation Reference* for details.
- Just as the ordinary `\glissando` function, the X coordinate of the terminating point for *all* of the lines between two dyads/chords is determined by the presence of accidentals in the arrival dyads/chords. Thus, if there is an accidental on one or more of the pitches in the

arriving dyad/chord, there may be a space between the tip of arrow and the pitches *without* the accidentals. Should this be avoided, it is best to apply the arrow lines in different layers, so that each of the layers will have a different X-coordinate value of the terminating point of the arrow lines.

[Table of Contents](#)

8.3 Boulez Tie



8.3.1 Description

Implementation of ties seen in Movement 5 *Tombeau of Pli selon pli* by Pierre Boulez.³ The shape is roughly a combination of a short, *laissez vibrer* sign on both originating and arriving notes, connected by a horizontal line. In the score, these are manually written in, and the shape is somewhat irregular.

8.3.2 Grammar

```
\override Tie.stencil = \boulezTie
```

8.3.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 boulezTie =
4 #(lambda (grob)
5
6   (let (
7     ;defines four control points, each of which containing
8     ;x and y, defined from a to h...
9     (a (caar (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points)) )
10    (b (cdar (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points)) )
11    (c (car (cadr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
12    (d (cdr (cadr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
13    (e (car (caddr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
14    (f (cdr (caddr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
15    (g (car (cadddr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
16    (h (cdr (cadddr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
17  )
18  (make-path-stencil
19
20    (list 'moveto a b
21          'curveto a b (* (+ a (+ c 0.5)) 0.5) d (+ c 0.5) b
22          'lineto (- e 0.5) b
23          'curveto (- e 0.5) b (+ (- e 0.5) (* (- g (- e 0.5)) 0.5)) f g h
24
25          'curveto g h (+ (- e 0.5) (* (- g (- e 0.5)) 0.6))
26          (+ f 0.1) (- e 0.5) (+ b 0.15)
```

3. Pierre Boulez, *Pli selon pli: V. Tombeau* (London: Universal Edition, 1971).

```

27         'lineto (+ c 0.5) (+ b 0.15)
28         'curveto (+ c 0.5) (+ b 0.15) (* (+ a (+ c 0.5)) 0.5) (+ d 0.1) a b
29         'closepath
30     )
31
32     0.01
33     1
34     1
35     #t
36 )
37 )
38 )
39
40 {
41
42     \override Tie.stencil = \boulezTie
43
44     c'1 ~ c'1
45     c''' ~ c'''
46     <a' d'' g''> ~ <a' d'' g''>
47 }

```

8.3.4 Discussion

It is possible to adjust the shape of the tie using `\shape` and `\vshape` commands.

[Table of Contents](#)

8.4 Dashed Arrow Lines



8.4.1 Description

Implementation of dashed arrow lines. Its design is nearly identical to that of the [Arrow Lines](#).

8.4.2 Grammar

```
\dashedArrowLineOn STARTING_NOTE (NOTES...)
\dashedArrowLineOff ARRIVAL_NOTE
```

8.4.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 dashedArrowLineOn =
4 #(define-music-function (note)(ly:music?)
5   (define paddingvalue (if (music-is-of-type? note 'event-chord)
6     (ly:duration-log
7       (ly:music-property
8         (first
9           (ly:music-property note 'elements))
10          'duration))
11     (ly:duration-log
12       (ly:music-property note 'duration))))
13
14 #{
15
16 \override Glissando.breakable = ##t
```

```

17   \override Glissando.after-line-breaking = ##t
18   \override Glissando.thickness = #2.35
19   \override Glissando.style = #'dashed-line
20   \override Glissando.bound-details.right.arrow = ##t
21   \override Glissando.bound-details.right-broken.arrow = ##f
22   \override Glissando.bound-details.right-broken.padding = #-1
23   \override Glissando.bound-details.left.padding =
24   #(cond ((= paddingvalue 0) 0.85)
25          ((= paddingvalue 1) 0.65)
26          ((>= paddingvalue 2) 0.65))
27
28   \override Glissando.bound-details.right.padding = #0.25
29   #note
30   \glissando \override NoteColumn.glissando-skip = ##t
31   #})
32
33
34 dashedArrowLineOff =
35 {
36   \revert Glissando.breakable
37   \revert Glissando.after-line-breaking
38   \revert Glissando.thickness
39   \revert Glissando.style
40   \revert Glissando.bound-details.right.arrow
41   \revert Glissando.bound-details.right-broken.arrow
42   \revert Glissando.bound-details.right-broken.padding
43   \revert Glissando.bound-details.left.padding
44   \revert Glissando.bound-details.right.padding
45   \revert NoteColumn.glissando-skip
46 }
47
48
49
50 \score {
51
52   {
53     \override Score.TimeSignature.stencil = ##f
54
55     \dashedArrowLineOn
56     c'1
57     \dashedArrowLineOff
58
59     \dashedArrowLineOn
60     g'2
61     \dashedArrowLineOff
62
63     \dashedArrowLineOn
64     c'4

```

```

65   \dashedArrowLineOff
66
67   \dashedArrowLineOn
68   g'8 \noBeam
69   \dashedArrowLineOff
70   \dashedArrowLineOn
71   c'16 s16 |
72
73   \break
74   \dashedArrowLineOff
75   \dashedArrowLineOn
76   c''8
77   \override Voice.NoteHead.transparent = ##t
78   8 8 8 8
79   \revert Voice.NoteHead.transparent
80   \dashedArrowLineOff
81
82   \dashedArrowLineOn
83   8 \harmonic
84   \override Voice.NoteHead.transparent = ##t
85   \once \override Voice.Dots.extra-offset = #'(-1 . -0.75)
86
87   8.
88   \revert Voice.NoteHead.transparent
89   \dashedArrowLineOff
90
91   \dashedArrowLineOn
92   16
93
94   \override Voice.NoteHead.transparent = ##t
95   8 8 8 8
96   \revert Voice.NoteHead.transparent
97   \dashedArrowLineOff
98   \easyHeadsOn
99   \dashedArrowLineOn
100  8
101  \dashedArrowLineOff
102  \easyHeadsOff
103  4.
104  \break
105  \dashedArrowLineOn
106  <c' a''>1
107
108  \dashedArrowLineOff
109  <aes'' c'>1
110
111  <<
112  { \dashedArrowLineOn a''1 \dashedArrowLineOff c'1} \

```

```

113     {\dashedArrowLineOn c'1 \dashedArrowLineOff aes''1}
114     >>
115     \break
116     \override Voice.Stem.stencil = ##f
117     \override Voice.NoteHead.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
118     \override Voice.NoteHead.text = \markup{\musicglyph "noteheads.s1"}
119     \set glissandoMap = #'((1 . 1) (1 . 1))
120     \dashedArrowLineOn
121     <c' e' g' bes' d'' fis'' a''>2
122     s4
123     \dashedArrowLineOff
124     <c'
125     \single \override NoteHead.text =
126     \markup{\musicglyph "noteheads.s2"} es'
127     g' bes' d'' fis'' a''>4
128
129   }
130
131   \layout {
132
133     indent = #0
134     line-width = #125
135
136     ragged-last = ##f
137
138     \context {
139       \Score
140       proportionalNotationDuration = #1/7
141     }
142   }
143 }

```

8.4.4 Discussion

See [Discussion of the Arrow Lines](#). [Table of Contents](#)

8.5 Dashed Flat Slurs



8.5.1 Description

See [Flat Slurs](#) for the ordinary non-dashed version.

Because the [Flat Slurs](#) is based on a rewritten stencil, further overrides within `Slur`, such as [Making slurs with complex dash structure](#) will not work. This particular implementation addresses the issue of achieving dashed lines for the flat slurs. Here, three different stencils are created, defined as variables, then combined using `ly:stencil-add`.

See [Flat Slurs](#) for the ordinary non-dashed version, as well as [Discussion](#) for hints on tweaking.

8.5.2 Grammar

```
\override Slur.stencil = \flatSlur
```

8.5.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 dashedFlatSlur =
4 #(lambda (grob)
5
6   (let* (
7     ;defines four control points, each of which containing
8     ;x and y, defined from a to h...
9     (a (caar (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points)) )
10    (b (cdar (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points)) )
11    (c (car (cadr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
12    (d (cdr (cadr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
13    (e (car (caddr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
```

```

14      (f (cdr (caddr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
15      (g (car (caddr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
16      (h (cdr (caddr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
17      (firstCurve (make-path-stencil
18                  (list 'moveto a b
19                        'curveto a b a (- d 0.2) c (- d 0.2)
20                        'lineto c (- d 0.4)
21                        'curveto c (- d 0.4) (+ a 0.1) (- d 0.3) a b
22                        'closepath
23                  )
24              0.01
25              1
26              1
27              #t
28              ))
29      (secondCurve (make-path-stencil
30                  (list 'moveto e (- f 0.2)
31                        'curveto e (- f 0.2) g (- f 0.2) g h
32                        'curveto g h (+ g 0.1) (- f 0.5) e (- f 0.4)
33                        'closepath
34                  )
35              0.01
36              1
37              1
38              #t
39              ))
40
41      (dashedLine (grob-interpret-markup
42                  grob
43                  (markup
44                    #:line
45                    (#:postscript
46                      (string-append
47                        "0.2 setlinewidth [0.4 0.4] 0 setdash "
48                        (number->string (+ c 0.2)) " "
49                        (number->string (- d 0.3))
50                        " moveto "
51                        (number->string (- e 0.2)) " "
52                        (number->string (- f 0.3))
53                        " lineto stroke"))
54                    ))
55              )
56      )
57      (ly:stencil-add firstCurve dashedLine secondCurve
58
59      )
60  )
61  )

```

```

62 \layout {
63   indent = 0
64   line-width = 80
65 }
66 {
67   \time 2/4
68   \override Slur.stencil = \dashedFlatSlur
69
70   \override Slur.details =
71   #'(
72     (max-slope . 0)
73     (max-slope-factor . 100)
74     (free-head-distance . 0.2)
75     (free-slur-distance . 0)
76     (extra-encompass-free-distance . 0.3)
77     (extra-encompass-collision-distance . 0.8)
78     (head-slur-distance-max-ratio . 3)
79     (head-slur-distance-factor . 10)
80   )
81
82   \shape #'(
83     (0 . 1)
84     (0 . 0.5)
85     (0 . 0.5)
86     (0 . 0.25)
87   ) Slur
88
89   e'16 ( d' c' d' e' d' c'8 )
90
91   \shape #'(
92     (0 . 0)
93     (0 . -0.5)
94     (0 . -0.5)
95     (0 . -1)
96   ) Slur
97   g''16 ( f'' e'' f'' g'' f'' e''8 ) \break
98
99
100  \shape #'(
101    (( 0 . 0) (0 . 0) (0 . 0) (0 . 0))
102    ((-1.25 . 3.5) (-1.25 . 3.75)(0 . 3.75)(0 . 2.5))
103  ) Slur
104  c''4 ( b' a' g' ~ | \break
105
106  g'8 )
107
108  \shape #'(
109    (0 . 0)

```

```
110          (0 . 0.2)
111          (0.75 . 2.45)
112          (0 . 3)
113          ) Slur
114
115
116    a ( c' e' g' b' ) r4 |
117
118
119 }
```

[Table of Contents](#)

8.6 Flat Slurs



8.6.1 Description

Implementation of a straight-line slur in which only the beginning and ending parts are curved. This type of slurs can be found in scores by such composers as Brian Ferneyhough, Claus-Steffen Mahnkopf, and Donald Martino, where such slurs were manually drawn using a ruler. Even in the age of digital musical engraving, composers such as Stefan Beyer have emulated this slur using the musical engraving software programs.

This flat slur requires careful tweaking in order to make it look optimal on the score. This is discussed further in [Discussion](#).

See also [Dashed Flat Slurs](#).

8.6.2 Grammar

```
\override Slur.stencil = \flatSlur
```

8.6.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 flatSlur =
4 #(lambda (grob)
5
6   (let (
7     ;defines four control points, each of which containing
8     ;x and y, defined from a to h...
9     (a (caar (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points)) )
10    (b (cdar (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points)) )
11    (c (car (cadr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
12    (d (cdr (cadr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
13    (e (car (caddr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points)))))
```

```

14      (f (cdr (caddr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
15      (g (car (caddr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
16      (h (cdr (caddr (ly:grob-property grob 'control-points))))
17    )
18    (make-path-stencil
19      (if (= (ly:grob-property grob 'direction) 1)
20        ;this is if the slur/tie direction is up...
21        (list 'moveto a b
22              'curveto a b a (- d 0.2) c (- d 0.2)
23              'lineto e (- f 0.2)
24              'curveto e (- f 0.2) g (- f 0.2) g h
25
26              'curveto g h (+ g 0.1) (- f 0.5) e (- f 0.4)
27              'lineto c (- d 0.4)
28              'curveto c (- d 0.4) (+ a 0.1) (- d 0.3) a b
29              'closepath
30            )
31        ;if the direction is down...
32        (list 'moveto a b
33              'curveto a b a (+ d 0.2) c (+ d 0.2)
34              'lineto e (+ f 0.2)
35
36              'curveto e (+ f 0.2) g (+ f 0.2) g h
37
38              'curveto g h (- g 0.1) (+ f 0.5) e (+ f 0.4)
39              'lineto c (+ d 0.4)
40              'curveto c (+ d 0.4) (+ a 0.3) (+ d 0.3) a b
41              'closepath
42            ))
43
44      0.01
45      1
46      1
47      #t
48    )
49  )
50 )
51 \layout {
52   indent = 0
53   line-width = 80
54 }
55 {
56   \time 2/4
57   \override Slur.stencil = \flatSlur
58
59   \override Slur.details =
60   #'(
61     (max-slope . 0)

```

```

62      (max-slope-factor . 100)
63      (free-head-distance . 0.2)
64      (free-slur-distance . 0)
65      (extra-encompass-free-distance . 0.3)
66      (extra-encompass-collision-distance . 0.8)
67      (head-slur-distance-max-ratio . 3)
68      (head-slur-distance-factor . 10)
69    )
70
71    \shape #'(
72      (0 . 1)
73      (0 . 0.5)
74      (0 . 0.5)
75      (0 . 0.25)
76    ) Slur
77
78    e'16 ( d' c' d' e' d' c'8 )
79
80    \shape #'(
81      (0 . 0)
82      (0 . -0.5)
83      (0 . -0.5)
84      (0 . -1)
85    ) Slur
86    g''16 ( f'' e'' f'' g'' f'' e''8 ) \break
87
88
89
90    c''4 ( b' a' g' ~ | \break
91
92    g'8 )
93
94    \shape #'(
95      (0 . 0)
96      (0 . 0.2)
97      (0.75 . 2.5)
98      (0 . 3)
99    ) Slur
100
101
102    a ( c' e' g' b' ) r4 |
103
104
105  }
```

8.6.4 Discussion

While this code can be used out of box by overriding `Slur.stencil` to `\flatSlur`, you may find that tweak will be needed. Initial experiments have shown that the following overrides of `Slur.details` help:

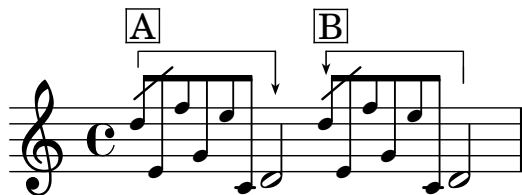
```
1  \override Slur.details =
2  #'(
3    (max-slope . 0)
4    (max-slope-factor . 100)
5    (free-head-distance . 0.2)
6    (free-slur-distance . 0)
7    (extra-encompass-free-distance . 0.3)
8    (extra-encompass-collision-distance . 0.8)
9    (head-slur-distance-max-ratio . 3)
10   (head-slur-distance-factor . 10)
11   )
```

There may be other effective `Slur.details` configurations.

Beyond this, further refinements can be made using `\shape` and `\vshape`.

[Table of Contents](#)

8.7 Grace Note Brackets I



8.7.1 Description

NB: See [Grace Note Brackets II](#) for the updated version of this code.) Replication of grace note brackets seen in scores by Pierre Boulez (e.g. *Sur Incises*,⁴ *...explosante-fixe...*⁵). Bracket A in the example shows that the grace notes are to be played *before* the beat to which they are applied. Whereas Bracket B shows that the grace notes are to be played *on* the beat to which they are applied.

8.7.2 Grammar

```
\graceNoteBeforeBeatOn NOTE
\graceNoteBeforeBeatOff NOTE
\graceNoteAfterBeatOn NOTE
\graceNoteAfterBeatOff NOTE
```

8.7.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 % This code includes snippet for grace note
4 % slashes, which has been taken from:
5 % https://lsr.di.unimi.it/LSR/Item?id=1048
6
7
8 graceNoteBeforeBeatOn =
9 #(define-music-function (starting_note) (ly:music?)
10  #{
11    \once \override TextSpanner.style = #'line
12    \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.left.text =
13    \markup { \draw-line #'(0 . -1) }
14    \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.right.text =
15    \markup {
16      \postscript
17      "newpath 0 0 moveto
18    0 -2.5 rlineto
```

4. Pierre Boulez, *Sur incises : pour trois pianos, trois harpes et trois percussions-claviers (1996/1998)* (Universal Edition, 1998).

5. Pierre Boulez, *... explosante-fixe ... transitoire VII : (version 1991/93)* (Universal Edition, 1991).

```

19 stroke
20 newpath
21 -0.275 -2 moveto
22 0.275 -0.75 rlineto
23 0.275 0.75 rlineto
24 -0.275 -0.2 rlineto
25 closepath
26 fill"
27   }
28   \once \override TextSpanner.Y-offset = #5
29   \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.left.padding = #0.5
30   \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.right.padding = #-0.25
31   #starting_note
32   \startTextSpan
33   #})
34
35
36 graceNoteBeforeBeatOff =
37 #(define-music-function (ending_note) (ly:music?)
38   #{
39     #ending_note
40     \stopTextSpan
41     #})
42
43
44 graceNoteAfterBeatOn =
45 #(define-music-function (starting_note) (ly:music?)
46   #{
47     \once \override TextSpanner.style = #'line
48     \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.right.text =
49     \markup {
50       \combine \draw-line #'(0 . -1)
51       \postscript "newpath
52 0 -1 moveto
53 0 -1 rlineto
54 stroke"
55   }
56   \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.left.text =
57   \markup {
58     \postscript
59     "newpath 0 0 moveto
60 0 -1 rlineto
61 stroke
62 newpath
63 -0.275 -0.75 moveto
64 0.275 -0.75 rlineto
65 0.275 0.75 rlineto
66 -0.275 -0.2 rlineto

```

```

67 closepath
68 fill"
69 }
70 \once \override TextSpanner.Y-offset = #2
71 \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.left.padding = #0.5
72 \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.right.padding = #-0.25
73 #starting_note
74 \startTextSpan
75 #})
76
77
78 graceNoteAfterBeatOff =
79 #(define-music-function (ending_note) (ly:music?)
80   #{
81     #ending_note
82     \stopTextSpan
83   #})
84
85 %%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%LSR SNIPPET START%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%
86
87 #(define (degrees->radians deg)
88   (* PI (/ deg 180.0)))
89
90 slash =
91 #(define-music-function (ang stem-fraction protrusion)
92   (number? number? number?)
93   (remove-grace-property 'Voice 'Stem 'direction)
94   #{
95     \once \override Stem.stencil =
96     #(lambda (grob)
97       (let* ((x-parent (ly:grob-parent grob X))
98              (is-rest? (ly:grob?
99                          (ly:grob-object x-parent 'rest)))
100              (beam (ly:grob-object grob 'beam))
101              (stil (ly:stem::print grob)))
102         (cond
103          (is-rest? empty-stencil)
104          ((ly:grob? beam)
105           (let* ((refp (ly:grob-system grob))
106                  (stem-y-ext (ly:grob-extent grob Y))
107                  (stem-length
108                    (- (cdr stem-y-ext) (car stem-y-ext)))
109                  (beam-X-pos (ly:grob-property beam 'X-positions))
110                  (beam-Y-pos (ly:grob-property beam 'positions))
111                  (beam-slope (/ (- (cdr beam-Y-pos) (car beam-Y-pos))
112                                (- (cdr beam-X-pos) (car beam-X-pos))))
112                  (beam-angle (atan beam-slope))
113                  (dir (ly:grob-property grob 'direction)))
114

```

```

115         (line-dy (* stem-length stem-fraction))
116         (line-dy-with-protrusions (if (= dir 1)
117                                     (+ (* 4 protrusion) beam-angle)
118                                     (- (* 4 protrusion) beam-angle)))
119         (ang (if (> beam-slope 0)
120                (if (= dir 1)
121                    (+ (degrees->radians ang) (* beam-angle 0.7))
122                    (degrees->radians ang))
123                (if (= dir 1)
124                    (degrees->radians ang)
125                    (- (degrees->radians ang) (* beam-angle 0.7)))))
126         (line-dx (/ line-dy-with-protrusions (tan ang)))
127         (protrusion-dx (/ protrusion (tan ang)))
128         (corr (if (= dir 1) (car stem-y-ext) (cdr stem-y-ext)))
129     (ly:stencil-add
130      stil
131      (grob-interpret-markup grob
132       (markup
133        #:translate
134        (cons (- protrusion-dx)
135              (+ corr
136                (* dir
137                  (- stem-length
138                    (+ stem-fraction protrusion))))))
139        #:override '(thickness . 1.7)
140        #:draw-line
141        (cons line-dx
142              (* dir line-dy-with-protrusions))))))
143    (else stil)))
144  #}})
145
146  startSlashedGraceMusic = {
147    \slash 40 1 0.5
148    \override Flag.stroke-style = #"grace"
149  }
150  stopSlashedGraceMusic = {
151    \revert Flag.stroke-style
152  }
153
154  startAcciaccaturaMusic = {
155    \slash 40 1 0.5
156    s1*0(
157    \override Flag.stroke-style = #"grace"
158  }
159  stopAcciaccaturaMusic = {
160    \revert Flag.stroke-style
161    s1*0)
162  }

```

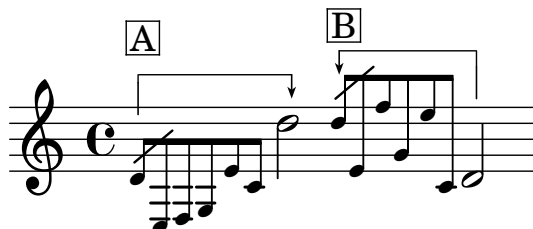
```

163 %%%%%%%%%%%%%%% LSR SNIPPET END %%%%%%%%%%%%%%%
164
165 {
166   \grace {
167     \startSlashedGraceMusic
168     \graceNoteBeforeBeatOn d''8^\markup{\box A} e' f'' g' e'' c'
169   }
170   \graceNoteBeforeBeatOff d'2
171   \grace {
172     \startSlashedGraceMusic
173     \graceNoteAfterBeatOn d''8^\markup{\box B} e' f'' g' e'' c'
174   }
175   \graceNoteAfterBeatOff d'2
176 }
177
178

```

[Table of Contents](#)

8.8 Grace Note Brackets II



8.8.1 Description

This is an updated version of Grace Note Brackets I. It differs from the original version in that this version takes a list of three parameters in order to finely adjust the shape of the bracket in order to accommodate various shapes of grace notes and the actual note.

8.8.2 Grammar

```
\graceNoteBeforeBeatOn #'(OVERALL LEFT RIGHT) NOTE
\graceNoteBeforeBeatOff #'(OVERALL LEFT RIGHT) NOTE
\graceNoteAfterBeatOn #'(OVERALL LEFT RIGHT) NOTE
\graceNoteAfterBeatOff #'(OVERALL LEFT RIGHT) NOTE
```

NB The list accepts three integers as parameters, i.e.:

1. **OVERALL** is a value of the distance between the top line of the staff and the horizontal line of the grace note bracket. This value cannot be smaller than the skyline value established by the staff line and the notes; when the skyline value is greater than what is specified in this bracket, the skyline value is favored. When in doubt, start with 0, then increase the amount gradually.
2. **LEFT** and **RIGHT** values (negative value only!) adjust the lengths of the left and right hooks.

8.8.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 % This code includes snippet for grace note
4 % slashes, which has been taken from:
5 % https://lsr.di.unimi.it/LSR/Item?id=1048
6
7 % Slightly revised, Jan. 19/22 2025 - YO
8
9 graceNoteBeforeBeatOn =
10 #(define-music-function (setting-list starting_note) (list? ly:music? )
11   #{
12     \once \override TextSpanner.style = #'line
13     \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.left.text =
14     \markup {
```

```

15     \combine
16     \draw-line #(cons 0 -0.5)
17     \postscript #(string-append "newpath
18 0 -0.5 moveto
19 0 " (number->string (cadr setting-list)) " rlineto
20 stroke")
21   }
22   \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.right.text =
23   \markup {
24     \postscript
25     #(string-append "newpath 0 0 moveto
26 0 " (number->string (caddr setting-list)) " rlineto
27 stroke
28 newpath
29 -0.275 " (number->string (+ (caddr setting-list) 0.25)) " moveto
30 0.275 -0.75 rlineto
31 0.275 0.75 rlineto
32 -0.275 -0.2 rlineto
33 closepath
34 fill")
35   }
36   \once \override TextSpanner.extra-offset = #(cons 0 (car setting-list))
37   \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.left.padding = #0.5
38   \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.right.padding = #-0.25
39   #starting_note
40   \startTextSpan
41   #})
42
43
44 graceNoteBeforeBeatOff =
45 #(define-music-function (ending_note) (ly:music?)
46   #{
47     #ending_note
48     \stopTextSpan
49     #})
50
51
52 graceNoteAfterBeatOn =
53 #(define-music-function (setting-list starting_note) (list? ly:music?)
54   #{
55     \once \override TextSpanner.style = #'line
56     \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.right.text =
57     \markup {
58       \combine
59       \draw-line #(cons 0 -1)
60       \postscript #(string-append "newpath
61 0 -1 moveto
62 0 " (number->string (caddr setting-list)) " rlineto

```

```

63 stroke")
64   }
65   \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.left.text =
66   \markup {
67     \postscript
68     #(string-append "newpath 0 0 moveto
69 0 " (number->string (cadr setting-list)) " rlineto
70 stroke
71 newpath
72 -0.275 " (number->string (+ (cadr setting-list) 0.25)) " moveto
73 0.275 -0.75 rlineto
74 0.275 0.75 rlineto
75 -0.275 -0.2 rlineto
76 closepath
77 fill")
78   }
79   \once \override TextSpanner.extra-offset = #(cons 0 (car setting-list))
80   \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.left.padding = #0.5
81   \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.right.padding = #-0.25
82   #starting_note
83   \startTextSpan
84   #})
85
86
87 graceNoteAfterBeatOff =
88 #(define-music-function (ending_note) (ly:music?)
89   #{
90     #ending_note
91     \stopTextSpan
92   #})
93
94 %%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%LSR SNIPPET START%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%
95
96 #(define (degrees->radians deg)
97   (* PI (/ deg 180.0)))
98
99 slash =
100 #(define-music-function (ang stem-fraction protrusion)
101   (number? number? number?)
102   (remove-grace-property 'Voice 'Stem 'direction)
103   #{
104     \once \override Stem.stencil =
105     #(lambda (grob)
106       (let* ((x-parent (ly:grob-parent grob X))
107              (is-rest? (ly:grob?
108                          (ly:grob-object x-parent 'rest)))
109              (beam (ly:grob-object grob 'beam))
110              (stil (ly:stem::print grob)))

```



```

111 (cond
112   (is-rest? empty-stencil)
113   ((ly:grob? beam)
114     (let* ((refp (ly:grob-system grob))
115            (stem-y-ext (ly:grob-extent grob grob Y))
116            (stem-length
117              (- (cdr stem-y-ext) (car stem-y-ext)))
118            (beam-X-pos (ly:grob-property beam 'X-positions))
119            (beam-Y-pos (ly:grob-property beam 'positions))
120            (beam-slope (/ (- (cdr beam-Y-pos) (car beam-Y-pos))
121                          (- (cdr beam-X-pos) (car beam-X-pos))))
122            (beam-angle (atan beam-slope))
123            (dir (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
124            (line-dy (* stem-length stem-fraction))
125            (line-dy-with-protrusions (if (= dir 1)
126                                          (+ (* 4 protrusion) beam-angle)
127                                          (- (* 4 protrusion) beam-angle)))
128            (ang (if (> beam-slope 0)
129                    (if (= dir 1)
130                        (+ (degrees->radians ang) (* beam-angle 0.7))
131                        (degrees->radians ang))
132                    (if (= dir -1)
133                        (degrees->radians ang)
134                        (- (degrees->radians ang) (* beam-angle 0.7)))))
135            (line-dx (/ line-dy-with-protrusions (tan ang)))
136            (protrusion-dx (/ protrusion (tan ang)))
137            (corr (if (= dir 1) (car stem-y-ext) (cdr stem-y-ext))))
138     (ly:stencil-add
139       stil
140       (grob-interpret-markup grob
141         (markup
142           #:translate
143           (cons (- protrusion-dx)
144                 (+ corr
145                   (* dir
146                     (- stem-length
147                       (+ stem-fraction protrusion))))))
148           #:override '(thickness . 1.7)
149           #:draw-line
150           (cons line-dx
151                 (* dir line-dy-with-protrusions))))))
152   (else stil)))
153 #})
154
155 startSlashedGraceMusic = {
156   \slash 40 1 0.5
157   \override Flag.stroke-style = #"grace"
158 }

```

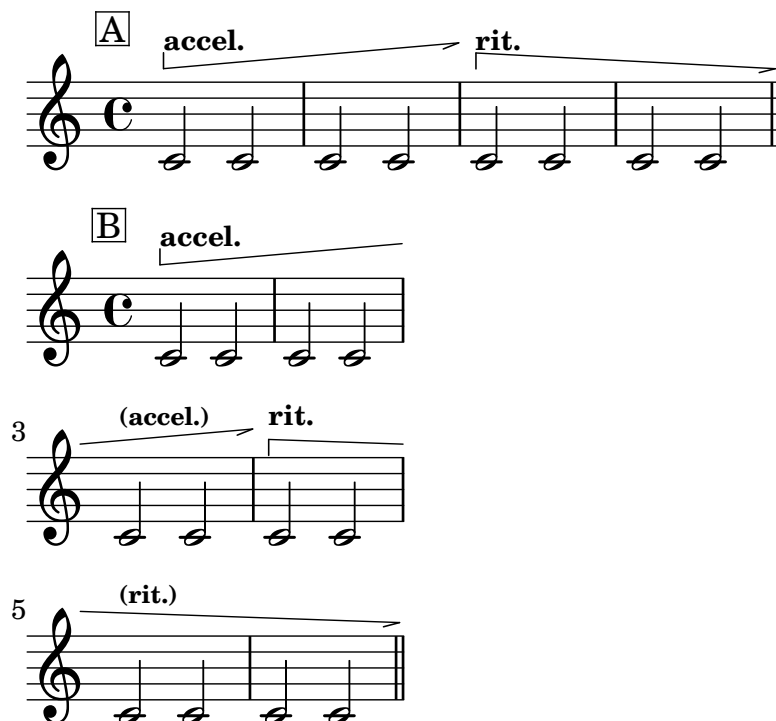
```

159 stopSlashedGraceMusic = {
160   \revert Flag.stroke-style
161 }
162
163 startAcciaccaturaMusic = {
164   \slash 40 1 0.5
165   s1*0(
166   \override Flag.stroke-style = #"grace"
167 }
168 stopAcciaccaturaMusic = {
169   \revert Flag.stroke-style
170   s1*0)
171 }
172 %%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%% LSR SNIPPET END %%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%
173
174 {
175   \grace {
176     \startSlashedGraceMusic
177     \graceNoteBeforeBeatOn #'(1 -2 -1) d'8^\markup{\translate #'(0 . 3) \box A}
178     e f g e' c'
179   }
180   \graceNoteBeforeBeatOff d''2
181   \grace {
182     \startSlashedGraceMusic
183     \graceNoteAfterBeatOn #'(0 -1 -2) d''8^\markup{\box B} e' f'' g' e'' c'
184   }
185   \graceNoteAfterBeatOff d'2
186 }
187

```

[Table of Contents](#)

8.9 Tempo Arrows



8.9.1 Description

Replication of accelerando and rallentando arrows chiefly seen in scores by Tōru Takemitsu.⁶ The snippets also handle line break.

8.9.2 Grammar

```
\accelArrow #Line_angle ... \stopTextSpan
\rallArrow #Line_angle ... \stopTextSpan
```

NB

1. `#Line_angle` sets how angled the horizontal line should be. `#5` should be more than sufficient for a short line. When it goes over a line break or it extends for a long time, a smaller number may be recommended, such as `#2`.
2. These commands only set the tempo arrows; as such, indications such as `accel.` and `rall.` need to be added separately.

8.9.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 % freely modified from: https://lsr.di.unimi.it/LSR/Item?id=1168
```

6. Examples abound, but see: Tōru Takemitsu, *Fantasma/cantos : for clarinet and orchestra* (Schott ; Schott Japan, 1993) and Tōru Takemitsu, *Les yeux clos II : for piano* (Schott ; Schott Japan, 1990) Other composers from the same publishing company, e.g. Toshio Hosokawa, have also adopted variants of the arrows in their music.

```

4  % as well as http://lsr.di.unimi.it/LSR/Item?id=1023
5
6
7  accelArrow =
8  #(define-music-function (line_angle) (number?)
9
10     (define x_value (cos (* (/ 3.14159265358979 180) (- 90 line_angle))))
11     (define y_value (sin (* (/ 3.14159265358979 180) (- 90 line_angle))))
12     #{
13       \tweak direction #up
14       \tweak style #'line
15       \tweak thickness #1
16       \tweak to-barline ##t
17       \tweak rotation #(list line_angle -1 0 )
18       \tweak bound-details.left.stencil #ly:text-interface::print
19       \tweak bound-details.left.text \markup \postscript
20       #(string-append
21         "gsave newpath
22 0 0 moveto "
23       (number->string x_value) " "
24       (number->string y_value)
25       " rlineto
26 stroke
27 grestore")
28       \tweak bound-details.left-broken.stencil #ly:text-interface::print
29       \tweak bound-details.left-broken.text ##f
30
31       \tweak bound-details.right.stencil #ly:text-interface::print
32       \tweak bound-details.right.text \markup \postscript
33       "newpath
34 0 0 moveto
35 -1 -0.3 rlineto
36 stroke"
37       \tweak bound-details.right-broken.stencil #ly:text-interface::print
38       \tweak bound-details.right-broken.text ##f
39       \tweak font-shape #'upright
40       \tweak bound-details.left.padding #0
41       \tweak bound-details.right.padding #0
42       \tweak breakable ##t
43       \tweak after-line-breaking ##t
44
45       \startTextSpan
46     #})
47
48  rallArrow =
49  #(define-music-function (line_angle) (number?)
50
51     (define x_value (cos (* (/ 3.14159265358979 180) (- 90 line_angle))))

```

```

52 (define y_value (sin (* (/ 3.14159265358979 180) (- 90 line_angle))))
53 #{
54   \tweak direction #up
55   \tweak style #'line
56   \tweak thickness #1
57   \tweak to-barline ##t
58   \tweak rotation #(list (* -1 line_angle) 1 0 )
59   \tweak bound-details.left.stencil #ly:text-interface::print
60   \tweak bound-details.left.text \markup \postscript
61   #(string-append
62     "gsave
63 newpath
64 0 0 moveto "
65     (number->string x_value) " "
66     (number->string (* -1 y_value))
67     " rlineto
68 stroke
69 grestore")
70   \tweak bound-details.left-broken.stencil #ly:text-interface::print
71   \tweak bound-details.left-broken.text ##f
72
73   \tweak bound-details.right.stencil #ly:text-interface::print
74   \tweak bound-details.right.text \markup \postscript
75   "newpath
76 0 0 moveto
77 -1 -0.3 rlineto
78 stroke"
79   \tweak bound-details.right-broken.stencil #ly:text-interface::print
80   \tweak bound-details.right-broken.text ##f
81   \tweak font-shape #'upright
82   \tweak bound-details.left.padding #0
83   \tweak bound-details.right.padding #0
84   \tweak breakable ##t
85   \tweak after-line-breaking ##t
86
87   \startTextSpan
88   #})
89
90 \score {
91   \layout {
92     indent = 0
93   }
94   {
95     c'2^\markup{\translate #'(-4 . 2) \box "A"}
96     ^\markup {\translate #'(0 . 1.5) \tiny \bold "accel."} \accelArrow #5   c'2
97     c'2 \after 2 \stopTextSpan c'2
98     c'2 ^\markup {\translate #'(0 . 1.5) \tiny \bold "rit."} \rallArrow #3   c'2
99     c'2 \after 2 \stopTextSpan c'2 \bar "||"

```

```

100   }
101   }
102
103   \score {
104     \layout {
105       indent = 0
106       line-width = 50
107     }
108     {
109       c'2^\markup{\translate #'(-4 . 2) \box "B"}
110       ^\markup {\translate #'(0 . 1.5) \tiny \bold "accel."} \accelArrow #5 c'2
111       c'2 c'2
112       c'2^\markup {\translate #'(0 . 1.5) \teeny \bold "(accel.)"} \after 2 \stopTextSpan c'2
113       c'2 ^\markup {\translate #'(0 . 1.5) \tiny \bold "rit."} \rallArrow #2 c'2 \break
114       c'2^\markup {\translate #'(0 . 1.5) \teeny \bold "(rit.)"} c'2
115       c'2 \after 2 \stopTextSpan c'2 \bar "||"
116     }
117   }
118
119   %^\markup{\translate #'(0 . 2) \bold "accel."}

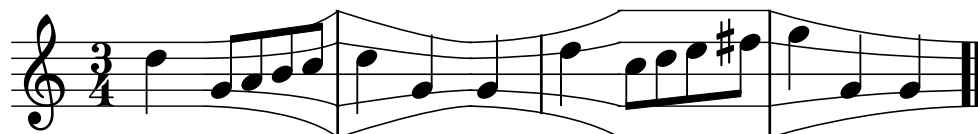
```

[Table of Contents](#)

Chapter 9

Staff Lines

9.1 Expanding, Shrinking and Bloated Staff Lines



9.1.1 Description

I made this code as a proof of concept after having read some excellent snippets on LSR.¹

9.1.2 Grammar

```
\expandingStaff #X-length  
\shrinkingStaff #X-length  
\bloatedStaff  
\normalStaff
```

9.1.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"  
2  
3 \language "english"  
4  
5 shrinkingStaff =  
6 #(define-music-function  
7   (staffDist)  
8   (number?)  
9  
10  #{
```

1. See: <https://lsr.di.unimi.it/LSR/Item?id=878>, <https://lsr.di.unimi.it/LSR/Item?id=1005>, and <https://lsr.di.unimi.it/LSR/Item?id=1007>.

```

11 \stopStaff
12 \once \override Staff.StaffSymbol.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
13 \once \override Staff.StaffSymbol.text = \markup {
14   \postscript #(string-append
15     "newpath
16     0 4 moveto
17     0 4 6 2 " (number->string staffDist) " 2 curveto
18     0 2 moveto
19     0 2 6 1 " (number->string staffDist) " 1 curveto
20     0 0 moveto "
21     (number->string staffDist) " 0 lineto
22     0 -2 moveto
23     0 -2 6 -1 " (number->string staffDist) " -1 curveto
24     0 -4 moveto
25     0 -4 6 -2 " (number->string staffDist) " -2 curveto
26     stroke")
27
28
29 }
30 \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions = #'(-4 -2 0 2 4 )
31 \startStaff
32 #})
33
34 normalStaff = {
35   \stopStaff
36   \revert Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions
37   \revert Staff.StaffSymbol.stencil
38   \startStaff
39 }
40
41 expandingStaff =
42 #(define-music-function
43   (staffDist)
44   (number?)
45
46   #{
47
48   \stopStaff
49   \once \override Staff.StaffSymbol.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
50   \once \override Staff.StaffSymbol.text = \markup {
51     \postscript #(string-append
52       "newpath
53       0 2 moveto
54       0 2 6 2 " (number->string staffDist) " 4 curveto
55       0 1 moveto
56       0 1 6 1 " (number->string staffDist) " 2 curveto
57       0 0 moveto "
58       (number->string staffDist) " 0 lineto

```



```

59         0 -1 moveto
60         0 -1 6 -1 " (number->string staffDist) " -2 curveto
61         0 -2 moveto
62         0 -2 6 -2 " (number->string staffDist) " -4 curveto
63         stroke ")
64     }
65
66     \startStaff
67     \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions = #'(-8 -4 0 4 8 )
68     #})
69
70     bloatedStaff = {
71         \stopStaff
72         \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions = #'(-8 -4 0 4 8 )
73         \override Staff.LedgerLineSpanner.stencil = ##f
74         \startStaff
75     }
76
77
78
79 % to adjust the length of the individual barlines, see:
80 % https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/internals/barline
81
82 {
83
84     \override Staff.LedgerLineSpanner.transparent = ##t
85     \numericTimeSignature
86     \time 3/4
87     \once \override Staff.BarLine.bar-extent = #'(-2 . 2)
88     d''4 \expandingStaff #8.5
89
90     g'8 a' b' c''
91     \once \override Staff.BarLine.bar-extent = #'(-4 . 4)
92     \shrinkingStaff #8.5
93     d''4 g' \expandingStaff #9.5 g'
94     \once \override Staff.BarLine.bar-extent = #'(-2.5 . 2.5)
95
96
97     e''4 \bloatedStaff c''8 d'' e'' fs''
98     \once \override Staff.BarLine.bar-extent = #'(-4 . 4)
99
100    \shrinkingStaff #13.5
101
102    g''4 g' g'
103    \bar "..."
104
105 }
106

```

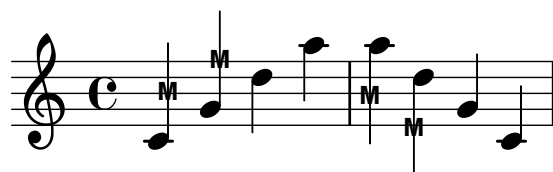
```
107 \layout {  
108   \context{  
109     \Score    proportionalNotationDuration = #1/6  
110   }  
111 }  
112
```

[Table of Contents](#)

Chapter 10

Stems

10.1 "M" on Stem



10.1.1 Description

This function attaches "M" to the stem. I have used this to indicate **M**ultiphonics on woodwind instruments in my pieces. This function lengthens the stem in order to give a balanced look, especially combined with stems/flags.

10.1.2 Grammar

```
\MOnStemOn NOTE ...  
\MOnStemOff
```

NB \MOnStemOn toggles the feature on, while \MOnStemOff toggles it off.

10.1.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"  
2  
3 MOnStemOn = {  
4   \override Stem.length = #12  
5   \override Stem.details.beamed-lengths = #'(5.5)  
6   \override Stem.stencil =  
7   #(lambda (grob)  
8     (let* ((x-parent (ly:grob-parent grob X))  
9            (is-rest? (ly:grob? (ly:grob-object x-parent 'rest))))  
10    (if is-rest?  
11        empty-stencil  
12        (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
```

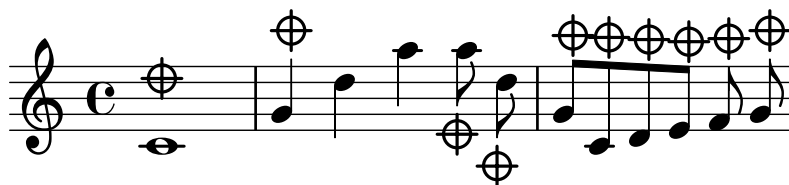
```

13      (ly:stem::print grob)
14      Y
15      (- (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
16      (grob-interpret-markup grob
17          (markup
18              #:center-align
19              #:teeny #:sans #:bold "M"))
20      -3.5))))
21  }
22
23  MOnStemOff = {
24      \revert Stem.length
25      \revert Stem.details.beamed-lengths
26      \revert Stem.stencil
27      \revert Flag.stencil
28  }
29
30  {
31      \MOnStemOn c'4 g' \MOnStemOff d'' a''
32      \MOnStemOn a'' d'' \MOnStemOff g' c'
33  }

```

[Table of Contents](#)

10.2 Mute Sign on Stem



10.2.1 Description

This function attaches a mute sign *above/below* the stem.

10.2.2 Grammar

`\muteSignOnStemOn NOTE ...`

`\muteSignOnStemOff`

NB `\muteSignOnStemOn` toggles the feature on, while `\muteSignOnStemOff` toggles it off.

10.2.3 Code

```

1
2 \version "2.26.0"
3
4 muteSignOnStemOn = {
5
6   % \override Stem.length =
7   % #(lambda (grob)
8   %       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction ))
9   %       %
10  %       7.5
11  %       7.5))
12
13
14   % \override Stem.details.beamed-lengths = #'(5.5)
15
16
17   \override Stem.stencil =
18   #(lambda (grob)
19     (let* ((x-parent (ly:grob-parent grob X))
20            (is-rest? (ly:grob-object x-parent 'rest))))
21     (if is-rest?
22         empty-stencil
23
24         (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
25
26             (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
27              (ly:stem::print grob)
28              Y

```

```

29      (+ (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
30      (grob-interpret-markup
31      grob
32      (markup
33
34          #:postscript
35          "newpath
36      0.2 setlinewidth
37      1 setlinecap
38      0 0 moveto
39      0 2.5 rlineto
40      -1.25 1.25 moveto
41      2.5 0 rlineto
42      stroke
43      newpath
44      0 1.25 0.85 0 360 arc
45      stroke"
46      ))
47      0.5)
48
49      (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
50      (ly:stem::print grob)
51      Y
52      (+ (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
53      (grob-interpret-markup
54      grob
55      (markup
56          #:rotate 180
57          #:postscript
58          "newpath
59      0.2 setlinewidth
60      1 setlinecap
61      0 0 moveto
62      0 2.5 rlineto
63      -1.25 1.25 moveto
64      2.5 0 rlineto
65      stroke
66      newpath
67      0 1.25 0.85 0 360 arc
68      stroke"
69      ))
70      0.5)
71      ))))
72  }
73
74  muteSignOnStemOff = {
75      \revert Stem.length
76      \revert Stem.details.beamed-lengths

```

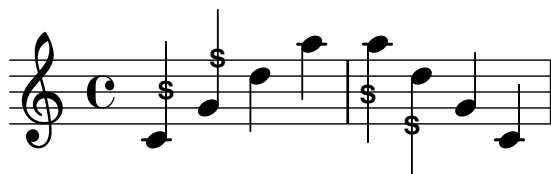
```

77  \revert Stem.stencil
78  \revert Flag.stencil
79  }
80
81  {
82  \muteSignOnStemOn c'1^\markup {\translate #'(0 . 3) \musicglyph "space"}
83
84  g'4 \muteSignOnStemOff d'' a''
85  \muteSignOnStemOn a''8 \noBeam d'' _\markup {\translate #'(0 . -3) \musicglyph "space" } g'
86  }
87

```

Table of Contents

10.3 "S" on Stem



10.3.1 Description

This function attaches "S" to the stem. I have used this to indicate Split tone on clarinet/bass clarinet in my pieces. This function lengthens the stem in order to give a balanced look, especially combined with stems/flags.

10.3.2 Grammar

`\SOnStemOn` NOTE ...
`\SOnStemOff`

NB `\SOnStemOn` toggles the feature on, while `\SOnStemOff` toggles it off.

10.3.3 Code

```

1  \version "2.26.0"
2
3  \pointAndClickOff
4
5  SOnStemOn = {
6    \override Stem.length = #12
7    \override Stem.details.beamed-lengths = #'(5.5)
8    \override Stem.stencil =
9    #(lambda (grob)
10      (let* ((x-parent (ly:grob-parent grob X))
11             (is-rest? (ly:grob? (ly:grob-object x-parent 'rest))))
12        (if is-rest?
13            empty-stencil
14            (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
15              (ly:stem::print grob)
16              Y
17              (- (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
18              (grob-interpret-markup grob
19                (markup
20                  #:center-align
21                  #:teeny #:sans #:bold "S"))
22              -3.5))))
23  }
24
25  SOnStemOff = {
26    \revert Stem.length
27    \revert Stem.details.beamed-lengths

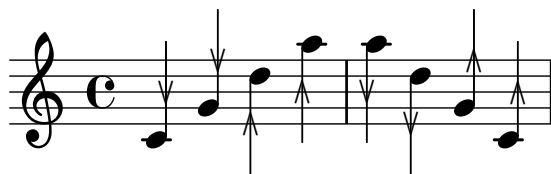
```



```
28  \revert Stem.stencil
29  \revert Flag.stencil
30  }
31
32  {
33  \SOnStemOn c'4 g' \SOnStemOff d'' a''
34  \SOnStemOn a'' d'' \SOnStemOff g' c'
35  }
```

[Table of Contents](#)

10.4 "V" on Stem



10.4.1 Description

This function attaches “V” to the stem. I have used this to designate a note with a differentiated timbre from others, for example “brassy tone” for bassoon in my *Gz III* (2019-21) for bass clarinet and bassoon. This function lengthens the stem in order to give a balanced look, especially combined with stems/flags.

I have also added a function where an inverted “V” is attached.

10.4.2 Grammar

```
\VOnStemOn NOTE ...
\VOnStemUpsideDownOn NOTE ...
\VOnStemOff
```

NB `\VOnStemOn` toggles the feature on, while `\VOnStemOff` toggles it off.

10.4.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 VOnStemOn = {
4   \override Stem.no-stem-extend = ##f
5   \override Stem.length = #12
6   \override Stem.details.beamed-lengths = #'(5.5)
7   \override Stem.stencil =
8   #(lambda (grob)
9     (let* ((x-parent (ly:grob-parent grob X))
10            (is-rest? (ly:grob? (ly:grob-object x-parent 'rest))))
11       (if is-rest?
12         empty-stencil
13         (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
14          (ly:stem::print grob)
15          Y
16          (- (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
17          (grob-interpret-markup grob
18            (markup
19              #:center-align
20              #:teeny #:sans
21              #:musicglyph "scripts.uupbow")))
22          -3.5))))
23 }
```

```

24
25 VOnStemUpsideDownOn = {
26   \override Stem.no-stem-extend = ##f
27   \override Stem.length = #12
28   \override Stem.details.beamed-lengths = #'(5.5)
29   \override Stem.stencil =
30   #(lambda (grob)
31     (let* ((x-parent (ly:grob-parent grob X))
32            (is-rest? (ly:grob? (ly:grob-object x-parent 'rest))))
33       (if is-rest?
34           empty-stencil
35           (ly:stencil-combine-at-edge
36             (ly:stem::print grob)
37             Y
38             (- (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
39             (grob-interpret-markup grob
40               (markup
41                 #:center-align
42                 #:teeny #:sans
43                 #:rotate 180
44                 #:musicglyph "scripts.uupbow")))
45             -3.5))))
46 }
47
48 VOnStemOff = {
49   \revert Stem.length
50   \revert Stem.stencil
51   \revert Flag.stencil
52 }
53
54
55 {
56   \VOnStemOn c'4 g' \VOnStemOff
57   \VOnStemUpsideDownOn d'' a'' \VOnStemOff
58   \VOnStemOn a'' d'' \VOnStemOff
59   \VOnStemUpsideDownOn g' c' \VOnStemOff
60 }
61

```

[Table of Contents](#)

Chapter 11

Time Signatures

New to 2.26.0: LilyPond's `\time` command accepts fractional time signatures, making the relevant codes discussed in the first nine entries of this chapter obsolete.¹ However, for the time being I will continue to keep the codes current, for they may offer good case studies of how custom Scheme codes interact with overriding stencil functions.

First nine entries of this chapter discuss fractional time signatures (variants of the irrational time signatures) and their compound forms. I have been inspired to create these implementations after chancing upon the email exchanges on `lilypond-user` dated from 2014.²

While Gould discourages the use of time signatures with numerators as fractions,³ there are cases where the use of such time signatures seems justified, particularly when the fractions deal with some form of tuplets. This is a form of time signature notation widely seen in works by Chaya Czernowin, Stefan Beyer, myself, and so many others.

I present the implementation of fractional time signatures in three different styles, A, B, and C. There are implementations for compound meters for each of the styles, in two and three time signatures.

1. <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.26/Documentation/changes/rhythm-improvements> and <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.26/Documentation/notation/displaying-rhythms#time-signature>

2. See: <https://lists.gnu.org/archive/html/lilypond-user/2014-06/msg00209.html>. However, in the process of writing this documentation I have come across another email thread on the same mailing list: <https://mail.gnu.org/archive/html/lilypond-user/2020-04/msg00423.html>

3. Gould, *Behind bars : the definitive guide to music notation*, 180.

11.1 Fractional Time Signatures, Style A



11.1.1 Description

This particular style of fractional time signatures⁴ can be seen in scores by Stefan Beyer, for example *Marsch* (2013-14),⁵ *Mittel und Zwecke (Boulevard)* (2014),⁶ *Bleib hier. Schau zu. Mach kein Geräusch.* (2017),⁷ and *Most of My Clients Come Back* (2012-13).⁸ In the case of *Mass und Gewicht* (2021), Beyer uses fractions on the denominator of the time signatures.⁹

Because the size the fractions is a half of the ordinary time signatures, it may be difficult to see from afar.¹⁰

11.1.2 Grammar

```
\fractionalTimeSignatureA
    #'(NUM1 NUM2 NUM3 NUM4) MEASURE_SPAN BEAT_STRUCT
\fractionalTimeSignatureA
    #'(NUM2 NUM3 NUM4) MEASURE_SPAN BEAT_STRUCT
\fractionalTimeSignatureAPlus
    #'(NUM1 NUM2 NUM3 NUM4) MEASURE_SPAN BEAT_STRUCT
\fractionalTimeSignatureAPlus
    #'(NUM2 NUM3 NUM4) MEASURE_SPAN BEAT_STRUCT

\backToNormalTimeSignature
```

4. After having come up with this code, there were other implementations that could be seen on this email thread: <https://mail.gnu.org/archive/html/lilypond-user/2020-04/msg00423.html>

5. Stefan Beyer, *Marsch* (Manuscript, 2013-14).

6. Stefan Beyer, *Mittel und Zwecke (Boulevard)* (Manuscript, 2014).

7. Stefan Beyer, *Bleib hier. Schau zu. Mach kein Geräusch.* (Manuscript, 2017).

8. Stefan Beyer, *Most of My Clients Come Back* (Manuscript, 2012-13).

9. It would be relatively easy to modify the Scheme code so that the fraction appears next to the denominator of the time signature, instead.

10. It should be noted that in other works such as Lotte Reiniger's *The Sleeping Beauty* (2020-21), Beyer also uses the irrational time signatures as seen in the [Incomplete Tuplet Bracket for Irrational Time Signatures](#) section of this document.

NB

1. `\fractionalTimeSignatureA` lists time signatures *without* the use of the + (plus) sign.
2. `\fractionalTimeSignatureAPlus` lists time signatures with the + (plus) sign, when the list with four NUMs are given.
3. NUM1, NUM2, NUM3, and NUM4 can be understood as follows:

$$\frac{1 + \frac{2}{3}}{4}$$

where NUM1 is optional. The code has `cond` clause, which adjusts the appearance of the time signature according to the length of the list, either having 3 or 4 numbers.

4. `MEASURE_SPAN` denotes how the measure may be written using an *irrational time signature*. In the example snippet, this would be:

$$\frac{3}{4} + \frac{2}{12} = \frac{11}{12}$$

5. `BEAT_STRUCT` indicates beat structure, by which the beaming of the measure abides.
6. When you wish to go back to a regular time signature, use `\backToNormalTimeSignature`, otherwise the identical fractional time signature will keep showing up.

11.1.3 Code

```

1 % Inspired by:
2 % https://lists.gnu.org/archive/html/lilypond-user/2014-06/msg00209.html
3
4 % Revised Aug 10 2025 to include the function to revert to a
5 % regular time signature
6
7 \version "2.26.0"
8
9 suppressWarning =
10 #(define-void-function (amount message)(number? string?)
11   (for-each
12     (lambda (warning)
13       (ly:expect-warning message))
14     (iota amount 1 1)))
15
16 \suppressWarning 3 "strange time signature found"
17
18 incompleteTupletBracket = {
19   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
20   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
21
22 }
23 incompleteSmallTupletBracket = {
```

```

24 \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
25 \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
26 \once \override Voice.TupletNumber.X-offset =
27   #(lambda (grob)
28     (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
29         2.2
30         1.2))
31
32 \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.shorten-pair =
33   #(lambda (grob)
34     (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
35         '(-0.7 . 0.15)
36         '(-0.3 . 0.8)))
37 \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.X-positions =
38   #(lambda (grob)
39     (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
40         '(1.8 . 3)
41         '(0.3 . 2.7)))
42 }
43
44 fractionalTimeSignatureA =
45 #(define-music-function
46   (timeSignatureToShow underlyingMeter beatStructure)
47   (list? fraction? number-list?)
48   #{
49     \time $underlyingMeter
50     \set beatStructure = $beatStructure
51
52     \override Staff.TimeSignature.stencil =
53       #ly:text-interface::print
54
55     \override Staff.TimeSignature.text =
56       #(if (= (length timeSignatureToShow) 4)
57
58         (markup
59           #:override
60           (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
61           (#:center-column
62             (#:number
63               (#:concat
64                 (#:simple
65                   (number->string (car timeSignatureToShow))
66                   #:halign -1.5
67                   (#:center-column
68                     ((#:translate
69                       (cons 0 1)
70                       (#:fontsize -6
71                         (number->string

```

```

72                                (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
73      (:translate
74      (cons 0 0)
75      (:fontsize -6
76      (number->string
77      (caddr timeSignatureToShow)))))))))
78      #:number
79      (number->string (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
80
81      (markup
82      #:override
83      (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
84      (:center-column
85      (:number
86      (:translate
87      (cons 0 1)
88      (:fontsize -6 (number->string
89      (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
90      #:number
91      (:translate
92      (cons 0 0)
93      (:fontsize -6 (number->string
94      (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
95      #:number
96      (number->string (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
97
98      )
99      #})
100
101      fractionalTimeSignatureAPlus =
102      #(define-music-function
103      (timeSignatureToShow underlyingMeter beatStructure)
104      (list? fraction? number-list?)
105      #{
106      \time $underlyingMeter
107      \set beatStructure = $beatStructure
108
109      \override Staff.TimeSignature.stencil =
110      #ly:text-interface::print
111
112      \override Staff.TimeSignature.text =
113      #(if (= (length timeSignatureToShow) 4)
114
115      (markup
116      #:override
117      (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
118      (:center-column
119      (:number

```



```

120      (:concat
121      (:simple
122      (number->string (car timeSignatureToShow))
123
124      (:fontsize -12 (string-append " "))
125      (string-append "+")
126      (:fontsize -12 (string-append " "))
127
128      #:center-column
129      ((#:translate
130      (cons 0 1)
131      (:fontsize -6
132      (number->string
133      (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
134      (:translate
135      (cons 0 0)
136      (:fontsize -6
137      (number->string
138      (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
139      #:number
140      (number->string (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))
141
142      (markup
143      #:override
144      (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
145      (:center-column
146      (:number
147      (:translate
148      (cons 0 1)
149      (:fontsize -6 (number->string
150      (car timeSignatureToShow))))
151      #:number
152      (:translate
153      (cons 0 0)
154      (:fontsize -6 (number->string
155      (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
156      #:number
157      (number->string (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))
158
159      )
160      #})
161
162
163      backToNormalTimeSignature =
164      {
165      \unset beatStructure
166      \revert Timing.TimeSignature.stencil
167      \revert Timing.TimeSignature.text

```

```

168 \revert Staff.TimeSignature.stencil
169 \revert Staff.TimeSignature.text
170 }
171
172
173 \new Staff \with { instrumentName = \markup {\fontsize #4 \box "A"}} {
174 \fractionalTimeSignatureA #'(3 2 3 4) 11/12 3,3,3,2
175 \tuplet 3/2 { c'8 c' c'} \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
176 \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
177 \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 3/2 {c' c'}
178 \backToNormalTimeSignature
179 \time 3/4
180 c'2.
181 }
182 \new Staff \with { instrumentName = \markup {\fontsize #4 \box "B"}} {
183 \fractionalTimeSignatureAPlus #'(3 2 3 4) 11/12 3,3,3,2
184 \tuplet 3/2 { c'8 c' c'} \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
185 \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
186 \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 3/2 {c' c'}
187 \backToNormalTimeSignature
188 \time 3/4
189 c'2.
190 }
191 \new Staff \with { instrumentName = \markup {\fontsize #4 \box "C"}} {
192 \fractionalTimeSignatureA #'(11 3 4) 11/12 3,3,3,2
193 \tuplet 3/2 { c'8 c' c'} \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
194 \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
195 \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 3/2 {c' c'}
196 \backToNormalTimeSignature
197 \time 3/4
198 c'2.
199 }
200

```

[Table of Contents](#)

11.2 Fractional Time Signatures, Style B



11.2.1 Description

Style B differs from Style A, as the fraction has a bigger font size. This is similar to the design of fractional time signatures I have used in works such as *Gz II* (2017-22).¹¹

11.2.2 Grammar

```
\fractionalTimeSignatureB
    #'(NUM1 NUM2 NUM3 NUM4) MEASURE_SPAN BEAT_STRUCT
\fractionalTimeSignatureB
    #'(NUM2 NUM3 NUM4) MEASURE_SPAN BEAT_STRUCT
\fractionalTimeSignatureBPlus
    #'(NUM1 NUM2 NUM3 NUM4) MEASURE_SPAN BEAT_STRUCT
\fractionalTimeSignatureBPlus
    #'(NUM2 NUM3 NUM4) MEASURE_SPAN BEAT_STRUCT

\backToNormalTimeSignature
```

NB

1. `\fractionalTimeSignatureB` lists time signatures *without* the use of the + (plus) sign.
2. `\fractionalTimeSignatureBPlus` lists time signatures with the + (plus) sign, when the list with four NUMs are given.
3. See [Grammar of Fractional Time Signatures, Style A](#) for the explanation on the arguments.
4. When you wish to go back to a regular time signature, use `\backToNormalTimeSignature`, otherwise the identical fractional time signature will keep showing up.

11. Yoshiaki Onishi, *Gz II : for two accordions* (Brühl and Berlin: Edition Gravis, 2024).

11.2.3 Code

```

1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 % Revised Jan 2 2025 for improving the appearance of fractions
4 % Revised Aug 10 2025 to include the function to revert to a
5 % regular time signature
6
7 suppressWarning =
8 #(define-void-function (amount message)(number? string?)
9   (for-each
10     (lambda (warning)
11       (ly:expect-warning message))
12     (iota amount 1 1)))
13
14 \suppressWarning 3 "strange time signature found"
15
16 incompleteTupletBracket = {
17   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
18   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
19
20 }
21 incompleteSmallTupletBracket = {
22   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
23   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
24   \once \override Voice.TupletNumber.X-offset =
25     #(lambda (grob)
26       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
27         2.2
28         1.2))
29
30   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.shorten-pair =
31     #(lambda (grob)
32       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
33         '(-0.7 . 0.15)
34         '(-0.3 . 0.8)))
35   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.X-positions =
36     #(lambda (grob)
37       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
38         '(1.8 . 3)
39         '(0.3 . 2.7)))
40 }
41
42 fractionalTimeSignatureB =
43 #(define-music-function
44   (timeSignatureToShow underlyingMeter beatStructure)
45   (list? fraction? number-list?)
46   #{

```

```

47
48 \time $underlyingMeter
49 \set beatStructure = $beatStructure
50
51 \override Staff.TimeSignature.stencil =
52 #ly:text-interface::print
53 \override Staff.TimeSignature.text =
54
55 #(if (= (length timeSignatureToShow) 4)
56
57     (markup
58       (make-override-markup
59         (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
60         (make-center-column-markup
61           (list
62             (make-line-markup
63               (list
64                 (make-number-markup
65                   (number->string (car timeSignatureToShow)))
66
67
68                 (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
69                 (make-right-align-markup
70                   (make-number-markup
71                     (make-translate-markup
72                       (cons 0 1.5)
73                       (make-fontsize-markup
74                         -3
75                         (number->string (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
76
77                 (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
78
79                 (make-override-markup
80                   (cons 'alignment 0)
81                   (make-translate-markup
82                     (cons 0 0.8)
83                     (make-draw-line-markup (cons 1.5 1.35))))))
84
85                 (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
86
87                 (make-number-markup
88                   (make-left-align-markup
89                     (make-fontsize-markup
90                       -3
91                       (number->string (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
92
93                 (make-number-markup
94                   (number->string (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))

```

```

95
96
97      (markup
98        (make-override-markup
99          (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
100          (make-center-column-markup
101            (list
102              (make-line-markup
103                (list
104                  (make-number-markup
105                    (make-right-align-markup
106                      (make-translate-markup
107                        (cons 0 1.5)
108                        (make-fontsize-markup
109                          -3
110                          (number->string (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
111
112              (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
113
114              (make-override-markup
115                (cons 'alignment 0)
116                (make-translate-markup
117                  (cons 0 0.8)
118                  (make-draw-line-markup (cons 1.5 1.35))))
119
120              (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
121
122              (make-translate-markup
123                (cons 0 0)
124                (make-fontsize-markup
125                  -3
126                  (make-number-markup
127                    (number->string (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
128
129              (make-number-markup
130                (number->string (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
131
132      )
133    #})
134
135    fractionalTimeSignatureBPlus =
136    #(define-music-function
137      (timeSignatureToShow underlyingMeter beatStructure)
138      (list? fraction? number-list?)
139      #{
140
141        \time $underlyingMeter
142        \set beatStructure = $beatStructure

```

```

143
144 \override Staff.TimeSignature.stencil =
145 #ly:text-interface::print
146 \override Staff.TimeSignature.text =
147
148 #(if (= (length timeSignatureToShow) 4)
149
150
151 (markup
152   (make-override-markup
153     (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
154     (make-center-column-markup
155       (list
156         (make-line-markup
157           (list
158             (make-number-markup
159               (number->string (car timeSignatureToShow)))
160             (make-fontsize-markup
161               -12
162               (make-simple-markup " ")))
163
164
165             (make-hspace-markup -1.25)
166             (make-translate-markup
167               (cons 0 0.4)
168               (make-bold-markup
169                 (make-simple-markup "+")))
170
171             (make-hspace-markup -0.25)
172
173             (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
174             (make-right-align-markup
175               (make-number-markup
176                 (make-translate-markup
177                   (cons 0 1.5)
178                   (make-fontsize-markup
179                     -3
180                     (number->string (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
181
182
183
184             (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
185
186             (make-override-markup
187               (cons 'alignment 0)
188               (make-translate-markup
189                 (cons 0 0.8)

```

```

191         (make-draw-line-markup (cons 1.5 1.35))))
192
193     (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
194
195     (make-number-markup
196       (make-left-align-markup
197         (make-fontsize-markup
198           -3
199           (number->string (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
200
201     (make-number-markup
202       (number->string (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))
203
204
205 (markup
206   (make-override-markup
207     (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
208     (make-center-column-markup
209       (list
210         (make-line-markup
211           (list
212             (make-number-markup
213               (make-right-align-markup
214                 (make-translate-markup
215                   (cons 0 1.6)
216                   (make-fontsize-markup
217                     -3
218                     (number->string (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
219
220             (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
221
222             (make-override-markup
223               (cons 'alignment 0)
224               (make-translate-markup
225                 (cons 0 0.8)
226                 (make-draw-line-markup (cons 1.5 1.35))))
227
228             (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
229
230             (make-translate-markup
231               (cons 0 0)
232               (make-fontsize-markup
233                 -3
234                 (make-number-markup
235                   (number->string (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
236
237             (make-number-markup
238               (number->string (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))

```

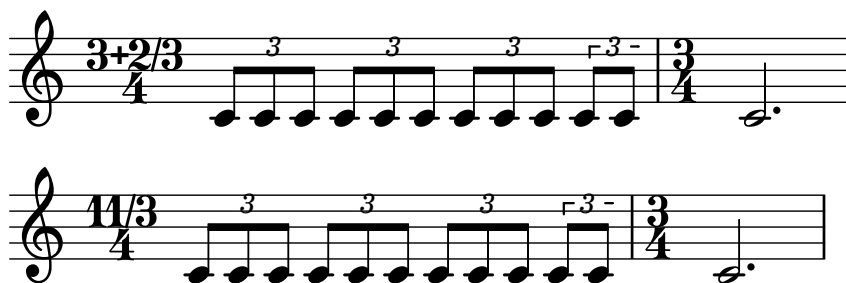


```

239         )
240     #})
241
242     backToNormalTimeSignature =
243     {
244         \unset beatStructure
245         \revert Timing.TimeSignature.stencil
246         \revert Timing.TimeSignature.text
247         \revert Staff.TimeSignature.stencil
248         \revert Staff.TimeSignature.text
249     }
250
251
252     {
253         \fractionalTimeSignatureB #'(1 2 3 4) 11/12 3,3,3,2
254         \tuplet 3/2 {c'8 c' c'} \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
255         \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
256         \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 3/2 {c' c'}
257         \backToNormalTimeSignature
258         \time 3/4
259         c'2.
260     }
261
262     {
263         \fractionalTimeSignatureBPlus #'(3 2 3 4) 11/12 3,3,3,2
264         \tuplet 3/2 {c'8 c' c'} \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
265         \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
266         \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 3/2 {c' c'}
267         \backToNormalTimeSignature
268         \time 3/4
269         c'2.
270     }
271
272     {
273         \fractionalTimeSignatureB #'(11 3 4) 11/12 3,3,3,2
274         \tuplet 3/2 {c'8 c' c'} \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
275         \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
276         \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 3/2 {c' c'}
277         \backToNormalTimeSignature
278         \time 3/4
279         c'2.
280     }
281

```

11.3 Fractional Time Signatures, Style C



11.3.1 Description

Style C of the fractional time signatures offers the largest font size for displaying the fractions. This design is commonly seen in scores by Chaya Czernowin, in such works as *String Quartet* (1995),¹² *Lovesong* (2010),¹³ *Streams (Slow Summer Stay I)* (2012),¹⁴ and *At the fringe of our gaze* (2012/13).¹⁵

11.3.2 Grammar

```
\fractionalTimeSignatureC
    #'(NUM1 NUM2 NUM3 NUM4) MEASURE_SPAN BEAT_STRUCT
\fractionalTimeSignatureC
    #'(NUM2 NUM3 NUM4) MEASURE_SPAN BEAT_STRUCT

\backToNormalTimeSignature
```

NB

1. By default, `\fractionalTimeSignatureC` shows + (plus) sign when four NUMs are given. As the font size for the ordinary numerator and the fractions is the same, without + it becomes very confusing to read the time signature. Thus, contrary to Styles A and B, there is no separate function for the time signature with the + sign given.
2. See [Grammar of Fractional Time Signatures, Style A](#) for the explanation on the arguments.
3. When you wish to go back to a regular time signature, use `\backToNormalTimeSignature`, otherwise the identical fractional time signature will keep showing up.

11.3.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 % Revised Jan 2 2025 for improving the appearance of fractions
4 % Revised Aug 10 2025 to include the function to revert to a
```

12. Chaya Czernowin, *String Quartet* (Schott, 1995).

13. Chaya Czernowin, *Lovesong : for mixed ensemble* (Schott, 2010).

14. Chaya Czernowin, *Streams (Slow Summer Stay I) : for 8 players* (Schott, 2012).

15. Chaya Czernowin, *At the fringe of our gaze : for Orchestra and Concertino Group* (Schott, 2012/13).

```

5 % regular time signature
6
7 suppressWarning =
8 #(define-void-function (amount message)(number? string?)
9   (for-each
10    (lambda (warning)
11      (ly:expect-warning message))
12    (iota amount 1 1)))
13
14 \suppressWarning 2 "strange time signature found"
15
16 incompleteTupletBracket = {
17   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
18   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
19
20 }
21 incompleteSmallTupletBracket = {
22   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
23   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
24   \once \override Voice.TupletNumber.X-offset =
25     #(lambda (grob)
26       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
27           2.2
28           1.2))
29
30   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.shorten-pair =
31     #(lambda (grob)
32       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
33           '(-0.7 . 0.15)
34           '(-0.3 . 0.8)))
35   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.X-positions =
36     #(lambda (grob)
37       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
38           '(1.8 . 3)
39           '(0.3 . 2.7)))
40 }
41
42 fractionalTimeSignatureC =
43 #(define-music-function
44   (timeSignatureToShow underlyingMeter beatStructure)
45   (list? fraction? number-list?)
46   #{
47
48     \time $underlyingMeter
49     \set beatStructure = $beatStructure
50
51     \override Staff.TimeSignature.stencil =
52     #ly:text-interface::print

```

```

53  \override Staff.TimeSignature.text =
54
55  #(if (= (length timeSignatureToShow) 4)
56
57      (markup
58        (make-override-markup
59          (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
60          (make-center-column-markup
61            (list
62              (make-line-markup
63                (list
64                  (make-number-markup
65                    (number->string
66                      (car timeSignatureToShow)))
67                  (make-fontsize-markup
68                    -12
69                    (make-simple-markup " ")))
70
71              (make-hspace-markup -1.25)
72              (make-translate-markup
73                (cons 0 0.4)
74                (make-bold-markup
75                  (make-simple-markup "+"))))
76
77              (make-hspace-markup -0.25)
78
79              (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
80              (make-right-align-markup
81                (make-number-markup
82                  (number->string
83                    (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
84
85              (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
86
87              (make-override-markup
88                (list (cons 'alignment 0)
89                      (cons 'thickness 2))
90                (make-draw-line-markup (cons 0.5 2)))
91
92              (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
93
94              (make-number-markup
95                (make-left-align-markup
96                  (number->string
97                    (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
98
99      (make-number-markup
100

```

```

101         (number->string
102         (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
103
104
105     (markup
106     (make-override-markup
107     (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
108     (make-center-column-markup
109     (list
110     (make-line-markup
111     (list
112
113         (make-right-align-markup
114         (make-number-markup
115         (number->string
116         (car timeSignatureToShow))))
117
118         (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
119
120         (make-override-markup
121         (list (cons 'alignment 0)
122              (cons 'thickness 2))
123         (make-draw-line-markup
124         (cons 0.5 2)))
125
126         (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
127
128         (make-number-markup
129         (make-left-align-markup
130         (number->string
131         (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
132
133         (make-number-markup
134         (number->string
135         (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
136     ))
137     #})
138
139 backToNormalTimeSignature =
140 {
141   \unset beatStructure
142   \revert Timing.TimeSignature.stencil
143   \revert Timing.TimeSignature.text
144   \revert Staff.TimeSignature.stencil
145   \revert Staff.TimeSignature.text
146 }
147
148

```

```

149 {
150   \fractionalTimeSignatureC #'(3 2 3 4) 11/12 3,3,3,2
151   \tuplet 3/2 { c'8 c' c'} \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
152   \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
153   \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 3/2 {c' c'}
154
155   \backToNormalTimeSignature
156   \time 3/4
157   c'2.
158 }
159
160
161 {
162   \fractionalTimeSignatureC #'(11 3 4) 11/12 3,3,3,2
163   \tuplet 3/2 { c'8 c' c'} \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
164   \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
165   \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 3/2 {c' c'}
166   \backToNormalTimeSignature
167   \time 3/4
168   c'2.
169 }
170

```

[Table of Contents](#)


```

12
13 \suppressWarning 1 "strange time signature found"
14
15 incompleteTupletBracket = {
16   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
17   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
18
19 }
20 incompleteSmallTupletBracket = {
21   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
22   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
23   \once \override Voice.TupletNumber.X-offset =
24     #(lambda (grob)
25       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
26           2.2
27           1.2))
28
29   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.shorten-pair =
30     #(lambda (grob)
31       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
32           '(-0.7 . 0.15)
33           '(-0.3 . 0.8)))
34   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.X-positions =
35     #(lambda (grob)
36       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
37           '(1.8 . 3)
38           '(0.3 . 2.7)))
39 }
40
41 compoundFractionalTimeSignatureATwo =
42 #(define-music-function
43   (timeSignatureToShow underlyingMeter beatStructure)
44   (list? fraction? number-list?)
45   (define mkup
46     (markup
47       #:concat
48       (
49         #:override
50         (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
51         (cond ((= (length (car timeSignatureToShow)) 2)
52               (make-center-column-markup
53                 (list (make-number-markup
54                       (number->string
55                        (car (car timeSignatureToShow))))
56                       (make-number-markup
57                        (number->string
58                         (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))))
59

```



```

60      ((= (length (car timeSignatureToShow)) 3)
61      (make-override-markup
62      (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
63      (make-center-column-markup
64      (list
65
66
67      (make-center-column-markup
68      (list
69      (make-translate-markup
70      (cons 0 1)
71      (make-fontsize-markup
72      -6
73      (make-number-markup
74      (number->string
75      (car (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
76      (make-translate-markup
77      (cons 0 0)
78      (make-fontsize-markup
79      -6
80      (make-number-markup
81      (number->string
82      (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
83      (make-number-markup
84      (number->string
85      (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
86      ))
87
88
89      ((= (length (car timeSignatureToShow)) 4)
90
91      (make-override-markup
92      (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
93      (make-center-column-markup
94      (list
95
96      (make-concat-markup
97      (list (make-number-markup
98      (number->string
99      (car (car timeSignatureToShow))))
100      (make-halign-markup
101      -1.5
102      (make-center-column-markup
103      (list
104      (make-translate-markup
105      (cons 0 1)
106      (make-fontsize-markup
107      -6

```

```

108             (make-number-markup
109               (number->string
110                 (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
111       (make-translate-markup
112         (cons 0 0)
113         (make-fontsize-markup
114           -6
115           (make-number-markup
116             (number->string
117               (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow)))))))))
118     (make-number-markup
119       (number->string
120         (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
121   ))
122 )
123
124
125 #:translate
126 (cons 0 -0.5)
127 (#:fontsize -12 " ")
128 #:translate
129 (cons 0 -0.5)
130 (#:bold "+")
131 #:translate
132 (cons 0 -0.5)
133 (#:fontsize -12 " ")
134
135 #:override
136 (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
137 (cond ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 2)
138        (make-center-column-markup
139          (list (make-number-markup
140                  (number->string
141                    (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
142                (make-number-markup
143                  (number->string
144                    (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow)))))))
145        ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 3)
146          (make-override-markup
147            (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
148            (make-center-column-markup
149              (list
150                (make-center-column-markup
151                  (list

```

```

156         (make-translate-markup
157         (cons 0 1)
158         (make-fontsize-markup
159         -6
160         (make-number-markup
161         (number->string
162         (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
163         (make-translate-markup
164         (cons 0 0)
165         (make-fontsize-markup
166         -6
167         (make-number-markup
168         (number->string
169         (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
170         (make-number-markup
171         (number->string
172         (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
173     ))
174
175
176     ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 4)
177
178     (make-override-markup
179     (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
180     (make-center-column-markup
181     (list
182
183     (make-concat-markup
184     (list (make-number-markup
185     (number->string
186     (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
187     (make-halign-markup
188     -1.5
189     (make-center-column-markup
190     (list
191     (make-translate-markup
192     (cons 0 1)
193     (make-fontsize-markup
194     -6
195     (make-number-markup
196     (number->string
197     (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
198     (make-translate-markup
199     (cons 0 0)
200     (make-fontsize-markup
201     -6
202     (make-number-markup
203     (number->string

```

```

204             (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))))))
205         (make-number-markup
206           (number->string
207             (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
208       ))
209     )
210   )))
211
212   #{
213     \time $underlyingMeter
214     \set beatStructure = $beatStructure
215
216     \override Timing.TimeSignature.stencil =
217     #ly:text-interface::print
218     \override Timing.TimeSignature.text =
219     #mkup
220     #})
221
222
223   backToNormalTimeSignature =
224   {
225     \unset beatStructure
226     \revert Timing.TimeSignature.stencil
227     \revert Timing.TimeSignature.text
228     \revert Staff.TimeSignature.stencil
229     \revert Staff.TimeSignature.text
230   }
231
232
233   {
234     \compoundFractionalTimeSignatureATwo #'((3 4)(2 3 4)) 11/12 3,3,3,2
235     \tuplet 3/2 { c'8 c' c'} \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
236     \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
237     \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 3/2 {c' c'}
238     \backToNormalTimeSignature
239     \time 3/4
240     c'2.
241   }
242

```

11.4.4 Discussion

1. This was a tricky one to make, as I had to resort to building the Scheme code without using the syntactic sugars, i.e. `#:`.¹⁶ If any modification are to be made to this code, it is recommended to carefully examine where the corresponding parenthesis of a starting parenthesis is located. It is also helpful to watch LilyPond Log for any errors, as it seems to give hints for how many

16. See *Known issues and warnings* at: <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/extending/markup-construction-in-scheme>

argument(s) a function is looking for.

2. I am hoping to find ways to simplify the code, as the same bits (with variations in variables that are called upon) of the codes are used to streamline the formatting of the time signature appearances.
3. When you wish to go back to a regular time signature, use `\backToNormalTimeSignature`, otherwise the identical fractional time signature will keep showing up.

[Table of Contents](#)

11.5 Compound Meter with Two Fractional Time Signatures, Style B



11.5.1 Description

This is an implementation of a compound meter with two fractional time signatures with Style B.

11.5.2 Grammar

```
\compoundFractionalTimeSignatureBTwo
    #'((TIME_SIG1)(TIME_SIG2)) MEASURE_SPAN BEAT_STRUCT

\backToNormalTimeSignature
```

NB

1. Following the convention of `\compoundMeter` to enter the two time signatures, you will create a list of lists. Each `TIME_SIG` accepts: an ordinary time signature (list with two numbers), a time signature with a fraction (list with three numbers), or a time signature with an ordinary numerator and a fraction. See [Grammar of Fractional Time Signatures, Style A](#) for the explanation on the arguments for the order of arguments to specify time signatures.
2. `MEASURE_SPAN` and `BEAT_STRUCT` follow the same convention as before.
3. When you wish to go back to a regular time signature, use `\backToNormalTimeSignature`, otherwise the identical fractional time signature will keep showing up.

11.5.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 % Revised Jan 2 2025 for improving the appearance of fractions
4 % Revised Aug 10 2025 to include the function to revert to a
5 % regular time signature
6
7 suppressWarning =
8 #(define-void-function (amount message)(number? string?)
9   (for-each
10    (lambda (warning)
11      (ly:expect-warning message))
12    (iota amount 1 1)))
13
14 \suppressWarning 1 "strange time signature found"
15
```

```

16 incompleteTupletBracket = {
17   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
18   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
19
20 }
21 incompleteSmallTupletBracket = {
22   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
23   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
24   \once \override Voice.TupletNumber.X-offset =
25     #(lambda (grob)
26       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
27           2.2
28           1.2))
29
30   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.shorten-pair =
31     #(lambda (grob)
32       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
33           '(-0.7 . 0.15)
34           '(-0.3 . 0.8)))
35   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.X-positions =
36     #(lambda (grob)
37       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
38           '(1.8 . 3)
39           '(0.3 . 2.7)))
40 }
41
42 compoundFractionalTimeSignatureBTwo =
43 # (define-music-function
44   (timeSignatureToShow underlyingMeter beatStructure)
45   (list? fraction? number-list?)
46   (define mkup
47     (markup
48       #:concat
49       (
50
51         #:override
52         (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
53         (cond ((= (length (car timeSignatureToShow)) 2)
54               (make-center-column-markup
55                 (list (make-number-markup
56                       (number->string
57                        (car (car timeSignatureToShow))))
58                       (make-number-markup
59                        (number->string
60                         (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow)))))))
61
62         ((= (length (car timeSignatureToShow)) 3)
63           (make-override-markup

```

```

64      (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
65      (make-center-column-markup
66      (list
67      (make-line-markup
68      (list
69      (make-number-markup
70      (make-right-align-markup
71      (make-translate-markup
72      (cons 0 1.6)
73      (make-fontsize-markup
74      -3
75      (number->string
76      (car (car timeSignatureToShow)))))))
77
78      (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
79
80      (make-override-markup
81      (cons 'alignment 0)
82      (make-translate-markup
83      (cons 0 0.8)
84      (make-draw-line-markup (cons 1.5 1.35))))
85
86      (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
87
88      (make-translate-markup
89      (cons 0 0)
90      (make-fontsize-markup
91      -3
92      (make-number-markup
93      (number->string
94      (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow)))))))
95
96      (make-number-markup
97      (number->string
98      (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
99
100
101      ((= (length (car timeSignatureToShow)) 4)
102
103      (make-override-markup
104      (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
105      (make-center-column-markup
106      (list
107      (make-line-markup
108      (list
109      (make-number-markup
110      (number->string
111      (car (car timeSignatureToShow))))

```



```

112         (make-fontsize-markup
113         -12
114         (make-simple-markup " "))
115
116         (make-hspace-markup -1.25)
117         (make-translate-markup
118         (cons 0 0.4)
119         (make-bold-markup
120         (make-simple-markup "+"))))
121
122         (make-hspace-markup -0.25)
123
124         (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
125         (make-right-align-markup
126         (make-number-markup
127         (make-translate-markup
128         (cons 0 1.5)
129         (make-fontsize-markup
130         -3
131         (number->string
132         (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))))))
133
134         (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
135
136         (make-override-markup
137         (cons 'alignment 0)
138         (make-translate-markup
139         (cons 0 0.8)
140         (make-draw-line-markup
141         (cons 1.5 1.35))))))
142
143         (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
144
145         (make-number-markup
146         (make-left-align-markup
147         (make-fontsize-markup
148         -3
149         (number->string
150         (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))))))
151
152         (make-number-markup
153         (number->string
154         (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))))))
155
156
157 #:translate
158 (cons 0 -0.5)
159 (#:fontsize -12 " ")

```

```

160 #:translate
161 (cons 0 -0.5)
162 (bold "+")
163 #:translate
164 (cons 0 -0.5)
165 (font-size -12 " ")
166
167 #:override
168 (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
169
170 (cond ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 2)
171        (make-center-column-markup
172          (list (make-number-markup
173                 (number->string
174                  (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
175                (make-number-markup
176                  (number->string
177                   (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow)))))))
178
179        ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 3)
180          (make-override-markup
181            (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
182            (make-center-column-markup
183              (list
184                (make-line-markup
185                  (list
186                    (make-number-markup
187                      (make-right-align-markup
188                        (make-translate-markup
189                          (cons 0 1.6)
190                          (make-fontsize-markup
191                            -3
192                            (number->string
193                             (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow)))))))
194
195                    (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
196
197                    (make-override-markup
198                      (cons 'alignment 0)
199                      (make-translate-markup
200                        (cons 0 0.8)
201                        (make-draw-line-markup (cons 1.5 1.35))))))
202
203                    (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
204
205                    (make-translate-markup
206                      (cons 0 0)
207                      (make-fontsize-markup

```

```

208         -3
209         (make-number-markup
210         (number->string
211         (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow)))))))))
212
213     (make-number-markup
214     (number->string
215     (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow)))))))))
216
217
218     ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 4)
219
220     (make-override-markup
221     (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
222     (make-center-column-markup
223     (list
224     (make-line-markup
225     (list
226     (make-number-markup
227     (number->string
228     (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
229     (make-fontsize-markup
230     -12
231     (make-simple-markup " ")))
232
233     (make-hspace-markup -1.25)
234     (make-translate-markup
235     (cons 0 0.4)
236     (make-bold-markup
237     (make-simple-markup "+"))))
238
239     (make-hspace-markup -0.25)
240
241     (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
242     (make-right-align-markup
243     (make-number-markup
244     (make-translate-markup
245     (cons 0 1.5)
246     (make-fontsize-markup
247     -3
248     (number->string
249     (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow)))))))))
250
251     (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
252
253     (make-override-markup
254     (cons 'alignment 0)
255     (make-translate-markup

```

```

256             (cons 0 0.8)
257             (make-draw-line-markup
258               (cons 1.5 1.35))))
259
260             (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
261
262             (make-number-markup
263               (make-left-align-markup
264                 (make-fontsize-markup
265                   -3
266                   (number->string
267                     (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow)))))))
268
269             (make-number-markup
270               (number->string
271                 (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
272     )))
273
274     #{
275       \time $underlyingMeter
276       \set beatStructure = $beatStructure
277
278       \override Timing.TimeSignature.stencil =
279       #ly:text-interface::print
280       \override Timing.TimeSignature.text =
281       #mkup
282       #})
283
284
285     backToNormalTimeSignature =
286     {
287       \unset beatStructure
288       \revert Timing.TimeSignature.stencil
289       \revert Timing.TimeSignature.text
290       \revert Staff.TimeSignature.stencil
291       \revert Staff.TimeSignature.text
292     }
293
294
295     {
296       \compoundFractionalTimeSignatureBTwo #'((3 4)(2 3 4)) 11/12 3,3,3,2
297       \tuplet 3/2 { c'8 c' c'} \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
298       \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
299       \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 3/2 {c' c'}
300       \backToNormalTimeSignature
301       \time 3/4
302       c'2.
303     }

```

304

11.5.4 Discussion

See [Discussion](#) of the entry *Compound Meter with Two Fractional Time Signatures, Style A*.

[Table of Contents](#)

11.6 Compound Meter with Two Fractional Time Signatures, Style C



11.6.1 Description

This is an implementation of a compound meter with two fractional time signatures with Style C.

11.6.2 Grammar

```
\compoundFractionalTimeSignatureCTwo
    #'((TIME_SIG1)(TIME_SIG2)) MEASURE_SPAN BEAT_STRUCT

\backToNormalTimeSignature
```

NB

1. Following the convention of `\compoundMeter` to enter the two time signatures, you will create a list of lists. Each `TIME_SIG` accepts: an ordinary time signature (list with two numbers), a time signature with a fraction (list with three numbers), or a time signature with an ordinary numerator and a fraction. See [Grammar of Fractional Time Signatures, Style A](#) for the explanation on the arguments for the order of arguments to specify time signatures.
2. `MEASURE_SPAN` and `BEAT_STRUCT` follow the same convention as before.
3. When you wish to go back to a regular time signature, use `\backToNormalTimeSignature`, otherwise the identical fractional time signature will keep showing up.

11.6.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3
4 % Revised Jan 2 2025 for improving the appearance of fractions
5 % Revised Aug 10 2025 to include the function to revert to a
6 % regular time signature
7
8 suppressWarning =
9 #(define-void-function (amount message)(number? string?)
10   (for-each
11     (lambda (warning)
12       (ly:expect-warning message))
13     (iota amount 1 1)))
14
15 \suppressWarning 1 "strange time signature found"
```

```

16
17 incompleteTupletBracket = {
18   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
19   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
20
21 }
22 incompleteSmallTupletBracket = {
23   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
24   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
25   \once \override Voice.TupletNumber.X-offset =
26     #(lambda (grob)
27       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
28           2.2
29           1.2))
30
31   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.shorten-pair =
32     #(lambda (grob)
33       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
34           '(-0.7 . 0.15)
35           '(-0.3 . 0.8)))
36   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.X-positions =
37     #(lambda (grob)
38       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
39           '(1.8 . 3)
40           '(0.3 . 2.7)))
41 }
42
43 compoundFractionalTimeSignatureCTwo =
44 #(define-music-function
45   (timeSignatureToShow underlyingMeter beatStructure)
46   (list? fraction? number-list?)
47   (define mkup
48     (markup
49       #:concat
50       (
51
52         #:override
53         (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
54         (cond ((= (length (car timeSignatureToShow)) 2)
55               (make-center-column-markup
56                 (list (make-number-markup
57                       (number->string
58                        (car (car timeSignatureToShow))))
59                       (make-number-markup
60                        (number->string
61                         (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow)))))))
62               ((= (length (car timeSignatureToShow)) 3)
63

```

```

64      (make-override-markup
65      (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
66      (make-center-column-markup
67      (list
68      (make-line-markup
69      (list
70
71      (make-right-align-markup
72      (make-number-markup
73      (number->string
74      (car (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
75
76      (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
77
78      (make-override-markup
79      (list (cons 'alignment 0)
80            (cons 'thickness 2))
81      (make-draw-line-markup
82      (cons 0.5 2)))
83
84      (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
85
86      (make-number-markup
87      (make-left-align-markup
88      (number->string
89      (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
90
91      (make-number-markup
92      (number->string
93      (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
94
95
96      ((= (length (car timeSignatureToShow)) 4)
97
98      (make-override-markup
99      (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
100      (make-center-column-markup
101      (list
102      (make-line-markup
103      (list
104      (make-number-markup
105      (number->string
106      (car (car timeSignatureToShow))))
107      (make-fontsize-markup
108      -12
109      (make-simple-markup " ")))
110
111

```



```

112         (make-hspace-markup -1.25)
113         (make-translate-markup
114         (cons 0 0.4)
115         (make-bold-markup
116         (make-simple-markup "+"))))
117
118         (make-hspace-markup -0.25)
119
120         (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
121         (make-right-align-markup
122         (make-number-markup
123         (number->string
124         (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
125
126         (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
127
128         (make-override-markup
129         (list (cons 'alignment 0)
130         (cons 'thickness 2))
131         (make-draw-line-markup (cons 0.5 2)))
132
133         (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
134
135         (make-number-markup
136         (make-left-align-markup
137         (number->string
138         (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
139
140         (make-number-markup
141         (number->string
142         (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
143
144
145 #:translate
146 (cons 0 -0.5)
147 (#:fontsize -12 " ")
148 #:translate
149 (cons 0 -0.5)
150 (#:bold "+")
151 #:translate
152 (cons 0 -0.5)
153 (#:fontsize -12 " ")
154
155 #:override
156 (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
157
158 (cond ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 2)
159        (make-center-column-markup

```

```

160         (list (make-number-markup
161                (number->string
162                  (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
163              (make-number-markup
164                (number->string
165                  (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
166
167      ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 3)
168       (make-override-markup
169         (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
170         (make-center-column-markup
171           (list
172             (make-line-markup
173               (list
174
175                 (make-right-align-markup
176                   (make-number-markup
177                     (number->string
178                       (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
179
180                 (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
181
182                 (make-override-markup
183                   (list (cons 'alignment 0)
184                         (cons 'thickness 2))
185                   (make-draw-line-markup
186                     (cons 0.5 2)))
187
188                 (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
189
190                 (make-number-markup
191                   (make-left-align-markup
192                     (number->string
193                       (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
194
195                 (make-number-markup
196                   (number->string
197                     (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
198
199      ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 4)
200       (make-override-markup
201         (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
202         (make-center-column-markup
203           (list
204             (make-line-markup
205               (list

```

```

208         (make-number-markup
209           (number->string
210             (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
211         (make-fontsize-markup
212           -12
213           (make-simple-markup " "))
214
215
216         (make-hspace-markup -1.25)
217         (make-translate-markup
218           (cons 0 0.4)
219           (make-bold-markup
220             (make-simple-markup "+")))
221
222         (make-hspace-markup -0.25)
223
224         (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
225         (make-right-align-markup
226           (make-number-markup
227             (number->string
228               (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow)))))
229
230         (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
231
232         (make-override-markup
233           (list (cons 'alignment 0)
234                 (cons 'thickness 2))
235           (make-draw-line-markup (cons 0.5 2)))
236
237         (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
238
239         (make-number-markup
240           (make-left-align-markup
241             (number->string
242               (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow)))))
243
244         (make-number-markup
245           (number->string
246             (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow)))))
247     )))
248
249   #{
250     \time $underlyingMeter
251     \set beatStructure = $beatStructure
252     \override Timing.TimeSignature.stencil =
253     #ly:text-interface::print
254     \override Timing.TimeSignature.text =
255     #mkup

```

```

256     #})
257
258
259     backToNormalTimeSignature =
260     {
261     \unset beatStructure
262     \revert Timing.TimeSignature.stencil
263     \revert Timing.TimeSignature.text
264     \revert Staff.TimeSignature.stencil
265     \revert Staff.TimeSignature.text
266     }
267
268
269     {
270
271     \compoundFractionalTimeSignatureCTwo #'((3 4)(2 3 4)) 11/12 3,3,3,2
272     \tuplet 3/2 {c'8 c' c'} \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
273     \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
274     \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 3/2 {c' c'}
275     \backToNormalTimeSignature
276     \time 3/4
277     c'2.
278     }
279

```

11.6.4 Discussion

See [Discussion](#) of the entry *Compound Meter with Two Fractional Time Signatures, Style A*.

[Table of Contents](#)

11.7 Compound Meter with Three Fractional Time Signatures, Style A



11.7.1 Description

This is an implementation of a compound meter with three fractional time signatures with Style A.

11.7.2 Grammar

```
\compoundFractionalTimeSignatureAThree
    #'((TIME_SIG1)(TIME_SIG2)(TIME_SIG3)) MEASURE_SPAN BEAT_STRUCT

\backToNormalTimeSignature
```

NB

1. Following the convention of `\compoundMeter` to enter the two time signatures, you will create a list of lists. Each `TIME_SIG` accepts:
 - an ordinary time signature (list with two numbers);
 - a time signature with a fraction (list with three numbers), or;
 - a time signature with an ordinary numerator and a fraction.

See [Grammar of Fractional Time Signatures, Style A](#) for the explanation on the arguments for the order of arguments to specify time signatures.
2. In the code of the given snippet, the value for `MEASURE_SPAN` may appear absurd. However, this results from following the same convention as before, i.e. adding the constituent time signatures to give a general irrational time signature for the entire bar. Thus:

$$\frac{3}{4} + \frac{4}{20} + \frac{2}{12} = \frac{67}{60}$$

3. `BEAT_STRUCT` follows the same convention as before; however, as the given code shows, it may be necessary to still use `[` and `]` to explicitly specify the beaming.
4. When you wish to go back to a regular time signature, use `\backToNormalTimeSignature`, otherwise the identical fractional time signature will keep showing up.

11.7.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3
```

```

4
5 % Revised Aug 10 2025 to include the function to revert to a
6 % regular time signature
7
8 suppressWarning =
9 #(define-void-function (amount message)(number? string?)
10   (for-each
11     (lambda (warning)
12       (ly:expect-warning message))
13     (iota amount 1 1)))
14
15 \suppressWarning 3 "strange time signature found"
16
17 incompleteTupletBracket = {
18   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
19   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
20
21 }
22 incompleteSmallTupletBracket = {
23   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
24   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
25   \once \override Voice.TupletNumber.X-offset =
26     #(lambda (grob)
27       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
28         2.2
29         1.2))
30
31   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.shorten-pair =
32     #(lambda (grob)
33       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
34         '(-0.7 . 0.15)
35         '(-0.3 . 0.8)))
36   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.X-positions =
37     #(lambda (grob)
38       (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
39         '(1.8 . 3)
40         '(0.3 . 2.7)))
41 }
42
43 compoundFractionalTimeSignatureAThree =
44 #(define-music-function
45   (timeSignatureToShow underlyingMeter beatStructure)
46   (list? fraction? number-list?)
47   (define mkup
48     (markup
49       #:concat
50       (
51         #:override

```



```

100             (make-halign-markup
101               -1.5
102             (make-center-column-markup
103               (list
104                 (make-translate-markup
105                   (cons 0 1)
106                 (make-fontsize-markup
107                   -6
108                 (make-number-markup
109                   (number->string
110                     (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
111               (make-translate-markup
112                 (cons 0 0)
113               (make-fontsize-markup
114                 -6
115               (make-number-markup
116                 (number->string
117                   (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))))))
118             (make-number-markup
119               (number->string
120                 (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
121         ))
122     )
123
124
125     #:translate
126     (cons 0 -0.5)
127     (#:fontsize -12 " ")
128     #:translate
129     (cons 0 -0.5)
130     (#:bold "+")
131     #:translate
132     (cons 0 -0.5)
133     (#:fontsize -12 " ")
134
135     #:override
136     (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
137     (cond ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 2)
138           (make-center-column-markup
139             (list (make-number-markup
140                   (number->string
141                     (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
142                 (make-number-markup
143                   (number->string
144                     (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow)))))))
145           ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 3)

```



```

148      (make-override-markup
149        (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
150        (make-center-column-markup
151          (list
152
153            (make-center-column-markup
154              (list
155                (make-translate-markup
156                  (cons 0 1)
157                  (make-fontsize-markup
158                    -6
159                    (make-number-markup
160                      (number->string
161                        (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
162                (make-translate-markup
163                  (cons 0 0)
164                  (make-fontsize-markup
165                    -6
166                    (make-number-markup
167                      (number->string
168                        (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
169                (make-number-markup
170                  (number->string
171                    (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
172              ))
173        ))
174
175      ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 4)
176
177      (make-override-markup
178        (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
179        (make-center-column-markup
180          (list
181
182            (make-concat-markup
183              (list (make-number-markup
184                (number->string
185                  (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
186                (make-halign-markup
187                  -1.5
188                  (make-center-column-markup
189                    (list
190                      (make-translate-markup
191                        (cons 0 1)
192                        (make-fontsize-markup
193                          -6
194                          (make-number-markup

```

```

196             (number->string
197             (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
198         (make-translate-markup
199         (cons 0 0)
200         (make-fontsize-markup
201         -6
202         (make-number-markup
203         (number->string
204         (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))))))
205     (make-number-markup
206     (number->string
207     (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
208 ))
209 )
210 #:translate
211 (cons 0 -0.5)
212 (#:fontsize -12 " ")
213 #:translate
214 (cons 0 -0.5)
215 (#:bold "+")
216 #:translate
217 (cons 0 -0.5)
218 (#:fontsize -12 " ")
219
220 #:override
221 (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
222 (cond ((= (length (caddr timeSignatureToShow)) 2)
223        (make-center-column-markup
224        (list (make-number-markup
225                (number->string
226                (car (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))
227              (make-number-markup
228              (number->string
229              (cadr (caddr timeSignatureToShow)))))))
230        ((= (length (caddr timeSignatureToShow)) 3)
231         (make-override-markup
232         (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
233         (make-center-column-markup
234         (list
235
236         (make-center-column-markup
237         (list
238         (make-translate-markup
239         (cons 0 1)
240         (make-fontsize-markup

```

```

244         -6
245         (make-number-markup
246         (number->string
247         (car (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
248     (make-translate-markup
249     (cons 0 0)
250     (make-fontsize-markup
251     -6
252     (make-number-markup
253     (number->string
254     (cadr (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
255     (make-number-markup
256     (number->string
257     (caddr (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
258 ))
259
260
261 ((= (length (caddr timeSignatureToShow)) 4)
262
263     (make-override-markup
264     (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
265     (make-center-column-markup
266     (list
267
268         (make-concat-markup
269         (list (make-number-markup
270         (number->string
271         (car (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))
272         (make-halign-markup
273         -1.5
274         (make-center-column-markup
275         (list
276         (make-translate-markup
277         (cons 0 1)
278         (make-fontsize-markup
279         -6
280         (make-number-markup
281         (number->string
282         (cadr (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
283         (make-translate-markup
284         (cons 0 0)
285         (make-fontsize-markup
286         -6
287         (make-number-markup
288         (number->string
289         (caddr (caddr timeSignatureToShow)))))))))
290     (make-number-markup
291     (number->string

```

```

292             (caddr (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
293         ))
294     )
295
296
297     )))
298
299     #{
300     \time $underlyingMeter
301     \set beatStructure = $beatStructure
302
303     \override Timing.TimeSignature.stencil =
304     #ly:text-interface::print
305     \override Timing.TimeSignature.text =
306     #mkup
307     #})
308
309     backToNormalTimeSignature =
310     {
311     \unset beatStructure
312     \revert Timing.TimeSignature.stencil
313     \revert Timing.TimeSignature.text
314     \revert Staff.TimeSignature.stencil
315     \revert Staff.TimeSignature.text
316     }
317
318
319     {
320
321     \compoundFractionalTimeSignatureAThree #'((3 4)(4 5 4)(2 3 4)) 67/60 3,3,3,4,2
322     \tuplet 3/2 {c'8 c' c'} \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
323     \tuplet 3/2 {c'[ c' c']}
324     \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 5/4 {c'16[ c' c' c']}
325     \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 3/2 {c'8 c'}
326
327     \backToNormalTimeSignature
328     \time 3/4
329     c'2.
330     }
331

```

11.7.4 Discussion

1. As mentioned in the **Grammar** section, it appears that specifying the beaming in the LilyPond code is still necessary. This is probably because of the unusual value of the fraction that needs to be given in the second argument of the function, `MEASURE_SPAN`.
2. As in the case of the other compound meters introduced in this document, I am hoping to

find ways to simplify the code.

3. When you wish to go back to a regular time signature, use `\backToNormalTimeSignature`, otherwise the identical fractional time signature will keep showing up.

[Table of Contents](#)

11.8 Compound Meter with Three Fractional Time Signatures, Style B



11.8.1 Description

This is an implementation of a compound meter with three fractional time signatures with Style B.

11.8.2 Grammar

```
\compoundFractionalTimeSignatureBThree
    #'((TIME_SIG1)(TIME_SIG2)(TIME_SIG3)) MEASURE_SPAN BEAT_STRUCT

\backToNormalTimeSignature
```

NB

1. See [Grammar](#) of the entry *Compound Meter with Three Fractional Time Signatures, Style A*.
2. When you wish to go back to a regular time signature, use `\backToNormalTimeSignature`, otherwise the identical fractional time signature will keep showing up.

11.8.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3
4
5 % Revised Jan 2 2025 for improving the appearance of fractions
6 % Revised Aug 10 2025 to include the function to revert to a
7 % regular time signature
8
9 suppressWarning =
10 #(define-void-function (amount message)(number? string?)
11   (for-each
12     (lambda (warning)
13       (ly:expect-warning message))
14     (iota amount 1 1)))
15
16 \suppressWarning 1 "strange time signature found"
17
18 incompleteTupletBracket = {
19   \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
```

```

20 \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
21
22 }
23 incompleteSmallTupletBracket = {
24 \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
25 \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
26 \once \override Voice.TupletNumber.X-offset =
27   #(lambda (grob)
28     (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
29         2.2
30         1.2))
31
32 \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.shorten-pair =
33   #(lambda (grob)
34     (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
35         '(-0.7 . 0.15)
36         '(-0.3 . 0.8)))
37 \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.X-positions =
38   #(lambda (grob)
39     (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
40         '(1.8 . 3)
41         '(0.3 . 2.7)))
42 }
43
44 compoundFractionalTimeSignatureBThree =
45 # (define-music-function
46   (timeSignatureToShow underlyingMeter beatStructure)
47   (list? fraction? number-list?)
48   (define mkup
49     (markup
50       #:concat
51
52       (
53
54         #:override
55         (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
56         (cond ((= (length (car timeSignatureToShow)) 2)
57               (make-center-column-markup
58                 (list (make-number-markup
59                       (number->string
60                        (car (car timeSignatureToShow))))
61                       (make-number-markup
62                        (number->string
63                         (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow)))))))
64               ((= (length (car timeSignatureToShow)) 3)
65                 (make-override-markup
66                  (cons 'baseline-skip 0)

```

```

68      (make-center-column-markup
69      (list
70      (make-line-markup
71      (list
72      (make-number-markup
73      (make-right-align-markup
74      (make-translate-markup
75      (cons 0 1.6)
76      (make-fontsize-markup
77      -3
78      (number->string
79      (car (car timeSignatureToShow)))))))))
80
81      (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
82
83      (make-override-markup
84      (cons 'alignment 0)
85      (make-translate-markup
86      (cons 0 0.8)
87      (make-draw-line-markup (cons 1.5 1.35))))))
88
89      (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
90
91      (make-translate-markup
92      (cons 0 0)
93      (make-fontsize-markup
94      -3
95      (make-number-markup
96      (number->string
97      (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow)))))))))
98
99      (make-number-markup
100      (number->string
101      (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
102
103      ((= (length (car timeSignatureToShow)) 4)
104
105      (make-override-markup
106      (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
107      (make-center-column-markup
108      (list
109      (make-line-markup
110      (list
111      (make-number-markup
112      (number->string
113      (car (car timeSignatureToShow))))
114      (make-fontsize-markup

```



```

116         -12
117         (make-simple-markup " ")
118
119         (make-hspace-markup -1.25)
120         (make-translate-markup
121         (cons 0 0.4)
122         (make-bold-markup
123         (make-simple-markup "+"))))
124
125         (make-hspace-markup -0.25)
126
127         (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
128         (make-right-align-markup
129         (make-number-markup
130         (make-translate-markup
131         (cons 0 1.5)
132         (make-fontsize-markup
133         -3
134         (number->string
135         (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))))))
136
137         (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
138
139         (make-override-markup
140         (cons 'alignment 0)
141         (make-translate-markup
142         (cons 0 0.8)
143         (make-draw-line-markup
144         (cons 1.5 1.35))))))
145
146         (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
147
148         (make-number-markup
149         (make-left-align-markup
150         (make-fontsize-markup
151         -3
152         (number->string
153         (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))))))
154
155         (make-number-markup
156         (number->string
157         (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))))))
158
159 #:translate
160 (cons 0 -0.5)
161 (#:fontsize -12 " ")
162 #:translate

```

```

164      (cons 0 -0.5)
165      (:bold "+")
166      #:translate
167      (cons 0 -0.5)
168      (:fontsize -12 " ")
169
170      #:override
171      (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
172
173      (cond ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 2)
174            (make-center-column-markup
175              (list (make-number-markup
176                    (number->string
177                      (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
178                    (make-number-markup
179                      (number->string
180                        (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow)))))))
181
182            ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 3)
183              (make-override-markup
184                (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
185                (make-center-column-markup
186                  (list
187                    (make-line-markup
188                      (list
189                        (make-number-markup
190                          (make-right-align-markup
191                            (make-translate-markup
192                              (cons 0 1.6)
193                              (make-fontsize-markup
194                                -3
195                                (number->string
196                                  (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow)))))))
197
198                        (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
199
200                        (make-override-markup
201                          (cons 'alignment 0)
202                          (make-translate-markup
203                            (cons 0 0.8)
204                            (make-draw-line-markup (cons 1.5 1.35))))))
205
206                    (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
207
208                    (make-translate-markup
209                      (cons 0 0)
210                      (make-fontsize-markup
211                        -3

```

```

212         (make-number-markup
213         (number->string
214         (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow)))))))))
215
216     (make-number-markup
217     (number->string
218     (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow)))))))))
219
220
221     ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 4)
222
223     (make-override-markup
224     (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
225     (make-center-column-markup
226     (list
227     (make-line-markup
228     (list
229     (make-number-markup
230     (number->string
231     (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
232     (make-fontsize-markup
233     -12
234     (make-simple-markup " ")))
235
236     (make-hspace-markup -1.25)
237     (make-translate-markup
238     (cons 0 0.4)
239     (make-bold-markup
240     (make-simple-markup "+"))))
241
242     (make-hspace-markup -0.25)
243
244     (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
245     (make-right-align-markup
246     (make-number-markup
247     (make-translate-markup
248     (cons 0 1.5)
249     (make-fontsize-markup
250     -3
251     (number->string
252     (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow)))))))))
253
254     (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
255
256     (make-override-markup
257     (cons 'alignment 0)
258     (make-translate-markup
259     (cons 0 0.8)

```

```

260             (make-draw-line-markup
261               (cons 1.5 1.35))))
262
263             (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
264
265             (make-number-markup
266               (make-left-align-markup
267                 (make-fontsize-markup
268                   -3
269                   (number->string
270                     (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))))
271
272             (make-number-markup
273               (number->string
274                 (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
275
276 #:translate
277 (cons 0 -0.5)
278 (#:fontsize -12 " ")
279 #:translate
280 (cons 0 -0.5)
281 (#:bold "+")
282 #:translate
283 (cons 0 -0.5)
284 (#:fontsize -12 " ")
285
286 #:override
287 (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
288
289 (cond ((= (length (caddr timeSignatureToShow)) 2)
290        (make-center-column-markup
291          (list (make-number-markup
292                  (number->string
293                    (car (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))
294                (make-number-markup
295                  (number->string
296                    (cadr (caddr timeSignatureToShow)))))))
297
298        ((= (length (caddr timeSignatureToShow)) 3)
299          (make-override-markup
300            (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
301            (make-center-column-markup
302              (list
303                (make-line-markup
304                  (list
305                    (make-number-markup
306                      (make-right-align-markup
307                        (make-translate-markup

```

```

308         (cons 0 1.6)
309         (make-fontsize-markup
310         -3
311         (number->string
312         (car (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
313
314     (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
315
316     (make-override-markup
317     (cons 'alignment 0)
318     (make-translate-markup
319     (cons 0 0.8)
320     (make-draw-line-markup (cons 1.5 1.35))))
321
322     (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
323
324     (make-translate-markup
325     (cons 0 0)
326     (make-fontsize-markup
327     -3
328     (make-number-markup
329     (number->string
330     (cadr (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
331
332     (make-number-markup
333     (number->string
334     (caddr (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
335
336
337     ((= (length (caddr timeSignatureToShow)) 4)
338
339     (make-override-markup
340     (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
341     (make-center-column-markup
342     (list
343     (make-line-markup
344     (list
345     (make-number-markup
346     (number->string
347     (car (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))
348     (make-fontsize-markup
349     -12
350     (make-simple-markup " ")))
351
352     (make-hspace-markup -1.25)
353     (make-translate-markup
354     (cons 0 0.4)
355     (make-bold-markup

```

```

356             (make-simple-markup "+"))
357
358         (make-hspace-markup -0.25)
359
360         (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
361         (make-right-align-markup
362         (make-number-markup
363         (make-translate-markup
364         (cons 0 1.5)
365         (make-fontsize-markup
366         -3
367         (number->string
368         (cadr (caddr timeSignatureToShow)))))))
369
370         (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
371
372         (make-override-markup
373         (cons 'alignment 0)
374         (make-translate-markup
375         (cons 0 0.8)
376         (make-draw-line-markup
377         (cons 1.5 1.35))))
378
379         (make-hspace-markup -1.5)
380
381         (make-number-markup
382         (make-left-align-markup
383         (make-fontsize-markup
384         -3
385         (number->string
386         (caddr (caddr timeSignatureToShow)))))))
387
388         (make-number-markup
389         (number->string
390         (caddr (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
391     )
392
393 ))
394
395 #{
396   \time $underlyingMeter
397   \set beatStructure = $beatStructure
398
399   \override Timing.TimeSignature.stencil =
400   #ly:text-interface::print
401   \override Timing.TimeSignature.text =
402   #mkup
403   #})

```

```

404
405 backToNormalTimeSignature =
406 {
407   \unset beatStructure
408   \revert Timing.TimeSignature.stencil
409   \revert Timing.TimeSignature.text
410   \revert Staff.TimeSignature.stencil
411   \revert Staff.TimeSignature.text
412 }
413
414 {
415
416   \compoundFractionalTimeSignatureBThree #'((3 4)(4 5 4)(2 3 4)) 67/60 3,3,3,4,2
417   \tuplet 3/2 {c'8 c' c'} \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
418   \tuplet 3/2 {c'[ c' c']}
419   \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 5/4 {c'16[ c' c' c']}
420   \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 3/2 {c'8 c'}
421   \backToNormalTimeSignature
422   \time 3/4
423   c'2.
424
425 }

```

11.8.4 Discussion

See [Discussion](#) of the entry *Compound Meter with Three Fractional Time Signatures, Style A*.

[Table of Contents](#)

11.9 Compound Meter with Three Fractional Time Signatures, Style C



11.9.1 Description

This is an implementation of a compound meter with three fractional time signatures with Style C.

11.9.2 Grammar

```
\compoundFractionalTimeSignatureCThree
    #'((TIME_SIG1)(TIME_SIG2)(TIME_SIG3)) MEASURE_SPAN BEAT_STRUCT

\backToNormalTimeSignature
```

NB

1. See [Grammar](#) of the entry *Compound Meter with Three Fractional Time Signatures, Style A*.
2. When you wish to go back to a regular time signature, use `\backToNormalTimeSignature`, otherwise the identical fractional time signature will keep showing up.

11.9.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3
4
5 % Revised Jan 2 2025 for improving the appearance of fractions
6 % Revised Aug 10 2025 to include the function to revert to a
7 % regular time signature
8
9 suppressWarning =
10 #(define-void-function (amount message)(number? string?)
11   (for-each
12     (lambda (warning)
13       (ly:expect-warning message))
14     (iota amount 1 1)))
15
16 \suppressWarning 1 "strange time signature found"
17
18 incompleteTupletBracket = {
```



```

19 \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
20 \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
21
22 }
23 incompleteSmallTupletBracket = {
24 \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.edge-height = #'(0.7 . 0)
25 \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.bracket-visibility = ##t
26 \once \override Voice.TupletNumber.X-offset =
27   #(lambda (grob)
28     (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
29         2.2
30         1.2))
31
32 \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.shorten-pair =
33   #(lambda (grob)
34     (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
35         '(-0.7 . 0.15)
36         '(-0.3 . 0.8)))
37 \once \override Voice.TupletBracket.X-positions =
38   #(lambda (grob)
39     (if (= UP (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
40         '(1.8 . 3)
41         '(0.3 . 2.7)))
42 }
43
44 compoundFractionalTimeSignatureCThree =
45   #(define-music-function
46     (timeSignatureToShow underlyingMeter beatStructure)
47     (list? fraction? number-list?)
48     (define mkup
49       (markup
50         #:concat
51         (
52
53           #:override
54           (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
55           (cond ((= (length (car timeSignatureToShow)) 2)
56                 (make-center-column-markup
57                   (list (make-number-markup
58                         (number->string
59                          (car (car timeSignatureToShow))))
60                         (make-number-markup
61                          (number->string
62                           (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow)))))))
63
64           ((= (length (car timeSignatureToShow)) 3)
65             (make-override-markup
66              (cons 'baseline-skip 0)

```

```

67      (make-center-column-markup
68      (list
69      (make-line-markup
70      (list
71
72      (make-right-align-markup
73      (make-number-markup
74      (number->string
75      (car (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
76
77      (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
78
79      (make-override-markup
80      (list (cons 'alignment 0)
81            (cons 'thickness 2))
82      (make-draw-line-markup
83      (cons 0.5 2)))
84
85      (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
86
87      (make-number-markup
88      (make-left-align-markup
89      (number->string
90      (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
91
92      (make-number-markup
93      (number->string
94      (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
95
96
97      ((= (length (car timeSignatureToShow)) 4)
98
99      (make-override-markup
100      (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
101      (make-center-column-markup
102      (list
103      (make-line-markup
104      (list
105      (make-number-markup
106      (number->string
107      (car (car timeSignatureToShow))))
108      (make-fontsize-markup
109      -12
110      (make-simple-markup " ")))
111
112
113      (make-hspace-markup -1.25)
114      (make-translate-markup

```

```

115         (cons 0 0.4)
116         (make-bold-markup
117         (make-simple-markup "+"))
118
119         (make-hspace-markup -0.25)
120
121         (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
122         (make-right-align-markup
123         (make-number-markup
124         (number->string
125         (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
126
127         (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
128
129         (make-override-markup
130         (list (cons 'alignment 0)
131         (cons 'thickness 2))
132         (make-draw-line-markup (cons 0.5 2)))
133
134         (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
135
136         (make-number-markup
137         (make-left-align-markup
138         (number->string
139         (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
140
141         (make-number-markup
142         (number->string
143         (caddr (car timeSignatureToShow))))))
144
145
146 #:translate
147 (cons 0 -0.5)
148 (#:fontsize -12 " ")
149 #:translate
150 (cons 0 -0.5)
151 (#:bold "+")
152 #:translate
153 (cons 0 -0.5)
154 (#:fontsize -12 " ")
155
156 #:override
157 (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
158
159 (cond ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 2)
160        (make-center-column-markup
161        (list (make-number-markup
162        (number->string

```

```

163             (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
164         (make-number-markup
165         (number->string
166         (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
167
168     ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 3)
169     (make-override-markup
170     (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
171     (make-center-column-markup
172     (list
173     (make-line-markup
174     (list
175
176         (make-right-align-markup
177         (make-number-markup
178         (number->string
179         (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
180
181     (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
182
183     (make-override-markup
184     (list (cons 'alignment 0)
185           (cons 'thickness 2))
186     (make-draw-line-markup
187     (cons 0.5 2)))
188
189     (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
190
191     (make-number-markup
192     (make-left-align-markup
193     (number->string
194     (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
195
196     (make-number-markup
197     (number->string
198     (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
199
200
201     ((= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 4)
202
203     (make-override-markup
204     (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
205     (make-center-column-markup
206     (list
207     (make-line-markup
208     (list
209     (make-number-markup
210     (number->string

```

```

211         (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
212 (make-fontsize-markup
213   -12
214   (make-simple-markup " "))
215
216
217 (make-hspace-markup -1.25)
218 (make-translate-markup
219   (cons 0 0.4)
220   (make-bold-markup
221     (make-simple-markup "+")))
222
223 (make-hspace-markup -0.25)
224
225 (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
226 (make-right-align-markup
227   (make-number-markup
228     (number->string
229       (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
230
231 (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
232
233 (make-override-markup
234   (list (cons 'alignment 0)
235         (cons 'thickness 2))
236   (make-draw-line-markup (cons 0.5 2)))
237
238 (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
239
240 (make-number-markup
241   (make-left-align-markup
242     (number->string
243       (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
244
245 (make-number-markup
246   (number->string
247     (caddr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))))
248
249 #:translate
250 (cons 0 -0.5)
251 (#:fontsize -12 " ")
252 #:translate
253 (cons 0 -0.5)
254 (#:bold "+")
255 #:translate
256 (cons 0 -0.5)
257 (#:fontsize -12 " ")
258

```

```

259      #:override
260      (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
261
262      (cond ((= (length (caddr timeSignatureToShow)) 2)
263             (make-center-column-markup
264               (list (make-number-markup
265                     (number->string
266                     (car (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))
267                     (make-number-markup
268                     (number->string
269                     (cadr (caddr timeSignatureToShow)))))))
270
271             ((= (length (caddr timeSignatureToShow)) 3)
272              (make-override-markup
273                (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
274                (make-center-column-markup
275                  (list
276                    (make-line-markup
277                      (list
278
279                        (make-right-align-markup
280                          (make-number-markup
281                            (number->string
282                            (car (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))
283
284                        (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
285
286                        (make-override-markup
287                          (list (cons 'alignment 0)
288                                (cons 'thickness 2))
289                          (make-draw-line-markup
290                            (cons 0.5 2)))
291
292                        (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
293
294                        (make-number-markup
295                          (make-left-align-markup
296                            (number->string
297                            (cadr (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
298
299                        (make-number-markup
300                          (number->string
301                          (caddr (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
302
303              ((= (length (caddr timeSignatureToShow)) 4)
304               (make-override-markup

```

```

307         (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
308     (make-center-column-markup
309     (list
310     (make-line-markup
311     (list
312     (make-number-markup
313     (number->string
314     (car (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))
315     (make-fontsize-markup
316     -12
317     (make-simple-markup " ")))
318
319
320     (make-hspace-markup -1.25)
321     (make-translate-markup
322     (cons 0 0.4)
323     (make-bold-markup
324     (make-simple-markup "+"))))
325
326     (make-hspace-markup -0.25)
327
328     (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
329     (make-right-align-markup
330     (make-number-markup
331     (number->string
332     (cadr (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
333
334     (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
335
336     (make-override-markup
337     (list (cons 'alignment 0)
338     (cons 'thickness 2))
339     (make-draw-line-markup (cons 0.5 2)))
340
341     (make-hspace-markup -0.6)
342
343     (make-number-markup
344     (make-left-align-markup
345     (number->string
346     (caddr (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
347
348     (make-number-markup
349     (number->string
350     (caddr (caddr timeSignatureToShow))))))
351 )
352 ))
353
354 #{"

```

```

355     \time $underlyingMeter
356     \set beatStructure = $beatStructure
357
358     \override Timing.TimeSignature.stencil =
359     #ly:text-interface::print
360     \override Timing.TimeSignature.text =
361     #mkup
362     #})
363
364 backToNormalTimeSignature =
365 {
366     \unset beatStructure
367     \revert Timing.TimeSignature.stencil
368     \revert Timing.TimeSignature.text
369     \revert Staff.TimeSignature.stencil
370     \revert Staff.TimeSignature.text
371 }
372
373
374 {
375
376     \compoundFractionalTimeSignatureCThree #'((3 4)(4 5 4)(2 3 4)) 67/60 3,3,3,4,2
377     \tuplet 3/2 {c'8 c' c'} \tuplet 3/2 {c' c' c'}
378     \tuplet 3/2 {c'[ c' c']}
379     \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 5/4 {c'16[ c' c' c']}
380     \incompleteTupletBracket \tuplet 3/2 {c'8 c'}
381     \backToNormalTimeSignature
382     \time 3/4
383     c'2.
384 }
385

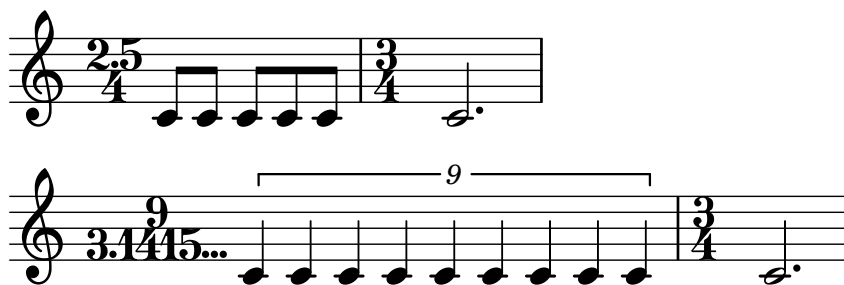
```

11.9.4 Discussion

See [Discussion](#) of the entry *Compound Meter with Three Fractional Time Signatures, Style A*.

[Table of Contents](#)

11.10 Time Signature with Decimals



11.10.1 Description

This is an implementation of a time signature with decimals. This function allows the user to use decimals for both numerator and denominator values of the time signature. While there are many examples where the numerator value contains decimals, notable examples for denominators that contain decimals include works by Mark Andre, such as *Un-fini I* (1995) for harp,¹⁷ *Un-fini II* (1994-95) for harpsichord,¹⁸ and *Contrapunctus* (1998/99) for piano..¹⁹ This function also has the option of showing ellipsis, as discussed in **Grammar**.

11.10.2 Grammar

```
\decimalPointTimeSignature
    #'((NUMERATOR)(DENOMINATOR)) MEASURE_SPAN BEAT_STRUCT

\backToNormalTimeSignature
```

NB

1. The first argument takes a list of two lists. For both `NUMERATOR` and `DENOMINATOR`, one or two numbers can be placed.
 - (a) If only one number is placed, it is treated as an integer. For example, `#'((3)(4))` would print: $\frac{3}{4}$.
 - (b) If two numbers are placed, the first number is the integer portion of the number, and the second number is the decimals. For example, `#'((3 5)(4 232))` would print: $\frac{3.5}{4.232}$.
 - (c) Placing a dot `.` at the end of the second number will print the ellipsis `...` at the end. This is useful for notating infinite decimal representations. For example, `#'((3 14159.)(4))` would print: $\frac{3.14159...}{4}$.
2. `MEASURE_SPAN` denotes how the measure may be written without the use of "decimal point" time signature.
3. `BEAT_STRUCT` indicates beat structure, by which the beaming of the measure abides.

17. Mark Andre, *Un-fini I : 1995, für eine Harfenistin/einen Harfenisten (Harfe, Tam-tam, grosse Trommel)*, Neue Musik bei Carus (Stuttgart: Carus, 1997).

18. Mark Andre, *Un-fini II : pour clavecin (1996)* (Paris: Editions Durand, 1998).

19. Mark Andre, *Contrapunctus : pour piano* (Paris: Durand, 2006).

4. When you wish to go back to a regular time signature, use `\backToNormalTimeSignature`, otherwise the identical fractional time signature will keep showing up.

11.10.3 Code

```

1  \version "2.26.0"
2
3
4
5  decimalPointTimeSignature =
6  #(define-music-function
7    (timeSignatureToShow underlyingMeter beatStructure)
8    (list? fraction? number-list?)
9
10    (define (is-float? x)
11      (and (number? x) (inexact? x)))
12
13    #{
14      \time $underlyingMeter
15      \set beatStructure = $beatStructure
16      \override Staff.TimeSignature.stencil =
17      #ly:text-interface::print
18      \override Staff.TimeSignature.text =
19      #(markup
20        (make-override-markup
21          (cons 'baseline-skip 0)
22          (make-center-column-markup
23            (list
24              (if (= (length (car timeSignatureToShow)) 1)
25                (make-number-markup
26                  (number->string
27
28                    (car (car timeSignatureToShow))))
29                (make-line-markup
30                  (list
31                    (make-number-markup
32                      (number->string
33                        (car (car timeSignatureToShow))))
34                    (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
35                    (make-translate-markup
36                      '(0 . 0.15)
37                    (make-musicglyph-markup "period"))
38                    (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
39                    (if (not (is-float? (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow))))
40                      (make-number-markup
41                        (number->string
42                          (inexact->exact (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow))))
43                      ))

```

```

44         (make-line-markup
45         (list (make-number-markup
46                 (number->string
47                 (inexact->exact
48                 (cadr (car timeSignatureToShow))))
49                 ))
50         (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
51         (make-translate-markup
52         '(0 . 0.15)
53         (make-musicglyph-markup "period"))
54         (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
55         (make-translate-markup
56         '(0 . 0.15)
57         (make-musicglyph-markup "period"))
58         (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
59         (make-translate-markup
60         '(0 . 0.15)
61         (make-musicglyph-markup "period"))))
62     )
63 )
64 )
65 )
66 (if (= (length (cadr timeSignatureToShow)) 1)
67     (make-number-markup
68     (number->string
69     (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
70     (make-line-markup
71     (list
72     (make-number-markup
73     (number->string
74     (car (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
75     (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
76     (make-translate-markup
77     '(0 . 0.15)
78     (make-musicglyph-markup "period"))
79     (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
80     (if (not (is-float? (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
81         (make-number-markup
82         (number->string
83         (inexact->exact (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
84         ))
85     (make-line-markup
86     (list (make-number-markup
87             (number->string
88             (inexact->exact
89             (cadr (cadr timeSignatureToShow))))
90             ))
91     (make-hspace-markup -0.5)

```

```

92             (make-translate-markup
93               '(0 . 0.15)
94               (make-musicglyph-markup "period"))
95             (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
96             (make-translate-markup
97               '(0 . 0.15)
98               (make-musicglyph-markup "period"))
99             (make-hspace-markup -0.5)
100            (make-translate-markup
101              '(0 . 0.15)
102              (make-musicglyph-markup "period"))))
103          )
104      )
105  )
106  )
107  )
108  ))
109  (make-hspace-markup -1))
110  #})
111
112  backToNormalTimeSignature =
113  {
114    \unset beatStructure
115    \revert Timing.TimeSignature.stencil
116    \revert Timing.TimeSignature.text
117    \revert Staff.TimeSignature.stencil
118    \revert Staff.TimeSignature.text
119  }
120
121
122  {
123    \decimalPointTimeSignature #'((2 5)(4)) 5/8 2,3
124    c'8 c' c' c' c'
125    \backToNormalTimeSignature
126    \time 3/4
127    c'2.
128  }
129
130
131  {
132    \decimalPointTimeSignature #'((9)(3 1415.)) 9/4 3,3,3
133    \tuplet 9/9 {c'4 4 4 4 4 4 4 4 4}
134    \backToNormalTimeSignature
135    \time 3/4
136    c'2.
137  }

```

11.10.4 Discussion

The structure of the code where the user specifies integer and decimal portions of either numerator, denominator, or both, resulted from the fact that the period "." by default appeared too close to the staff line and the denominator, possibly rendering the time signature difficult to read. In the code I made these periods appear via `\translate` feature, where I offset the period upward by the value of 0.15, allowing the period sign to be separated from the staff line and the denominator.

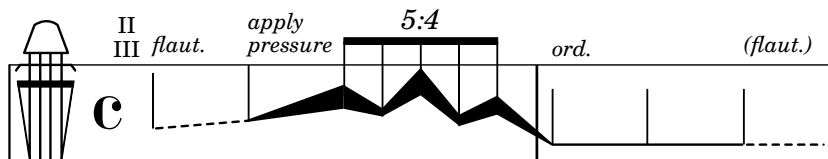
[Table of Contents](#)

Chapter 12

Combinations

This chapter presents examples that combine several snippets from the previous chapters. **Variables Used** provides a comprehensive list of all the variables required to generate the snippet. Among these, indented variables indicate "variables of a variable," i.e., dependent variables necessary for the main variables to function. The **Code** section only lists the score portion of the LilyPond code.

12.1 Prescriptive Notation for String Instruments



12.1.1 Description

An example of a prescriptive notation for a string instrument. Vertical placement of the notehead corresponds to the position at which bowing takes place. Horizontally it shows the change of the bow pressure against the string(s).

12.1.2 Variables Used

```
\stringPositionClef
  \stringPositionClefDesign
\dashedLineNotehead
\modularLineNotehead
\noteheadless
```

12.1.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 strPosClefDesign = #(ly:make-stencil (list 'embedded-ps
```

```

4                                     "gsave
5   currentpoint translate
6   /fingboardpath
7   {
8
9   newpath
10
11   -0.55 7.5 moveto
12   0 -3 rlineto
13   1 -6.5 rlineto
14   -1 -1 rlineto
15   0 -3 rlineto
16   4.1 0 rlineto
17   0 3 rlineto
18   -1 1 rlineto
19   1 6.5 rlineto
20   0 3 rlineto
21   closepath
22
23   } def
24
25   fingboardpath clip
26   newpath
27   0.15 setlinewidth
28   0.5 4.75 moveto
29   0 -6.8 rlineto
30   -0.75 5 rlineto
31   3.5 0 rlineto
32   -0.75 -5 rlineto
33   0. 6.8 rlineto
34   stroke
35   0.35 setlinewidth
36   -0.4 2.75 moveto
37   3.75 0 rlineto
38   stroke
39
40   %inner two line
41   newpath
42   0.15 setlinewidth
43   1.16 4.75 moveto
44   0. -6.8 rlineto
45   1.8 4.75 moveto
46   0. -6.8 rlineto
47   stroke
48
49   %bridge
50   newpath
51   -0.4 3.6 moveto

```

```

52 0.3 0.4 rlineto
53 3.2 0 rlineto
54 0.3 -0.4 rlineto
55 stroke
56
57 %tailpiece
58 0.15 4.75 moveto
59 1 setlinecap
60 1 setlinejoin
61 2.75 0 rlineto
62 -0.65 1.75 rlineto
63 -0 -0 -0.6 0.55 -1.45 0 rcurveto
64 closepath
65 stroke
66
67 newpath
68 0.2 setlinewidth
69 1 setlinecap
70 1.5 -2.25 moveto
71 0 -2.5 rlineto
72 0.25 -3.5 moveto
73 2.5 0 rlineto
74 stroke
75 newpath
76 1.5 -3.5 0.85 0 360 arc
77 stroke
78 grestore")
79                                     (cons 0 3)
80                                     (cons 0 1))
81
82 strPosClefSize =
83 #(lambda (grob)
84   (let* ((bCS (ly:grob-property grob 'font-size 0.0))
85          (mult (magstep bCS)))
86     (ly:stencil-scale
87      strPosClef
88      mult mult)))
89
90 strPosClef = {
91   \override Staff.Clef.stencil = \strPosClefDesign
92 }
93
94
95 dashedLineNotehead =
96 #(define-music-function
97   (beginning end x-distance) (ly:music? ly:music? number?)
98   (let*
99     (

```



```

100 (p1 (ly:music-property beginning 'pitch))
101 (p2 (ly:music-property end 'pitch))
102 (steps
103   (-
104     (+ (* 7 (ly:pitch-octave p2)) (ly:pitch-notename p2))
105     (+ (* 7 (ly:pitch-octave p1)) (ly:pitch-notename p1))
106   )
107 )
108 )
109 #{
110   {
111
112     \once \override Voice.NoteHead.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
113     \once \override Voice.NoteHead.stem-attachment = #'(0 . 0)
114     \once \override Staff.LedgerLineSpanner.stencil = ##f
115     \once \override Voice.NoteHead.text = \markup          {
116       % \translate #(cons 0 0)
117       \postscript
118       #(string-append
119         "newpath 1 setlinecap
120           0.15 setlinewidth
121           0 0 moveto
122           [.4 .4 .4 .4] 3 setdash "
123           (number->string x-distance) " " (number->string (* steps 0.5))
124           " rlineto stroke"
125       )
126     }
127     #beginning
128     \revert Voice.NoteHead.stencil
129     \revert Staff.LedgerLineSpanner.stencil
130   }
131 #})
132 )
133
134 modularLineNotehead =
135 #(define-music-function
136   (beginning end beginningThickness endingThickness x-distance)
137   (ly:music? ly:music? number? number? number?)
138   (let*
139     (
140       (p1 (ly:music-property beginning 'pitch))
141       (p2 (ly:music-property end 'pitch))
142       (steps
143         (-
144           (+ (* 7 (ly:pitch-octave p2)) (ly:pitch-notename p2))
145           (+ (* 7 (ly:pitch-octave p1)) (ly:pitch-notename p1))
146         )
147       )

```

```

148   )
149   #{
150   {
151
152     \once \override Voice.NoteHead.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
153     \once \override Voice.NoteHead.stem-attachment = #'(0 . 0)
154     \once \override Voice.LedgerLineSpanner.transparent = ##t
155     \once \override Voice.NoteHead.text = \markup          {
156       \postscript
157       #(string-append
158         "newpath 1 setlinecap 0.1 setlinewidth -0.05 0 moveto 0 "
159         (number->string (* beginningThickness 0.005)) " rlineto "
160         (number->string x-distance) " "
161         (number->string (+ (- (* endingThickness 0.005)
162                               (* beginningThickness 0.005) )
163                             (* steps 0.5)))
164         " rlineto 0 "
165         (number->string (* endingThickness -0.01)) " rlineto "
166         (number->string (* -1 x-distance)) " "
167         (number->string (- (* endingThickness 0.005)
168                             (* beginningThickness 0.005)
169                             (* steps 0.5)))
170         " rlineto
171           closepath
172           fill"
173       )
174     }
175     #beginning
176     \revert Voice.NoteHead.stencil
177     \revert Staff.LedgerLineSpanner.stencil
178   }
179   #})
180 )
181
182 noteheadless = \once \override Voice.NoteHead.stencil = ##f
183
184 #(define-public ((tuplet-number::append-note-wrapper function note) grob)
185   (let ((txt (function grob)))
186     (markup txt #:fontsize -5 #:note note UP)))
187
188
189
190 \score {
191   {
192     \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions = #'(6 -6)
193     \strPosClef \dashedLineNotehead g'4
194     ^\markup {\fontsize #-4 \italic flaut.}
195     ^\markup \translate #'(-2.5 . -0)

```

```

196 \center-column {
197   \translate #'(0 . -1.5)
198   \fontsize #-4 II \fontsize #-4 III
199 }
200 a' #6
201 \modularLineNotehead a'
202 ^\markup \column {
203   \translate #'(0 . -1.5)
204   \fontsize #-4 \italic apply
205   \fontsize #-4 \italic pressure
206 }
207 d'' #15 #150 #6
208 \override TupletNumber.text = #tuplet-number::calc-fraction-text
209 \stemUp \tuplet 5/4 {
210   \modularLineNotehead d''8 b' #150 #50 #2.5
211   \modularLineNotehead b' f'' #50 #175 #2.5
212   \modularLineNotehead f'' a' #175 #70 #2.5
213   \modularLineNotehead a' c'' #70 #120 #2.5
214   \modularLineNotehead c'' e' #120 #15 #3.5
215 }
216 |
217 \modularLineNotehead e'4
218 ^\markup {\fontsize #-4 \italic ord.} e' #15 #15 #12
219 \noteheadless e'
220 \dashedLineNotehead e'
221 ^\markup {\fontsize #-4 \italic (flaut.)} e' #5
222 }
223
224 \layout {
225   \context {
226     \Score proportionalNotationDuration = #1/10
227     \override SpacingSpanner.uniform-stretching = ##t
228   }
229 }
230 }
231

```

[Table of Contents](#)

12.2 Multiple Instances Of Spanners At Once

Two musical staves, A and B, illustrating a 'rall.' (rallentando) effect. Both staves start with a tempo marking of quarter note = 100. An arrow labeled 'rall.' points from the beginning to a later point where the tempo is marked as quarter note = 50. The music consists of eighth and sixteenth notes, with triplets indicated by a '3' over a bracket. The staves are labeled 'A' and 'B' in boxes at the beginning.

12.2.1 Description

Invoking two or more Text Spanners (that require `\stopTextSpan` for them to finish their processes) all on one single layer could cause the spanners to behave unexpectedly. This entry is an attempt to avoid such unexpected behaviors by invoking a spanner per layer (A), or per staff line (B).

12.2.2 Variables Used

```
\startSlashedGraceMusic
\stopSlashedGraceMusic
\graceNoteBeforeBeatOn
\graceNoteBeforeBeatOff
\graceNoteAfterBeatOn
\graceNoteAfterBeatOff
\rallArrow
```

12.2.3 Code

```
1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3
4
5 accelArrow =
6 #(define-music-function (line_angle) (number?)
7
8   (define x_value (cos (* (/ 3.14159265358979 180) (- 90 line_angle))))
9   (define y_value (sin (* (/ 3.14159265358979 180) (- 90 line_angle))))
10  #{
```

```

11     \tweak direction #up
12     \tweak style #'line
13     \tweak thickness #1
14     \tweak to-barline ##t
15     \tweak rotation #(list line_angle -1 0 )
16     \tweak bound-details.left.stencil #ly:text-interface::print
17     \tweak bound-details.left.text \markup \postscript
18     #(string-append
19       "gsave newpath
20 0 0 moveto "
21       (number->string x_value) " "
22       (number->string y_value)
23       " rlineto
24 stroke
25 grestore")
26     \tweak bound-details.left-broken.stencil #ly:text-interface::print
27     \tweak bound-details.left-broken.text ##f
28
29     \tweak bound-details.right.stencil #ly:text-interface::print
30     \tweak bound-details.right.text \markup \postscript
31     "newpath
32 0 0 moveto
33 -1 -0.3 rlineto
34 stroke"
35     \tweak bound-details.right-broken.stencil #ly:text-interface::print
36     \tweak bound-details.right-broken.text ##f
37     \tweak font-shape #'upright
38     \tweak bound-details.left.padding #0
39     \tweak bound-details.right.padding #0
40     \tweak breakable ##t
41     \tweak after-line-breaking ##t
42
43     \startTextSpan
44     #})
45
46 rallArrow =
47 #(define-music-function (line_angle) (number?)
48
49   (define x_value (cos (* (/ 3.14159265358979 180) (- 90 line_angle))))
50   (define y_value (sin (* (/ 3.14159265358979 180) (- 90 line_angle))))
51   #{
52     \tweak direction #up
53     \tweak style #'line
54     \tweak thickness #1
55     \tweak to-barline ##t
56     \tweak rotation #(list (* -1 line_angle) 1 0 )
57
58     \tweak bound-details.left.stencil #ly:text-interface::print

```

```

59     \tweak bound-details.left.text \markup \postscript
60     #(string-append
61       "gsave
62 newpath
63 0 0 moveto "
64       (number->string x_value) " "
65       (number->string (* -1 y_value))
66       " rlineto
67 stroke
68 grestore")
69     \tweak bound-details.left-broken.stencil #ly:text-interface::print
70     \tweak bound-details.left-broken.text ##f
71
72     \tweak bound-details.right.stencil #ly:text-interface::print
73     \tweak bound-details.right.text \markup \postscript
74     "newpath
75 0 0 moveto
76 -1 -0.3 rlineto
77 stroke"
78     \tweak bound-details.right-broken.stencil #ly:text-interface::print
79     \tweak bound-details.right-broken.text ##f
80     \tweak font-shape #'upright
81     \tweak bound-details.left.padding #0
82     \tweak bound-details.right.padding #0
83     \tweak breakable ##t
84     \tweak after-line-breaking ##t
85     \startTextSpan
86     #})
87
88
89 graceNoteBeforeBeatOn =
90 #(define-music-function (starting_note) (ly:music?)
91   #{
92     \once \override TextSpanner.style = #'line
93     \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.left.text =
94     \markup { \draw-line #'(0 . -1) }
95     \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.right.text =
96     \markup {
97       \postscript
98       "newpath 0 0 moveto
99 0 -2.5 rlineto
100 stroke
101 newpath
102 -0.275 -2 moveto
103 0.275 -0.75 rlineto
104 0.275 0.75 rlineto
105 -0.275 -0.2 rlineto
106 closepath

```

```

107 fill"
108   }
109   \once \override TextSpanner.Y-offset = #5
110   \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.left.padding = #0.5
111   \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.right.padding = #-0.25
112   #starting_note
113   \startTextSpan
114   #})
115
116
117 graceNoteBeforeBeatOff =
118 #(define-music-function (ending_note) (ly:music?)
119   #{
120     #ending_note
121     \stopTextSpan
122     #})
123
124
125 graceNoteAfterBeatOn =
126 #(define-music-function (starting_note) (ly:music?)
127   #{
128     \once \override TextSpanner.style = #'line
129     \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.right.text =
130     \markup {
131       \combine \draw-line #'(0 . -1)
132       \postscript "newpath
133 0 -1 moveto
134 0 -1 rlineto
135 stroke"
136     }
137     \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.left.text =
138     \markup {
139       \postscript
140       "newpath 0 0 moveto
141 0 -1 rlineto
142 stroke
143 newpath
144 -0.275 -0.75 moveto
145 0.275 -0.75 rlineto
146 0.275 0.75 rlineto
147 -0.275 -0.2 rlineto
148 closepath
149 fill"
150   }
151   \once \override TextSpanner.Y-offset = #2
152   \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.left.padding = #0.5
153   \once \override TextSpanner.bound-details.right.padding = #-0.25
154

```

```

155     #starting_note
156     \startTextSpan
157   #})
158
159
160   graceNoteAfterBeatOff =
161   #(define-music-function (ending_note) (ly:music?)
162     #{
163       #ending_note
164       \stopTextSpan
165     #})
166
167   %%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%LSR SNIPPET START%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%%
168
169   #(define (degrees->radians deg)
170     (* PI (/ deg 180.0)))
171
172
173   slash =
174   #(define-music-function (ang stem-fraction protrusion)
175     (number? number? number?)
176     (remove-grace-property 'Voice 'Stem 'direction)
177     #{
178       \once \override Stem.stencil =
179       #(lambda (grob)
180         (let* ((x-parent (ly:grob-parent grob X))
181                (is-rest? (ly:grob?
182                             (ly:grob-object x-parent 'rest)))
183                (beam (ly:grob-object grob 'beam))
184                (stil (ly:stem::print grob)))
185           (cond
186             (is-rest? empty-stencil)
187             ((ly:grob? beam)
188              (let* ((refp (ly:grob-system grob))
189                     (stem-y-ext (ly:grob-extent grob grob Y))
190                     (stem-length
191                      (- (cdr stem-y-ext) (car stem-y-ext)))
192                     (beam-X-pos (ly:grob-property beam 'X-positions))
193                     (beam-Y-pos (ly:grob-property beam 'positions))
194                     (beam-slope (/ (- (cdr beam-Y-pos) (car beam-Y-pos))
195                                    (- (cdr beam-X-pos) (car beam-X-pos))))
196                     (beam-angle (atan beam-slope))
197                     (dir (ly:grob-property grob 'direction))
198                     (line-dy (* stem-length stem-fraction))
199                     (line-dy-with-protrusions (if (= dir 1)
200                                                    (+ (* 4 protrusion) beam-angle)
201                                                    (- (* 4 protrusion) beam-angle))))
202             (ang (if (> beam-slope 0)

```



```

203             (if (= dir 1)
204                 (+ (degrees->radians ang) (* beam-angle 0.7))
205                 (degrees->radians ang))
206             (if (= dir 1)
207                 (degrees->radians ang)
208                 (- (degrees->radians ang) (* beam-angle 0.7))))))
209         (line-dx (/ line-dy-with-protrusions (tan ang)))
210         (protrusion-dx (/ protrusion (tan ang)))
211         (corr (if (= dir 1) (car stem-y-ext) (cdr stem-y-ext))))
212     (ly:stencil-add
213       stil
214       (grob-interpret-markup grob
215         (markup
216           #:translate
217           (cons (- protrusion-dx)
218             (+ corr
219               (* dir
220                 (- stem-length
221                   (+ stem-fraction protrusion))))))
222           #:override '(thickness . 1.7)
223           #:draw-line
224           (cons line-dx
225             (* dir line-dy-with-protrusions))))))
226     (else stil))))
227   #})
228
229   startSlashedGraceMusic = {
230     \slash 40 1 0.5
231     \override Flag.stroke-style = #"grace"
232   }
233   stopSlashedGraceMusic = {
234     \revert Flag.stroke-style
235   }
236
237   startAcciaccaturaMusic = {
238     \slash 40 1 0.5
239     s1*0(
240     \override Flag.stroke-style = #"grace"
241   }
242   stopAcciaccaturaMusic = {
243     \revert Flag.stroke-style
244     s1*0)
245   }
246   %%%%%%%%%%%%%%% LSR SNIPPET END %%%%%%%%%%%%%%%
247
248   %%%%%%%%%%%%%%% A %%%%%%%%%%%%%%%
249
250   \score {

```

```

251
252 \new Staff = "allElementsCombined"
253 \with {instrumentName = \markup {\fontsize #4 \box "A"}} {
254   \numericTimeSignature
255   \override Score.MetronomeMark.Y-offset = #5.75
256   \tempo 4 = 100
257   \time 5/4
258
259   <<
260   {
261     \tieNeutral \stemNeutral
262     d'4~
263     \tuplet 3/2 {d'8 d'4}
264     \stemUp \grace {
265       \startSlashedGraceMusic \graceNoteBeforeBeatOn e'8 f'
266       \stopSlashedGraceMusic
267     } \graceNoteBeforeBeatOff g'4~
268     \stemNeutral g'8.[ \grace {
269       \startSlashedGraceMusic \graceNoteAfterBeatOn
270       e''16 c'' e' c' \stopSlashedGraceMusic
271     }
272     \graceNoteAfterBeatOff d''16]~
273     \tuplet 3/2 {d''8 d'8 d'8~} |
274     \time 4/4
275     d'1 \bar"||"
276   }
277   \\\
278   {
279     s4 \tuplet 3/2 {
280       s8 \override Voice.TextSpanner.Y-offset = #6.5
281       s4~\markup {\translate #'(0 . 6.5) \bold "rall."}
282       \rallArrow #4
283     } s2. \tempo 4 = 50 s4*4 \stopTextSpan
284   }
285   >>
286 }
287 }
288 %%%%%%%%% B %%%%%%%%%
289 \score {
290   <<
291   \new Staff = "tempoLine" \with {
292     \remove Clef_engraver
293     \remove Staff_symbol_engraver
294     \remove Time_signature_engraver
295   }
296   {
297     \numericTimeSignature
298     \override Score.MetronomeMark.Y-offset = #6

```

```

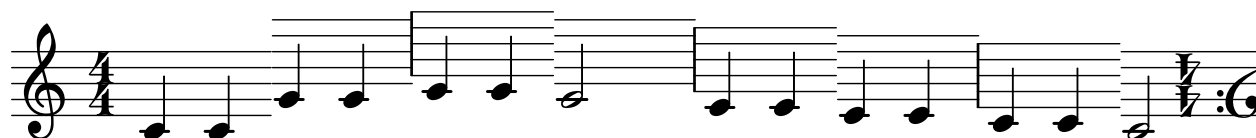
299     \tempo 4 = 100
300     \time 5/4
301     s4 \tuplet 3/2 {
302         s8 \override Voice.TextSpanner.Y-offset = #-2.25
303         s4^\markup {\translate #'(0 . 0) \bold "rall."}
304         \rallArrow #4
305     } s2 \after 64*15 \stopTextSpan s8*2 |
306     \tempo 4 = 50   s4*4
307 }
308
309 \new Staff = "music"
310 \with { instrumentName = \markup {\fontsize #4 \box "B"}}
311 {
312     \tieNeutral \stemNeutral
313     d'4~
314     \tuplet 3/2 {d'8 d'4}
315     \grace {
316         \startSlashedGraceMusic \graceNoteBeforeBeatOn e'8 f'
317         \stopSlashedGraceMusic
318     } \graceNoteBeforeBeatOff g'4~
319     g'8.[ \grace {
320         \startSlashedGraceMusic \graceNoteAfterBeatOn
321         e''16 c' e' c' \stopSlashedGraceMusic
322     }
323     \graceNoteAfterBeatOff d''16]~
324     \tuplet 3/2 {d''8 d'8 d'8~} |
325     \time 4/4
326     d'1 \bar"||"
327 }
328 >>
329 }
330

```

[Table of Contents](#)

Miscellanies

13.1 Shifting Staves, Rotated Clef and Time Signature



Staff lines that are shifted so that, when the note moves away from the middle C, the staff lines move accordingly. The excerpt ends with a time signature and a clef that are rotated 180 degrees.

```

1 \version "2.26.0"
2
3 staone = {
4   \stopStaff
5   \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions =
6   #'(0 2 4 6 8)
7   \startStaff
8 }
9
10 statwo = {
11   \stopStaff
12   \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions =
13   #'(1 3 5 7 9)
14   \startStaff
15 }
16
17 stathree = {
18   \stopStaff
19   \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions =
20   #'(2 4 6 8 10)
21   \startStaff
22 }

```

```

17 \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions =
18 #'(-1 1 3 5 7)
19 \startStaff
20 }
21 stafour = {
22 \stopStaff
23 \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions =
24 #'(-2 0 2 4 6)
25 \startStaff
26 }
27 stafive = {
28 \stopStaff
29 \override Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions =
30 #'(-3 -1 1 3 5)
31 \startStaff
32 }
33 stanorm = {
34 \stopStaff
35 \revert Staff.StaffSymbol.line-positions
36 \startStaff
37 }
38 {
39 \numericTimeSignature
40 \time 4/4
41
42 c'4 c' \staone g' g' \statwo a' a' \staone g'2
43 \stathree f'4 f' \stafour e' e' \stafive d' d' \stanorm
44 \override TextScript.outside-staff-priority = ##f
45 \once \override TextScript.extra-offset = #'(0 . -4.5)
46 c'2 ^\markup \concat {
47 {
48 \hspace #3 \rotate #180
49 {\compound-meter #'(4 4)}
50 }
51 {
52 \translate-scaled #'(1 . 0.5)
53 \rotate #180 \musicglyph "clefs.F"
54 }
55 }
56 \bar ""
57
58 }
59
60 \layout {
61 \context{
62 \Score proportionalNotationDuration = #1/7
63 }
64 }

```

65

66

67

Table of Contents

Chapter 14

Exploring Scheme

14.1 Introduction

Scheme, one of the dialects of the Lisp family of programming languages, is used in LilyPond as its extension language. Scheme allows LilyPond users to explore the inner workings of the program, enabling significant customization. The snippets in this document would not exist without taking advantage of it.¹

However, learning Scheme can be daunting. In his unfinished book on Scheme and LilyPond, Urs Liska refers to its "thorny path."² While I have experience with Common Lisp (another Lisp dialect) from my work with OpenMusic, adjusting to Scheme's grammatical nuances still took some time.

This chapter does not aim to be a comprehensive guide to using Scheme in LilyPond.³ Instead, it offers suggestions for newcomers to familiarize themselves with Scheme.

14.1.1 Step 1a: Focus on the Scheme Language Itself

Scheme is a language distinct from LilyPond, and understanding this distinction is essential. For simpler LilyPond tasks, Scheme may not be necessary. However, when working with internal parameters, Scheme allows deeper customization. It is beneficial to first study Scheme independently, learning its syntax and concepts by writing simple code.

14.1.2 Step 1b: Get Used to Prefix Notation

Scheme, like its Lisp relatives, uses prefix notation (Cambridge Polish Notation). Here are examples:

```
(+ 12 34)
>> This expression results in the value of 46.
```

1. For newcomers: parts of LilyPond code written in Scheme are often enclosed in `#(` and `)`. Numerical values preceded by `#`, and number pairs such as `\#' (1 . -2)`, are also part of the Scheme language.

2. Urs Liska, *Understanding Scheme In LilyPond*, vol. 2024, December 19 (2020), Web Page, <https://scheme-book.readthedocs.io/en/latest/>.

3. For a deeper dive, refer to the resource by Liska, as well as Jean Abou Samra, *Extending LilyPond*, vol. 2024, December 19 (2021), Web Page, <https://extending-lilypond.gitlab.io/en/index.html>. LilyPond also provides its own Extending Manual: <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/extending/index>

```
(+ 4 (* 3 9))
```

```
>> This expression first resolves the multiplication: (+ 4 27), which is 31.
```

If you are new to this, I recommend starting with Daniel P. Friedman and Matthias Felleisen, *The little Schemer (4th ed.)* (Cambridge, MA, USA: MIT Press, 1996), ISBN: 0262560992. While you might be eager to dive into using Scheme in LilyPond, learning Scheme as a programming language will make the process smoother.⁴

14.1.3 Step 2: Study Lots of Snippets

Once familiar with Scheme, study how it integrates with LilyPond by reviewing snippets from LSR. Start with shorter examples and analyze their structure. Here is an example snippet for adding the *Schleifer* ornament:⁵ The corresponding code:⁶



Figure 14.1: LSR No. 1185: *Schleifer* Ornament.

```

1 % Implementation by Martin Straeten of the Schleifer ornament
2 % as used by Johann Sebastian Bach, contributed to the user
3 % mailing list. In this case, it functions like a set of (always?)
4 % two grace notes, hence using a modified grace note to represent
5 % it in LilyPond makes sense.
6 %
7 % Code styling and user interface by Simon Albrecht 2024.
8
9 schleiferMarkup = \markup {
10   \large \halign #.2 \raise #0.0
11   \combine
12   \halign #.8 \musicglyph "scripts.prall"
13   \rotate #140 \normalsize \raise #2.4 \musicglyph "flags.u3"
14 }
15 schleiferGrace =
16 #(define-music-function (note) (ly:music?)
17   #{
18     \grace {
19       \once\override NoteHead.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
20       \once\override NoteHead.X-extent = #'(-2 . -0)
21       \once\override NoteHead.text = \schleiferMarkup
22       \once\omit Stem
23       \once\omit Flag

```

4. Liska and Samra's resources serve as excellent refreshers later on.

5. <https://lsr.di.unimi.it/LSR/Item?id=1185>

6. The mailing list thread referenced in the preamble is available at <https://lists.gnu.org/archive/html/lilypond-user/2021-09/msg00352.html>


```

24         $note
25     }
26     #})
27
28 \relative {
29     \time 3/8
30     \partial 8
31     \clef bass
32     \key c \minor
33     g8
34     \schleiferGrace c es8. d16 c8
35     c4
36 }
37 \addlyrics {
38     Ich ha -- be ge -- nug
39 }

```

The `\schleiferGrace` variable creates a customized ornament using Scheme’s `define-music-function` macro. For a deeper understanding of the macro syntax, refer to the *LilyPond – Internals Reference*.⁷

Taking the variable `\schleiferGrace`, we see that invoking it creates an instance of activating a Scheme function that starts at Line 16. `define-music-function` is a macro that allows you to create a function that operates on LilyPond.

According to *LilyPond – Internals Reference*, the syntax for `define-music-function` is:

```

(define-music-function (arg1 arg2 ...)
  (type1? type2? ...)
  function-body)

```

In the code, the argument’s name is `note`, and it is tested according to the type specified in `type1?`, which in this case is `ly:music?`. According to the *Internal Reference*, `ly:music?` is a function that checks whether the object—in this case, `note`—is a `Music` object. Thus, it becomes clear that this function will not work unless it is followed by a musical note.

From Line 17 to Line 26, we see that a LilyPond code snippet has been inserted, as `#{` and `#}` signify the boundary of the LilyPond code within the Scheme code. This means that as part of invoking the variable `\schleiferGrace`, it passes through this LilyPond fragment, which is responsible for creating a grace note. Here, the notehead of the grace note is replaced with `\schleiferMarkup`, which is defined in Lines 9 to 14 of the code.⁸

Lines 22 and 23 show that the stem and flag are omitted from the grace note, while Line 24’s `$note` signifies that the original argument `note` is called upon.⁹ In this way, the *Schleifer* ornament is

7. <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/internals/scheme-functions>

8. The technique of sequential overrides, invoking the Scheme command `#ly:text-interface::print`, sets the `.stencil` of the notehead to use whatever is defined in the `.text` parameter. This technique is frequently used and is very useful in customizing notation. See also: <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/notation/modifying-stencils>.

9. Refer to this page for the difference between `#` and `$`: <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/extending/lilypond-scheme-syntax>

created from a note that follows the variable `\schleiferGrace`. This note is transformed into a grace note with a customized stencil setting, all done within the Scheme code.

14.1.4 Step 3: Hack the Codes

Once you study a code and become familiar with how it operates, experimenting with the code by hacking is a good way to deepen your understanding. Below, I give one example using the preceding *Schleifer* ornament snippet.

The *LilyPond – Internal Reference* reveals that the object `NoteHead` has its own standard settings, as well as support for about a dozen other interfaces.¹⁰ One of them is the `grob-interface`, which makes it possible to change the color of a graphical object, or *Grob*.¹¹ Further reading in the *LilyPond – Notation Reference* shows that it is possible to override the color of an object.¹² Let us now tweak the *Schleifer* ornament code to allow us to change the ornament's color.

Following the reference, add the following line underneath `\once\override NoteHead.X-extent`:

```
\once\override NoteHead.color = #red
```

Running LilyPond now should produce the following result: Hard-coding a change like this may



Figure 14.2: LSR No. 1185: *Schleifer* Ornament in red.

be good for testing the waters, but we may want the *Schleifer* ornament in more than just one color. The beauty of extending LilyPond is that we can customize the Scheme code to allow for this flexibility.

Let us move on. We should now let the `define-music-function` know that we are adding an additional argument to specify the color. The first part of the code will look like this:

```
#(define-music-function (note schleiferColor) (ly:music? color?)
```

This adds the argument `schleiferColor`, which only accepts color, as indicated by the corresponding test function `color?`.

Then, implement this argument in the sequence of `\once\override` processes. The line `NoteHead.color` can now be changed to:

```
\once\override NoteHead.color = #schleiferColor
```

Now, the variable `\schleiferGrace` requires one more argument to specify the ornament's color. The entire code should look like this:

```
1 schleiferMarkup = \markup {
2   \large \halign #.2 \raise #0.0
3   \combine
4   \halign #.8 \musicglyph "scripts.prall"
```

10. <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/internals/notehead>

11. https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/internals/grob_002dinterface

12. <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/notation/inside-the-staff#coloring-objects>

```

5   \rotate #140 \normalsize \raise #2.4 \musicglyph "flags.u3"
6   }
7
8   schleiferGrace =
9   #(define-music-function (note schleiferColor) (ly:music? color?)
10     #{
11       \grace {
12         \once\override NoteHead.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
13         \once\override NoteHead.X-extent = #'(-2 . 0)
14         \once\override NoteHead.color = #schleiferColor
15         \once\override NoteHead.text = \schleiferMarkup
16         \once\omit Stem
17         \once\omit Flag
18         $note
19       }
20     #})
21   \relative {
22     \time 3/8
23     \partial 8
24     \clef bass
25     \key c \minor
26     g8
27     \schleiferGrace c #green es8. d16 c8
28     c4
29   }
30   \addlyrics {
31     Ich ha -- be ge -- nug
32   }

```

This produces the following output:



Figure 14.3: LSR No. 1185: *Schleifer* Ornament in green.

Notice that on Line 27, `#green` has been added. You can change this to any of the colors listed under "Normal Colors" in the *Notation Reference*,¹³ such as `#'"lightsalmon"`, `#(x11-color "medium turquoise")`, or even `#'"#5e45ad"`.

As an exercise, try replicating the following excerpt:¹⁴



Figure 14.4: Can you replicate this?

[Table of Contents](#)

13. <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/notation/list-of-colors>

14. See [LSR1185e3.ly](https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/notation/list-of-colors) for the answer.

14.2 Example 1: Creating a Time Signature with Its Compound Meter Form

On January 1, 2025, I came across a post by an anonymous user on Facebook.¹⁵ The post asked if it would be possible to create a time signature that had its beat structure expressed in the form of a compound meter. Something like this:



Figure 14.5: What the anonymous user wanted to achieve.

I responded to the post with relevant email threads on `lilypond-user` mailing list. I commented that it would be possible to override `TimeSignature.stencil` with custom-made time signatures. Incidentally, I was making a series of [Fractional Time Signatures](#), which used this method.

The code for the aforementioned example is as follows:

```
1 \version "2.24.4"
2
3 {
4   \clef "G"
5   \time 9/8
6   \set beatStructure = #'(2 2 2 3)
7   \once \override Timing.TimeSignature.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
8   \once \override Timing.TimeSignature.text = \markup
9   {
10    \override #'(baseline-skip . 0)
11    \center-column \number {9 8}
12    \center-column {\fontsize #6 \musicglyph "accidentals.leftparen"}
13    \hspace #-0.75
14    \override #'(baseline-skip . 0)
15    \center-column \number {{2+2+2+3} 8}
16    \hspace #-0.75
17    \center-column {\fontsize #6 \musicglyph "accidentals.rightparen"}
18    \hspace #-1
19  }
20  \repeat unfold 9 {<e' g'>8 }
21 }
```

I realized that, while this might be an acceptable method if such time signatures appeared only once or twice in a piece, it may become problematic if I had to copy and paste this code every time I have such a time signature. Normally this could easily be resolved by making a variable out of `\override` clauses; however, a piece of music may use time signatures of this form in different configurations, just as the following example:

The code:

```
1 \version "2.24.4"
```

15. <https://www.facebook.com/groups/gnulilypond/posts/10162467719483529/>



Figure 14.6: More compound meters.

```

2
3 {
4   \clef "G"
5   \time 9/8
6   \set beatStructure = #'(2 2 2 3)
7   \once \override Timing.TimeSignature.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
8   \once \override Timing.TimeSignature.text = \markup
9   {
10    \override #'(baseline-skip . 0)
11    \center-column \number {9 8}
12    \center-column {\fontsize #6 \musicglyph "accidentals.leftparen"}
13    \hspace #-0.75
14    \override #'(baseline-skip . 0)
15    \center-column \number {{2+2+2+3} 8}
16    \hspace #-0.75
17    \center-column {\fontsize #6 \musicglyph "accidentals.rightparen"}
18    \hspace #-1
19  }
20  \repeat unfold 9 {<e' g'>8}
21
22  \time 11/8
23  \set beatStructure = #'(2 2 2 3 2)
24  \once \override Timing.TimeSignature.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
25  \once \override Timing.TimeSignature.text = \markup
26  {
27    \override #'(baseline-skip . 0)
28    \center-column \number {11 8}
29    \center-column {\fontsize #6 \musicglyph "accidentals.leftparen"}
30    \hspace #-0.75
31    \override #'(baseline-skip . 0)
32    \center-column \number {{2+2+2+3+2} 8}
33    \hspace #-0.75
34    \center-column {\fontsize #6 \musicglyph "accidentals.rightparen"}
35    \hspace #-1
36  }
37  \repeat unfold 11 {<e' g'>8 }
38
39  \time 7/8
40  \set beatStructure = #'(2 3 2)
41  \once \override Timing.TimeSignature.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
42  \once \override Timing.TimeSignature.text = \markup

```

```

43 {
44   \override #'(baseline-skip . 0)
45   \center-column \number {7 8}
46   \center-column {\fontsize #6 \musicglyph "accidentals.leftparen"}
47   \hspace #-0.75
48   \override #'(baseline-skip . 0)
49   \center-column \number {{2+3+2} 8}
50   \hspace #-0.75
51   \center-column {\fontsize #6 \musicglyph "accidentals.rightparen"}
52   \hspace #-1
53 }
54 \repeat unfold 7 {<e' g'>8 }
55
56 }

```

Writing as long of a code as this (for just three measures!) would be cumbersome, indeed. What could help is to come up with a music function, using the Scheme.

14.2.1 Step 1: Analyze What Could Be Automatized

I quote the code for the first example of this section again. This time, however, I turn the variables that could change each time I create an instance of this kind of time signature, into **red**:

```

1  \version "2.24.4"
2
3  {
4    \clef "G"
5    \time 9/8
6    \set beatStructure = #'(2 2 2 3)
7    \once \override Timing.TimeSignature.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
8    \once \override Timing.TimeSignature.text = \markup
9    {
10     \override #'(baseline-skip . 0)
11     \center-column \number {9 8}
12     \center-column {\fontsize #6 \musicglyph "accidentals.leftparen"}
13     \hspace #-0.75
14     \override #'(baseline-skip . 0)
15     \center-column \number {{2+2+2+3}{8}}
16     \hspace #-0.75
17     \center-column {\fontsize #6 \musicglyph "accidentals.rightparen"}
18     \hspace #-1
19   }
20   \repeat unfold 9 {<e' g'>8 }
21 }

```

14.2.2 Step 2: Write the Code

It would be good if this function could accept the following as arguments:

- Time signature of the measure as defined normally in the LilyPond function `\time`. For this, I will set `timesig` as the name of the argument, that tests its value with `fraction?`.
- The customized stencil of the time signature. I need to declare how it looks, namely:
 - Overall time signature;
 - Numerator portion of the compound meter, and;
 - Denominator portion of the compound meter.

It should look similar to how the LilyPond function `\compoundMeter` that accepts a list of lists. For this, I will set `beatstruct` as the name of the argument, that tests its value with `list?`.

I will now build the rest of the function. Notice the way the Scheme code references various locations of a list, using `car`, `cadr`, and so on:

```

1  \version "2.24.4"
2
3  compoundTimeWithBeatStructure =
4  #(define-music-function (timesig beatstruct) (fraction? list?)
5    #{
6      \time #timesig
7      \set beatStructure = #(cadr beatstruct)
8      \once \override Timing.TimeSignature.stencil = #ly:text-interface::print
9      \once \override Timing.TimeSignature.text = \markup
10     {
11       \override #'(baseline-skip . 0)
12       \center-column \number
13       {
14         #(number->string (car (car beatstruct)))
15         #(number->string (cadr (car beatstruct)))
16       }
17       \center-column {\fontsize #6 \musicglyph "accidentals.leftparen"}
18       \hspace #-0.75
19       \override #'(baseline-skip . 0)
20       \center-column \number
21       {
22         {#(string-join (map number->string (cadr beatstruct)) "+")}
23         #(number->string (car (caddr beatstruct)))
24       }
25       \hspace #-0.75
26       \center-column {\fontsize #6 \musicglyph "accidentals.rightparen"}
27       \hspace #-1
28     }
29   #}
30
31 )
32
33 {

```



```

34 \compoundTimeWithBeatStructure 9/8 #'((9 8)(2 2 2 3)(8))
35 \repeat unfold 9 {<e' g'>8}
36 \compoundTimeWithBeatStructure 11/8 #'((11 8)(2 2 2 3 2)(8))
37 \repeat unfold 11 {<e' g'>8}
38 \compoundTimeWithBeatStructure 7/8 #'((7 8)(2 3 2)(8))
39 \repeat unfold 7 {<e' g'>8}
40 }

```

Thus, there is now a function called `\compoundTimeWithBeatStructure`, whose grammar is:

```

\compoundTimeWithBeatStructure
    TIME_SIGNATURE #'((TIME_SIGNATURE)(BEAT_STRUCTURE)(DENOMINATOR))

```

Running the code will result in the identical snippet as [the previous figure](#):

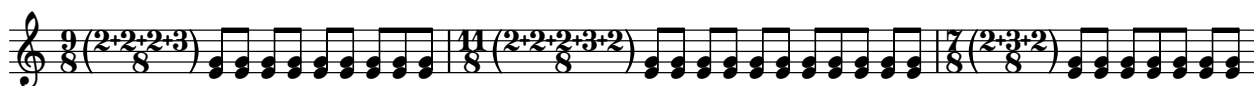


Figure 14.7: The same result as before with a shorter code.

[Table of Contents](#)

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Appendices

Appendix A: Resources

As I taught LilyPond in a special topic course at the University of Delaware in Fall 2024, I compiled a list of links to useful websites and pages. It is in no way intended as a comprehensive list; instead, I list some essential pages that I have frequently looked up and found very useful. This page is subject to frequent revision.

On LilyPond

- Website: <https://lilypond.org/>
- Installing: <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/learning/installing>
- Manuals: <https://lilypond.org/manuals.html>

Text Editor for LilyPond

- Frescobaldi (Editor): <https://frescobaldi.org/>

Coding LilyPond

- Cheat Sheet: <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/notation/cheat-sheet>
- Snippets: <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/web/snippets>
- LilyPond Snippet Repository: <https://lsr.di.unimi.it/>

Mailing List

- Mailing list: <https://lists.gnu.org/mailman/listinfo/lilypond-user>
- Archives 1 <https://lists.gnu.org/archive/html/lilypond-user/>
- Archives 2 <https://www.mail-archive.com/lilypond-user@gnu.org/>

Advanced Topic on LilyPond

- LilyPond – Extending v2.24.4: <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.24/Documentation/extending/index#top>
- Scheme (in LilyPond): <https://scheme-book.readthedocs.io/en/latest/>
- Extending LilyPond: <https://extending-lilypond.gitlab.io/en/extending/index.html>
- Scheme Resources <https://www.gnu.org/software/guile/learn/#scheme-resources>
- PostScript Manual: <https://www.adobe.com/jp/print/postscript/pdfs/PLRM.pdf>
- PostScript Tutorial: <https://paulbourke.net/dataformats/postscript/>

Troubleshooting

- [The default text font for LilyPond doesn't seem to work \(Mac\)](#)
- [Frescobaldi freezes upon loading](#)

Miscellaneous Items

- About Emmentaler font: <https://lilypond.org/doc/v2.25/Documentation/notation/the-emmentaler-font>

[Table of Contents](#)